

His Divine Grace

swami

Founder-Acarya of the International

His Divine Grace

A.C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Pnibhupada

Plate 1 Just to protect the progeny of the Kuru dynasty, Sri Kṛṣṇa covered the embryo of Uttara by His personal energy. (p. 388)

Plate 2 Queen Kunti addressed Lord Kṛṣṇa as He started for home. (p. 390)

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Srimad-Bhagavatam

ALL GLORY TO 5Rl GURU AND GAURANGA

Srlmad-Bhagavatam

of

K□SNA-DVAIPAYANA VYAsA

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yasya rO.fl.fre prajiifl. saroiis

trasyante siidhvy asiidhubhifl.

tasya mattasya nl1Syanti

kirtir iiyur bhago gatifl.

e□a riijiiirh paro dharmo

hy iirtiiniim iirti-nigrahafl.

ata enarh vadhi□yiimi

bhiita-druham assattamam (p. 888)

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First Canto

"Creation"

<Part Three-Chapters 13-19>

With the Original Sanskrit Text,
Its Roman Transliteration, Synonyms,
Translation and Elaborate Purports by
His Divine Grace

A.C. Bhaktivedanta swami Prabhupada

Founder-Acarya of the International Society for Krishna Consciousness

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International Society for Krishna Consciousness

3764 Watseka Ave.

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The Bhaktivedanta Book Trust

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CHAPTER THIRTEEN

Dhrtarastra Quits Home

TEXT I

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..-n □I.

\II□I•II(IMwt□(ij□li418□fitfffl□t: II □ II

siita uviica

viduras tTrtha-yiitriiyiim

maitreyiid itmano gatim

jiiitviigiidd hiistina-purom

tayiiipta vivitsitafr

sri siitafr uviica-Sri Siita Gosvam¹ said; vidurafr-Vidura; tirtha

yiitriiyiim-while traveling to different places of pilgrimage; maitreyiit

from the great sage Maitreya; itmanafr-of the self; gatim-destination;

jiiitvii-by knowing it; i.igiit- went back; hiistina-purom-the city of

Hastinapura; taya-by that knowledge; aviipta-sufficiently gainer; vivitsitafr

-being well versed in everything knowable.

TRANSLATION

Sri Siita Gosvami said: While traveling on a pilgrimage, Vidura received knowledge of the destination of the self from the great sage Maitreya and then returned to Hastinapura. He became as well versed in the subject as he desired.

PURPORT

Vidura: One of the prominent figures in the history of the Mahabharata. He was conceived by Vyasadeva in the womb of the maidservant of Am-
661

662 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 13

bika, mother of Maharaja Parashu. He is the incarnation of Yamaraja. Being cursed by Marichukunda Muni, he was to become a sudra. The story is narrated as follows. Once upon a time the state police caught some thieves who concealed themselves in the hermitage of Marichukunda Muni. The police constables, as usual, arrested all the thieves and Marichukunda Muni along with them. The Magistrate specifically punished the muni to death by being pierced with a lance. When he was just to be pierced, the news reached the king, and he at once stopped the act on consideration of his being a great muni. The king personally begged the muni's pardon for the mistake of his men, and the saint at once went to Yamaraja, who prescribes the destiny of living beings. Yamaraja, being questioned by the muni, replied that the muni in his childhood pierced an ant with a sharpened straw, and for that reason he was put into difficulty. The muni thought it unwise on the part of Yamaraja that he was punished for his childish innocence, and thus the muni cursed yamaraja to become a sudra, and this sudra incarnation of Yamaraja was known as Vidura, the sudra brother of Dhritarashtra and Maharaja Pandu. But this sudra son of the Kuru dynasty was equally treated by Bhishmadeva, along with his other nephews, and in due course Vidura was married with a girl who was also born in the womb of a sudra. By a Brahmarshi. Although Vidura did not inherit the property of his father (the brother of Bhishmadeva), still he was given sufficient state property by Dhritarashtra, the elder brother of Vidura. Vidura was very much attached to his elder brother, and all along he tried to guide him in the

right path. During the fratricidal war of Kurukṣetra, Vidura repeatedly implored his elder brother to do justice to the sons of Pandu, but Duryodhana did not like such interference by his uncle, and thus he practically insulted Vidura. This resulted in Vidura's leaving home for pilgrimage and taking instructions from Maitreya.

TEXT2

qmr: iḥ U 31 41<t41'1tt: I

ii1MctiYtRtiin i q((l+t II II

yiivata krtaviin prasniin

kattii kau iiraviigrata

jiitaika-bhaktir govinde

tebhya coparariima ha

yiivata-all that; krtaviin-did he put; prasniin-questions ; kattii-a

name of Vidura; kau iirava -a name of Maitreya; agrata-in the presence

Text 2] Dhṛtarāṣṭra Quits Home 663

of; jata-having grown up; eka-one; bhakti-transcendental loving

service; govinde-unto Lord Kṛṣṇa; tebhya-regarding further questions;

ca-and; upararama-retired from; ha-in the past.

TRANSLATION

After asking various questions and becoming established in the transcendental loving service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Vidura retired from putting questions to Maitreya Muni.

PURPORT

Vidura retired from putting questions before Maitreya Muni when he was convinced by Maitreya that the summum bonum of life is to be finally situated in the transcendental loving service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, who is Govinda or one who satisfies His devotees in all respects. The conditioned soul or living being in material existence seeks happiness by employing his senses in the modes of materialism, but that cannot give him satisfaction. He then searches after the Supreme Truth by the empiric philosophical speculative method and intellectual feats. But if he does not find the ultimate goal, he again goes down to material activities and engages himself in

various philanthropic and altruistic works, which all fail to give him satisfaction. So neither fruitive activities nor dry philosophical speculation can give one satisfaction because by nature a living being is the eternal servitor of the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and all the Vedic literatures give him direction towards that ultimate end. The Bhagavad-gītā confirms this statement (Bg.15.15).

Like Vidura, an inquisitive conditioned soul must approach a bona fide spiritual master like Maitreya and by intelligent inquiries must try to know everything about karma (fruitive activities), jñāna (philosophical research for the Supreme Truth) and yoga (the linking process of spiritual realization). One who is not seriously inclined to put questions before a spiritual master need not accommodate a show bottle spiritual master, nor should a person who may be a spiritual master for others pose to be so if he is unable to engage his disciple ultimately in the transcendental loving service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. Vidura was successful in approaching a spiritual master like Maitreya, and he got the ultimate goal of life: bhakti unto Govinda. Thus there was nothing to be known further about spiritual progress.

664 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 13]

TEXTS 3-4

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t6(ift ṁṁ wr: ṁ: 'P-IT II ṁ II

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ac;q•ṁṁ: ṁṁ:«ṁ:fṁ:mm

tam bandhum ii.gatarh drṣṭvii

dharma-putraṁ sahii.nujaṁ

dhrtariiṣtro yuyutsus ca

siitaṁ sii.radvataṁ prthii.

gii.ndhii.n draupadl brahman

subhadra cottarii. krp"i

anyii.S ca jii.mayaṁ pii.r-!Jor

jnii.tayaṁ sasutii.ṁ striyaṁ

tam-him; bandhum-relative; iigatam-having arrived there; drṣṭvii-by

seeing it; dharma-putra□ - Yudhi□□hira; sahii anuja[l-along with his younger brothers; dhrtarii\$tra□-Dhrtara□□ra; yuyutsu□-Satyaki; ca-and; siita□ Saiijaya; sii.radvata□-Krpacarya; prthii.-Kunti; gii.ndhii.rl:-Gandhari; draupadl- Draupadi; brahman-o brie.hmar-as; subhadrii-Subhadra; ca and; uttarii-Uttara; krpi-Krpi; anyii□-others; ca-and;jiimayaft-wives of other family members; pii.r-!Jo□-of the Pal)<).avas;jnii.taya□-family members; sasutiift-along with their sons; striya□-the ladies.

TRANSLATION

When they saw Vidura return to the palace, all the inhabitants, Maharaja Yu<lhi!}thira, his younger brothers, Dhrtar□tra, Satyaki, Saiijaya, 1\ .rpacarya, Kunti, Gandhari, Draupadi, Subhadra, Uttara, 1\ .rpi, and many others, who were wives of the Kauravas, and other ladies with children, all hurried to him in great delight. It so appeared that they had regained their consciousness after a long period.

PURPORT

Giindhiiri: The ideal chaste lady in the history of the world. She was the daughter of Maharaja Subala, the King of Gandhara (now Kanda□ar in Kabul), and in her maiden state she worshiped Lord Siva. Lord Siva is worshiped generally by the Hindu maidens to get a good husband.

Texts 3-4] Dhftara□tra Quits Home 665

Gandhari satisfied Lord Siva, and by his benediction to obtain one hundred sons, she was betrothed to Dhrtara□tra, despite his being blind forever. When Gandhari came to know that her would-be husband was a blind man, to follow her life companion she decided to become voluntarily blind. So she wrapped up her eyes with many silk linens, and she was married to Dhftara□tra under the guidance of her elder brother Sakuni. She was the most beautiful girl of her time, and she was equally qualified by her womanly qualities, which endeared every member of the Kaurava court. But despite all her good qualities, she had the natural frailties of a woman, and she was envious of Kunti when the latter gave birth to a male child. Both the queens were pregnant, but Kunti first gave birth to a male child. Thus Gandhari became angry and gave a blow

to her own abdomen. As a result, she gave birth to a lump of flesh only, but since she was a devotee of Vyasadeva, by instruction of Vyasadeva the lump was divided into one hundred parts, and each part gradually developed to become a male child. Thus her ambition to become the mother of one hundred sons was fulfilled, and she began to nourish all the children according to her exalted position. When the intrigue of the battlefield of Kurukṣetra was going on, she was not in favor of fighting with the Pāṇavas; rather, she blamed Dhrtaraṣṭra, her husband, for such a fratricidal war. She desired that the state be divided into two parts, for the sons of Pāṇdu and her own. She was very affected when all her sons died in the Battle of Kurukṣetra, and she wanted to curse Bhimasena and Yudhiṣṭhira, but she was checked by Vyasadeva. Her mourning over the death of Duryodhana and Duryodhanasana before Lord Kṛṣṇa is very pitiful, and Lord Kṛṣṇa pacified her by transcendental messages. She was equally aggrieved on the death of Kṛṣṇa, and she described to Lord Kṛṣṇa the lamentation of Kṛṣṇa's wife. She was pacified by Śrīla Vyasadeva when he showed her dead sons, then promoted to the heavenly kingdoms. She died along with her husband in the jungles of the Himalayas near the mouth of the Ganges; she burned in a forest fire. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira performed the death ceremony of his uncle and aunt.

Prthivī: Daughter of Maharaja Surasena and sister of Vasudeva, Lord Kṛṣṇa's father. Later she was adopted by Maharaja Kuntibhoja, and hence she is known as Kunti. She is the incarnation of the success potency of the Personality of Godhead. The heavenly denizens from the upper planets used to visit the palace of the King Kuntibhoja, and Kunti was engaged for their reception. She also served the great mystic sage Durvasa, and being satisfied by her faithful service, Durvasa Muni gave her a mantra by which it was possible for her to call for any demigod she pleased. As a matter of inquisitiveness, she at once called for the sun-god, who desired couplement with her, but she declined. But the sun-god assured her immunity from virgin adulteration, and so she agreed to his proposal. As a result of this

couplement, she became pregnant, and Karl).a was born by her. By the grace of the sun, she again turned into a virgin girl, but being afraid of her parents, she quitted the newly born child Karl).a. After that, when she actually selected her own husband, she preferred Pai).□U to be her husband. Maharaja Pai).□U later on wanted to retire from family life and adopt the renounced order of life. Kunti refused to allow her husband to adopt such life, but at last Maharaja Piil).□u gave her permission to become a mother of sons by calling some other suitable personalities. Kunti did not accept this proposal at first, but when vivid examples were set by Pai).□U she agreed_ Thus by dint of the mantra awarded by Durvasa Muni she called for Dharmaraja, and thus Yudhi□thira was born: She called for demigod Vayu (air), and thus Bhima was born. She called for Indra, the King of heaven, and thus Arjuna was born. The other two sons, namely Nakula and Sahadeva, were begotten by Pai).□U himself in the womb of Madri. Later on, Maharaja Pai).□U died at an early age, for which Kunti was so aggrieved that she fainted. Two cowives, namely Kunti and Madri, decided that Kunti should live for the maintenance of the five minor children, the Pa□□avas, and Madri should accept the sat"i rituals by meeting voluntary death along with her husband. This agreement was endorsed by great sages like Satsrri and others present on the occasion.

Later on, when the Pa□□avas were banished from the kingdom by the intrigues of Duryodhana, Kunti followed her sons, and she equally faced all sorts of difficulties during those days, During the forest life one demon girl, HiQ.imbi, wanted Bhima as her husband, which was refused by Bhima, but when the girl approached Kunti and Yudhi□thira, they ordered Bhima to accept her proposal and give her a son. As a result of this combination, Ghatotkach was born, and he fought very valiantly with his father against the Kauravas. In their forest life they lived with a brahmarta family that was in trouble because of one Bakasura demon, and Kunti ordered Bhima to kill the Bakasura to protect the brahmap.a family against troubles created by the demon. She advised Yudhi□thira to start for the Paficala desa. Draupadi was gained in this Paficala-de8a by Arjuna, but by order of

Kunti all the five brothers of the Pandavas became equally the husbands of Panchali or Draupadi. She was married with five Pandavas in the presence of Vyasadeva. Kuntidevi never forgot her first child, Karishma, and after Karishma's death in the Battle of Kurukshetra she lamented and admitted before her other sons that Karishma was her eldest son prior to her marriage with Maharaja Pandu. After the Battle of Kurukshetra, when Lord Krishna was going back home, her prayers for the Lord are excellently explained. Later (Texts 3-4) Dhritara Quits Home 667

she went to the forest with Gandhari for severe penance. She used to take meals after each thirty days. She finally sat down in profound meditation and later burned to ashes in a forest fire.

Draupadi: The most chaste daughter of Maharaja Drupada and partly an incarnation of goddess Sachi, the wife of Indra. Maharaja Drupada performed a great sacrifice under the superintendence of the sage Yaja. By his first offering, Dhritadyumna was born, and by the second offering, Draupadi was born. She is therefore the sister of Dhritadyumna, and she is also named Panchali. The five Pandavas married her as a common wife, and each of them begot a son in her. Maharaja Yudhishthira begot a son named Pratibindh, Bhimasena begot a son named Sutasoma, Arjuna begot Srutakirti, Nakula begot Sahadeva, and Sahadeva begot Srutakama. She is described as a most beautiful lady, equal to her mother-in-law Kunti. During her birth there was an astro-message that she should be called Krishna. The same message also declared that she is born to kill many a Kshatriya. By dint of her blessings from Sankara, she was awarded five husbands, equally qualified. When she preferred to select her own husband, princes and kings were invited from all the countries of the world. She was married with the Pandavas during their exile in the forest, but when they went back home Maharaja Drupada gave them immense wealth as a dowry. She was well received by all the daughters-in-law of Dhritarashtra. When she was lost in a gambling game, she was forcibly dragged into the assembly hall, and an attempt was made to see her naked beauty by Duryodhana, even though there were elderly persons like Bhishma and Drona

present. She was a great devotee of Lord Krishna, and by her praying, the Lord Himself became an unlimited garment to save her from the insult. A demon of the name Jatasura kidnapped her, but her second husband Bhimasena killed the demon and saved her. She saved the Pandavas from the curse of Maharishi Durvasa by the grace of Lord Krishna. When the Pandavas lived incognito in the palace of Virata, Kicaka was attracted by her exquisite beauty, and by arrangement with Bhima the devil was killed and she was saved. She was very much aggrieved when her five sons were killed by Asvatthama. At the last stage, she accompanied her husband Yudhishthira and others and fell on the way. The cause of her falling was explained by Yudhishthira, but when Yudhishthira entered the heavenly planet he saw Draupadi gloriously present there as the goddess of fortune in the heavenly planet.

Subhadra: Daughter of Vasudeva and sister of Lord Sri Krishna. She was not only a very dear daughter of Vasudeva, but also a very dear sister to both Krishna and Baladeva. The two brothers and sister are represented in 668 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 13

the famous Jagannatha Temple of Puri, and the temple is still visited by thousands of pilgrims daily. This temple is in remembrance of the Lord's visit at Kurukshetra during an occasion of solar eclipse and His subsequent meeting with the residents of Vrindavana. The meeting of Radha and Krishna during this occasion is a very pathetic story, and Lord Sri Caitanya in the ecstasy of Radharani always pined for Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa at Jagannatha Puri. While Arjuna was at Dvaraka, he wanted to have Subhadra as his queen, and he expressed his desire to Lord Krishna. Sri Krishna knew that His elder brother, Lord Baladeva, was arranging her marriage elsewhere, and since He did not dare to go against the arrangement of Baladeva, He advised Arjuna to kidnap Subhadra. So when all of them were on a pleasure trip on the Raivata Hill, Arjuna managed to kidnap Subhadra according to the plan of Sri Krishna. Sri Baladeva was very angry at Arjuna, and He wanted to kill him, but Lord Krishna implored His brother to excuse Arjuna. Then Subhadra was duly married with Arjuna, and Ahimsya was born of

Suhhadra. At the premature death of Ahhimanyu, Suhhadra was very mortified, but on the birth of Parikṣit she was happy and solaced.

TEXTS

pmtyujjagmu[l. praharṇe!la

praflarh tanva ivagatam

abhisangamya vidhivat

pariṣvangaabhivadanai[l.

prati- towards; ujjagmu[l.-went; praharṇe!la-with great delight; priipam
-life; tanva[l.-of the body; iva-like; iigatam-retuned back; abhisangamya
-approaching; vidhivat-in due form; pariṣvanga-emhracing; abhivadanai[l.
-by obeisance.

TRANSLATION

With great delight they all approached him, as if life returned to their bodies. They exchanged obeisances and welcomed each other with embraces.

Text 7] Dhrtarāṣṭra Quits Home 669

PURPORT

In the absence of consciousness, the limbs of the body remain inactive. But when consciousness returns, the limbs and senses become active, and existence itself becomes delightful. Vidura was so dear to the members of the Kaurava family that his long absence from the palace was comparable to inactivity. All of them were feeling acute separation from Vidura, and therefore his return to the palace was joyful for all.

TEXT6

m: a.....\cflq f'CI(il□□□·6(t: 1

oo □□ t□le-«qf(st(¥(II □ II

mumucu[l prema-bii□paugharh

virahautkarzfhya-katara[l

raja tam arhayai cakre

krtiisana-parigraham

mumucu[l-emanated; prema-affectionate; bii□paugham-emotional

tears; viraha -separation; autkarzfhya-anxiousness; katarii[l-being ag

grieved; riiiii- King Yudhiṭhira; tam-unto him (Vidura); arhayan-reception; cakre-offered; kṛta-performance of; iisana-sitting accommodations; parigraha-arrangement of.

TRANSLATION

Due to anxieties and long separation, they all cried out of affection.

King Yuṭhira then arranged to offer sitting accommodations and a reception.

TEXT7

d "!!4 Rṭlki'41(1l:f Wct'lteit I
spjṭṭlii4-«ṭ (m sm: ṭ ṭ 'Rṭ II \9 II
tam bhuktavantarh vi.Srantam
iisinarh sukham-iisane
prasrayavanato raja
praha teṭarh ca srrzvatam

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tam-him (Vidura); bhuktavantam-after feeding him sumptuously;
visriintam-and having taken rest;iisinaṭ-being seated;sukham iisane-on
a comfortable seat; prasraya-avanata[l.-naturally very gentle and meek;
nzja-King Yudhiṭhira; praha-began to speak; teṣiim ca-and by them;
srr-vatiim-being heard.

TRANSLATION

After Vidura ate sumptuously and took sufficient rest, he was comfortably seated. Then the King began to speak to him, and all who were present there listened.

PURPORT

King Yudhiṭhira was expert in reception also, even in the case of his family members. Vidura was well received by all the family members by exchange of embraces and obeisances. After that, bathing and arrangements for a sumptuous dinner were made, and then he was given sufficient rest. After finishing his rest, he was offered a comfortable place to sit, and then the King began to talk about all happenings, both family and otherwise. That is the proper way to receive a beloved friend, or even an enemy.

According to Indian moral codes, even an enemy received at home should be so well received that he will not feel any fearful situation. An enemy is always afraid of his enemy, but this should not be so when he is received at home by his enemy. This means that a person, when received at home, should be treated as a relative, so what to speak of a family member like Vidura, who was a well-wisher for all the members of the family. Thus Yudhiṭhira Maharaja began to speak in the presence of all other members.

TEXTS

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 AqAUiiifl'ti;W411«iM61 □€(1+tld}fii: II □ II
 yudh□thira uviica
 api smaratha no yuṣmat
 pakṣac-chiiyii-samedhitiin
 vipad-gar-iid v□iignyiider
 mocitii yat sa-miitrkii[l.

Text 8] Dhrtar□p-a Quits Home 671

yudh□thira[l uvaca-Maharaja Yudhi□thira said;api-whether;smarotha
 you remember; na[l- us;yuṣmat-from you;pakṣat-partiality towards us
 like the wings of a bird; saya-protection; samedhitan-we who were
 brought up by you; vipat-gartiit-from various types of calamities;vi.ṣa
 by administration of poison; agnyiide[l-by setting on fire; mocita[l
 released from; yat-what you have done; sa-along with; miitrkiifl.-our
 mother.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yu□ihira said: My uncle, do you remember how you
 always protected us, along with our mother, from all sorts of calamities?
 Your partiality, like wings of a bird, saved us from poisoning and arson.

PURPORT

Due to Pandu 's death at an early age, his minor children and widow were the object of special care by all the elderly members of the family, especially Blu□madeva and Mahatma Vidura. Vidura was more or less

partial to the Pāṇavas due to their political position. Although Dhṛtarāṣṭra was equally careful for the minor children of Maharaja Pāṇdu, he was one of the intriguing parties who wanted to wash away the descendants of Pāṇdu and replace them by raising his own sons to become the rulers of the kingdom. Mahatma Vidura could follow this intrigue of Dhṛtarāṣṭra and company, and therefore, even though he was a faithful servitor of his eldest brother Dhṛtarāṣṭra, he did not like his political ambition for the sake of his own sons. He was therefore very careful about the protection of the Pāṇavas and their widow mother. Thus he was, so to speak, partial to the Pāṇavas, preferring them to the sons of Dhṛtarāṣṭra, although both of them were equally affectionate in his ordinary eyes. He was equally affectionate to both the camps of nephews in the sense that he always chastised Duryodhana for his intriguing policy against his cousins. He always criticized his elder brother for his policy of encouragement to his sons, and at the same time he was always alert in giving special protection to the Pāṇavas. All these different activities of Vidura within the palace politics made him well-known as partial to the Pāṇavas. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira has referred to the past history of Vidura before his going away from home for a prolonged pilgrim's journey. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira reminded him that he was equally kind and partial to his grown-up nephews, even after the Battle of Kurukṣetra, a great family disaster.

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Before the Battle of Kurukṣetra, Dhṛtarāṣṭra's policy was peaceful annihilation of his nephews, and therefore he ordered Purocana to build a house at Varanavata, and when the building was finished Dhṛtarāṣṭra desired that his brother's family live there for some time. When the Pāṇavas were going there in the presence of all the members of the royal family, Vidura tactfully gave instructions to the Pāṇavas about the future plan of Dhṛtarāṣṭra. This is specifically described in the Mahābhārata (Ch. 144 Adi parva). He indirectly hinted, "A weapon not made of steel or any other material element can be more than sharp to kill an enemy, and he who knows this is never killed." That is to say, he hinted that the party of the

Pa!lāvas was_ being sent to Varālavat to be killed, and thus he warned
 Yudhiṭhira to be very careful in their new residential palace. He also gave
 indications of fire and said that fire cannot extinguish the soul, but it can
 annihilate the material body. But one who protects the soul can live.
 Kunti could not follow such indirect conversations between Maharaja
 Yudhiṭhira and Vidura, and thus when she inquired from her son about
 the purport of the. conversation, Yudhiṭhira replied that from the talks of
 Vidura it was understood that there was a hint of fire in the house where
 they were proceeding. Later on, Vidura came in disguise to the Pa!lāvas
 and informed them that the housekeeper was going to set fire to the house
 on the fourteenth night of the waning moon. It was an intrigue of
 Dhrtaraṭra that the P3.1āvas might die all together with their mother.
 And by his warning the Pa!lāvas escaped through a tunnel underneath
 the earth so that their escape was also unknown to Dhrtaraṭra, so much so
 that after setting the fire, the Kauravas were so certain of the death of the
 Pa!lāvas that Dhrtaraṭra performed the last rites of death with great
 cheerfulness. And during the mourning period all the members of the
 palace became overwhelmed with lamentation, but Vidura did not become
 so, because of his knowledge that the Pa1;1āvas were alive somewhere.
 There are many such instances of calamities, and in each of them Vidura
 gave protection to the Pa!lāvas on one hand, and on the other he tried
 to restrain his brother Dhrtaraṭra from such intriguing policies. Therefore,
 he was always partial to the Pa!lāvas, just as a bird protects its eggs by
 his wing.

TEXT9

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Text 10) Dhftar□a Quits Home

kayii vrṭṭyī vartitam vas

caradbhifl k□iti-map!falam

tirthiini k□etra-mukhyiini

sevitiiniha bhiitale

kayii-by which; v.rttyii-means; var titam-maintained your livelihood;
 va[l-your good self; caradbhi[l-while traveling; k□iti-miip!falam-on the
 surface of the earth; tirthiini -places of pilgrimage; k□etra-mukhyiini-the
 principal holy places; sevitiini- served by you; iha- in this world; bhiitale
 on this planet.

TRANSLATION

While traveling on the surface of the earth, how did you maintain
 your livelihood? At which holy places and pilgrimages did you render
 service?

PURPORT

Vidura went out from the palace to detach himself from household
 affairs, especially political intrigues. As referred to hereinbefore, he was
 practically insulted by Duryodhana 's calling him a son of a siidriipi,
 although it was not out of place to talk loosely in the case of one's
 grandmother. Vidura's mother, although a siidriip□ was the grandmother of
 Duryodhana, and funny talks are sometimes allowed between grandmother
 and grandchildren. But because the remark was an actual fact, it was
 unpalatable talk for Vidura, and it was accepted as a direct insult. He
 therefore decided to quit his paternal house and prepare for the renounced
 order of life. This preparatory stage is called viinaprastha-iisrama, or
 retired life for traveling and visiting the holy places on the surface of the
 earth. In the holy places of India, like Vrndavana, Hardvar, Jagannatha
 Puri, Prayaga, etc., there are many great devotees, and there are still free
 kitchen houses for persons who desire to advance spiritually. Maharaja
 Yudhi□thira was inquisitive to learn whether Vidura maintained himself
 by the mercy of the free kitchen houses (chhatras).

TEXT 10

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 ffitftt□□ □if.□ □:□□□□ II□ o II

674 Srimad-Bhagavatam

bhavad-vidhii bhiigavatiis

tirtha-bhutii[l svayarh vibho

tirthikurvanti tirthiini

sviinta[l-sthena gadiibhrtii

[Canto I, Ch. 13

bhavat-your good self; vidhii[l-like; bhiigavatii[l- devotees; tirtha -the holy places of pilgrimage; bhutii[l-converted into; svayam-personally; bibho-o powerful one; tirthikurvanti-make into a holy place of pilgrimage; tirthiini-the holy places; sviinta[l-sthena-having been situated in the heart; gadiibhrtii-the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

My Lord, devotees like your good self are verily holy places personified. Because you carry the Personality of Godhead within your heart, you turn all places into places of pilgrimage.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead is omnipresent by His diverse potencies everywhere, just as electricity power is distributed everywhere within space. Similarly, the Lord's omnipresence is perceived and manifested by His unalloyed devotees like Vidura, just as electricity is manifested in an electric bulb. A pure devotee like Vidura always feels the presence of the Lord everywhere. He sees everything in the potency of the Lord and the Lord in everything. The holy places all over the earth are meant for purifying the polluted consciousness of the human being by an atmosphere surcharged with the presence of the Lord's unalloyed devotees. If anyone visits a holy place, he must search out the pure devotees residing in such holy places, take lessons from them, try to apply such instructions in practical life and thus gradually prepare oneself for the ultimate salvation, going back to Godhead. To go to some holy place of pilgrimage does not mean only to take a bath in the Ganges or Yamuna or to visit the temples situated in those places. One should also find out representatives of Vidura who have no other desire in life save and except to serve the Personality of Godhead. The Personality of Godhead is always with such pure devotees because of their unalloyed service which is without any tinge of fruitive

action. They are in the actual service of the Lord specifically by the process of hearing and chanting. The pure devotees hear from the authorities and chant, sing and write of the glories of the Lord. Mahamuni Vyasadeva heard from Narada, and then he chanted in writing; Sukadeva Text 11) Dhftar□p-a Quits Home 675

Gosvami studied from his father, and he described it to Parik□it; that is the way of Srimad-Bhiigavatam. So by their actions the pure devotees of the Lord can render any place into a place of pilgrimage, and the holy places are worth the name only on their account. Such pure devotees are able to rectify the polluted atmosphere of any place, and what to speak of a holy place rendered unholy by the questionable actions of interested persons who try to adopt a professional life at the cost of the reputation of a holy place.

TEXT 11

atfq 91: ij(((ijiii □: □: I
-at: □ qf □: □ ij(CI+tl«□ II□□ II
api na[l suhrdas tiita
biindhavii[l knTJa-devatii[l
dn!iib- srutii vii yadava[l
sva-puryiim sukham iisate
api-whether; na[l-our; suhrdafi.-well-wishers; tiita-o my uncle;
biindhavii[l-friends; kr.sr-a-devatii[l-those who are always rapt in the service of Lord Sri Kr□IJ.a; dr□!ii[l-by seeing them; srutii[l-or by hearing about them; vii-either; yadava[l-the descendants of Yadu; sva- puryiim along with their residential place; sukham iisate-if they are all happy.

TRANSLATION

My uncle, you must have visited Dvaraka. In that holy place there are our friends and well-wishers, the descendants of Y adu, who are always rapt in the service of the Lord Sri l<f□J.la. You might have seen them or heard about them. Are they all living happily in their abodes?

PURPORT

The particular word Kr□!la-devatii[l, i.e., those who are always rapt in

the service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, is significant. The Yadavas and the Pāṇḍavas, who were always rapt in the thought of the Lord Kṛṣṇa and His different transcendental activities; were all pure devotees of the Lord like Vidura. Vidura left home in order to devote himself completely to the service of the Lord, but the Pāṇḍavas and the Yadavas were always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa. Thus there is no difference in their pure devotional

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qualities. Either remaining at home or leaving home, the real qualification of a pure devotee is to become rapt in the thought of Kṛṣṇa favorably, i.e., knowing well that Lord Kṛṣṇa is the Absolute Personality of Godhead. Kamsa, Jarasandha, Sisupala and other demons like them were also always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa, but they were absorbed in a different way, namely unfavorably, or thinking Him to be a powerful man only. Therefore, Kamsa and Sisupala are not on the same level of pure devotees like Vidura, the Pāṇḍavas or the Yadavas.

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira was also always rapt in the thought of Lord Kṛṣṇa and His associates at Dvaraka. Otherwise he would not have asked all about them from Vidura. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira is, therefore, on the same level of devotion as Vidura, although engaged in the state affairs of the kingdom of the world.

TEXT 12

ṣaṅkṣaṁ yadā yadā kṛṣṇa-
rūpam āśṛya

dharmāyuktāḥ kṛṣṇa-
bhaktāḥ

ity ukto dharma-rījēna

saroam tat samavarṛtayat

yathīnubhutam kramaso

vinī yadu-kulakṣayam

iti-thus; ukta[t-being asked; dharmarījēna-by King Yudhiṣṭhira;

sa roam-all; tat-that; samavarṛtayat-properly described; yathī-anubhutam

-as he experienced; kramasa[t-one after another; vina-without; yadu

kulakṣayam-annihilation of the Yadu dynasty ..

TRANSLATION

Thus being questioned by Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, Mahatma Vidura gradually described everything that he personally experienced, except news of the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty.

TEXT 13

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ṣ·ṣa:ṣṣ Q'iṣ ṣ:ṣ ṣ¥(ṣ¥(: ṣṣṣṣṣṣ

Text 14] Dhftari!tra Quits Home

nanv apriyam duroiṭaham

n.rpiim svayam upasthitam

niivedayat sakaruro

duflkhitiin draṣṭum akṣamafl

677

nanu-as a matter of fact; apriyam-unpalatable; duroṣaham-unhear-
ahle; n.rpiim-of humankind; svayam-in its own way; upasthitam
appearance; na-did not; iivedayat-expressed; sakaruzwfl-compassionate;
duflkhitiin-distressed; draṣṭum-to see; akṣamafl-unahle.

TRANSLATION

Compassionate Mahatma Vidura could not stand to see the p-ll!ṣavas
distressed at any time. Therefore he did not disclose this unpalatable and
unbearable incidence because calamities come of their own accord.

PURPORT

According to Niti-siistra (civic laws) one should not speak an unpalatable
truth to cause distress to others. Distress comes upon us in its own way by
the laws of nature, so one should not aggravate it by propaganda. For a
compassionate soul like Vidura, especially in his dealings with the beloved
Papṣavas, it was almost impossible to disclose an unpalatable piece of news
like the annihilation of the Yadu dynasty. Therefore purposely he refrained
from it.

TEXT 14

ṣ-ṣlṣ¥iṣlṣl«ft«"t€tdl <1!4€tṣ(ili(I
!liiṣSṣ ṣttftiffi';fqi «ṣṣ IIṣ \lll

kancit kiilam athiiviitsit

satkrto devavat sukham

bhriitur jyeṣṭhasya sreyaś-kṛt

saroeṣām sukham iivahan

kaiicit-for a few days; kiilam-time; atha-thus; aviitsit-resided ;

satkrtaḥ-being well treated; devavat-just like a godly personality; sukham

-amenities; bhriitu[.]-of the brother; jyeṣṭhasya-of the elder; sreyaś-kṛt

for doing good to him; saroeṣām-all others; sukham-happiness ; iivahan made it possible.

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TRANSLATION

Thus Mahatma Vidura, being treated just like a godly person by his kinsmen, remained there for a certain period just to pacify the mentality of his eldest brother and in this way bring happiness to all the others.

PURPORT

Saintly persons like Vidura must be treated as well as a denizen from heaven. In those days denizens of heavenly planets used to visit homes like that of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, and sometimes persons like Arjuna and others used to visit higher planets. Narada is a spaceman who can travel unrestrictedly, not only within the material universes but also in the spiritual universes. Even Narada used to visit the palace of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira and what to speak of other celestial demigods. It is only the spiritual culture of the people concerned that makes interplanetary travel possible, even in the present body. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira therefore received Vidura in the manner of a reception offered to the demigods. Mahatma Vidura had already adopted the renounced order of life, and therefore he did not return to his paternal palace to enjoy some material comforts. He accepted out of his own mercy what was offered to him by Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, but the purpose of living in the palace was to deliver his too much materially attached elder brother Dhrtaraṣṭra. Dhrtaraṣṭra lost all his state and descendants in the fight with Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, and still, due to his sense of helplessness, he did not feel ashamed to accept the charity and hospitality of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira. On the part of Maha

PURPORT

Vidura, born in the womb of a siidra woman, was forbidden even to a party of royal heritage along with his brothers Dhftara□tra and Pa!!lu. Then how could he occupy the post of a preacher to instruct such learned kings and k□atriyas as Dhftara□tra and Maharaja Yudhi□thira? The first answer is that even though it is accepted that he was siidra by birth, because he renounced the world for spiritual enlightenment by the authority of :{t□i Maitreya and was thoroughly educated by him in transcendental knowledge, he was quite competent to occupy the post of an iiciirya or spiritual preceptor. According to Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu, anyone who is conversant in the transcendental knowledge or the science of Godhead, be he a briihmar-a or a siidra, a householder or a sannyyiis□ is eligible to become a spiritual master. Even in the ordinary moral codes (maintained by Ca!lakya Pa!!iit, the great politician and moralist) there is no harm in taking lessons from a person who may be by birth less than a siidra. This is one part of the answer. The other is that Vidura was not actually a

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sudra. He was to play the part of a so-called sudra for one hundred years, being cursed by Ma!J.□uka Muni. He was the incarnation of Y amaraja, one of the twelve Mahajanas on the level with such exalted personalities as Brahma, Narada, Siva, Kapila, Bln□ma, Prahlada, etc. Being a Mahajana, it is the duty of Yamaraja to preach the cult of devotion to the people of the world, as Narada, Brahma, and other Mahajanas do. But Y amaraja is always busy in his plutonic kingdom, punishing the doers of sinful acts. Yamaraja is deputed by the Lord to a particular planet, some hundreds of thousands of miles away from the planet of earth, to take away the corrupt souls after death and convict them in accordance with their respective sinful activities. Thus Y amaraja has very little time to take leave from his responsible office of punishing the wrongdoers. There are more wrongdoers than righteous men. Therefore, Yamaraja has to do more work than other demigods who are also authorized agents of the Supreme Lord. But he wanted to preach the glories of the Lord, and therefore by the will of the Lord he was cursed by Ma!J.□uka Muni to come into the world in the

TEXT 16

- fllll

d.□tva pautram kulandharam

mumude parayii sriyii

yudh□thira□- Yud□thira; labdha-riijya□-possessing his paternal king
dom; dr□tvii-by seeing; pautram-the grandson; kulandharam- just suit
able for the dynasty; bhriitrh□- by the brothers; loka-piilabhai□-who
were all expert administrators; mumude-enjoyed life; parayii-uncommon;
sriyii-opulence.

Having won his kingdom and observed the birth of one grandson competent to continue the noble tradition of his family, Maharaja Yudhishtira reigned peacefully and enjoyed uncommon opulence in cooperation with

his younger brothers, who were all expert administrators to the common people.

PURPORT

Both Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira and Arjuna were unhappy from the beginning of the Battle of Kurukṣetra, but even though they were unwilling to kill their own men in the fight, it had to be done as a matter of duty, for it was planned by the supreme will of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. After the battle, Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira was unhappy over such mass killings. Practically there were none to continue the Kuru dynasty after them, the Pāṇḍavas. The only remaining hope was the child in the womb of his daughter-in-law, Uttara, and he was also attacked by Aśvatthama, but by the grace of the Lord the child was saved. So after the settlement of all disturbing conditions and reestablishment of the peaceful order of the state, and after seeing the surviving child Parikṣit well satisfied, Maharaja felt some relief as a human being, although he had very little attraction for material happiness, which is always illusory and temporary.

TEXT 17

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Sl'i"E'II;wf (tG_<:qI I

□: q(+{§;(ij(t II □ \911

evārḥ grheṣu saktiiniirḥ

pramattiiniirḥ tadihayii

atyakriimad avijñiitā

kiilā parama-dustara

evam- thus; grheṣu-in the family affairs; saktiiniim-of persons who are

too attached; pramattiiniim-insanely attached; tadihayii- engrossed in

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such thoughts; atyakriimat-surpassed; avijñiitā[l-imperceptibly; kiilā[l-

eternal time; parama-supremely; dustara[l-insurmountable.

TRANSLATION

Insurmountable, eternal time imperceptibly overcomes those who are

too much attached to family affairs and are always engrossed in their thought.

PURPORT

"I am now happy; I have everything in order; my bank balance is quite enough; I can now give my children enough estate; I am now successful; the poor beggar sannyasis depend on God, but they come to beg from me; therefore I am more than the Supreme God, etc." are some of the thoughts which engross the insanely attached householder who is blind to the passing of eternal time. Our duration of life is measured, and no one is able to enhance it even by a second against the scheduled time ordained by the supreme will. Such valuable time, especially for the human being, should be cautiously spent because even a second passed away imperceptibly cannot be replaced, even in exchange of thousands of golden coins amassed by hard labor. Every second of human life is meant for making an ultimate solution to the problems of life, i.e. repetition of birth and death and revolving in the cycle of 8,400,000 different species of life. The material body, which is subject to birth and death, diseases and old age, is the cause of all sufferings of the living being, otherwise the living being is eternal: he is never born, nor does he ever die. Foolish persons forget this problem. They do not know at all how to solve the problems of life, but become engrossed in temporary family affairs without knowing that the eternal time is passing away imperceptibly, and their measured duration of life is diminishing every second without any solution of the big problem, namely repetition of birth and death, disease and old age. This is called illusion.

But such illusion cannot work on one who is awake in devotional service of the Lord. Yudhisthira Maharaja, or his brothers the Pāṇavas, were all engaged in the service of the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, and they had very little attraction for the illusory happiness of this material world. As we have discussed previously, Maharaja Yudhisthira was fixed up in the service of the Lord Mukunda (the Lord who can award salvation), and therefore he had no attraction even for such comforts of life as are available in the

kingdom of heaven, because even the happiness obtained in the planet of
Brahmaloka is also temporary and illusory. Because the living being is
Text 18] Dhrtaraṇa Quits Home 683

eternal, he can be happy only in the eternal abode of the kingdom of God
(Paravyoma) from which no one returns to this region of repeated birth
and death, disease and old age. Therefore, any comforts of life or any
material happiness, which does not warrant an eternal life, are but illusion
for the eternal living being. One who understands this factually is learned,
and such a learned person can sacrifice any amount of material happiness
to achieve the desired goal known as brahma-sukham or absolute happi-
ness. Real transcendentalists are hungry for this happiness, and as a hungry
man cannot be made happy by all comforts of life minus foodstuff, so the
hungry man for eternal absolute happiness cannot be satisfied by any
amount of material happiness. Therefore, the instruction described in this
verse cannot be applied to Maharaja Yudhiṇthira or his brothers and
mother. It was meant for persons like Dhrtaraṇa, for whom Vidura came
especially to impart lessons.

TEXT 18

Nṣ)«ad11ṇffl

UJtfo\$1•lRt<tf ṇd

t<t<llY4Y11'16 I

ṇ Ytti•U•I<t'(IIṇ ṇII

viduras tad abhipretya

dhrtarf4tram abhiiṣata

riijan nirgamyatiirh sighrarh

pa5yedarh bhayam iigatam

vidura[t- Mahatma Vidura; tat-that; abhipretya-knowing it well;

dhrtariiṣtram-unto Dhrtaraṇtra; abhiiṣata-said; riijan-o King;

nirgamyatiim-please get out immediately; sighram-without the least

delay; pasya-just see; idam-this; bhayam-fearfulness; iigcitam-already
arrived.

TRANSLATION

Mahatma Vidura knew all this, and therefore he addressed Dhrtarastra, saying: My dear King, please get out of here immediately. Do not delay. Just see how fear has overtaken you.

PURPORT

Cruel death cares for none, be he Dhrtarastra or even Maharaja Yudhisthira; therefore spiritual instruction, as was given to old Dhrtarastra, was equally applicable to younger Maharaja Yudhisthira. As a matter of fact, everyone in the royal palace including the King and his brothers and
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mother was raptly attending the lectures. But it was known to Vidura that his instructions were especially meant for Dhrtarastra, who was too materialistic. The word riijan is especially addressed to Dhrtarastra significantly. Dhrtarastra was the eldest son of his father, and therefore according to law he was to be installed on the throne of Hastinapura. But because he was blind from birth, he was disqualified from his rightful claim. But he could not forget the bereavement, and his disappointment was somewhat compensated after the death of Pradyumna, his younger brother. His younger brother left behind him some minor children, and Dhrtarastra became the natural guardian of them, but at heart he wanted to become the factual King and hand over the kingdom to his own sons, headed by Duryodhana. With all these imperial ambitions, Dhrtarastra wanted to become a king and contrive all sorts of intrigues in consultation with his brother-in-law Sakuni. But everything failed by the will of the Lord, and at the last stage, even by losing everything, men and money, he wanted to remain as King, being the eldest uncle of Maharaja Yudhisthira. Maharaja Yudhisthira, as a matter of duty, maintained Dhrtarastra in royal honor, and Dhrtarastra was happily passing away his numbered days in the illusion of becoming a king or the royal uncle of King Yudhisthira. Vidura, as a saint and as the duty-bound affectionate youngest brother of Dhrtarastra, wanted to awaken Dhrtarastra from his slumber of disease and old age. Vidura therefore sarcastically addressed Dhrtarastra as the "King," which he was actually not.. Everyone is the servant of eternal time, and therefore no one

can be king in this material order. King means the person who can order. The celebrated English King wanted to order time and tide, but the time and tide refused to obey his order. Therefore one is a false king in the material world, and Dhrtarastra was particularly reminded of this false position and of the factual fearful happenings which had already approached him at that time. Vidura asked him to get out immediately, if he wanted to be saved from the fearful situation which was approaching him fast. He did not ask Maharaja Yudhisthira in that way because he knew that a king like Maharaja Yudhisthira is aware of all the fearful situations of this flimsy world, and he would take care of himself, in due course, even though Vidura might not be present at that time.

TEXT 19

saRtfsti u WI f14 fN<:SI I
u +«•1sn'l. ::'It ;r: e+u•l<t: 1111

Text 19] Dhrtarastra Quits Home

pratikriyaa na yasyeha
kutaicit karhicit prabho
sa e a bhagaviin kiilafl ·
sarveṣiirita na/;1 samiigata/;1

685

pratikriyaa-remedial measure; na-there is none; yasya-of which; iha
in this material world; kutascit-by any means; karhicit-or by anyone;
prabho-O my lord; sa-that; e afl- positively; bhagaviin-the Personality
of Godhead; kiila/;1-eternal time; sarveṣiim-of all; na[l.-of us; samiigata/;1-
arrived.

TRANSLATION

This rightful situation cannot be remedied by any person in this material world. My lord, it is the Supreme Personality of Godhead as eternal time [kala] that has approached us all.

PURPORT

There is no superior power which can check the cruel hands of death. No one wants to die, however acute the source of bodily sufferings may

be. Even in the days of so-called scientific advancement of knowledge, there is no remedial measure either for old age or for death. Old age is the notice of the arrival of death served by cruel time, and no one can refuse to accept either summon calls or the supreme judgment of eternal time. This is explained before Dhrtarastra because he might ask Vidura to find out some remedial measure for the imminent fearful situation, as he had ordered many times before. Before ordering, however, Vidura informed Dhrtarastra that there was no remedial measure by anyone or from any source in this material world. And because there is no such thing in the material world, death is identical with the Supreme Personality of Godhead, as it is said by the Lord Himself in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg.12.32). Death cannot be checked by anyone or from any source within this material world. Hiral'yakasipu wanted to be immortal and underwent a severe type of penance by which the whole universe trembled, and Brahma himself approached him to dissuade Hiral'yakasipu from such a severe type of penance. Hiral'yakasipu asked Brahma to award him the blessings of immortality, but Brahma said that he himself was subject to death, even in the topmost planet, so how could he award him the benediction of immortality? So there is death even in the topmost planet of this universe, and what to speak of other planets, which are far, far inferior in quality to

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Brahmaloka, the residing planet of Brahma. Wherever there is the influence of eternal time, there is this set of tribulations, namely birth, disease, old age and death, and all of them are invincible.

TEXT 20

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\i□Wl: □ W9l□6 fitia61□□;ufa.fl: ll□oll

yena caiviibhipanno 'yam

priir-ail;t priyatamair api

jana□ sadyo viyujyeta

kimutanyair dhanadibhifl

yena- pulled by such time; ca-and; eva-certainly; abhipanna□-over

taken; ayam- this; prartaifl- with life; priyatamai[l-which is most dear to everyone; api-even though; jana/1-person; sadyafl-forthwith; viyujyeta do give up; kimuta anyai fl-what to speak of any other thing; dhana-iidibhifl -such as wealth, honor, children, land and house.

TRANSLATION

Whoever is under the influence of supreme kala [eternal time] must surrender his most dear life, and what to speak of other things, such as wealth, honor, children, land and home.

PURPORT

A great Indian scientist, busy in the planmaking business, was suddenly called by invincible eternal time while going to attend a very important meeting of the planning commission, and he had to surrender his life, wife, children, house, land, wealth, etc. During the political upsurge in India and its division into Pakistan and Hindusthan, so many rich and influential Indians had to surrender life, property and honor due to the influence of time, and there are hundreds and thousands of examples like that all over the world, all over the universe, which are all effects of the influence of time. Therefore, the conclusion is that there is no powerful living being within the universe who can overcome the influence of time. Many poets have written verses on the influence of time, many devastations have taken place over the universes due to the influence of time, and no one could check them by any means. Even in our daily life, so many things

Text 21] Dhrtarāstra Quits Home 687

come and go in which we have no hand, but we have to suffer or tolerate them without remedial measure. That is the result of time.

TEXT 21

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□ 'q' i51□ m: q(i\,JtiRie II□□ II

pitr-bhriitr-suhrt-putrii

hatiis te vigatarh vayam

iitmii ca jarayii grastaf:t

para-geham upiisase

pitr-father; bhriitr-brother; suhrt-well-wishers; putrii□-sons; hatii□
all dead; te-yours; vigatam-expended; vayam-age; iitmii-the body; ca
also ;jarayii- by invalidity; grastaf:t-overcome; p ara-geham- another' s home;
upiisase- you do live.

TRANSLATION

Your father, brother, well-wishers and sons are all dead and passed
away. You yourself have expended the major portion of your life, your
body is now overtaken by invalidity, and you are living in the home of
another.

PURPORT

The King is reminded of his precarious condition, influenced by cruel
time, and by his past experience he should have been more intelligent to
see what was going to happen to his own life. His father Vicitravirya died
long ago, when he and his younger brothers were all little children, and it
was due to the care and kindness of Blii□madeva that they were properly
brought up. Then again his brother Piil)gu died also. Then in the Battlefield
of Kuruk□etra his one hundred sons and his grandsons all died, along with
all other well-wishers like Blii□madeva, Drol)iicarya, Karl)a and many other
kings and friends. So he had lost all men and money, and now he was living
at the mercy of his nephew, whom he had put into troubles of various
types. And despite all these reverses, he thought that he would prolong
his life more and more. Vidura wanted to point out to Dhrtara□tra that
everyone has to protect himself by his action and the grace of the Lord.
One has to execute his duty faithfully depending for the result on the
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supreme authority. No friend, no children, no father, no brother, no state
and no one else can protect a person who is not protected by the Supreme
Lord. One should, therefore, seek the protection of the Supreme Lord, for
the human form of life is meant for seeking that protection. He was warned
of his precarious conditions more and more by the following words.

TEXT 22

3P'I: st□ □)

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□'CSI'*If'l(tU"SSd I

tmlf: □11'! □□□□□□

andha□ puraiva vadhiro

manda-prajniis ca siimpratam

viiirr-a danto mandiigno

sariiga□ kapham udvahan

andha□- blind; pura- from the beginning; eva-certainly; vadhira□-hard

of hearing; manda-prajniib - memory shortened; ca- and ; siimpratam

recently; viiirr-a□-loosened; danta□- teeth; manda-agn*- liver action

decreased; sariiga□-with sound; kapham-coughing with mucus; udvahan
coming out.

TRANSLATION

You have been blind from your very birth, and recently you have become hard of hearing. Your mmemory is shortened, and your intelligence is disturbed. Your teeth are loose, your liver is defective, and you are coughing up mmucus.

PURPORT

The symptoms of old age, which had already developed in Dhrtara□tra, were all one after another pointed out to him as warning that death was nearing very quickly, and still he was foolishly carefree about his future. The signs pointed out by Vidura in the body of Dhrtara□tra were signs of apak□aya, or dwindling of the material body before the last stroke of death. The body is born, it develops, stays, creates other bodies, dwindles and then vanishes. But foolish men want to make a permanent settlement of the perishable body and think that their estate, children, society,

Text 23] Dhftara□tra Quits Home 689

country, etc., will give them protection. With such foolish ideas, they become overtaken by such temporary engagements and forget altogether that they must give up this temporary body and take a new one again to arrange for another term of society, friendship and love, again to be perished ultimately. They forget their permanent identity and become

foolishly active for non-permanent occupations, forgetting altogether their prime duty. Saints and sages like Vidura approach such foolish men to awaken them to the real situation, but they take such siidhus and saints as parasites of society, and almost all of them refuse to hear the words of such siidhus and saints, although they welcome show bottle siidhus and so-called saints who can satisfy their senses. Vidura is not a siidhu who satisfies the ill gotten sentiment of Dhrtarastra. He was correctly pointing out the real situation of life, and how one can save oneself from such catastrophies.

TEXT 23

Qhli\444\ \ifflliifijlijl □□ I

□·nqq□d Aoc+ua:-El •uqR□qa: 11 □ □11

aho mahiyasi jantor

fivitiisii yathii bhaviin

bhimiipavarjitarit pir.t;lām

iidatte grha-piilavat

aho- alas; mahiyasi- powerful; janto□- of the living beings; jivitiisii

hope for life; yathii-as much as; bhaviin-you are; bhima-Bmmasena (a

brother of Yudhi□thira's); apavarjitam- remnants; pir-t;lām- foodstuff;

iidatte- eaten by; grha-piilavat- like a household dog.

TRANSLATION

Alas, how powerful are the hopes of a living being to continue his life. Verily, you are living just like a household dog and are eating remnants of food given by Bhima.

PURPORT

A siidhu should never flatter kings or rich men to live comfortably at their cost. A siidhu is to speak to the householders about the naked truth
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of life so that they may come to their senses about the precarious life in material existence. Dhrtarastra is a typical example of an attached old man in household life. He had become a pauper in the true sense, yet he wanted to live comfortably in the house of the Paṇḍavas, of whom Bhishma especially is mentioned because personally he killed two prominent sons

of Dhrtarastra, namely Duryodhana and Dupsasana. These two sons were very much dear to him for their notorious and nefarious activities, and Bhima is particularly pointed out because he killed these two pet sons. Why was Dhrtaristra living there at the house of the Palakavas? Because he wanted to continue his life comfortably, even at the risk of all humiliation. Vidura, therefore, was astonished how powerful is the urge to continue life. This sense of continuing one's life indicates that a living being is eternally a living entity, and he does not want to change his bodily habitation. The foolish man does not know that a particular term of bodily existence is awarded to him to undergo a term of imprisonment, and the human body is awarded, after many, many births and deaths, as a chance for self-realization to go back home, back to Godhead. But persons like Dhrtarastra try to make plans to live there in a comfortable position with profit and interest, for they do not see things as they are. Dhrtarastra is blind and continues to hope to live comfortably in the midst of all kinds of reverses of life. A sadhu like Vidura is meant to awaken such blind persons and thus help them go back to Godhead, where life is eternal. Once going there, no one wants to come back to this material world of miseries. We can just imagine how responsible a task is entrusted to a sadhu like Mahatma Vidura.

TEXT 24

aaRif.1qil tRI : 1

im ij(tJf4n 11 'cIll

agnir ni.11to dattaS ca

garo dariiS ca diiitafl

hrtarit ketrarit dhanarit yeSam

tad-dattair asubhifl kiyat

agni[l-fire; nistr\$tafl-set; datta[l-given; ca-and; garaft-poison; daraft married wife; ca-and; du\$itii(l-insulted; hrtam- usurped ; k\$e tram- king dom; dhanam-wealth; ye\$iiim-of those; tat-their; dattai[l-given by; asubhifl- subsisting; kiyat-is unnecessary.

Text 25] Dhrtar3{!tra Quits Home 691

TRANSLATION

There is no need to live a degraded life and subsist on the charity of those whom you tried to kill by arson and poisoning. You also insulted one of their wives and usurped their kingdom and wealth.

PURPORT

The system of var[ṇa] religion sets aside a part of one's life completely for the purpose of self-realization and attainment of salvation in the human form of life. That is a routine division of life, but persons like Dhrtaraṣṭra, even at their weary ripened age, want to stay home, even in a degraded condition of accepting charity from enemies. Vidura wanted to point this out and impressed upon him that it was better to die like his sons than accept such humiliating charity. Five thousand years ago there was one Dhrtaraṣṭra, but at the present moment there are Dhrtaraṣṭras in every home. Politicians especially do not retire from political activities unless they are dragged by the cruel hand of death or killed by some opposing element. To stick to family life up to the end of one's human life is the grossest type of degradation, and there is absolute need of educating such Dhrtaraṣṭras by the Viduras, even at the present moment.

TEXT 25

□ □ w□ ,qUI4A m□: ,

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tasyiipi tava deho'yam

k.rpapasya jijiv□o[l

paraity anicchato fi'llo

jarayii viisasi iva

tasya-of this; api-in spite of; tava-your; deha[l-body; ayam-this ;

krpa[lasya-of one who is miserly; jijiv□o[l-of you who desire life;paraiti

-will dwindle; anicchata[l-even unwilling; ji'[la[l-deteriorated; jaraya

old; viisasz-garments; iva-like.

TRANSLATION

Despite your unwillingness to die and your desire to live even at the cost of honor and prestige, your miserly body will certainly dwindle and

deteriorate like an old garment.

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PURPORT

The words *krparasya jivivi* are significant. There are two classes of men. One is called the *krpara*, and the other is called the *briihmara*. The *krpa*'a, or the miserly man, has no estimation of his material body, hut the *briihmara* has a true estimation of himself and the material body. The *krpara*, having a wrong estimation of his material body, wants to enjoy sense gratification with his utmost strength, and even in old age he wants to become a young man by medical treatment or otherwise. *Dhftara* is addressed herein as a *krpara* because without any estimation of his material body he wants to live at any cost, and Vidura is trying to open his eyes to see that he cannot live more than his term and that he must prepare for death. Since death is inevitable, why should he accept such a humiliating position for living? It is better to take the right path, even at the risk of death. Human life is meant for finishing all kinds of miseries of material existence, and life should be so regulated that one can achieve the desired goal. *Dhftara*, due to his wrong conception of life, had already spoiled eighty percent of his achieved energy, so it behooved him to utilize the remaining days of his miserly life for the ultimate good. Such a life is called miserly because one cannot properly utilize the assets of the human form of life. Such a miserly man, by good luck only, meets a self realized soul like Vidura and by his instruction gets rid of the nescience of material existence.

TEXT 26

gata-sviirtham imam deham

virakto mukta-bandhanafl

avijiiiita-gatir jahyiit

sa vai dhira udiihrtat

gata-sviirtham- without being properly utilized; *imam* - this; *deham*

material body; *viraktalt*-indifferently; *mukta*-being freed; *bandhanalt*

from all obligations; *avijfiita-gatilt*- unknown destination; *jahyiit*- one

should give up this body; salt- such a person; vai-certainly; dhiralt-undisturbed; udihratap-is said to be so.

Text 27] Dhrtarawa Quits Home 693

TRANSLATION

He is called undisturbed who goes to an unknown, remote place and, freed from all obligations, quits his material body when it has become useless.

PURPORT

Narottama Dasa 'fhakur, a great devotee and iiciirya of the Gausfiya V ai□l)ava sect, has sung: "My Lord, I have simply wasted my life. Having obtained the human body, I have neglected to worship Your Lordship, and therefore willingly I have drunk poison." In other words, the human body is especially meant for cultivating knowledge of devotional service of the Lord, without which life becomes full of anxieties and miserable conditions_ Therefore, one who has spoiled his life without such cultural activities is advised to leave home without knowledge of friends and relatives and, being thus freed from all obligations of family, society, country, etc_, give up the body at some unknown destination so that others may not know where and how he has met his death. Dhira means one who is not disturbed, even when there is sufficient provocation. One cannot give up a comfortable family life due to his affectionate relation with wife and children. Self-realization is obstructed by such undue affection for family, and if anyone is at all able to forget such a relation, he is called the undisturbed, or dhira. This is, however, the path of renunciation based on a frustrated life, but stabilization of such renunciation is possible only by association with bona fide saints and self-realized souls by which one can be engaged in the loving devotional service of the Lord. Sincere surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord is possible by awakening the transcendental sense of service, made possible by association of pure devotees of the Lord_ Dhrtara□tra was lucky enough to have a brother whose very association was a source of liberation for his frustrated life.

TEXT 27

□ = weii□'Jt □ \illaf-t::fa: 311€Y4f!Ui{ 1

□ im □ it{JdiA□at □: □□□□□□

ya[l. svakiit parato veha

jiita-nirveda itmaviin

hrdi k.rtvii harirh gehiit

pravrajat sa narottama[l.

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ya{t-anyone who; svakiit-by his own awakening; parata[l. vii-or by

hearing from another; iha-here in this world; jiita-becomes; niroeda[l.

indifferent to material attachment; atmaviin-consciousness; hrdi-within

the heart; krtvii-having been taken by; harim-the Personality of Godhead;

gehiit-from home; pravrajat-goes away; sa[l.-he Is; nara-uttama[l.-the

first-class human being.

TRANSLATION

He is certainly a first-class man who awakens and understands, either by himself or from others, the falsity and misery of this material world and thus leaves home and depends fully on the Personality of Godhead residing within his heart.

PURPORT

There are three classes of transcendentalists, namely, 1) the dhira, or the one who is not disturbed by being away from the family association, 2) one in the renounced order of life, a sannyasi by frustrated sentiment, and 3) a sincere devotee of the Lord, who awakens God consciousness by hearing and chanting and leaves home depending completely on the Personality of Godhead who resides in his heart. The idea is that the renounced order of life, after a frustrated life of sentiment in the material world, may be the stepping stone on the path of self-realization, but real perfection of the path of liberation is attained when one is practiced to depend fully on the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who lives in everyone's heart as Paramatma. One may live in the darkest jungle alone out of home, but a steadfast devotee knows very well that he is not alone. The Supreme Personality of Godhead is with him, and He can protect His sincere devotee in

any awkward circumstance. One should therefore practice devotional service at home, hearing and chanting the holy name, quality, form, pastimes, entourage, etc., in association with pure devotees, and this practice will help one awaken God consciousness in proportion to one's sincerity of purpose. One who desires material benefit by such devotional activities can never depend on the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although He sits in everyone's heart. Nor does the Lord give any direction to persons who worship Him for material gain. Such materialistic devotees may be blessed by the Lord with material benefits, but they cannot reach the stage of the first-class human being, as above mentioned. There are many examples of such sincere devotees in the history of the world, especially

Text 28] Dhrtarastra Quits Home 695

in India, and they are our guides on the path of self-realization. Mahatma Vidura is one such great devotee of the Lord, and we should all try to follow in his lotus footsteps for self-realization.

TEXT 28

□□□□□□□

□Sii4ksfl4□t:□: □□□:□□□□II

athodicim diSam yiitu

svair ajiiiita-gatir bhaviin

ito 'rviik priiyasafl kiilafl

p urhsiim gu!la-vikar\$a!lafl

atha-therefore; udicim-northern side; diSam-direction; yiitu-please

go away; svaifl-by your relatives; ajiiiita-without knowledge; gatifl

movements; bhaviin-of yourself; itafl-after this; arviik-will usher in;

prayasafl-generally; kalafl-time; purhsam-of men; gu!Ja-qualities;

vikarwcwfl- diminishing.

TRANSLATION

Please, therefore, leave for the North immediately, without letting your relatives know, for soon that time will approach which will diminish the good qualities of men.

PURPORT

A life of frustration can be compensated by becoming a dhira, or leaving home for good without communicating with relatives, and Vidura advised his eldest brother to adopt this way without delay, because very quickly the age of Kali was approaching. A conditioned soul is already degraded by the material association, and still in the Kali-yuga the good qualities of a man will deteriorate to the lowest standard. He was advised to leave home before Kali-yuga approached because the atmosphere which was created by Vidura, his valuable instructions on the facts of life, would fade away due to the influence of the age which was fast approaching. To become narottama, or a first-class human being depending completely on the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛpā, is not possible for any ordinary man. It is stated in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 7.28) that a person who is completely

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relieved of all taints of sinful acts can alone depend on the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. Dhṛtarāṣṭra was advised by Vidura at least to become a dhira in the beginning if it were impossible for him to become a sannyāsi or a narottama. Persistently endeavoring on the line of self-realization helps a person to rise to the conditions of a narottama from the stage of a dhira. The dhira stage is attained after prolonged practice of the yoga system, but by the grace of Vidura one can attain the stage immediately simply by willing to adopt the means of the dhira stage, which is the preparatory stage for sannyāsa. The sannyāsa stage is the preparatory stage of paramahansa, or the first-grade devotee of the Lord.

TEXT 29

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f.r.lt.qaq iillct4"a:RM•'41 □□□□□□

evam riijii vidurepiinujena

prajiiii-cak'□ur bodhita iijami!Jhafl.

chittvii sveṣu sneha-piisiin draphimno
niScakriima bhriitr-sandarsitiidhvii
evam-thus; riiiii-King Dhrtaraṁtra; vidurerta anujena-by his younger
brother Vidura; prajl'iii-introspective knowledge; cakṁ uṁ-eyes; bodhita
being understood; iijami!Jha[l.-DhrtaraṢ.ra, scion of the family ofAjamiṁha;
chittvii-by breaking; sveṁu- regarding kinsmen; sneha-piisiin-strong net
work of affection; dra{lhimna[l.- because of steadfastness; niscakriima
got out; bhriitr-brothe r; sandarsita-direction to; adhvii-the path of
liberation.

TRANSLATION

Thus Maharaja Dhftarṁtra, the scion of the family of Ajamiṁha, firmly
convinced by introspective knowledge [prajfia] , broke at once the strong
network of familial affection by his resolute determination. Thus. he im-
Text 29] Dhrtarawa Quits Home 697

mediately left home to set out on the path of liberation, as directed by
his younger brother Vidura.

PURPORT

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu, the great preacher of the principles of
\$rimad-Bhiigavatam, has stressed the importance of associating with siidhus
or pure devotees of the Lord. He said that even by a moment's association
with a pure devotee, one can achieve all perfection. We are not ashamed to
admit that this fact was experienced in our practical life. Were we not
favored by His Divine Grace Srimad Bhaktisiddhiinta Sarasvati Gosviimi
Mahiiriija, by our first meeting for a few minutes only, it would have been
impossible for us to accept this mighty task of describing \$rimad
Bhiigavatam in English. Without seeing him at that opportune moment,
we could have become a very great business magnate, but never would we
have been able to walk the path of liberation and be engaged in the factual
service of the Lord under instructions of His Divine Grace. And here is
another practical example by the action of Vidura's association with
Dhftaraṁtra. Maharaja Dhftaraṁtra was tightly bound in a network of
material affinities related to politics, economy and family attachment, and

he did everything in his power to achieve so-called success in his planned projects, but he was frustrated from the beginning to the end so far as his material activities were concerned. And yet, despite his life of failure, he achieved the greatest of all success in self-realization by the forceful instructions of a pure devotee of the Lord, who is the typical emblem of a *siidhu*. The scriptures enjoin, therefore, that one should associate with *siidhus* only, rejecting all other kinds of association, and by doing so one will have ample opportunity to hear the *siidhus* who can cut to pieces the bonds of illusory affection in the material world. It is a fact that the material world is a great illusion because everything appears to be a tangible reality, but the next moment everything is evaporated like the dashing foam of the sea or a cloud in the sky. A cloud in the sky undoubtedly appears to be a reality because it rains, and due to rains so many temporary green things appear, but in the ultimate issue, everything disappears, namely the cloud, rain and green vegetation, all in due course. But the sky remains, and the varieties of sky or luminaries also remain forever. Similarly the Absolute Truth, which is compared to the sky, remains eternally, and the temporary cloudlike illusion comes and goes away. Foolish living beings are attracted by the temporary cloud, but

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intelligent men are more concerned with the eternal sky with all its variegatedness.

TEXT 30

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qRI?H'II :qa□•nq □ 1

fto¥1ttJS4 ril(ije(o6Sic:cl

¥1wtf(q;uf14q 6ffl'SI(I(: II□ oil

patirh prayiintam subalasya putri

pati-vratii ciinujagiima siidhvi

himiilayarh nyasta-dar□a-praharṣarh

manasviniim iva sat samprahiirafl

patim-her husband; prayiintam-while leaving home; subalasya-of King

Suhala; putri- worthy daughter; pati-vratii-devoted to her husband; ca also; anujagiima-foll owed; siidhvi-the chaste; himiilayam-towards the Himalayan mountains; nyasta-dar□a-one who has accepted the rod of the renounced order; prahar□am- object of delight; manasviniim-of the great fighters; iva- like; sat-legitimate ; samprahiirafl- good lashing.

TRANSLATION

Gindhari, who was the daughter of King Suhala of Kandahara [or Gandhara] , followed her husband, seeing that he was going to the Himalayan mountains, which are the delight of those who have accepted the staff of the renounced order like fighters who have accepted a good lashing from the enemy.

PURPORT

Saubaliru or Gandharī, daughter of King Subala and wife of King Dhrtarastra, was ideal as a devoted wife to her husband. The Vedic civilization especially prepares chaste and devoted wives, of whom Gandhari is one amongst many mentioned in history. Lakṣmī Sitadevi was also a daughter of a great king, hut she followed her husband Lord Ramacandra into the forest. Similarly, as a woman she could remain at home or at her father's house, hut as a chaste and gentle lady she followed her husband
Text 31] Dhrfarawa Quits Home 699

without consideration. Instructions for the renounced order of life were imparted to Dhftarastra by Vidura, and Gandhari was by the side of her husband. But he did not ask her to follow him because he was at that time fully determined, like a great warrior who faces all kinds of dangers in the battlefield. He was no longer attracted to so-called wife or relatives, and he decided to start alone, but as a chaste lady Gandhari decided to follow her husband till the last moment. Maharaja Dhftarastra accepted the order of viinaprastha, and at this stage the wife is allowed to remain as a voluntary servitor, but in the sannyyiisa stage no wife can stay with her former husband. A sannyyiisi is considered to be a dead man civilly, and therefore the wife becomes a civil widow without connection with her former husband. Maharaja Dhftarastra did not deny his faithful wife, and she followed her

husband at her own risk.

The sannyiis accept a rod as the sign of the renounced order of life.

There are two types of sannyiis. Those who follow the Mayavadi philosophy, headed by Sripada Sailkaracarya, accept only one rod (eka-darpa), but those who follow the Vaiṣṇava philosophy accept three combined rods (tri-darṣa). The Mayavadi sannyiis are ekadarpi-sviimis, whereas the Vaiṣṇava sannyiis are known as tridarpi-sviimis, or more distinctly, tridarṣi gosviimis, in order to be distinguished from the Mīyiviidi philosophers. The ekadarpi sviimis are mostly fond of the Himalayas, but the Vaiṣṇava sannyiis are fond of Vrndavana and Puri. The Vaiṣṇava sannyiis are narottamas, whereas the Mayavadi sannyiis are dhiras. Maharaja D.J. rtaṅtra was advised to follow the dhiras because at that stage it was difficult for him to become a narottama.

TEXT 31

ajiṭa-satro[l. k.rta-maitro hutignir

vipriin natvii tila-go-bhiimi-rokma*

grham praviṣṭo guro-vandaniiya

na ciipasyat pitarau saubalim ca

700 Srimad-Bhigavatam [Canto I, Ch. 13

ajiṭa-never born; satrup-enemy; krta-having performed; maitmp

worshiping the demigods; huta-agni[l-and offering fuel in the fire; vipriin

-the briihmapas; natvii-offering obeisances; tila-go-bhumi-rokmai[l-along

with grains, cows, land and gold; grham-within the palace; pravṅtafl

having entered into; guro-vandaniiya-for offering respect to the elderly

members; na-did not; ca-also; apasyat pitarau-his uncle; saub alim

Gandhari; ca-also.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yuṅhira, whose enemy was never hom, perfonned his

daily morning duties by praying, offering fire sacrifice to_ the sun-god, and

offering obeisances, grains, cows, land and gold to the hrihmṅs. He then

entered the palace to pay respects to the elderly. However, he could not

find his uncle and aunt, the daughter of King Subala.

PURPORT

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira was the most pious king because he personally practiced daily the pious duties for the householders. _ The householders are required to rise early in the morning, and after bathing, they should offer respects to the Deities at home by prayers, by offering fuel in the sacred fire, by giving the brihmaruu in charity land, cows, grains, gold, etc., and at last offering to the elderly members due respects and obeisances. Unless one is prepared to practice injunctions which are prescribed in the śiistras, one cannot be a good man simply by book knowledge. Modern householders are practiced to different modes of life, namely to rise late and then take bed tea without any sort of cleanliness and without any purificatory practices as mentioned above. The household children are taken to practice that which the parents practice, and therefore the whole generation glides towards hell. Nothing good can be expected from them unless they associate with śiidhus. Like Dbrtarātra, the materialistic person may take lessons from a śiidhu like Vidura and thus be cleansed of the effects of modern life.

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, however, could not find in the palace his two uncles, namely Dbrtarātra and Vidura, along with Gandhiri, the daughter of King Subala. He was anxious to see them and, therefore, asked Saiijaya, the private secretary of Dbrtaraṣṭra.

Text 33) Dhrtariṣṭra Quits Home

TEXT 32

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ill4ctilṣ 'li ṣ fi) ṣ;{ṣṣ ṣ: ṣṣṣṣII
tatra sanjayam iisinam
paprochodvigna-miinasap
giivalgape kva nas tiito
v[ddho hina.S ca netrayop

701

tatra-there; sanjayam-unto Saiijaya; iisinam-seated; papraccha-in
quired from; udvigna-manasa[l-filled with anxiety; giivalga!le-the son of

Gavalgan, Saiijaya; kva-where is; nap-our; tiitap-uncle; v,rddha[l-old;
hina[l ca-as also bereft of; netrayop-by the eyes.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yu□!hira, full of anxiety, turned to Saiijaya, who was
sitting there, and said: o Saiijaya, where is our uncle, who is old and
blind?

TEXT 33

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ambii ca hata-putrii.'rtii

pitrvya[l kva gata[l suhrt

api mayy akarta-prajne

hata-bandhup sa bhiiryayii.

iiSamsamiinap samalam

gangiiyii.m du[lkhito'patat

ambii.[l-mother aunt; ca-and; hata-putrii.-who had lost all her sons;

ii.rtii.-in a sorry plight; pit.royap-uncle Vidura; kva-where; gatap-gone;

suhrt-well-wisher; api-whether; mayi-unto me; akrtaprajne-ungrateful;

hata-bandhu[l-one who has lost all his sons; sap-along with; bhii.ryayii.-

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his wife; iisamsa-miina[l.-in doubtful mind; samalam-offenses;gahgiyiim

in the Ganges water; du[l.khita[l.-in distressed mind; apatat-fell down.

TRANSLATION

Where is my well-wisher, uncle Vidura, and mother Gandhari, who is
very afflicted due to all her sons' demise? My uncle Dh.ttara□ra was also
very mortified due to the death of all his sons and grandsons. Undoubtedly
I am very ungratefuL Did he, therefore, take my offenses very seriously
and, along with his wife, drown himself in the Ganges?

PURPORT

The Pa!J.slavas, especially Maharaja Yudhi□thira and Arjuna, anticipated
the aftereffects of the Battle of Kuruk□etra, and therefore Arjuna declined

to execute the fighting. The fight was executed by the will of the Lord, hut the effects of family aggrievement, as they thought of it before, had come to be true. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was always conscious of the great plight of his uncle Dh.ttar□tra and aunt Gandhari, and therefore he took all possible care of them in their old age and aggrieved conditions. When, therefore, he could not find his uncle and aunt in the palace, naturally his doubts arose, and he conjectured that they went down to the water of the Ganges. He thought himself ungrateful because when the Pa!slavas were fatherless, Maharaja Dh.ttar□tra gave them all royal facilities to live, and in return he had killed all his sons in the Battle of Kuruk□etra. As a pious man, Maharaja Yudhi□thira took into account all his unavoidable misdeeds, and he never thought of the misdeeds of his uncle and company. Dh.ttar□tra had suffered the effects of his own misdeeds by the will of the Lord, hut Maharaja Yudhi□thira was only thinking of his own unavoidable misdeeds. That is the nature of a good man and devotee of the Lord. A devotee never finds fault with others, but tries to find out his own, and thus rectify them as far as possible.

TEXT 34

Aa+td □ □: w:: ftl'ul

□ oqe;ca: Actwil • •tad4a: u□vu

pitary uparate piicr9au

saroiiin na[l. suhrda{l si.Sun

ara□□atiim vyasanata{l

pit_royau kva gatiivita[l.

Text 35] Dhrtar□tra Quits Home 703

pitari-upon my father; uparate-falling down; pa[l{iau- Maharaja Pap□u;
saroan-all; na[l-us; suhrdafl-well- wisher; siSun-small children; arak□atiim
-protected; vyasanata[l-from all kinds of dangers; pit.rvyau-uncles; kva
where; gatau-have departed; ita[l-from this place.

TRANSLATION

When my father Pap□u fell down and we were all small children,
these two uncles gave us protection from all kinds of calamities. They were

always our good well-wishers. Alas, where have they gone from here?

TEXT 35

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suta uviica

k[payii sneha-vaiklavyiit

suto viraha-karṣita[]

iitmesvaram acak□iirto

na pratyiihiitipi!]ita[]

suta[] uviica-Siita Gosvami said; k.rpayii-out of full compassion; sneha

vaiklavyiit-mental derangement due to profound affection; suta[]

Saiijaya; viraha-karsita[]-distressed by separation; iitma-iSvaram-his

master; acak□iirtafl-having not seen; na-did not; pratyiiha- replied;

atipi!]ita[]-being too aggrieved.

TRANSLATION

Siita Gosvami said: Saiijaya, having not seen his own master, Dhftar

□tra, due to compassion for his grief and mental condition, could not properly reply to Maharaja Yud□hira.

PURPORT

Saiijaya was the personal assistant of Maharaja Yudhi□thira for a very long time, and thus he had the opportunity to study the life of Dhftara□tra.

And when he saw at last that Dhftara□tra had left home without his know-

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ledge, even his sorrows had no bound. He was fully compassionate toward

Dhftara□tra because in the game of the Battle of Kuruk□etra, King Dhftar

a□tra had lost everything, men and money, and at last the King and the

Queen had to leave home in utter frustration. He studied the situation in

his own way because he did not know that the inner vision of D hftara□ra

was awakened by Vidura and that therefore he had left home in enthusi

astic cheerfulness for a better life after departure from the dark well of

home. Unless one is convinced of a better life after renunciation of the

present life, one cannot stick to the renounced order of life simply by artificial dress or staying out of the home.

TEXT 36

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3hUa;a! □ !Pit: ql&>l'll□"(i{ □□□□II

vim.rjyiiSrnpī papibhyīm

viṣṭabhyītmīnam ītmanī

ajīta-satrum pratyuce

prabho[l piidiivanusmaran

vim.rjya-smearing; asrupi-tears of the eyes; piipibhyīm-with his

hands; viṣṭabhya-situated; itmaniim-the mind; itmanī-by intelligence;

ajīta-satrum-unto Maharaja Yudhi□thira; pratyilce-began to reply;

prabho{l-of his master; padau-feet; anusmaran-thinking after.

TRANSLATION

First he slowly pacified his mind by intelligence, and wiping away his tears and thinking of the feet of his master Dhrtar□!fa, he began to reply to Maharaja Yu□thira.

TEXT 37

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saii.jaya uviica

niiham veda vyavasitam

pitror va[l kula-nandana

giindhiiryii vii mahii-biiho

muṣito•smi mahiitmabhifi.

Text 37] Dhrtar□tfa Quits Home 705

sanjayap uviica-Safijaya said; na-not; aham-myself; veda-in know

ledge; vyavasitam-determination; pitro"{l-of your uncles; vafi.-your; kula

nandana-o descendant of the Kuru dynasty; giindhiiryii"{l-by Gandhari;

vii-or: mahii-biiho-o great King; muṣitap-cheated; asmi-I have been;

mahiitmabhi"{l-great souls.

TRANSLATION

Saijaya said: My dear descendant of the Kuru dynasty, I have no information of the determination of your two uncles and' Gandhliri. O King, I have been cheated by those great souls.

PURPORT

That great souls cheat others may be astonishing to know, but it is a fact that great souls cheat others for a great cause. It is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa also advised Yudhiṣṭhira to tell a lie before Droṇa, and it was also for a great cause. The Lord wanted it, and therefore it was a great cause. Satisfaction of the Lord is the criterion of the bona fides, and the highest perfection of life is to satisfy the Lord by one's occupational duty. That is the verdict of Gītā and Bhāgavatam. * Dhṛtaraṣṭra and Vidura, followed by Gandhārī, did not disclose their determination to Saṁjaya, although he was constantly with Dhṛtaraṣṭra as his personal assistant. Saṁjaya never thought that Dhṛtaraṣṭra could perform any act without consulting him. But Dhṛtaraṣṭra's going away from home was so confidential that it could not even be disclosed to Saṁjaya. Sanātana Gosvami also cheated the keeper of the prison house while going away to see Śrī Caitanya Mahāprabhu, and similarly Rāghunātha Dīkṣa Gosvami also cheated his priest and left home for good to satisfy the Lord. To satisfy the Lord, anything is good, for it is in relation with the Absolute Truth. We also had the same opportunity to cheat the family members and leave home to engage in the necessary for a great cause, and there is no loss for any party in such transcendental fraud.

*_yataft pravrttir bhiltiiniim yena sarvam idam tatam
svakarma[lii tam abhyarcya siddhim vindati miinavaft. (Bg. 18.46)
ataft pumbhir dvija-sreṣ[hii var[liisrama-vibhiigasaft
.wanus[hitasya dharmasya saril.siddhir hari-toṣa[lam (Bhiig. 1.2.13)
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TEXT 38

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Slts;□tll..lfitsntU((11□&□)s.-q\$("fJMt(□□□□II

athijagiima bhagaviin

nirada□ saha-tumburu□

pratyutthiibhiviidya

siinujobhyarcayan munim

atha-thereafter; ajagiima-arrived ; bhagaviin-the godly personality;

nirada□-Narada; saha tumburu□-along with his tumbu'ru (musical instrument); pratyutthaya- having gotten up from their seats; abhiviidya

offering their due obeisances; aha-said; sa-anuja□- along with younger brothers; abhyarcayan-thus while receiving in a proper mood; munim the sage.

TRANSLATION

While Safijaya was thus speaking, Sri Narada, the powerful devotee of the Lord, appeared on the scene. Maharaja Yudhi□hira and his brothers received him properly by getting up from their seats and offering obeisances.

PURPORT

Devar□i Narada is described herein as bhagaviin due to his being the most confidential devotee of the Lord. The Lord and His very confidential devotees are treated on the same level by those who are actually engaged in the loving service of the Lord. Such confidential devotees of the Lord are very much dear to the Lord because they travel everywhere to preach the glories of the Lord in different capacities and try their utmost to convert the nondevotees of the Lord into devotees in order-to bring them to the platform of sanity. Actually a living being cannot be a nondevotee of the Lord because of his constitutional position, but when one becomes a nondevotee or nonbeliever, it is to be understood that the person concerned is not in a sound condition of life. The confidential devotees of the Lord treat such illusioned living beings, and therefore they are most pleasing in the eyes of the Lord. The Lord says in the Bhagavad-gita that no one is dearer to Him than one who actually preaches the glories of the Lord to convert the nonbelievers and nondevotees. Such personalities as Narada must be offered all due respects, like those offered to the Personality of Godhead Himself, and Maharaja Yudhi□thira, along with his noble brothers,

were examples for others in receiving a pure devotee of the Lord like Narada, who had no other business save and except singing the glories of the Lord along with his vi[tii, a musical stringed instrument ..

Text 40] Dhrtarawa Quits Home

TEXT 39

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;nt □ '1M fq=it□liti • •r<nfiHu 1

PRCIT«<t□SII□tli'RII □ <Jqftcl;t1ll□'ll

yudh□thira uviica

niiharh veda gatirh pitror

bhagavan kva gatiiv ita□

ambii vii hata-putriirtii

kva gatii ca tapasvini

707

yudh□thira□ uviica-Maharaja Yudhi□thira said; na-do not; aham myself; veda-know it;gatim-departure;pitro□-of the uncles; bhagavan-o godly personality;kva-where;gatau-gone;ita□-from this place; ambii mother aunt; vii-either; hata-putrii-bereft of her sons; iirtii-aggrieved; kva-where;gata-gone;ca-also; tapasvini-ascetic.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yudhi□thira said: o godly personality, I do not know where my two uncles have gone. Nor can I find my ascetic aunt who is grief stricken by the loss of all her sons.

PURPORT

Maharaja Yudhi□thira, as a good soul and devotee of the Lord, was always conscious of the great loss of his aunt and her sufferings as an ascetic. An ascetic is never disturbed by all kinds of sufferings, and that makes him strong and determined on the path of spiritual progress. Queen Gandhari is a typical example of an ascetic by her marvelous character in many trying situations. She was an ideal woman as mother, wife and ascetic, and in the history of the world such character in a woman is rarely found.

TEXT40

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31'-IM¥111 □ wnoo lf.tQ"CI¥1: ll\lo II

kaJ?la-dharo iviipare

bhagavan para-dar5aka□

athababhafle bhagavan

narado muni-sattama□

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ka1'fllldhiiro-captain of the ship; iva-like; apiire-in the extensive oceans; bhagaviin-representative of the Lord; parodarsakap-one who can give directions to the other end; atha- thus; ababhiiJe-began to say; bhagavan-the godly personality; niirodap-the great sage Narada; muni sattamap-the greatest among the devotee-philosophers.

TRANSLATION

You are like a captain of a ship in a great ocean and you can direct us to our destination. Thus addressed, the godly personality, Devar□ Narada, greatest of the philosopher devotees, began to speak.

PURPORT

There are different types of philosophers, and the greatest of all of them are those who have seen the Personality of Godhead and have surrendered themselves in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. Among all such pure devotees of the Lord, Devar□i Narada is the chief, and therefore he has been described herein as the greatest of all philosopher devotees. Unless one is a sufficiently learned philosopher by hearing the Vedanta philosophy from a bona fide spiritual master, one cannot be a learned philosopher devotee. One must be very faithful, learned and renounced, otherwise one cannot be a pure devotee. A pure devotee of the Lord can give us direction towards the other end of nescience. Devar□i Narada used to visit the palace of Maharaja Yudhi□thira because the Pap.□avas were all pure devotees of the Lord, and the Devar□i was always ready to give them good counsel whenever needed.

TEXT41

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B □Ria□ B □□,..1\i □ IIV□II

niirada uviica

mii kaicana suco riijan

yad iSvara-va5am jagat

lokiip sapalii yasyeme

vahanti balim iSitup

sa sarhyunakti bhii.tiini

sa eva viyunakti ca

Text 41] Dhrtar□va Quits Home 709

niiradafl uviica-Narada said; mii-never; kaicana-by all means; sucafl
do you lament; riijan-o King; yat-because; iSvaro-vasam-under the
control of the Supreme Lord; jagat-world; lokiifl-all living beings;
sapiiliifl-in cluding their leaders; yasya-whose; ime-all these; vahanti-do
bear; balim-means of worship; iSitufi-for being protected; safl-he;
samyunakti-gets together; bhutiini-all living beings; safl-he; eva-also;
viyunakti-disperses; ca-and.

TRANSLATION

Sri Narada said: o pious King, do not lament for anyone, for every
one is under the control of the Supreme Lord. Therefore all living beings
and their leaders carry on worship to be well protected. It is He only who
brings them together and disperses them.

PURPORT

Every living being, either in this material world or in the spiritual world,
is under the control of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead.
Beginning from Brahmaji, the leader of this universe, down to the insig-
nificant ant, all are abiding by the order of the Supreme Lord. Thus the
constitutional position of the living being is subordination under the
control of the Lord. The foolish living being, especially man, artificially
rebels against the law of the Supreme and thus becomes chastised as an

iisura or lawbreaker. A living being is placed in a particular position by the order of the Supreme Lord, and he is again shifted from that place by the order of the Supreme Lord or His authorized agents. Brahma, Siva, Indra, Candra, Maharaja Yudhishthira or, in modern history, Napoleon, Akbar, Alexander, Gandhi, Subhas or Nehru, all are servants of the Lord, and they are placed in and removed from their respective positions by the supreme will of the Lord. None of them is independent. Even though such men or leaders rebel so as not to recognize the supremacy of the Lord, they are put under still more rigorous laws of the material world by different miseries. Only the foolish man, therefore, says that there is no God. Maharaja Yudhishthira was being convinced of this naked truth because he was greatly overwhelmed by the sudden departure of his old uncles and aunt. Maharaja Duryodhana was placed in that position according to his past deeds; he had already suffered or enjoyed the benefits accrued to him in the past, but due to his good luck, somehow or other he got a good younger brother, Vidura, and by his instruction he had left to achieve salvation by closing all accounts in the material world.

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Ordinarily no one can change the course of one's due happiness and distress by plan. Everyone has to accept them as they come under the subtle arrangement of kila, or invincible time. There is no use trying to counteract them. The best thing is, therefore, that one should endeavor to achieve salvation, and this prerogative is given only to man because of his developed condition of mental activities and intelligence. Only for man are there different Vedic instructions for attainment of salvation during the human form of existence. One who misuses this opportunity of advanced intelligence is verily condemned and put into different types of miseries, either in this present life or in the future. That is the way the Supreme controls everyone.

TEXT42

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ttlifi□ffil4•□"feYftfal:u□□□□

yathii giivo nasi protiis

tantiim baddhiis ca diimabhifi.

viiktantiim niimabhir baddhii

vahanti balim iSitu[]

yathii-as much as; giivafl.-cow; nasi- by the nose; protiifl.-women;

tantiim-by the thread; baddhii[]-bound up by; ca-also; diimabhi[]- by

ropes; viiktantiim-in the network of Vedic hymns; niimabhi[]-by

nomenclatures; baddhiifl.- conditioned; vahan ti- carry on; balim-orders;

iSitu[]-for being controlled by the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

As a cow, bound through the nose by a long rope, is conditioned,

so also htlllan beings are bound by different Vedic injunctions and are

conditioned to obey the orders of the Supreme.

PURPORT

Every living being, whether a man or an animal or a bird, etc., thinks that he is free by himself, but actually no one is free from the severe laws of the Lord. The laws of the Lord are severe because they cannot be disobeyed in any circumstance. The manmade laws may be evaded by cunning outlaws, but in the codes of the supreme lawmaker, there is not the slightest possibility of neglecting the laws. A slight change in the course of

Text 42) Dhrtar3{!tra Quits Home 711

God-made law can bring about a massive danger to be faced by the lawbreaker- Such laws of the Supreme are generally known as the codes of religion under different conditions, but the principle of religion everywhere is one and the same, namely, obey the orders of the Supreme God. (Codes of Religion) That is the condition of material existence. All living beings in the material world have taken up the risk of conditioned life by their own selection and are thus entrapped by the laws of material nature. The only way to get out of the entanglement is to agree to obey the Supreme. But instead of becoming free from the clutches of miiyii or illusion, foolish human beings become bound up by different nomenclatures, being designated as briihma!laS, kṣatriyas, vai.Syas, sudras, Hindus, Mussulmans,

Indians, Europeans, Americans, Chinese, and many others, and thus they carry out the orders of the Supreme Lord under the influence of respective scriptural or legislative injunctions. The statutory laws of the state are imperfect imitation replicas or Religious Codes. The secular state, or the godless state, allows the citizens to break the laws of God, but restricts them from disobeying the laws of the state; the result is that the people in general suffer more by breaking the laws of God than by obeying the imperfect laws made by man. Every man is imperfect by constitution under conditions of material existence, and there is not the least possibility of enacting a perfect legislation by the most materially advanced man. On the other hand, there is no such imperfection in the laws of God. If they are educated in the laws of God, there is no necessity of a makeshift legislative council of aimless men. There is necessity of change in the makeshift laws of man, but there is no change in the God-made laws because they are made perfect by the all-perfect Personality of Godhead. (Codes of Religion) Scriptural injunctions are made by liberated representatives of God in consideration of different conditions of living, and by carrying on the orders of the Lord gradually, the conditioned living beings become free from the clutches of material existence. The factual position of the living being is, however, that he is the eternal servitor of the Supreme Lord. In his liberated state he renders service to the Lord in transcendental love and thus enjoys a life of full freedom, even sometimes on the equal level with the Lord or sometimes more than the Lord. But in the conditioned material world, every living being wants to be the Lord of other living beings, and thus by the illusion of *mīyī* such mentality of lording it becomes a cause of further extension of conditional life. So in the material world the living being is still more conditioned, until he surrenders unto the Lord by reviving his original state of eternal servitorship. That is the last instruction of the Bhagavad-gītā and all other recognized scriptures of the world.

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yathii kri!lopaskariipam

samyoga-vigamiiv iha

icchayii kri!'itu{l. syatiim

tathaivesecchayii n{!liim

yathii.-as much as; kri!la -paskaravam- playthings; samyoga-union;
vigamau-disunion; iha-as much as; icchaya-by the will of; kri!litu{l.-just
to play a part; syatam-takes place; tatha-so also; eva- certainly; iSa-the
Supreme Lord; icchaya-by the will of; nrvam-of the human being.

TRANSLATION

As a player sets up and disperses his playthings according to his own
sweet will, so the supreme will of the Lord brings men together and
separates them.

PURPORT

We must know for certain that the particular position in which we are
now set up is an arrangement of the supreme will in terms of our own acts
in the past. The Supreme Lord is present as the localized Paramatma in the
heart of every living being, as it is said in the Bhagavad-gita (Bg. 13.22),
and therefore He knows everything of our activities in every stage of our
lives. The reactions of our actions are rewarded by Him by placing us in
some particular place. A rich man gets his son born with a silver spoon in
his mouth, but the child who came as the rich man's son deserved such a
place, and therefore he is placed there by the will of the Lord. And at a
particular moment when the child has to be removed from that place, he
is also carried by the will of the Supreme, even if the child or the father
does not wish to be separated from the happy relation. The same thing
happens in the case of a poor man also. Neither rich man nor poor man has
any control over such meetings or separations of living beings. The example
of a player and his playthings should not be misunderstood. One may argue
that the Lord is bound to award the reactionary results of our own actions,
and thus the example of a player cannot be applied. But it is not so. We

Text44) Dhrīarātra Quits Home 713

must always remember that the Lord is the supreme will, and He is not bound by any law. Generally the law of karma is that one is awarded the result of one's own actions, but in special cases, by the will of the Lord; such resultant actions are changed also. But this change can be effected by the will of the Lord only, and no other. Therefore, the example of the player cited in this verse is quite appropriate, for the Supreme Will is absolutely free to do whatever He likes; and because He is all-perfect, there is no mistake in any of His actions or reactions. These changes of resultant actions are especially rendered by the Lord when a pure devotee is involved. It is assured in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 9.30-31) that the Lord saves a pure devotee who has surrendered unto Him without reservation from all sorts of reactions of sins, and there is no doubt about this. There are hundreds of examples of this by the Lord in the history of the world. If the Lord is able to change the resultant reactions of one's past deeds, then certainly He is not Himself bound up by any action or reaction of His own deeds. He is perfect and transcendental to all laws.

TEXT44

yan manyase dhrnvam lokam

adhrnvam vii na cobhayam

sarvathii na hi socyis te

snehiid anyatra mohajiit

yat-even though; manyase-you think; dhrnvam-Absolute Truth;

lokam-persons; adhrnvam- nonreality; vii- either; na-or not; ca-also;

ubhayam- or bothwise; sarvathii-in all circumstances; na-never; hi-cer-

tainly; socyii [I]-subject for lamentation; snehiit-due to affection;

anyatra-or otherwise; mohajiit-due to bewilderment.

TRANSLATION

O King, in all circumstances, whether you consider the soul to be an eternal principle, or the material body to be perishable, or everything to exist in the impersonal Absolute Truth, or everything to be an inexplicable combination of matter and spirit, feelings of separation are due only to

illusory affection and nothing more.

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PURPORT

The actual fact is that every living being is an individual part and parcel of the Supreme Being, and his constitutional position is subordinate cooperative service. Either in his conditional material existence or in his liberated position of full knowledge and eternity, the living entity is eternally under the control of the Supreme Lord. But those who are not conversant with factual knowledge put forward many speculative propositions about the real position of the living entity. It is admitted, however, by all schools of philosophy, that the living being is eternal and that the covering body of five material elements is perishable and temporary. The eternal living entity transmigrates from one material body to another by the law of karma, and material bodies are perishable by their fundamental structures. Therefore there is nothing to be lamented in the case of the soul's being transferred into another body, or the material body perishing at a certain stage. There are others also who believe in the merging of the spirit soul in the Supreme Spirit when it is uncovered by the material encagement, and there are others also who do not believe in the existence of spirit or soul, but believe in tangible matter. In our daily experience we find so many transformations of matter from one form to another, but we do not lament such changing features. In either of the above cases, the force of divine energy is uncheckable; no one has any hand in it, and thus there is no cause of grief.

TEXT⁴⁵

tasmiiḥ jāyā āṅga vāiklaivyam

ajīrṇa-kṛtām itmanaḥ.

katham tvanīthīḥ. kṛpāṇāṁ

varteraṁ te ca mīmāṃsīṇaḥ

tasmiit-therefore; jāyā-give up; āṅga-o King; vāiklaivyam-disparity of the mind; ajīrṇa-ignorance; kṛtām-due to; itmanaḥ-of yourself; katham-how; tu-but; anīthīḥ-helpless; kṛpāṇāṁ-poor creatures; varteraṁ-be

able to survive; te-they; ca-also; miim-me; vinii-without.

TRANSLATION

Therefore give up your anxiety due to ignorance of the self. You are now thinking of how they, who are helpless, poor creatures, will exist with()Ut you.

Text46] Dhrtar3{11J"a Quits Home 715

PURPORT

When we think of our kith and kin being helpless and dependent on us, it is all due to ignorance. Every living creature is allowed all protection by the order of the Supreme Lord in terms of each one's acquired position in the world. The Lord is known as bhiita-bhrt, one who gives protection to all living beings. One should discharge his duties only; only the Supreme Lord can give protection to anyone else. This is explained more clearly in the following verse.

TEXT46

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kiila-karma.gupiidhino

deho'yam piinca-bhautika[l

katham anyiims tu gopiiyet

sarpa-grasto yathiiparam

kiila[l-eterna l time; karma-action; gupa-modes of nature; iidhina[l

under the control of; deha[l-mater ial body and mind; ayam-this; piiica

five; bhautika[l-made of the five elements; katham-how; anyiin-others;

tu-but; gopiiyet-give protection; sarpa-grasta[l-one who is bitten by the

snake; yathii- as much as; param-others.

TRANSLATION

This gross material body made of five elements is already under the control of eternal time [kala] , action [karma] and the modes of material nature [guQa] . How, then, can it, being already in the jaws of the serpent, protect others?

PURPORT

The freedom movements of the world and political, economic, social, and cultural propaganda can do no benefit to anyone due to their being controlled by superior power. A conditioned living being is under the full control of material nature represented by eternal time and activities under the dictation of different modes of nature. There are three material modes of nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. Unless one is situated in the mode of goodness, one cannot see things as they are. The passionate and the ignorant cannot even see things as they are. Therefore a person who is passionate and ignorant cannot direct his activities on the right path. Only the man in the quality of goodness can help to a certain extent. Most persons are passionate and ignorant, and therefore, their plans and projects can hardly do any good to others. Above the modes of nature

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there is eternal time, which is called kiila because it changes the shape of everything in the material world. Even if we are able to do something temporarily beneficial, time will see that the good project is frustrated in course of time. The only thing which is possible to be done is to get rid of the eternal time, kiila, which is compared to kiila-sarpa, or the cobra snake whose bite is always lethal. No one can be saved from the bite of a cobra. The best remedy for getting out of the clutches of the cobralike kiila or its integrity, the modes of nature, is bhakti-yoga, as it is recommended in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 14.26). The highest perfectional project of philanthropic activities is to engage everyone in the act of preaching bhakti-yoga all over the world because that alone can save the people -from the control of miiyii or the material nature represented by kiila, karma and gura, as described above. The Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 14.26) confirms this definitely.

TEXT47

31C(ijlr.t (C((ijl-.l'tq(IM "4d"ti\li(I
CMt[f.l ft Q □'R) □ □q.i(II \l\911
ahadiini sa-hastiiniim
apadiini catu□-padiim
phalgii.ni tatm mahatiim

jivo jivasya jivanam

ahastiini-those who are devoid of hands; sa-hastiiniim-of those who are endowed with hands; apadiini-those who are endowed with legs; catu[l-padiim-of those who have four legs ; phalguni-those who are weak; tatra-there; mahatiim-of the powerful; jiva[l-the living being; jivasya of the living being; jivanam-subsistence.

TRANSLATION

Those who are devoid of hands are prey for those who have hands; those devoid of legs are prey for the four-legged. The weak are the subsistence of the strong, and the general rule holds that one living being is food for another.

PURPORT

A systematic law of subsistence in the struggle for existence is there by the supreme will, and there is no escape for anyone by any amount of planning. The living beings who have come to the material world against the will of the Supreme Being are under the control of a supreme power called miiyii-sakti, the deputed agent of the Lord, and this daivi miiyii is Text 47] Dhrtar□a Quits Home 717

meant to pinch the conditioned souls by threefold miseries, one of which is explained here in this verse: the weak is the subsistence of the strong. No one is strong enough to protect himself from the onslaught of a stronger, and by the will of the Lord there are systematic categories of the weak, th□ stronger and the strongest. There is nothing to be lamented if a tiger eats a weaker animal, including a man, because that is the law of the Supreme Lord. But although the law states that a human being must subsist on another living being, there is the law of good sense also, for the human being is meant to obey the laws of the scriptures also. This is impossible for other animals. The human being is meant for self-realization, and for that purpose he is not to eat anything which is not first offered to the Lord. The Lord accepts from His devotee all kinds of food preparations made of vegetable, namely fruits and leaves and grains. Fruits, leaves and milk in different varieties can be offered to the Lord, and after

the Lord accepts the foodstuff, the devotee can partake of the prasiidam by which all sufferings in the struggle for existence will be gradually mitigated. This is confirmed in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 9.22). Even those who are accustomed to eat animals can offer foodstuff, not to the Lord directly, but to an agent of the Lord, under certain conditions of religious rites. Injunctions of the scriptures are not meant to encourage the eaters of animals, hut to restrict them by regulated principles.

The living being is the source of subsistence for other stronger living beings. No one should be very anxious for his subsistence in any circumstances because there are living beings everywhere, and no living being starves for want of food at any place. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira is advised by Narada not to worry about his uncles' suffering for want of food, for they could live on vegetables available in the jungles as prasiidam of the Supreme Lord and thus realize the path of salvation.

Exploitation of the weaker living being by the stronger is the natural law of existence; there is always an attempt to devour the weak in different kingdoms of the living being. There is no possibility of checking this tendency by any artificial means under material conditions, but it can only be checked by awakening the spiritual sense of the human being by practice of spiritual regulations. The spiritual regulative principles, however, do not allow a man to slaughter weaker animals on one side and teach others peaceful coexistence. If man does not allow the animals peaceful coexistence, how can he expect peaceful existence in human society?

The blind leaders must therefore understand the Supreme Being and then try to implement the kingdom of God. The kingdom of God or Rīimariijya is impossible without the awakening of God consciousness in the mass mind of the people of the world.

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TEXT48

□ □ □NI-'"4 iiR+iiSRtMI □I

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tad idarh bhagaviin riijann

eka itmiitmaniirh svadrk

antaro'nantaro bhiiti

pasya tam miiyayorudhii

tat-therefore; idam-this manifestation; bhagavan-the Personality of Godhead; rajan-o King; eka{l-one without a second; atmii-the Supersoul; atmanam-by His energies; svadrk-qualitatively like Him; antara{l-with out; ananta ra{l-within and by Himself; bhati-so manifests; pasya-look; tam-unto Him only; mayaya-by manifestations of different energies; urudha-appears to be many.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, o King, you should look to the Supreme Lord only, who is one without a second and who manifests Himself by different energies and is both within and without.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is one without a second, but He manifests Himself by different energies because He is by nature blissful. The living beings are also manifestations of His marginal energy, qualitatively one with the Lord, and there are innumerable living beings both within and without the external and internal energies of the Lord. Since the spiritual world is a manifestation of the Lord's internal energy, the living beings within that internal potency are qualitatively one with the Lord without contamination from the external potency. Although qualitatively one with the Lord, the living being, due to contamination of the material world, is pervertedly manifested, and therefore he experiences so-called happiness and distress in the material world. Such experiences are all ephemeral and do not affect the spirit soul. The perception of such ephemeral happiness and distress is due only to the forgetfulness of his qualities, which are equal to the Lord's. There is, however, a regular current by which to rectify the fallen condition of the living being by the Lord Himself from within and without. From within He corrects the desiring living being as localized Paramatma, and from without He corrects by His manifestations, the spiritual master and the revealed scriptures. One

should look unto the Lord; one should not be disturbed by the so-called
 Text49] Dhrtarii{ltra Quits Home 719
 manifestations of happiness or distress, but he should try to cooperate
 with the Lord in His outward activities for correcting the fallen souls. By
 His order only one should become a spiritual master and cooperate with
 the Lord. One should not become a spiritual master for one's personal
 benefit or for some material gain or as an avenue of business or occupation
 for earning livelihood. Bona fide spiritual masters who look unto the
 Supreme Lord to cooperate with Him are actually qualitatively one with
 the Lord, and the forgetful ones are perverted reflections only. Yudhi□thira
 Maharaja is advised, therefore, by Narada not to be disturbed with the
 affairs of so-called happiness and distress, but to look only unto the Lord
 to execute the mission for which the Lord has descended. That was his
 prime duty.

TEXT49

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so 'yam adya mahiirijja

bhagaviin bhiita-bhiivanafl

kiila-riipo 'vatirro 'syiim

abhiiviiya sura-dv□iim

sap-that Supreme Lord; ayam-the Lord Sri Kr□l}a; adya- at present;
 mahiirijja-o King; bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead; bhuta-bhiivanafl
 -the creator or the father of everything created; kiila-riipafl- in the disguise
 of devouring time; avatirrafl-descended; asyiim-upon the world; abhiiviiya
 -for eliminating; sura-dviṣiim-those who are against the will of the Lord.

TRANSLATION

That Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kr□!la in the guise of
 all devouring time [kala-riipa] has now descended on earth to eliminate
 the envious from the world.

PURPORT

There are two classes of human beings, namely the envious and the obedient. Since the Supreme Lord is one and the father of all living beings, the envious living beings are also His sons, but they are known as the asums. But the living beings who are obedient to the Supreme Father are called devatiis, or demigods, because they are not contaminated by the material conception of life. The asums are not only envious of the Lord in even denying the existence of the Lord, but they are also envious of all other living beings. The predominance of asums in the world is occasionally

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rectified by the Lord when He eliminates them from the world and establishes a rule of devatiis like the Part9avas. His designation as kiila in disguise is significant. He is not at all dangerous, but He is the transcendental form of eternity, knowledge and bliss. For the devotees His factual form is disclosed, and for the nondevotees He appears like kiila-rilpa which is causal form. This causal form of the Lord is not at all pleasing to the asuras, and therefore they think of the Lord as formless in order to feel secure that they will not be vanquished by the Lord.

TEXT 50

f.l..q.fd>□ □ti□Yti!4□4 □I

lAt □n□R□: ll□ollmt 4{ttYt□□

n4paditam deva-krtyam

avllSeṣam pratikṣate

tiivad yuyam avekṣadhvam

bhaved yiivad ihesvara[]

n4piiditam-performed; deva-krtyam-what was to be done on behalf of the demigods; avaseṣam-the rest; pratikṣat e-being awaited; tiivat-up to that time; yuyam-all of you Part9avas; avekṣadhvam-observe and wait; bhavet-may; yiivat-as long as; iha-in this world; iSvara[],-the Supreme Lord.

TRANSLATION

The Lord has already performed His duties to help the demigods, and

He is awaiting the rest. You Partgavas may wait as long as the Lord is here on earth.

PURPORT

The Lord descends from His abode (Kṣīratiloka), the topmost planet in the spiritual sky, in order to help the demigod administrators of this material world when they are greatly vexed by the asuras, who are not only envious of the Lord but also of His devotees. As referred to above, the conditioned living beings contact material association by their own choice, dictated by a strong desire to lord it over the resources of the material world and become imitation lords of all they survey. Everyone is trying to become an imitation God; there is keen competition amongst such imitation gods, and such competitors are generally known as asuras. When there are too many asuras in the world, then it becomes a hell for those who are devotees of the Lord. Due to the growth of the asuras, the mass of people who are generally devoted to the Lord by nature and the

Text 51] Dhrtarāṣṭha Quits Home 721

pure devotees of the Lord, including the demigods in higher planets, pray to the Lord for relief, and the Lord either descends personally from His abode or deposes some of his devotees to remodel the fallen condition of human society, or even animal society. Such disruptions take place not only in the human society but also amongst animals, birds or other living beings, including the demigods in the higher planets. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa descended personally to vanquish asuras like Kamsa, Jarasandha, Śiṣupala, etc., and during the reign of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira almost all these asuras were killed by the Lord. Now he was awaiting the annihilation of His own dynasty, called the Yaduvamśa, who appeared by His will in this world. He wanted to take them away before His own departure to His eternal abode. Narada, like Vidura, did not disclose the imminent annihilation of the Yadu dynasty, but indirectly gave a hint to the King and his brothers to wait till the incident happens and the Lord departs.

TEXT 51

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C\ff □ Sll'ftun•u»JPi mr: 11 □ □ 11

dhrtar□trafi. saha bhriitrii

giindhiiryii ca sva-bhiiryayii

dakṣi!lena himavata

.□i!liim iisramam gatafi.

dhrtarii□frafi.- Dhrtarastra; saha- along with; bhriitrii-his brother Vidura;

giindhiiryii-Gandhari also; ca- and; sva-bhiiryayii-his own wife; dak□i!lena

-by the southern side; himavata[l.-of the Himalayan mountains; ni!liim

of the nis; iisramam-in shelter; gatafi.-he has gone.

TRANSLATION

O King, your uncle, Dhrtar□ra, his brother Vidura and his wife

Gandhari have gone to the southern side of the Himalayan mountains

where there are shelters of the great sages.

PURPORT

To pacify the mourning Maharaja Yudhi□thira, Narada first of all spoke from the philosophical point of view, and then he began to describe the future movements of his uncle, which he could see by his foreseeing powers, and thus began to describe as follows.

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TEXT 52

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«8r--f sffitit ;n;tt (18\itl6: □ □□□□II

srotobhifl. saptabhir yii vai

svardhuni saptadhii vyadhiit

saptiiniim pritaye niima

sapta-srotafl. pracak1ate

srotobhi[l.-by currents; saptabhifi.-by seven (divisions); yii-the river;

vai-certainly; svardhuni-the sacred Ganges; saptadhii-seven branches;

vyadhiit-created; saptiiniim-of the seven; pritaye-for the satisfaction of;

nama-various; sapta-srotafl.-seven sources;pracak□ate-known by name.

TRANSLATION

The place is called Saptasrota (divided by seven) because there the

waters of the sacred Ganges divide into seven branches. This was done for the satisfaction of the seven great Āis.

TEXT 53

(ai□HJ(1i!4•ht□..□□ :qasll;:qvnPd\t 1

□ '□Nijlw:(fl□l ij' □ Ntl3ttat: □□□□□□

sniitviinusavanam tasmin

hutvii ciignin yathiiividhi

abbhak□ upa.Siintiitma

sa iiste vigata4af1afl.

sniitvii-by taking bath; anusavanam-regularly three times (morning, noon and evening); tasmin-in that Ganges divided into seven; hutvii-by performing the Agni-hotra sacrifice; ca-also; agnin- in the fire; yathii vidhi-just according to the tenets of the scripture; abbhakṣa[l.-fasting by drinking only water; upasiinta-completely controlled; iitmii-the gross senses and the subtle mind; sa[i.-Dhrtarii.□tra; iiste-would be situated; vigata -devoid of; eṣapa[i.-thoughts in relation with family welfare.

TRANSLATION

On the banks at Saptasrota, Dhftarfu:!tra is now engaged in beginning □tariga-yoga by bathing three times daily, in the morning, noon and evening, by performing the Agnihotra sacrifice with fire and by drinking only water. This helps one control the mind and the senses and frees one completely from thoughts of familial affection.

Text 53] Dhrtarii{[va Quits Home 723

PURPORT

The yoga system is a mechanical way to control the senses and the mind and divert them from matter to spirit. The preliminary processes are the sitting posture, meditation, spiritual thoughts, manipulation of air passing within the body, and gradual situation in trance, facing the Absolute Person Paramatma. Such mechanical ways of rising up to the spiritual platform prescribe some regulative principles of taking bath daily three times, fasting as far as possible, sitting and concentrating the mind on spiritual matters and thus gradually becoming free from viṣaya or material

objectives. Material existence means to be absorbed in the material objective, which is simply illusory. House, country, family, society, children, property, business, etc., are some of the material coverings of the spirit iitmii, and the yoga system helps one to become free from all these illusory thoughts and gradually turn towards the Absolute Person Paramatma. By material association and education, we learn simply to concentrate on flimsy things, but yoga is the process of forgetting them altogether. Modern so-called yogis and yoga systems manifest some magical feats, and ignorant persons are attracted by such false things. or they accept the yoga system as a cheap healing process for diseases of the gross body. But factually the yoga system is the process of learning to forget what we have acquired throughout the struggle for existence. Dhrtarastra was all along engaged in improving family affairs by raising the standard of living of his sons or by usurping the property of the Pandavas for the sake of his own sons. These are common affairs for a man grossly materialistic and without knowledge of the spiritual force. He does not see how this can drag one from heaven to hell. By the grace of his younger brother Vidura, Dhrtarastra was enlightened and could see his grossly illusory engagements, and by such enlightenment he was able to leave home for spiritual realization. Sri Naradadeva was just foretelling the way of his spiritual progress in a place which was sanctified by the flow of the celestial Ganges. Drinking water only without solid food is also considered fasting. This is necessary for advancement of spiritual knowledge. A foolish man wants to be a cheap yogi without observing the regulative principles. A man who has no control over the tongue at first can hardly become a yogi. Yogi and bhogi are two opposite terms. The bhogi or the merryman who eats and drinks cannot be a yogi, for a yogi is never allowed to eat and drink unrestrictedly. We may note with profit how Dhrtarastra began his yoga system by drinking water only and sitting calmly in a place with a spiritual atmosphere, deeply absorbed in the thoughts of the Lord Hari, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 54

falaaQ;it □6JWIQ: Sl□lt61RPI\41: I

lR¥tl:twl□l lit(ij(liiltQ"fCC64it¥M: II□ \111

jitiisano jitaSviisa[l

pratyii-hrta-□al}-indriya[l

hari-bhiivanayii dhvasta-

raja[l sattva-tamomalalz.

jita-iisana[l-one who has controlled the sitting posture;jita-sviisa[l-one who has controlled the breathing process;pratyii-hrta-turning hack; □t six; indriya[l-senses; hari-the Absolute Personality of Godhead; bhiivanayii -absorbed in; dhvasta- conquered; raja"{l-passion; sattva-goodness; tamap -ignorance; mala"{l-contaminations.

TRANSLATION

One who has controlled the sitting postures [the yogic iisana) and the breathing process can turn the senses toward the Absolute Personality of Godhead and thus become immuned from the contaminations of the modes of material nature, namely mundane goodness, passion and ignorance. PURPORT

The preliminary activities of the way of yoga are iisana, prii[liiyiima, pratyiihiira, dhyiina, dhiirarii, etc. Maharaja Dhftara□tra was to attain success in those preliminary actions because he was seated in a sanctified place and was concentrating upon one objective, namely the Supreme Personality of Godhead (Hari). Thus all his senses were being engaged in the service of the Lord. This process directly helps the devotee to get freedom from the contaminations of the three material modes of nature. Even the highest mode, the material mode of goodness, is also a cause of material bondage, and what to speak of the other qualities, namely passion and ignorance. Passion and ignorance increase the material propensities of hankering for material enjoyment, and a strong sense of lust provokes the accumulation of wealth and power. One who has conquered these two base mentalities and has raised himself on the platform of goodness, which is full of knowledge and morality, cannot also control the senses, namely the

eyes, the tongue, the nose, the ear and touch. But one who has surrendered himself unto the lotus feet of Lord Hari, as above mentioned, can transcend all influences of the modes of material nature and he fixed in the service of the Lord. The bhakti-yoga process, therefore, directly applies senses to the loving service of the Lord. This prohibits the performer from

Text 55] Dhrtarawa Quits Home 725

engaging in material activities. This process of turning the senses from material attachment to the loving transcendental service of the Lord is called pratyihira, and the very process is called priip.iyyiima, ultimately ending in samiidhi, or absorption in pleasing the Supreme Lord Hari by all means. TEXT 55

N(lwtl□Ytr.t □ □ smeM □ I

i1QIIH4l□lwt'41□ EltiMI(f'HIMI' □□□□II

vijii.iiniitmani samyojya

k□etrafie praviliipya tam

brahmap.y itmiinam iidhiire

ghafiimbaram iviimbare

vijniina-purified identity; itmani-of intelligence; samyojya-perfectly fixing up; k□etrajne-in the matter of the living being;praviLlpya-merging; tam-hiin; brahmaczi-in the Supreme; atmanam-pure living being; adhare -in the reservoir; ghatiimbaram-sky within the block; iva-like; ambare in the supreme sky.

TRANSLATION

Dhrtar□a will have to amalgamate his pure identity with intelligence and then merge into the Supreme Being with knowledge of his qualitative oneness, as a living entity, with the Supreme Brahman. Being freed from the blocked sky, he will have to rise to the spiritual sky.

PURPORT

The living being, by his desiring to lord it over the material world and declining to cooperate with the Supreme Lord, contacts the sum total of the material world, namely the mahat-tattva, and from the mahat-tattva his false identity, with the material world, intelligence, mind, and the

senses, is developed. This covers his pure spiritual identity. By the yogic process, when his pure identity is realized, which is known as self-realization, then one has to revert to the original position by amalgamating the five gross elements and the subtle elements, mind and intelligence into the mahat-tattva again. Thus getting freed from the clutches of the mahat tattva, he has to merge in the existence of the Supersoul. In other words, he has to realize that qualitatively he is non-different from the Supersoul, and thus he transcends the material sky by his pure identical intelligence and thus becomes engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord. This is the highest perfectional development of spiritual identity, which was attained by Dhrtarastra by the grace of Vidura and the Lord. The

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Lord's mercy was bestowed upon him by his personal contact with Vidura, and when he was actually practicing the instructions of Vidura, the Lord helped him to attain the highest perfectional stage.

A pure devotee of the Lord does not live in any planet of the material sky, nor does he feel any contact with material elements. His so-called material body does not exist, being surcharged with the spiritual current of the Lord's identical interest, and thus he is permanently freed from all contaminations of the sum total of the mahat-tattva. He is always in the spiritual sky, which he attains by being transcendental to the sevenfold material coverings by the effect of his devotional service. The conditioned souls are within the coverings, whereas the liberated soul is far beyond the cover. TEXT 56

<tq(ij+(l41gtJO<(□ f.lqCfi(UII\14: I
f.li!lki61Rf4el□l(31M □lt!Ri!ii4R□: 1
6□1;:ij(li(t □: Q::tt(ij1Rf4e4i4uu H□□ 11
dhvast a-miiyii-gurtodarko
nir uddha-karartii.SayafI
nivartitiikhiliihiira
iiste sthiirtur iviicalafI
tasyiintariiyo maiviibhufl

sannyastiikhila-karmartafl

dhvasta-being destroyed; miiya-gu11a -the modes of material nature;
udarkafl-aftereffects; niruddha-being suspended; kararta-iisayafl-the
senses and the mind; niva rtita-stopped; akhila-all; iihira{l-food for the
senses; aste-is sitting; sthiif1up-immovable; ioo-like; adhuni-acalafl
fixed up; tasya-his; antariiyaf1-hindrances; mii iva-never like that; abhii[t
be; sannyasta-renounced; akhila-all sorts; karmartafl-material duties.

TRANSLATION

He will have to suspend all the actions of the senses, even from the outside, and will have to be impervious to interactions of the senses, which are influenced by the modes of material nature. After renouncing all material duties, he must become immovably established, beyond all sources of hindrances on the path.

PURPORT

Dhftar□tra had attained, by the yogic process, the stage of negation of all sorts of material reaction. The effects of the material modes of nature
Text 57] Dhrtar□tra Quits Home 727

draw the victim to the indefatigable desires of enjoying matter, but one can escape such false enjoyment by the yogic process. Every sense is always busy in searching for its food, and thus the conditioned soul is assaulted from all sides and has no chance to become steady in any pursuit. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was advised by Narada not to disturb his uncle by attempting to bring him back home. He was now beyond the attraction of anything material. The material modes of nature (the gup.as) have their different modes of activities, but above the material modes of nature there is a spiritual mode also which is absolute. Nirgup.a means without reaction. The spiritual mode and its effect are identical; therefore the spiritual quality is distinguished from its material counterpart by the word nirgup.a. After complete suspension of the material modes of nature, one is admitted to the spiritual sphere, and action dictated by the spiritual modes is called devotional service or bhakti. Bhakti is therefore nirgup.a attained by direct contact with the Absolute.

TEXT 57

q □ atQ(twtli! □ m: qirit□ 1

mt □ □ □ •Rifhtfci""RI □□□□II

sa vii adya.taniid rii.jan

parata[l paicame'hani

kalevaram hii.syati svam

tac ca bhasmibhaviṣyati

sa[!,-he; vii-in all probability; adya-today; taniit-from; rii.jan-o King;

para ta[l-ahead; paicame-on the fifth; ahani-day; kalevaram-body;

hii.syati-shall quit; svam-his own; tat- that; ca-also; bhasmi-ashes;

bhaviṣyati-will turn into.

TRANSLATION

o King, he will quit his body, most probably, on the fifth day from today. And his body will turn to ashes.

PURPORT

Narada Muni's prophecy prohibited Yudhi□!hira Maharaja to go to the place where his uncle was staying because even after quitting the body by his own mystic power, Dhftara□tra would not be in need of any funeral ceremony because Narada Muni indicated that his body by itself would burn to ashes. The perfection of the yoga system is attained by such mystic power: the yogi is able to quit his body by his own choice of time and can
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attain any planet he desires by turning the present body into ashes by self-made fire. TEXT 58

((□+tl□sfitf□ □: tRfi □ I

41ft:□ 'fffl'm□fhl+tM+tij□ □□□□II

dahyamiine'gnibhir dehe

patyufl patni sahotaje

bahifl sthita patim siidhvi

tam agnim anu vek□yati

dahyamiine-while it is burning; agnibhi[l-by the fire; dehe-the body;

patyufl-of the husband; patni-the wife; saha-utaje-along with the

thatched cottage; bahifl-outside;sthitii-situated;patim-onto the husband;
siiddvi-the chaste lady; tam-that; agnim-fire; anu vek\$yati-looking
with great attention shall enter the fire.

TRANSLATION

While outside observing her husband who will burn in the fire of
mystic power along with his thatched cottage, his chaste wife will enter
the fire with rapt attention.

PURPORT

Gandhari was an ideal chaste lady, a life companion of her husband, and
therefore when she saw her husband burning in the fire of mystic yoga
along with his cottage of leaves, she despaired. She left home after
losing her one hundred sons, and in the forest she saw that her most
beloved husband was also burning. Now she actually felt alone, and there
fore entered the fire of her husband and followed her husband to death.
This entering of a chaste lady into the fire of her dead husband is called
the sati rite, and the action is considered to be most perfect for a woman.
In a later age, this sati rite became an obnoxious criminal affair because the
ceremony was forced upon even an unwilling woman. In this fallen age it
is not possible for any lady to follow the sati rite as chastely as it was done
by Gandhliii and others in past ages. A chaste wife like Gandhari would
feel the separation of her husband to be more burning than actual fire.
Such a lady can observe the sati rite voluntarily, and there is no criminal
force by anyone. When the rite became a formality only and force was
applied upon a lady to follow the principle, actually it became criminal,
and therefore the ceremony was to be stopped by state law. This prophecy
of Narada Muni to Maharaja Yudhi□thira forbade him to go to his widow
aunt.

Text 60] Dhrtarawa Quits Home

TEXT 59

A((□ <ldJII□ fwt□IQ4 -□□.. I
ri□Cfi\$1(ij4Ui{ tR1 □: □□□□II
viduras tu tad iiScaryam

niSiimya kuru-nandana
harṣa-soka-yutas tasmiid
gantii tirtha-nivakaf

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viduraf-Vidura also; tu-but; tat-that incidence; iiScaryam-wonderful;
n iSiimya- seeing; kuru-nandana-o son of the Kuru dynasty; harṣa
delight; soka-grief; yutap-affected by; tasmiit-from that place; gantii
went away; tirtha- place of pilgrimage; nivakap-for being enlivened.

TRANSLATION

Vidura, being affected with delight and grief, will then leave that
place of sacred pilgrimage.

PURPORT

Vidura was astonished to see the marvelous departure of his brother
Dharmatara as a liberated yogi, for in his past life he was much attached to
materialism. Of course it was only due to Vidura that his brother attained
the desirable goal of life. He was therefore glad to learn about it. But he
was sorry that he could not make his brother turn into a pure devotee.
This was not done by Vidura because of Dharmatara's being inimical to the
Pappavas, who were all devotees of the Lord. An offense at the feet of a
Vaiṣṇava is more dangerous than an offense at the lotus feet of the Lord.
Vidura was certainly very liberal to bestow mercy upon his brother
Dharmatara, whose past life was very materialistic. But ultimately the
result of such mercy certainly depended on the will of the Supreme Lord
in the present life; therefore Dharmatara attained liberation only, and
after many such liberated states of life one can attain to the stage of
devotional service. Vidura was certainly very mortified by the death of
his brother and sister-in-law, and the only remedy to mitigate such lamen-
tation was to go out to pilgrimage. Thus Maharaja Yudhishthira had no
chance to call back Vidura, his surviving uncle.

TEXT 60

ṣṣ ifRG:: ij: I

Fttfkil it"i!! ṣṣ ṣṣ'I'JI(Iii"iii:

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ity uktviitharuhat svargam

naradah saha-tumburuh. .

yudhiṣṭhiro vacas tasya

hrdi krtviijahiiic chuca[l.

[Canto 1, Ch. 13

iti-thus; uktvii-having addressed; atha-thereafter; arnhat-ascended;

svargam-outer space; niiroda[l.-the great sage Narada; saha-along with;

tumburu[l.-his stringed instrument; yudh□thira[l.-Maharaja Yudhi□thira;

vaca[l.-instructions; tasya-of his; hrdi krtvii-keeping in the heart; ajahat

gave up; suca[l.-all lamentations.

TRANSLATION

Having spoken thus, the great sage Narada, along with his vin.ii,

ascended into outer space. Yudhi□thira kept his instruction in his heart and

so was able to get rid of all lamentations.

PURPORT

Sri Naradaji is an eternal spaceman, having been endowed with a spiritual body by the grace of the Lord. He can travel in the outer spaces of both the material and spiritual worlds without restriction and can approach any planets by mechanical means. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was a pious king, and his previous life as the son of a maidservant. Because of his association with pure devotees, he was elevated to the position of an eternal spaceman and thus had freedom of movement. One should therefore try to follow in the footsteps of Narada Muni and not make a futile effort to reach other planets by mechanical means. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was a pious king, and therefore he could see Narada Muni occasionally; anyone who desires to see Narada Muni must first be pious and follow in the footsteps of Niirada Muni.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Thirteenth

Chapter, of Srimad-Bhigavatam, entitled ..Dhrtarii\$/TU Quits Home.,

CHAPTER FOURTEEN

Disappearance of Lord Kf\$1Ja

TEXT I

. f[!f □'fR

ij...,□a . ,,...4, ftiam □r:a.aa□• 1

q t;(□□ □=if fcl□f!6¥(11 □ II

suta uviica

samprasthite dvarakayam

j4rwu bandhu-didrk□aya

jnatum ca pur'-ya-slokasya

k□r'-asya ca viceHitam

sri suta□ uvaca-Sri Siita Gosvami said; samprasthite-having gone to;

dviirakayam-the city of Dvaraka; j4zwu-Arjuna; bandhu-friends and

relatives; didrk□aya-for meeting them; jnatum-to know; ca-also; puflyā

slokasya-of one whose glories are. sung by Vedic hymns; kn1Jasya-of Lord

Kr□qa; ca-and; vice□titam-further programs of work.

TRANSLATION

Sri Suta Gosvami said: Arjuna went to Dviraki to see Lord Sri K.r!!□a

and other friends and also to learn from the Lord of His next activities.

PURPORT

As stated in the Bhagavad-gita, the Lord descended on earth for the protection of the faithful and annihilation of the impious, so after the Battle of Kuruk□etra and establishment of Maharaja Yudhisthira, the mission of the Lord was complete. The Pap□avas, especially Sri Arjuna, were eternal companions of the Lord, and therefore Arjuna went to Dvaraka to hear from the Lord of His next program of work.

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TEXT2

"f□dt: Efi□MriiiQHMJ •wu□Jtst.J: I

□ "w;qafUt Rf□ □:II□ II

vyatita[l. katicin mii.sas

tada nayat tato 'rjuna[l.

dadarsa ghora-riipir&i

nimittiini kuriidvaha[l.

vyatitii[l.-after passing away; katicit-a few; miisii[l.-months; tadii-at that time; na iyyit- did not return; tata[l.-from there; aljuna[l.-Arjuna ; dadar5a-observed; gho m- fearful; riipir&i-appearances; nimittiini- various causes; kuriidvaha[l.- Maharaja Yudhi□hira. ·

TRANSLATION

A few months passed, and Arjuna did not return. Maharaja Yu□hira then began to observe some inauspicious omens, which were fearful in themselves.

PURPORT

Lord Sri □pa the Supreme Personality of Godhead is ad infinitum, more powerful than the most powerful sun of our experience. Millions and billions of suns are created by Him and annihilated by Him within His one breathing period. In the _material world the sun is considered to be the source of all productivity and material energy, and due to the sun only w□ can have the necessities of life. Therefore, during the personal presence of the Lord on the earth, all paraphernalia of our peace and prosperity, especially religion and knowledge, were in full display because of the Lord's presence, just as there is a full flood of light in the presence of the glowing sun. Maharaja Yudhi□thira observed some discrepancies in his kingdom, and therefore he became very anxious about Arjuna, who was long absent, and there was also no news about Dvaraka's well-being. He suspected the disappearance of Lord Kr□a, otherwise there would have been no possibility of fearful omens.

TEXT3

□ □ □ mJ □q4e□fifar: 1

- qawft44'f□ □ itfNJhU'ldlt:'lwtlt;QI □ II

Text 3) Disappearance of Lord .Kr□a

kiilasya ca gatim raudrom

viparyastar tu dharmi!wb

piipiyasim nr!J.iim viirtiim

krodha-lobhiinrtatmaniim

kiilasya-of the eternal time; ca-also; gatim-direction; raudriim-fearful; viparyastab--discrepancies; tu-but; dharmi!J.ab--specific function; piipiyasim-sinful; nrr-iim-of the human being; viirtiim-means of livelihood; krodha-anger; lobha-greed; anrta-falsehood; iitmaniim-of the people.

TRANSLATION.

He saw that the direction of eternal time had changed, and this was very fearful. There were disruptions in the seasonal regularities. The people in general had become very greedy, angry and deceitful. And he saw that they were adopting foul means of livelihood.

PURPORT

When civilization is disconnected from the loving relation of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, symptoms like changes of seasonal regulations, foul means of livelihood, greed, anger and fraudulence become rampant. The change of seasonal regulations refers to the atmosphere of one season becoming manifest in another season, for example the rainy season being transferred to autumn, or the fruits and flowers of one season fructifying in another season. A godless man is invariably greedy, angry and fraudulent. Such a man can earn his livelihood by any means, black or white. During the reign of Maharaja Yudhiṭhira, all the above symptoms were conspicuous by their absence. But Maharaja Yudhṭhira was astonished to experience even a slight change in the godly atmosphere of his kingdom, and at once he suspected the disappearance of the Lord. Foul means of livelihood implies deviation from one's occupational duty. There are prescribed duties for everyone, such as the briihmap.a, kṭatriya, vaiSya and sudra, but any one of them who deviates from his prescribed duty and declares another's duty to be his own is following a foul and improper duty. A man becomes too greedy for wealth and power when he has no higher objective in life and when he thinks that this earthly life of a few years is all in all. Ignorance is the cause for all these anomalies in human society, and to remove this ignorance, especially in this age of degradation, the powerful

sun is there to distribute light in the shape of Srimad-Bhigavatam.

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TEXT4

□PFI □□□='f□l

f14q}U((«({WI((C("i6'Rf ='f □--'(II \l II

jihmaprayam vyavahrtam

sathya-miSram ca sauhrdam

pitr-matr-suhrd-bhratr

dampatiniim ca kalkanam

jihma-prayam-cheating; vyavahrtam-in all ordinary transactions;

sathya-duplicity; miSram ca-adulterated in and; sauhrdam-regar ding

friendly well-wishers;pitr- father; matr-regarding the mother; suhrt-well

wishers; bhratr- one's own brother; dampatinam-regarding husband and

wife3 ca-also; kalkanam-mutual quarrel.

TRANSLATION

All ordinary transactions and dealings became polluted with cheating, even between friends. And in familial affairs, there was always misunderstanding between fathers and mothers and sons, and between well-wishers and between brothers. Even between husband and wife there was always strain and quarrel.

PURPORT

A conditioned living being is endowed with four principles of malpractice, namely errors, insanity, inability and cheating. These are signs of imperfection, and out of the four the propensity to cheat others is most prominent. And this cheating practice is there in the conditioned souls because the conditioned souls are primarily in the material world imbued with an unnatural desire to lord it over the material world. A living being in his pure state is not conditioned by the laws because in his pure state he is conscious that a living being is eternally subservient to the Supreme Being, and thus it is always good for him to remain subservient, instead of falsely trying to lord it over the property of the Supreme Lord. In the conditioned state the living being is not satisfied even if he actually

becomes the lord of all that he surveys, which he never becomes, and therefore he becomes the victim of all kinds of cheating, even with his nearest and most intimate relations. In such an unsatisfactory state of Text 6] Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa 735

affairs, there is no harmony, even between father and sons or between husband and wife. But all these contending difficulties can be mitigated by one process, and that is devotional service of the Lord. The world of hypocrisy can be checked only by counteraction of devotional service of the Lord and nothing else. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, having observed the disparities, conjectured the disappearance of the Lord from the earth.

TEXT 5

P-rll\ '11t4o1 R!IM f4atM I

lY11Q SI tl : 11 11

nimittany atyar4fani

kale tv anugate nrrzam

lobhady-adharma-pmkrtim

drfvoviicanujam nrpa

nimittiini-causes; ati-very serious; ariṣṭiini-bad omens; kiile-in course of time; tu-hut; anugate-passing away; n,rrziim-of humanity at large; labhiidi-agreed, etc.;adharma-irreligious;prakrtim-habits; d,rfvii-having observed; uviica-said; anujam-younger brother; n,rpa-the King.

TRANSLATION

In course of time it came to pass that people in general became accustomed to greed, anger, pride, etc. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, observing all these omens, spoke to his younger brother.

PURPORT

A pious king like Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira at once became perturbed when there were such inhuman symptoms as greed, anger, irreligiosity and hypocrisy rampant in society. And it appears from this statement that all these symptoms of degraded society were unknown to the people of the time, and it was astonishing for them to have experienced them with the advent of the Kali-yuga or the age of quarrel.

TEXT6

□□□en□

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□cq□□□cqf?f□d(l □II

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yudh□fhira uviica

sampre□ito dvarakiiyam

j□!lur bandhu-didrk□aya

jiiatum ca pufiya-slokasya

kr□f1Usya ca vice□titam

(Canto 1, Ch. 14

yudh□thira□ uvaca-Maharaja Yudhi□thira said; sampre□ita□-has gone to; dvarokayam-Dv arak a; j□r-u□-Arjuna; bandhu-friends; didrk□aya for the sake of meeting;jiiiitum-to know;ca-also;pur-ya-s'lokasya-of the Personality of Godhead; krgwsya-of Lord Sri Kr□l}a;ca-and;vice□titam program of work.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yu□thira said to his younger brother Bhimasena: Bhima sena, I sent Arjuna to Dvaraka to meet his friends and to learn from the Personality of Godhead □□!la of His program of work.

TEXT7

□R□t: (4811wtl '11m lftq(\;w □: I

•U41RI □ en □1(□G:'4t51(11 II \9 II

gata□ saptadhuna miisii

bhimasena taviinuja

niiyati kasya va hetor

naham vededam aijasa

gatii"fl!--has gone; sapta-seven; adhunii-to date; miisii□-months;

bhimasena-o Bhimasena; tava-your; anuja□-younger brother; na-does not; ayati-come back; kasya-fo r what; va-or; heto□-rea son; na-not; aham-I; veda-know; idam-this;anjasa-factu ally.

TRANSLATION

Since he departed, seven months have passed, yet he has not returned.

I do not know factually how things are going there.

Text 8] Disappearance of Lord 1\,r□qa

TEXTS

3{fq loctMunss□e: □ □Sflf!4m□H I

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api deva□irtad4talz.

sa kalo 'yam upasthitalz.

yadatmano ,ngam akrit)arit

bhagavan utsisrk¥Jti

737

api-whether; devar□irtii- by the demigod-saint (Narada); adi\$talz.

instructed; salz.-that; kala(t-eternal time; ayam-this; upasthita(t-arrived;

yada-when; iitmana(t-of His own self; angam-plenary portion; iikripam

manifestation; bhagaviin- the Personality of Godhead; utsisrk\$ati-is going to quit.

TRANSLATION

Is He going to quit His earthly pastimes, as Dev□i Narada indicated?

Has that time already arrived?

PURPORT

As we have discussed many times, the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Sri 1\,r□tta has many plenary expansions, and each and every one of them, although equally powerful, executes different functions. In the Bhagavad-gitii there are different statements by the Lord, and each of these statements is meant for different plenary portions or portions of the plenary portions. For example, Sri Kr□tta the Lord says in theBhagavad-gitii: "Whenever and wherever there is a decline in religious practice, o descendant of Bharata, and a predominant rise of irreligion-at that time I descend Myself." (Bg. 4.7)

"O son of Kunfi [Arjuna] , I am the taste of water, the light of the sun and the moon, the syllable om in the Vedic mantras; I am the sound in ether and ability in man." (Bg. 7.8)

"If I should cease to work, then all these worlds would be put to ruin. I would also be the cause of creating unwanted population, and I would thereby destroy the peace of all sentient beings." (Bg. 3.24)

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"Whatever action is performed by a great man, common men will follow in his footsteps. And whatever standards he sets by exemplary acts, all the world pursues." (Bg. 3.21)

All the above statements of the Lord apply to different plenary portions of the Lord, namely His expansions of Satikarṣapa, Vasudeva, Pradyumna, Aniruddha, Narayana, etc. All these expansions are He Himself by different transcendental expansions, and still the Lord as Sri Kṛṣṇa functions in a different sphere of transcendental exchange with different grades of devotees. And yet Lord Kṛṣṇa as He is appears once in the day of Brahma (or after a lapse of 864 trillion solar years) in each and every universe, and all His transcendental pastimes are displayed in each and every universe in a routine spool. But in that routine spool the functions of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Lord Vasudeva, etc., are complex problems for the layman. There is no difference between the Lord's Self and the Lord's transcendental body. The expansions execute differential activities. When the Lord, however, appears in His person as Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, His other plenary portions also join in Him by His inconceivable potency called yogamāyā, and thus the Lord ṣapa of Vrndavana is different from the Lord Kṛṣṇa of Mathura or the Lord Kṛṣṇa of Dvārakā. The viriṭa rōpa of Lord Kṛṣṇa is also different from Him, by His inconceivable potency. The viriṭa rōpa exhibited on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra is the material conception of His form. Therefore when Lord Kṛṣṇa was apparently killed by the bow and arrow of the hunter, it should be understood that the Lord left His so-called material body in the material world. The Lord is kaivalya, and for Him there is no difference between matter and spirit because everything is created from Him. Therefore His quitting one sort of body or accepting another body does not mean that He is like the ordinary living being. All such activities are simultaneously one and different by His inconceivable potency. When

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira was lamenting the possibility of His disappearance, it was just in pursuance of a custom of lamenting the disappearance of a great friend, but factually the Lord never quits His transcendental body, as is misconceived by less intelligent persons. Such less intelligent persons have been condemned by the Lord Himself in the Bhagavad-gītā, and they are known as the mūṣhas. That the Lord left His body means that He left again His plenary portions in the respective dhīmas (transcendental abodes), as He left His viriṭa-ropa in the material world.

TEXT 9

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31Rr.1 □□□ □□ □□□II□ II

Text 9] Disappearance of Lord ((r□qa

yasmiin naft sampado riiyam

diiriift priir-iift kulam prajiift

iisan sapatna-vijayo

lokiis ca yad-anugrahiit

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yasmat-from whom; naft-our; sampadaft-opulence; rajyam-kingdom; dara[1-good wives; prar-aft-existence of life; kulam-dynasty ; praja[1-subjects; asan-have become possible; sapatna-competitors; vijaya[1-conquering; lokaft-future accomodation in higher planets; ca-and; yat by whose; anugrahat-by the mercy of.

TRANSLATION

From Him only, all our kingly opulence, our good wives, lives, progeny, our control over our subjects, victory over our enemies and future accomodations in higher planets, have become possible. All this is due to His causeless mercy upon us.

PURPORT

Material prosperity consists of a good wife, good home, sufficient land, good children, aristocratic family relations, victory over competitors and, by pious work, attainment of accomodations in the higher celestial planets for better facilities of material amenities. These facilities are earned not

only by one's hard manual labor or by unfair means, but by the mercy of the Supreme Lord. Prosperity earned by one's personal endeavor also depends on the mercy of the Lord. Personal labor must be there in addition to the Lord's benediction, but without the Lord's benediction no one is successful simply by personal labor. The modernized man of Kali-yuga believes in personal endeavor and denies the benediction of the Supreme Lord. Even a great sannyasi of India delivered speeches in Chicago protesting the benedictions of the Supreme Lord. But as far as Vedic sastras are concerned, as we find in the pages of Srimad-Bhagavatam, the ultimate sanction for all success rests in the hands of the Supreme Lord. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira admits this truth in his personal success, and it behooves one to follow in the footsteps of a great king and devotee of the Lord to make life a full success. If one could achieve success without the sanction of the Lord then no medical practitioner would fail to cure a patient. Despite the most advanced treatment of a suffering patient by the most up-to-date medical practitioner, there is death, and even in the most hopeless case, without medical treatment, a patient is cured astonishingly. Therefore the

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conclusion is that God's sanction is the immediate cause for all happenings, good or bad. Any successful man should feel grateful to the Lord for all he has achieved.

TEXT 10

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□□ □ms□I"A4 ;if !f'l'llwt(II□ o II

pasyotpiitan nara-vyaghra

divyan bhaumiin sa-daihikan

daruflan sarhsato 'diirad

bhayarh no buddhi-mohanam

pasya-just see; utpatiin-disturbances; nara-vyiighra-o man of tigerlike

strength; divyan-happenings in the sky or by planetary influence;

bhauman-happenings on the earth; sa-daihikan-happenings of the body

and the mind; darufian-awfully dangerous; .Sarhsata□-indicating; adiirat

in the near future; bhayam-danger; na□-our; buddhi-intelligence;
mohanam-deluding.

TRANSLATION

Just see, O man with a tiger's strength, how many miseries due to celestial influences, earthly reactions and bodily pains-all very dangerous in themselves-are forboding danger in the near future by deluding our intelligence.

PURPORT

Material advancement of civilization means advancement of the reactions of the threefold miseries due to celestial influence, earthly reactions and bodily or mental pains. By the celestial influence of the stars there are many calamities like excessive heat, cold, rains or no rains, and the after effects are famine, disease, and epidemic, and the aggregate result is agony of the body and the mind. Man-made material science cannot do anything to counteract all these threefold miseries. They are all punishments from the superior energy of maya under the direction of the Supreme Lord.

Therefore our constant touch with the Lord by devotional service can give us relief without being disturbed in the discharge of our human duties. The

Text 11) Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa 741

asuras, however, do not believe in the existence of God, and they make their own plans to counteract all these threefold miseries, and so they meet with failures every time. The Bhagavad-gītā clearly states that the reaction of material energy is never to be conquered because of the binding effects of the three modes. They can simply be overcome by one who surrenders fully in devotion under the lotus feet of the Lord. (Bg. 7.14)

TEXT 11

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uro-ak□i-biihavo mahyam

sphuranty anga punaJ:i. punaJ:i.

vepathus ciipi hrdaye

iiriid diisyanti vipriyam

urn-thighs; akṣi-eyes; bīhava- the arms; mahyam-in my; sphuranti quivering; ahga-left side of the body; puna puna-again and again; vepathu- palpitations; ca-also ; api-certainly; hrdaye-in the heart; iirīit due to fearfulness; diisanti- indicating; vipriyam- undesirables.

TRANSLATION

The left side of my body, my thighs, arms and eyes are all quivering again and again. I am having heart palpitations due to fear. All this indicates undesirable happenings.

PURPORT

Material existence is full of undesirables. Things we do not want are forced upon us by some superior energy, and we do not see that these undesirables are under the grip of the three modes of material nature. When a man's eyes, arms and thighs all quiver constantly, one must know that something is going to happen which is undesirable. These undesirables are compared with fire in a forest. No one goes in the forest to set fire, but fire automatically takes place in the forest, creating inconceivable calamities for the living beings of the forest. Such fire cannot be extinguished by any human efforts. The fire can only be extinguished by the mercy of the Lord, who sends clouds to pour water on the forest. Similarly, undesirable happenings in life cannot be checked by any number of plans. Such miseries can be removed only by the mercy of the Lord, who sends His bona fide representatives to enlighten human beings and thus save them from all calamities.

TEXT 12

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sivaodyantam iidityam

abhiraaty analiinanii

miim anga siirameyo 'yam

abhirebhaty abhiruvat

siva-jackal; eṣli-this; udyantam-rising; adityam-onto the sun; abhi

towards; rauti-crying; anala-fire; anana-face; mam-unto me; ahga-o Bhima; sarameya[t- dog; ayam-this ; abhirebhati- barking ; abhiruvat without fear.

TRANSLATION

Just see, o Bhima, how the she-jackel cries at the rising sun and vomits fire and how the dog barks at me fearlessly.

PURPORT

These are some bad omens indicating something undesirable in the near future.

TEXT 13

fill: □□'It□□ □1m: 1

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sastii[t kurvanti miim savyam

dak□irwm pasavo 'pare

viihiims ca puru□-vyiighra

lak□ye rudato mama

Text 15] Disappearance of Lord Kr!!f!.a 743

sasta[t-useful animals like the cow; kuroanti-are keeping; miim-me; savyam-on the- left ; dak□irwm-circumambulating; pasava[t apare-other lower animals like asses;- vahan-the horses (carriers); ca_:also; puru□a vyaghra-o tiger among men; lak□aye-are seen; rudata[t-weeping; mama of mine.

TRANSLATION

O Bhimasena, tiger amongst men, nolf useful animals like cows are passing me on my left side, and lower animals like the asses are circumambulating me. My horses appear to weep upon seeing me.

TEXT 14

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Skttfiii tlt□A□ □ u.□fil□: 11□\lll

mrtyu-duta[t kapoto yam

uluka[t kampayan mana[t

pratyulukas ca kuhviinair

viSvam vai sun yam icchata[t
 mrtyu-death; diita[t-messenger of; kapota[t-pigeon; ayam-this ;
 uluka[t-owl; - kampayan-trembling; mana[t-mind; pratyuluka[t-the
 rivals of owls (crows); ca-and; kuhviinai[t-shrieking scream; viSvam
 the cosmos; vai-either; siinyam-void; icchata[t-wishing.

TRANSLATION

Just see! This pigeon is like a messenger of death. The shrieks of the
 owls and their rival crows make my heart tremble. It appears that they
 want to make a void of the whole universe.

TEXT 15

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 dhumra diSa□ paridhaya□
 kampate bhu□ sahadribhi□
 nirghatas ca mahams tiita
 sakam ca stanayitnubh□

[Canto 1, Ch. 14

dhumrn[t-smoky; diSa[t-all directions; paridhaya[l,-encirclement;
 kampate-throbbing; bhu[t- the earth; saha adribhi[t-along with the hills
 and mountains; nirghata□- bolt from the blue; ca-also; mahan-very
 great; tata-that; sakam-lightning; ca-also; stanayitnubhi[t- thundering
 sound without any cloud.

TRANSLATION

Just see how the smoke encircles the sky. It appears that the earth
 and mountains are throbbing. Just hear the cioudless thunder and see the
 bolts from the blue.

TEXT 16

*U9;'!tikl (CIWI□ □ Aq::sf{6YU I
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 vayur vati khara-sparso
 rajasa visrjams tama□

asrg var□anti jalada

bibhatsam iva sarvata□

vayu[t-wind; vati-blowing; khara-sparsa□-sharply; rq,jasa- by the dust;
vis.rjan-creating; tama[l,-darkness; asrk-blood; var§anti-is raining; jalada[l.
-the cloud; bibhatsam-disastrous; iva-like; sarvata[t-everywhere.

TRANSLATION

The wind blows violently, blasting dust everywhere and creating
darkness. Clouds are raining everywhere with bloody disasters.

TEXT 17

Text 19) Disappearance of Lord Kr!!Qa

suryam hata-prabham pasya

graha-mardam mitho divi

sasamk ulair bhuta-ga!J.air

jvalite iva rodasi

745

siiryam-the sun; hata-prabham-its rays declining; pasya-just see;
graha-mardam-clashes of the stars; mithab--among one another; divi-in
the sky; sasamkulaib--being mixed with; bhiita-ga!J.aib--by the living
entities;jvalite-being ignited;iva-as if;rodasi-crying.

TRANSLATION

The rays of the sun are declining, and the stars appear to be fighting
amongst themselves. Confused living entities appear to be ablaze and
weeping.

TEXT 18

W(Q)□□:□□□□I

WI ii'4#qftl(□;w □{\$□II□ □II

nadyo nadiiS ca k□ubhita

saromsi ca manamsi ca

na jvalaty agnir ajyena

kalo 'yam kim vidhasyati

nadya□-rivers; nadii□ ca-and the tributaries; k§ubhitii□-all perturbed;

sariimsi-reservoirs of water; ca-and; maniimsi-the mind; ca-also; na

does not; jvalati-ignite; agni[-fire;iijyena-with the help of butter;kiila[-
-the time; ayam-extraordinary it is; kim-what; vidhiisyati-going to
happen.

TRANSLATION

Rivers, tributaries, ponds, reservoirs and the mind are all perturbed.
Butter no longer ignites fire. What is this extraordinary time? What is going
to happen?

TEXT 19

WI□□□WI□"f□: I
□ 'lffi WI fW44't¥11 □ II□ □II

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na pibanti stanam vatsii
na duhyanti ca miitarafl.
rudanty asru-mukhii giivo
na hr□yanty □abhii vraje

[Canto 1, Ch. 14

na-does not; pibanti-suck; stanam-breast; vatsiifl-the calf; na-does
not; duhyanti-allow milking; ca-also; miitarafl-the cow; rudanti-crying;
asru-mukhiifl-with a fearful face;gavafl-the cow; na-does not; h,r\$yanti
take pleasure; nabhiifl-the bull;vraje-in the pasturing ground.

TRANSLATION

The calves do not suck the teats of the cows, nor do the cows give
milk. They are standing, crying, tears in their eyes, and the bulls take no
pleasure in the pasturing grounds.

TEXT 20

□□HUM □ct □Mt u-.eP<t l'f I
□ Gt□q□l Jmn: ,;(\QI□IEMI'l1111: I
nf□M(I□□I:□((4i44M WI: ll□oll
daivatiini rudantiva
svidyanti hy uccalanti ca
ime jana-padii griimiifl
purodyiiniikariisramiifl.

bhr̥ta-sriyo niriinandiifl.

kim agham darṣayanti nafl.

daivatiini-the Deities in the temples; rudanti-seem to be crying; iva
-like that; svidyanti-lamenting; hi-certainly ;uccalanti-as if going out;
ca-also; ime -this;jana-padiifl.-city;griimiifl-villages;pura-towns;udyiina
-gardens; iikara-mines; iisramiifl-hermitages, etc.; bhraṣṭa-devoid of;
sriyafl.-beauties; niriinandiifl-bereft of all happiness; kim-what sort of;
agham-calamities; darsayanti-shall manifest; nafl-to us.

TRANSLATION

The Deities seem to be crying in the temple, lamenting and perspiring.
They seem about to leave. All the cities, villages., towns, gardens, mines
Text 22) Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa 747
and hermitages are now devoid of beauty and bereft of all happiness. I do
not know what sort of calamities are now awaiting us.

TEXT 21

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□: 11t: I

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manya etair mahotpīi.tair

nunam bhagavatafl padaifl

ananya-puru□a-sribhir-

hinii bhur hata-saubhagii

manye-you may take it for granted; etaifl-by all these; maha-great;
utpiitaifl-upsurges ; niinam-for want of; bhaw□vatafl-of the Personality of
Godhead; padaifl- the marks on the sole of the foot; ananya- extraordi
nary; puru□a-of the Supreme Personality; sribhiifl- by the auspicious signs;
hinii-dispossessed; bhii□-the earth; hata-saubhagii-without the fortune.

TRANSLATION

I think that all these earthly disturbances preclude some greater loss
to the good fortune of the world. The world was fortunate to have been
marked with the footprints of the lotus feet of the Lord. These signs

indicate that this will no longer be.

TEXT 22

□ M□46(ij□ lliR!Wf □ I

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iti cintayatas tasya

dr□fiir4fena cetasi

riijiial;l pratyigamad brahman

yadu-puryiil;l kapi-dhvajal;l

iti-thus; cintayata□-while thinking to himself; tasya- of him; dntii

by observing; ar4tena-bad omens; cetasi-by the mind; riipia[l-of the

king; prati-back; igamat-came; brahman-o briihmap.as; yadu-puryii□

from the kingdom of the Yadus; kapi-dhvaja□-Arjuna_

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TRANSLATION

o BrihmC!!la Saunaka, while Maharaja Yu□hira, observing the

inauspicious signs on the earth at that time, was thus thinking to himself,

Arjuna came back from the city of the Yados [Dvaraka] .

TEXT 23

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tam piidayor nipatitam

ayatha-purvam aturam

adhovadanam abbindun

srjantam nayaniibjayofl

tam-him (Arjuna); piidayofl-at the feet; nipatitam-bowing down;

ayathii-piirvam-unprecedented; iitumm-dejected; adhovadanam-down

ward face; abbindun-drops of water;s.rjantam-creating; nayana-abjayo[l

from the lotuslike eyes.

TRANSLATION

When he bowed at his feet, the King saw that his dejection was

unprecedented. His head was down, and tears glided from his lotus eyes.

TEXT 24

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vilokyodvigna-hfdayo

vicchayam anujam nrpafl

prcchati sma suhrn madhye

samsmaran namderitam

vilokya-by seeing; uduigna-anxious; hrdaya[l-heart; vicchayam-pale

appearance;anujam-Arjuna;nrpafi.-the King;prcchati-asked;sma-in the

past; suhrt-friends; madhye-amongst; samsmamn-remembering; '!iirada

-Sage Narada; iritam-indicated by.

Text 26] Disappearance of Lord Kr□a 749

TRANSLATION

Seeing Arjuna pale due to heartfelt anxieties, the King, remembering

the indications of the sage Narada, questioned him in the midst of friends.

TEXT 25

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yudh□thira uvaca

kaccid anartapuryam nafi,

sva-janafi, sukham asate

madhu-bhoja-daiarharha

satvatandhaka-vr□rzayafi,

yudhi□thira□ uvaca- Yudhi□thira said; kaccit- whether ; anartapuryam

of Dviiraka; na[l-our; sva-jana[l-relatives; sukham-happily; asate-are

passing their days; madhu-Madhu; bhoja-Bhoja; dasarha-Dasarha; arha

-Arha; satvata-Satvata; andhaka-Andhaka; V[§r.wya[l-of the family of

Vp,?J].i.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yudhi□□hira said: My dear brother, please tell me whether

our friends and relatives, such as Madhu, Bhoja, Dasarha, Arha, Satvata, Andhaka and the members of the Yadu family, are all passing their days in happiness.

TEXT 26

□¥1R11¥t□: .□«.q@ll□ □□: I
□: □: Efi□1□CAIIwt□□fil: 11□,11
suro miitiimaha"{l kaccit
svasty aste ootha m a□a"{l
miitula"{l sanuja"{l kaccit
kusaly anaka-dundubhi"{l

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siimfl-Surasena; m1Wimaha[l-maternal grandfather; kaccit-whether;
svasti-all good; aste-passing his days; va-or; atha-therefore; ma□a[l
respectful; matula[l-maternal uncle;sa-anuja{l-with his younger brothers;
kaccit-whether; kusali-all well; anaka-dundubhi[l- Vasudeva.

TRANSLATION

Is my respectable grandfather Siirasena in a happy mood? And are my maternal uncle and his younger brothers all doing well?

TEXT 27

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311d□: □ □t7hlfl(cU: □ 11□\911
sapta sva-siiras tat-patnyo
miituliinya{l sahiitmajii[l
iiste sasnuṣii[l kṣemam
devaki-pramukhii{l svayam
sapta-seven; sva-sara[l-own sisters; tat-patnya[l-his wives; miituliinya[l
-maternal aunts; saha-along with; iitmajii{l-sons and grandsons; asate
are all; sasnuṣa{l-with their daughters-in-law; kṣemam-happiness; devaki
Devaki;pramukha[l-headed by; svayam-personally.

TRANSLATION

His seven wives, headed by Devaki, are all sisters. Are they and their sons and daughters-in-law all happy?

TEXTS 28-29

"□□□□□ □lH□e□;:(l□ □iiJ: I

□: □□ il1qr(141(«1(UU: II□Gll

□ - id'□ □ □3□(1□q: I

□N(I□ wcimi't□ei<:□Hdq: □□□□□□

kaccid rijjii "huko jlvaty

asat-putro 'sya ciinuja{l

hrdika{l sasuto 'kruro

jayanta-gada-sara!la{l

Texts 28-29] Disappearance of Lord Kf□q.a

asate kusalam kaccid-

ye ca satrujid iidaya"fl

kaccid iiste sukharh riimo

bhagaviin siitvatiirh prabhu['

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kaccit-whether; rijjii-the King; iihuka"fl.-another name of Ugrasena;

jivati-still living; asat-mischievous; putra"fl-son; asya-his; ca-also ; anujaf

-younger brother; hrdika"fl-Hrdika; sa-sutafl-along with sons such as;

akrii.ra"fl-Akrura; jayanta-J ayanta; gada-Gada; sii rallii"fl-Sarapa; iisate□

are they ,all; kusalam-in happiness; kaccit-whether; ye-they; ca-.also;

5atrujit-Satrujit; iidayafl-headed by; kaccit-whether; iiste-are they;

sukham-all right; riima"fl.-Balarama; bhagaviin-the Personality of God

head; siitvatiim-of the devotees; prabhu"fl.-protector.

TRANSLATION

Ugrasena's sons, Kamsa and his younger brother Devaka, are still living.

Is Ugrasena happy? Are Hrdika and sons, Krtavarma, Akriira, Jayanta,

Gada, Sirapa and Satrujit, all happy? How is Balarama, the Personality of

Godhead and the protector of devotees?

PURPORT

Hastinapura, the capital of the Pa!l□avas, was situated somewhere near

present New Delhi, and the kingdom of Ugrasena was situated in Mathura.

While returning to Delhi from Dvaraka, Arjuna must have visited the city

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$$\square: \square \forall U fhd \text{ ij}(\text{ctltl} \square \square: I$$

pradyumna"fl. saroa-vmtiniim

gambhira-rayo 'niruddho

pradyumna"fl.-Pradyumna (a son of Lord Kn>Qa); sarva-all; Vf§pin.iim

ratha"fl.- the great general; gambhira-deeply; raya"fl.-dexterity; aniruddha"fl..

-Aniruddha (another grandson of Lord Kṛṣṇa); vardhate-flourishing;
bhagavān-the Personality of Godhead; uta-must.

TRANSLATION

How is Pradyumna, the great general of the Vṛṣṇi family? Is He
happy? And is Aniruddha, the plenary expansion of the Personality of
Godhead, faring well?

PURPORT

Pradyumna and Aniruddha are also expansions of the Personality of
Godhead, and thus They are also Viṣṇu-tattva.. At Dvaraka Lord Vasudeva
is engaged in His transcendental pastimes along with His plenary expan-
sions, namely Sailkarṇaṭṭha, Pradyumna and Aniruddha, and therefore each
and every one of Them can be addressed as the Personality of Godhead, as
it is mentioned in connection with the name Aniruddha.

TEXT 3 1

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Texts 32-33] Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa;□a

su□ertas carude□rtas ca

siimbo jiimbavat"i-suta;l.

anye ca kar□rti-pravaral;l.

sa-putra □abhadaya;l.

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su□ertal;l.-Su□epa; ciirude\$rtal;l.-Carude□pa; ca-and; siimba[t-Siimba;
jiimbavati-suta;l;l.-the son of Jamhavati; anye-other□; ·ca- also; kiir\$rti- the
sons of Lord J<r□l).a; pravarii[t-all chieftains; sa-putrii[t- along with their
sons; !\$abha- □abha; iidayal;l.-etc.

TRANSLATION

Are all the chieftain sons of Lord Kṛṣṇa, such as Su□pa, Carude□la,
Samba the son of Jambavati, □bha and all others, along with their sons,
all doing well?

PURPORT

As already mentioned, Lord J<r□pa had married 16,108 wives, and each

of them had ten sons. Therefore $16,108 \times 10 = 161,080$ sons. They all grew up, and each of them had as many sons as their father, and the whole aggregate was something near 1,610,800 family members of the Lord. The Lord is the father of all living beings, who are countless in number; there fore only a few of them are called to associate with the Lord in His transcendental pastimes as the Lord of Dvaraka on this earth. It is not astonishing if the Lord maintained a visible family consisting of so many members. It is better to refrain from comparing the Lord's position with ours, and it becomes a simple truth as soon as we understand at least a partial calculation of the Lord's transcendental position. King Yudhiṣṭhira, while inquiring about the Lord's sons and grandsons at Dvaraka, mentioned only the chieftains amongst them, otherwise it was impossible for him to remember all the names of the Lord's family members.

TEXTS 32-33

Ml"4(1: □: ¥!d□it(41(q: I
tj'i;((□;((ijlqu□u lt □ Qlf: idwt'la: II □ II
3lfit □□qma «l □: 1
3lft □ •□□'14u;t il'i«i((a: □□□□□

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tathaiviinucara□ saure□
srutadevoddhaviidaya□
sunanda-nanda-Sir□a!' ya
ye canye satvatar□abha□
api svasty asate sarve
rama-k □!Ja-bhujasraya□
api smaranti kusalam
asmakam baddha-sauhrda□

[Canto I, Ch. 14

tathii eva-similarly; anucara{]-constant companions; 5aure□-of Lord
Sri Kr□IJa such as; srutadeva-Srutadeva; uddhava-iidaya□- Uddhava and
others; sunanda-Sunanda; nanda-Nanda; sir□arya□-other leaders; ye

all of them; ca-and; anye-others; satvata-liberated souls; nabhii[l.-the best men; api-if; svasti-doing well; asate-are; sarve-all of them;rama Ba larama; kr□□a- Lord Kr□IJ.a; bhujasraya[l.-under the protection of; api if also; smaranti-do remember; kusalam-welfare; asmakam-about our selves; baddha-sauhrda[l.-bound by eternal friendship.

TRANSLATION

Also, are Uddhava and others, Nanda, Sunand.a and other leaders of liberated souls who are constant companions of the Lord, who are protected by Lord Balarama and Kr¥.1a, all doing well in their respective functions? Do they, who are all eternally bound in friendship with us, remember our welfare?

PURPORT

The constant companions of Lord Kr□!J.a, such as Uddhava, etc., are all liberated souls, and they had descended along with Lord Kr□pa on this material world to fulfill the mission of the Lord. The Pap□avas are also liberated souls who descended along with Lord Kr□pa to serve Him in His transcendental pastimes on this earth. As stated in the Bhagavad-gita (Bg. 4.5), the Lord and His eternal associates, who are also liberated souls like the Lord, come down on this earth at certain intervals. The Lord remembers them all, but His associates, although liberated souls, forget due to their being tatasthii-sakti, or marginal potency of the Lord. That is the difference between the Vi\$ru-tattva and jiva-tattvas. The jiva-tattvas are infinitesimal potential particles of the Lord, and therefore they require the protection of the Lord at all times. And to the eternal servitors of the Lord, the Lord is pleased to give all protection at all times. The liberated souls never, therefore, think themselves as free as the Lord or as powerful
Text 34] Disappearance of Lord Kt□t11a 755

as the Lord, but they always seek the protection-of the Lord in all circumstances, both in the material world and in the spiritual world. This dependence of the liberated soul is constitutional, just as sparks of a fire can exhibit the glow of fire along with the fire and not independently. Independently the glow of the sparks is extinguished, although the

quality of fire or the glowing is there. Thus those who give up the protection of the Lord and become so-called lords themselves, out of spiritual ignorance, come back again to this material world, even after prolonged tapasya of the severest type. That is the verdict of all Vedic literature.

TEXT 34

AN tftf AN ¥iM«t<?S: I

'□□□"(□ ij(CI+U□ ti(ftij: 11□\lll

bhagaviin api govindo

brahmartyo bhakta-vatsala□

kaccit pure sudharmiiyim

sukham iiste suhrd-vrta□

bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead, Kr□t:J.a; api-also;govinda[l- one who enlivens the cows and the senses; brahmaczya[l-devoted to the devotees or the briihmaczas; bhakta-vatsala[l-affectionate to the devotees; kaccit-whether; pure-in Dvaraka Puri; sudharmiiyim-pious assembly; sukham-happiness; iiste-does enjoy; suhrt-vrta[l-surrounded by friends.

TRANSLATION

Is Lord .Kf□pa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, who gives pleasure to the cows, senses and the brahmapas, who is very affectionate towards His devotees, enjoying the pious assembly at Dvaraka Puri surrounded by friends?

PURPORT

Here in this particular verse the Lord is described as Bhagaviin, Govinda, Brahmaczya and Bhaktavatsala. He is Bhagaviin svayam, or the original Supreme Personality of Godhead full with all opulences, all power, all knowledge, all beauty, all fame and all renunciation. No one is equal to or greater than Him. He is Govinda because He is the pleasure of the cows and the senses. Those who have purified their senses by devotional service of the Lord can render unto Him real service and thereby derive transcendental pleasure out of such purified senses. Only the impure conditioned

living being cannot derive any pleasure from the senses, but being illu-
sioned by false pleasures of the senses, he becomes servant of the senses.
Therefore, we need His protection for our own interest. The Lord is the
protector of cows and the brahminical culture. A society which is devoid
of cow protection and brahminical culture is not under the direct pro-
tection of the Lord, just as the prisoners in the jails are not under the
protection of the king but under the protection of a severe agent of the
king. Without cow protection and cultivation of the brahminical qualities
in human society, at least for a section of members of the society, no
human civilization can prosper at any length. By brahminical culture or
by developing the dormant qualities of goodness, namely truthfulness,
equanimity, sense control, forbearance, simplicity, general knowledge,
transcendental knowledge, and firm faith in the Vedic wisdom, one can
become a briihmara and thus see the Lord as He is. And after surpassing
the brahminical perfection, one has to become a devotee of the Lord so
that His loving affection in the form of proprietor, master, friend, son and
lover can be transcendently achieved. The stage of a devotee, which
attracts the transcendental affection of the Lord, does not develop unless
one has developed the qualities of a briihmara as above mentioned. The
Lord is inclined to a briihmara of quality and not of false prestige. Those
who are less than a briihmara by qualification cannot establish any relation
with the Lord, just as fire cannot be kindled from the raw earth unless
there is wood, although there is a relation between wood and the earth.
Since the Lord is all-perfect in Himself, there could not be any question of
His welfare, and Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira refrained from asking this question.
He simply inquired about His residential place, Dvaraka Puri, where pious
men assemble. The Lord stays only where pious men assemble and takes
pleasure in their glorifying the Supreme Truth. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira was
anxious to know about the pious men and their pious acts in the city of
Dvaraka.

TEXTS 35-36

Texts 35-36 J Disappearance of Lord Kṛṣṇa

mangaliija ca lo kiiniim
k□emiiya ca bhaviya ca
iiste yadu-kuliimbhodhiiv
iidyō 'nanta-sakhafl pumiin
yad biihu-da"(l□a-guptiiyim
sva-puryiim yadavo 'rcitiifl
ki4fanti paramiinandam
mahii-pauru□ika iva

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mangaliya-for all good; ca- also;lokiiniim- of all the planets; k□emiiya
for protection; ca-and; bhaviya- for elevation; ca-also; iiste-is there;
yadu-kula-ambhodhau-in the ocean of the Yadu dynasty; adyafl - the
original; ananta.-sakhafl-in the company of Ananta (Balarama); pumiin
the supreme enjoyer; yat- whose; biihu-da"(l□a guptiiyim- being protected
by His arms; sva-puryiim-in His own city; yadavafl-the members of the
Yadu family; arcitiifl-as they deserve; ki4fanti- are relishing; paramii
nandam-transcendental pleasure; mahii-pauru□ikafl-the residents of the
SP.iritual sky; iva-like__

TRANSLATION

The original Personality of Godhead, the enjoyer, and Balarama, the
primeval Lord Ananta, are staying in the ocean of the Y adu dynasty for
the welfare, protection and general progress of the entire universe. And
the members of the Yadu dynasty, being protected by the arms of the
Lord, are enjoying life like the residents of the spiritual sky.

PURPORT

As we have discussed many times, the Personality of Godhead V□!lu
resides within each and every universe in two capacities, namely as the
Garbhodakasayi Vi□!lu and the □irodakasayi Vi□!lu. The □irodakasayi
Vi□pu has His own planet on the northern top of the universe, and there
is a great ocean of milk where the Lord resides on the bed of the Ananta
incarnation of Baladeva. Thus Maharaja Yudhi□thira has compared the
Yadu dynasty to the ocean of milk and Sri Balarama to the Ananta where

Lord Kṛiṇa resides. He has compared the citizens of Dvīraka to the liberated inhabitants of the Vaiṇuṭhalokas. Beyond the material sky, further than we can see with our eyes and beyond the sevenfold coverings of the universe, there is the Causal Ocean in which all the universes are floating like footballs, and beyond the Causal Ocean there is an unlimited span of 758 Srimad-Bhāvatam [Canto 1, Ch. 14

spiritual sky generally known as the effulgence of Brahman. Within this effulgence there are innumerable spiritual planets, and they are known as the Vaiṇuṭha planets. Each and every Vaiṇuṭha planet is many, many times bigger than the biggest universe within the material world, and in each of them there are innumerable prototypes of Vṛiṇu inhabitants who look exactly like Lord Vṛiṇu. These inhabitants are known as the Mahapauruṇikas, or persons directly engaged in the service of the Lord. They are happy in those planets and are without any kind of misery, and they live perpetually in full youthfulness, enjoying life in full bliss and knowledge without fear of birth, death, old age or disease, and without the influence of kiṇa, eternal time. Maharaja Yūṭhira has compared the inhabitants of Dvaraka to the Mahapauruṇikas of Vaiṇuṭhaloka because they are so happy with the Lord. In the Bhagavad-gītā there are many references to the Vaiṇuṭhalokas, and they are mentioned there as Mad-dhīma, or the kingdom of the Lord.

TEXT 37

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(1(411{ṇ INtG«llṇAa: 1

fitṇṇ m f5il{ijf(d((rṇil

ṇ ṇ:11ṇṇ1

yat-pada-susriiṇa!!a-mukhya-karma!!a

satyadaya dvyṇfa-sahasra-yaṇitaṇ

nirjitya sankhye tridasams tad-ii.s4o

haranti vajriyudha-vallabhocitiiṇ

yat-whose; piṇda-feet; susriṬṣapa-administration of comforts; mukhya

-the most important; karmaczii-by the acts of; satyii-iidayalt-queens

headed by Satyabhama; dvya□Ja-twice eight; sahasra-thousand; yo□ita□
the fair sex; nirjitya-by subduing; sankhye-in the battle; tridaian-of the
denizens of heaven; tat-iis4a□-what is enjoyed by the demigods; haranti
do take away; vajra-iiyudha-vallabha-the wives of the personality who
controls the thunderbolt; ucitii□-deserving.

TRANSLATION

The queens at Dvaraka, headed by Satyabhama, simply by administering
comforts at the lotus feet of the Lord, which is the most important of
Text 37) Disappearance of Lord Kṛṇa 759
all services, induced the Lord to conquer the demigods. Thus the queens
enjoy things which are prerogatives of the wives of the controller of
thunderbolts.

PURPORT

Satyabhiimii: One of the principal queens of Lord Sri Kṇ!la at Dvaraka.
After killing Narakasura, Lord ṇ!la visited the palace of Narakasura
accompanied by Satyabhama. He went to Indraloka also with Satyabhiimii,
and she was received by Sacidevi, who introduced her to the mother of the
demigods, Aditi. Aditi was very much pleased with Satyabliama, and she
benedicted her with the blessings of permanent youth as long as Lord
Kṛṇ!la remained on the earth. Aditi also took her with her to show her
the special prerogatives of the demigods in the heavenly planets. When she
saw the piirijiita flower, she desired to have it in her palace at Dvarakii.
After that, she came back to Dvaraka along with her husband and expressed
her willingness to have the piirijiita flower at her palace. Satyabhiimii's
palace was especially bedecked with valuable jewels, and even in the
hottest season of summer the inside of the palace remained cool, as if
air-conditioned. She decorated her palace with various flags, heralding the
news of her great husband's presence there. Once, along with her husband,
she met Draupadi, and she was anxious to be instructed by Draupadi in
the ways and means of pleasing her husband. Draupadi was expert in this
affair because she kept five husbands, the Pii!J.pavas, and all were very
much pleased with her. On receipt of Draupadi's instructions, she was

very much pleased and offered her good wishes and returned back to Dvāraka. She was the daughter of Satrujit. After the departure of Lord Kṛṣṇa, when Arjuna visited Dvāraka, all the queens, including Satyabhama and Rukmīṣi, lamented for the Lord with great feelings. At the last stage of her life, she left for the forest to undergo severe penances.

Satyabhama instigated her husband to get the pīrijāta flower from the heavenly planets, and the Lord got it even by force from the demigods, as a common husband secures things to please his wife. As already explained, the Lord had very little to do with so many wives to carry out their orders like an ordinary man. But because the queens accepted the high quality of devotional service, namely administering the Lord all comforts, the Lord played the part of a faithful complete husband. No earthly creature can expect to have things from the heavenly kingdom, especially the pīrijāta flowers which are simply to be used by the demigods. But due to their becoming the Lord's faithful wives, all of them enjoyed the special prerogatives of the great wives of the denizens of heaven. In other words, since the Lord is the proprietor of everything within His creation, it is not very astonishing for the queens of Dvāraka to have any rare thing from any part of the universe.

TEXT 38

□□□.9;□q3\if□

□Tu Ui6IW Q: I

atN□eJII□□

□ u\t1d t\ (6'El&itM61'(II □Gil

yad bīhu-da{l{liibhyudayiinuḥvivino

yadu-pravīrī hy akuto-bhayī muhu□

adhikramanty anghribhir īhrtīm baliit

sabhiim sudharmiim sura-sattamocitiim

yat-whose; bīhu- dar.pa- arms ; abhyudaya-influenced by; anujivinaft

always living; yadu-the members of the Y adu dynasty; pravīrī[l-great

heroes; akuta[l- bhayī[l-fearless in every respect; muh u□-constantly;

adhikramanti- traversing ; anghribhi[l-by foot; iihrtiim-hrought about;
baliit-by force; sabhiim-assemhly house; sudharmam- Sudharma; sura
sattama-the best among the demigods; ucitiim-deserving.

TRANSLATION

The great heroes of the Yadu dynasty, being protected by the arms
of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, always remain fearless in every respect. And therefore
their feet trample over the Sudharma assembly house, which the best
demigods deserved but which was taken away from them.

PURPORT

Those who are directly servitors of the Lord are not only protected by
the Lord from all fearfulness, hut also enjoy the best of things, even if
they are forcibly accumulated. The Lord is equal in behavior to all living
beings, hut He is partial to His pure devotees, being very affectionate
toward them. The city of Dvaraka was flourishing, being enriched with
Text 39) Disappearance of Lord .Kṛṣṇa 761

the best of things in the material world. The state assembly house is
constructed according to the dignity of the particular state. In the heavenly
planet, the state assembly house called Sudharma was deserving of the
dignity of the best of the demigods. Such an assembly house is never
meant for any state on the globe because the human being on the earth
is unable to construct it, however far a particular state may be materially
advanced. But during the time of Lord Kṛṣṇa's presence on the earth, the
members of the Yadu family forcibly brought the celestial assembly house
to earth and placed it at Dvaraka. They were able to use such force
because they were certain of the indulgence and protection of the Supreme
Lprd Kṛṣṇa. In other words, the Lord is provided with the best things in
the universe by His pure devotees. Lord Kṛṣṇa was provided with all kinds
of comforts and facilities available within the universe by the members of
the Yadu dynasty, and in return such servitors of the Lord were protected
and fearless.

A forgetful conditioned soul is fearful. But a liberated soul is never
fearful, just as a small child completely dependent on the mercy of his

father is never fearful of anyone. Fearfulness is a sort of illusion for the living being when he is in slumber and forgetting his eternal relation with the Lord. Since the living being is never to die by his constitution, as stated in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 2.20), then what is the cause of fearfulness? A person may be fearful of a tiger in dream, but another man who is awake by his side sees no tiger there. The tiger is a myth for both of them, namely the person dreaming and the person awake, because actually there is no tiger; but the man forgetful of his awakened life is fearful, whereas the man who has not forgotten his position is not at all fearful. Thus the members of Yadu dynasty were fully awake in their service of the Lord, and therefore there was no tiger for them to be afraid of at any time. Even if there were a real tiger, the Lord was there to protect them.

TEXT 39

□□ m □iffl fcuum 11 1

st(JS□'4'lt;i\□: ft□m□<lfla: □□□□□□

kaccit te 'niimayam tiita

bhra□fa-tejii vibhiisi me

alnbda-mano 'vajiiiita[l,

kim vii tiita ciro□ita[l,

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kaccit-whether; te-your; amimayam-health is all right;tiita-my dear

brother; bhra□ta-bereft of; tejii[l-luster; vibhiisi-appear; me-to me;

alabdha-miina[l-without respect; avajiiiita[l-neglected; kim-whether; vii

or;tiita-my dear brother; ciro§ita[l-because of long residence.

TRANSLATION

My brother Arjuna, please tell me whether your health is all right.

You appear to have lost your bodily luster. Is this due to others disrespecting and neglecting you because of your long stay at Dvaraki?

PURPORT

From all angles of vision, the Maharaja inquired from Arjuna about the welfare of Dviraka, but he concluded at last that as long as Lord Sri Kf□pa Himself was there, nothing inauspicious could happen. But at the same

time, Arjuna appeared to be bereft of his bodily luster, and thus he inquired of his personal welfare and asked so many vital questions.

TEXT 40

.r...afitmSliR: □flRq□.'

if □ □ □ □□□oll

kaccin nabhihato 'bhavai[

Sa.bdadibhir amangalai[

na dattam uktam arthibhya

asaya yat pratiSrutam

kaccit-whether; na-could not; abhihata[addresses by; abhavai[unfriendly; sabda-adibhil;l-by sounds;amangalail;l-inauspicious; na-did not; dattam-give in charity; uktam-is said; arthibhyal;l-unto one who asked; asaya-with hope;yat-what;pratiSrutam-promised to be paid.

TRANSLATION

Has someone addressed you with unfriendly words or threatened you? Could you not give charity to one who asked, or could you not keep your promise to someone?

Text 41) Disappearance of Lord Kr□ 763

PURPORT

A k□triya or a rich man is sometimes visited by persons who are in need of money. When they are asked for a donation, it is the duty of the possessor of wealth to give in charity in consideration of the person, place and time. If a k□atriya or a rich man fails to comply with this obligation, he must be very sorry for this discrepancy. Similarly, one should not fail to keep his promise to give in charity. These discrepancies are sometimes causes of despondency, and thus failing, a person becomes subjected to criticism, which might also be the cause of Arjuna's plight.

TEXT 41

□QIOf□qj ti itf1lui □ I

tQ(Ci(lqkti □ wtl□lit: 1Q(UIS14.: 11\l□ll

kaccit tvam brohma□Jam biilam

giim VT;ddham rogi□Jam striyam

5ara□Jopasrtam sattvam

niityiik□lfr. sara□Ja-prada□

kaccit-whether; tvam-yourself; brohma□Jam- the briihma□Jas; biilam
the child; giim-the cow; vrddham-old; rogizwm-the diseased; striyam
the woman; 8arana-upsrtam-having approached for protection; sattvam
any living being; na-whether; atyiik§ifl-not given shelter; 8ampa-pradafi.
deserving protection.

TRANSLATION

You are always the protector of the deserving living beings, such as
brihm□, children, cows, women and the diseased. Could you not give
them protection when they approached you for shelter?

PURPORT

The briihmaras, who are always engaged in researching knowledge for
the society's welfare work, both materially and spiritually, deserve the
protection of the king in all respects. Similarly, the children of the state,
the cow, the diseased person, the woman and the old man specifically

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require the protection of the state or a kṣatriya king. If such living beings
do not get protection by the kṣatriya, or the royal order, or by the state,
it is certainly shameful for the kṣatriya or the state. Maharaja Yu□thira
was anxious to know about this discrepancy on the part of Arjuna, if such
things had actually happened.

TEXT 42

□ wntOO□ □ iil6€tidi □I

q(a□<n ifN ¥1iil,ih,awtma: C□N 11\l□ll

kaccit tvam nagamo 'gamyam

gamyam vasat-krtam striyam

parojito vatha bhavan

nottamair nasamai□ pathi

kaccit-whether; tvam-yourself; na-not; agama[l- did contact;

agamyiim- impeachable; gamyiim-acceptable; vii-either; asat-k.rtiim

improperly treated; striyam-a woman; parijita[l-defeated by; vii-either;

atha-after all; bhaviin-your good self; na-not; uttamaift-by superior power; na-nor; asamaift-by equals; pathi-on the road.

TRANSLATION

Have you contacted a woman of impeachable character, or have you not properly treated a deserving woman? Or have you been defeated on the way by someone who is inferior or equal to you?

PURPORT

It appears from this verse that during the time of the Papāvas free contact between man and woman was allowed in certain conditions only. The higher caste men, namely the briihmaras and kṣatriyas, could accept a woman of the vai.Sya or the sudra community, but a man from the lower castes could not contact a woman of the higher caste. Even a kṣatriya could not contact a woman of the briihmara caste. The wife of a briihmara is considered one of the seven mothers (namely one's own mother, the wife of the spiritual master or teacher, the wife of a briihmara, the wife of a king, the cow, the nurse, and the earth). Such contact between man and woman was known as uttama and adhama. Contact of a briihmara with a

Text 43) Disappearance of Lord Kṛṇa 765

kṣatriya woman is uttama, but the contact of a kṣatriya with a woman of a briihma[la is adhama and therefore condemned. A woman approaching a man for contact should never be refused, but at the same time the discretion as above mentioned may also be considered. Bhima was approached by Hi!lmbi from a community lower than the sildras, and Yayati refused to marry the daughter of Sukracarya because of his being a briihma[la. Vyasadeva, a briihma[la, was called to beget Papāu and Dhftara[tra. Satyavati belonged to a family of fishermen, but Para8ara, a great briihma[la, begot in her Vyasadeva. So there are so many examples of such contacts with woman, but in all cases the contacts were not abominable nor were the results of such contacts bad. Contact between man and woman is natural, but that also must be carried out under regulated principles so that social consecration may not be disturbed nor unwanted worthless population be increased for the unrest of the world.

It is abominable for a kṣatriya to be defeated by one who is inferior in strength or equal in strength. If one is defeated at all, he should be defeated by some superior power. Arjuna was defeated by Bhiṣmadeva, and Lord Kṛṣṇa saved him from the danger. This was not insult for Arjuna because Bhiṣmadeva was far superior to Arjuna in all ways, namely age, respect and strength. But Karpā was equal to Arjuna, and therefore Arjuna was in crisis when fighting with Karpā. It was felt by Arjuna, and therefore Karpā was killed even by crooked means. Such are the engagements of the kṣatriyas, and Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira inquired from his brother whether anything undesirable happened on the way home from Dvarakā.

TEXT 43

31fif□?.□□□mt□l

ijgf<{td d ftRcd)d□l'l □ ll'd□ll

apisvit parya-bhunkthiis tvarh

sambhojyiin vrddha-biilakiin

jugupsitarh karma kincit

krtaviin na yad ak□amam

apisvit-if it were so that; parya-by leaving aside; bhunkthiifl.-have

dined; tvam-yourself; sambhojyiin-deserving to dine together; v.rddha

the old men; . biilakiin-boys; jugupsitam-abominable; karma-action;

kiiicit-something; krtaviin-you must have done; na-not; yat-that which;

ak□amam-unpardonable.

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TRANSLATION

Have you not taken care of old men and boys who deserve to dine with you? Have you left them and taken your meals alone? Have you committed some unpardonable mistake which is considered to be abominable?

PURPORT

It is the duty of a householder to feed first of all the children and old members of the family, the brīhmaṇas and the invalids. Besides that, an ideal householder is required to call for any unknown hungry man to come

and dine before he himself goes to take his meals. He is required to call for such a hungry man thrice on the road. The neglect of this prescribed duty of a householder, especially in the matter of the old men and children, is unpardonable.

TEXT 44

□ □ □ Jij □ ir {l' l □ m \ '1" □ I

U" t l s f 4 1 o o n □ □ M □ I W l □ l \ l \ l l "

kaccit pre □ fhatamenatha

hrdayenatma-bandhuna

sunyo 'smi rahito nityam

manyase te 'nyatha na ruk

kaccit-whether; p re □ thatamena- unto the most dear one; atha-my brother Atjuna; hrdayena-most intimate; iitma-bandhuna -own friend Lord Kf l } l].a; sunya { l -void; asmi-I am; rahita { l -having lost; nityam- for all time; manyase-you think; te- your; anyathii-otherwise; na-never; ruk mental distress.

TRANSLATION

Or is it that you are feeling empty all the time because you might have lost your most intimate friend Lord Kf □ a? o my brother Arjuna, I can think of no other reason for you becoming so dejected.

PURPORT

All the inquisitiveness of Maharaja Yudhizthira about the world situation was already conjectured by Maharaja Yudhizthira on the basis of Lord □ pa's disappearance from the vision of the world, and this was now Text 44) Disappearance of Lord Kr □ q.a 767 disclosed by him because of the acute dejection of Arjuna, which could not have been possible otherwise. So even though he was doubtful about it, he was obliged to inquire frankly from Arjuna on the basis of Sri Narada's indication.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports to the First Canto, Fourteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Disappearance of Lord K[§]la."

CHAPTER FIFTEEN

The Paoc;1avas Retire Timely

TEXT I

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□*I)UII(1(CI:□□□SSN*fi(i;qil: I

Wllwtl\ltiW□ □ □W;;□□ia: II □ ll

suta uvaca

evam kmw-sakhafi, kmw

bhriitrii rijjiiii 'vikalpitaḥ,

niinii-sankaspadam riipam

k□rw-viSleṣa-karsitaḥ,

siita[l uviica- Suta Gosvami said; evam-thus; 1q§1Ja-sakhafi,- the cele

brated friend of Kr□I].a; knTJafi.- Arjuna; bhriitrii-by his elder brother;

rijjia- King Yudhi□thira; iivikalpitaḥ, - speculated; niina-various; sankā

iispadam-based on many doubts; riipam-forms; knTJa- Lord Sri Kr□I].a;

viSleṣa- feelings of separation; karsita{l- became greatly bereaved.

TRANSLATION

Suta Gosvami said: Arjuna, the celebrated friend of Lord Kr□J;ta, was

griefstricken because of his strong feeling of separation from K□!la, over

and above all Maharaja Yudhi□!hira's speculative inquiries.

PURPORT

Being too much aggrieved, Arjuna practically became choked up, and

therefore it was not possible for him to reply properly to the various

speculative inquiries of Maharaja Yu□thira.

769

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TEXT 2

UIW.Id\G\wt(«1Uii11 Will: 1

ttili!41?J□«<Iji\etftlli1Ad(It □ It

sokena su□yadvadana

hrt-saroja hata-prabha□

vibhum tameviinusmaran

niisaknot pratibhii□itum

sokena-due to bereavement; su□yat-vadana-drying up of the mouth;
hrt-saroja□- lotuslike heart; hata-lost; prabha□-bodily luster; vibhum
the Supreme; tam-unto Lord Kr□l)a; eva-certainly ; anusmaran- thinking
within; na-could not; asaknot-be able; pratibhaṣitum- properly replying.

TRANSLATION

Due to grief, Arjuna's mouth and lotuslike heart had become dried up.
Therefore his body lost all luster. Now, remembering the Supreme Lord,
he could hardly utter a word in reply.

TEXT3

□□□: q'lfUiwtiS□ □: I

□ f.'IJ!'iliSIUI□€\fiU(N'filtt(: II □ II

krcchreT)a samstabhya suca□

pīT)inīi ,mrjya netrayo□

parok□eT)a samunnaddha

pral)ayautkaT)thya-kiitara□

krcchrel)a-with great difficulty; samstabhya-by checking the force;
suca□-of bereavement;pa!īina-with his hands; am.rjya-smearing; netrayo□
-the eyes; parokṣena- due to being out of sight; samunnaddha-increas
ingly; pra!laya-autka!l)thya-eagerly thinking of the affection; katara□
distressed.

Text4) The P□avas Retire Timely 771

TRANSLATION

With great difficulty he checked the tears of grief that smeared his
eyes. He was very distressed because Lord Kr□ was out of his sight, and
he increasingly felt affection for Him.

TEXT4

□□□l'f□□l

WJoqt(tli\$1fli€441C illt44•1t::(("4□1 ftm II \l II

sakhyam maitrim sauhrdam ca

siirathyīd□u samsmaran

nrpam agrajam ity iiha

bii□pa-gadgadayii giro

sakhyam-well- wishing; maitrim-benediction; sauhrdam-intimately related; ca-also; siirathi-iidiṣu-in becoming the chariot driver; samsmaran -remembering all these; n.rpam-unto the King; agrajam-the eldest brother; iti-thus; iiha-said; bfYpa-heavily breathing; gadgadayii-overwhelmingly; girii-by speeches.

TRANSLATION

Remembering Lord Kṛṣṇa and His well wishes, benefactions, intimate familial relations and His chariot driving, Arjuna, overwhelmed and breathing very heavily, began to speak.

PURPORT

. The Supreme Living Being is perfect in all relations with His pure devotee. Sri Arjuna is one of the typical pure devotees of the Lord reciprocating in the fraternal relationship, and the Lord's dealings with Arjuna are displays of friendship of the highest perfect order. He was not only a well-wisher of Arjuna, but also He was actually a benefactor, and to make it still more perfect the Lord tied him into a family relationship by arranging Subhadra's marriage with him. And above all, the Lord agreed to become a chariot driver of Arjuna in order to protect His friend from warfare risks, and the Lord became actually happy when He established
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the Pañjāras to rule over the world. Arjuna remembered all these one after another, and thus he became overwhelmed with such thoughts.

TEXTS

arjuna uvaca

vancito 'ham maharaja

haril)a bandhu-rupil)a

yena me ,pahrtam tejo

deva-vismiipanam mahat

arjunaf!. uvaca- Arjuna said; vaiicitaf!.- left by Him; aham-myself ;

maha raja-o King; haril)a-by the Personality of Godhead; bandhu

riipir-a-as if an intimate friend; yena- by whom; me- my ; apahrtam-1

have been bereft; tejaf!.- power; deva-the demigods; vismapanam- astonishing; mahat-astounding.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna said: o King! The Supreme Personality of Godhead Hari, who treated me exactly like an intimate friend, has left me alone. Thus my astounding power, which astonished even the demigods, is no longer with me.

PURPORT

In the Bhagavad-gita (Bg. 10.41) the Lord says, "Anyone specifically powerful and opulent in wealth, strength, beauty, knowledge and all that is materially desirable is to be considered but a product of an insignificant portion of the complete whole of My energy." No one, therefore, can be independently powerful in any measure without being endowed by the Lord. When the Lord descends on the earth along with His eternal ever liberated associates, He not only displays the divine energy possessed by Himself, but He also empowers His associate devotees with the required Text6) The P□□avas Retire Timely 773

energy to execute His mission of incarnation. It is also stated in the Bhagavad-gitii, Fourth Chapter, that the Lord and His eternal associates descend on the earth many times, but the Lord remembers all the different roles of incarnations, whereas the associates, by His supreme will, forget them. Similarly, the Lord takes away with Him all His associates when He disappears from the earth. The power and energy which were bestowed upon Arjuna were required for fulfillment of the mission of the Lord, but when His mission was fulfilled, the emergency powers were withdrawn from Arjuna because the astounding powers of Arjuna, which were astonishing even to the denizens of heaven, were no longer required, and they were now meant for going back home, back to Godhead. If endowment of powers and withdrawal of powers by the Lord are possible even for a great devotee like Arjuna, or even the demigods in heaven, then what to speak of the ordinary living beings who are but figs compared to such great souls. The lesson is, therefore, that no one should be puffed up for

his borrowed powers from the Lord. The sane man should rather feel obliged to the Lord for such benefaction and must utilize such power for the service of the Lord. Such power can be withdrawn at any time by the Lord, so the best use of such power and opulence is to engage them in the service of the Lord.

TEXT6

□ ?4o1Attli\wt □ GfSPot«o□i;w: I

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yasya k□a!la-viyogena

loko hy apriya-darSo.nal;t

ukthena rahito hy e□a

mrtakal;t procyate yathii

yasya-whose; lc□a[la-a moment; viyogena-by separation; lolca□- all the universe; hi- certainly; apriya-darsana□-everything appears unfavorable; ukthena-by life; rahita□- being devoid of; hi-certainly; e□□-all these bodies; mrtaka□-dead bodies; pro cyate-are designated; yathii-as it were.

TRANSLATION

I have just lost Him whose separation for a moment would render all the universes unfavorable and void, as bodies without life.

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PURPORT

Factually for a living being there is no one dearer than the Lord. The Lord expands Himself by innumerable parts and parcels as sviimsa and vibhinniimsa. Paramatma is the sviimsa part of the Lord, whereas the vibhinniirhsa parts are the living beings. As the living being is the important factor in the material body, or without the living being the material body has no value, similarly without Paramatma the living being has no status quo. Similarly, Brahman or Paramatma has no locus standi without the Supreme Lord Sri Kr□!la. This is thoroughly explained in the Bhagavad gitii (Bg. 15.18). They are all interlinked with one another or interdependent factors; thus in the ultimate issue the Lord is the summum bonum and therefore the vital principle of everything.

TEXT 7

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e□'lt*'. □□□ ll\911

yat-samsrayiid drupada-geham upiigatiiniim

rojiiiim svayariwara-mukhe smara-durmadiiniim

tejo hrtam khalu mayibbihatas ca matsya"ft

sajfkrtena dhanu□iidhigatii ca kr□r-ii

yat-by whose merciful; samsmyit-by strength; drupada-geham-in the

palace of King Drupada; upiigatiiniim-all those assembled; rijniim-of

the princes; svayamvara-mukhe-on the occasion of the selection of the

bridegroom; smara-durmadiiniim-all lusty in thought; tejafl-power;

hrtam-vanquished; khalu-as it were; maya-by me; abhahatafl-pierced;

ca-also; matsyafl- the fish target; sajilqtena-by equipping the bow;

dhanufiii-by that bow also; adhigatii-gained; ca-also; lcrfirtii-Draupadi.

TRANSLATION

Only by His merciful strength was I able to vanquish all the lusty

princes assembled at the palace of King Drupada for the selection of the

bridegroom. With my bow and arrow I could pierce the fish target and

thereby gain the hand of Draupadi.

Text 8] The P□□avas Retire Timely 775

PURPORT

Draupadi was the most beautiful daughter of King Drupada, and when

she was a young girl almost all the princes desired her hand. But Drupada

Maharaja decided to hand over his daughter to Arjuna only and therefore

contrived a peculiar way. There was a fish hanging on the inner roof of the

house under the protection of a wheel. The condition was that out of the

princely order, one must be able to pierce the fish's eyes through the wheel

of protection, and no one would be allowed to look up at the target. On

the ground there was a water pot in which the target and wheel were

reflected, and one had to fix his aim towards the target by looking at the trembling water in the pot. Maharaja Drupada well knew that only Arjuna or alternately Karpa could successfully carry out the plan. But still he wanted to hand his daughter to Arjuna. And in the assembly of the princely order, when Dhr̥tadyumna, the brother of Draupadi, introduced all the princes to his grown-up sister, Karpa was also present in the game. But Draupadi tactfully avoided Karpa as the rival of Arjuna, and she expressed her desire through her brother Dhr̥tadyumna that she was unable to accept anyone who was less than a kṣatriya. The vaiiys and the siidras are less important than the kṣatriyas. Karpa was known as a son of a carpenter, who is a siidra. So Draupadi avoided Karpa by this plea. When Arjuna, in the dress of a poor briihmapa, pierced the difficult target, every one was astonished, and all of them, especially Karpa, offered a stiff fight to Arjuna, but as usual by the grace of Lord Kr̥pa he was able to emerge very successful in the princely fight and thus gain the valuable hand of Kr̥la, or Draupadi. Arjuna was lamentingly remembering the incidence in the absence of the Lord by whose strength only he was so powerful.

TEXTS

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e

yat-sannidhav aham ukha□t}avam agnaye 'dam

ind ram ca samara-ga□m tarasa vijitya

labdha sabha maya-kr;tadbhuta-silpa-miiya

digbhyo 'haran nr;patayo balim adhvare te

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yat-whose; sann idhau-being nearby; aham-myself; u-note of aston

ishment; khiir.{la vam-the protected forest of Indra, King of heaven;

agnaye-unto the fire-god; adam-delivered; indram-Indra; ca- also; sa

along with; amara-gar.am-the demigods; tarasii-with all dexterity; vijitya

-having conquered; labdhii-having obtained; sabhii-assembly house; maya-krtii-built by Maya; adbhuta-very wonderful; silpa-art and workmanship; maya-potency; digbhyast-from all directions; aharan -collecting; nrpatayast-all princes; balim-presentations; adhvare-brought; te unto you.

TRANSLATION

Because He was near me, it was possible for me to conquer with great dexterity the powerful King of heaven, Indradeva, along with his demigod associates and thus enable the fire-god to devastate the Khatvanga forest. And by His grace only the demon named Maya was saved from the blazing Khatvanga forest, and thus we could build our assembly house of wonderful architectural workmanship where all the princes assembled during the performance of Rajasuya-yajna and paid you tributes.

PURPORT

The demon Mayadanava was an inhabitant of the forest Khatvanga, and when the Khatvanga forest was set on fire, he asked protection from Arjuna. Arjuna saved his life, and as a result of this the demon felt obliged. He reciprocated by building a wonderful assembly house for the Pundarikakshas, which attracted the extraordinary attention of all state princes. They felt the supernatural power of the Pundarikakshas, and thus without grudge all of them submitted and paid tributes to the Emperor. The demons possess wonderful and supernatural powers to create material wonders. But they are always disturbing elements of the society. The modern demons are the harmful material scientists who create some material wonders for disturbance in the society. For example, the creation of the nuclear weapons has caused some panic in the human society. Maya was also a materialist like that, and he knew the art of creating wonderful things. And yet Lord Krishna wanted to kill him. When he was chased both by the fire and the wheel of Lord Kṛṣṇa, he took shelter of a devotee like Arjuna, who saved him from the wrath of the fire of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. Devotees are therefore more merciful than the Lord, and in devotional service the mercy of a devotee is more valuable than the mercy of the Lord. Both the fire and

Text9J The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 777

the Lord ceased from chasing the demon as soon as both of them saw that the demon was given shelter by a devotee like Arjuna. The demon, feeling obliged to Arjuna, wanted to do him some service to show his gratefulness, but Arjuna declined to accept anything from him in exchange. Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, however, being pleased with Maya for his taking shelter of a devotee, asked him to render service unto King Yudhiṣṭhira by building a wonderful assembly house. The process is that by the grace of the devotee the mercy of the Lord is obtained, and by the mercy of the Lord a chance to serve the Lord's devotee is obtained. The club of Bhimasena was also a gift of Mayadanava.

TEXT9

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□wtl(ijl: Slii□wtl□+({qi1J lf'1

□flitRdiMG\wt□' {ilks+t\4□ it II □II

yat-tejasii m;pa-siro 'nghrim ahan makhiirtham

iiryo 'nujas tava gajiiyuta-sattva-viryafī

teniihr;tiifl pramatha-niitha-makhiiya bhiipii

yan mocitiis tad anayan balim-adhvare te

yat-whose; tejasii-by influence; nrpa- sirafī-anghrim-one whose feet are

adored by the heads of kings; ahan-the great; makhiirtham-for the

sacrifice; iiryafl-respectable; anujafl-younger brother; tava- your; gaja

ayuta-ten thousand elephants; sattva-viryafī -powerful existence; tena-by

him; iihrtiifl-collected; pramatha-niitha-the lord of the ghosts (Maha

bhairava); makhiiya-for sacrifice; bhiipiiifl- kings; yat mocitiifl-by whom

they were released; tat a nayan-all of them brought; balim-taxes;

advhare- presented; te- your.

TRANSLATION

Your respectable younger brother, who possesses the strength of ten thousand elephants, killed, by His grace, Jarasandha, whose feet were worshiped by many kings. These kings had been brought for sacrifice in

Jarasandha's Mahabhairava-yajfia, but they were thus released. Later they paid tribute to Your Majesty.

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PURPORT

Jarasandha was a very powerful king of Magadha, and the history of his birth and activities is also very interesting. His father, King Brhadratha, was also a very prosperous and powerful King of Magadha, but he had no son, although he married two daughters of the King of Kasi. Being disappointed in not getting a son from either of the two queens, the King, along with his wives, left home to live in the forest for austerities, but in the forest he was benedicted by one great rishi to have a son, and he gave him one mango to be eaten by the queens. The queens did so and were very soon pregnant. The King was very happy to see the queens bearing children, but when the ripe time approached, the queens delivered one child in two parts, one from each of the queens' wombs. The two parts were thrown in the forest, where a great she-demon used to live, and she was glad to have some delicate flesh and blood from the newly born child. Out of curiosity she joined the two parts, and the child became complete and regained life. The she-demon was known as Jara, and being compassionate on the childless King, she went to the King and presented him with the nice child. The King was very pleased with the she-demon and wanted to reward her according to her desire. The she-demon expressed her desire that the child be named after her, and thus the child was surnamed Jarasandha, or one who was joined by Jara the she-demon. In fact, this Jarasandha was born as one of the parts and parcels of the demon Viprachitti. The saint by whose benediction the queens bore the child was called Candra Kousik, who foretold of the child before his father Brhadratha.

Since he possessed demoniacal qualities from birth, naturally he became a great devotee of Lord Siva, who is the lord of all ghostly and demonic men. Ravallabha was a great devotee of Lord Siva, and so also King Jarasandha. He used to sacrifice all arrested kings before Lord Mahabhairava (Siva),

and by his military power he defeated many small kings and arrested them to butcher before Mahabhairava. There are many devotees of Lord Mahabhairava or Kalabhairava in the province of Bihar, formerly called Magadha. Jarasandha was a relative of Kamsa, the maternal uncle of Krishna, and therefore after Kamsa's death King Jarasandha became a great enemy of Krishna, and there were many fights between Jarasandha and Krishna. Lord Krishna wanted to kill him, but He also wanted that those who served as military men for Jarasandha might not be killed. Therefore a plan was adopted to kill him. Krishna, Bhima and Arjuna together went to Jarasandha in the dress of poor Brahmins and begged charity from King Jarasandha.

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Jarasandha never refused charity to any Brahmin, and he performed many sacrifices also, yet he was not on a par with devotional service. Lord Krishna, Bhima and Arjuna asked Jarasandha the facility of combating him, and it was settled that Jarasandha would fight with Bhima only. So all of them were both guests and combatants of Jarasandha, and Bhima and Jarasandha fought every day for several days. Bhima became disappointed, but Krishna gave him hints about Jarasandha's being joined together as an infant, and thus Bhima dissected him again and so killed him. All the kings who were detained in the concentration camp to be killed before Mahabhairava were thus released by Bhima. Feeling thus obliged to the Pandavas, they paid tribute to King Yudhishthira.

TEXT 10

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ñtNS*41W1Ciñ: «'lltlli(I

ñññ:ñ

tl«tñtftñ t:'d:tif?lfl"ffiQt:llñ oil

patnyiiis taviidhimakha-kJpta-mahii-bh4eka

sliigh4tha-ciiru-kabaram kitavail;l sabhiyiim

sprñtam vikirya padayol;l patitiisrumukhyii

yas tat-striyo 'krta hatesa-vimukta-kesiil;l

patnyiiift-of the wife; tava-your; adhimakha- during the great sacrifici

cial ceremony; kJpta-- dressed; m ahii-bh4eka- greatly sanctified; sliighi\$tha
 -thus glorified; cam-beautiful; kabaram-clustered hair; kitava ift-by the
 miscreants; sabhiyiim-in the great assembly; sp!\$tam-being caught;
 vikirya-being loosened; padayoft-on the feet; patita-asru-mukhyiil;l-of the
 one who fell down with tears in the eyes; yaft-He; tat-their; striya[l
 wives; akrtā-became; hatesa-bereft of husbands; vimukta-kesiil;l-loosened
 hair.

TRANSLATION

It was He only who loosened the hair of all the wives of the
 miscreants who dared open the cluster of your Queen's hair when she was
 nicely dressed and sanctified for the _great Rajasiya sacrificial ceremony.
 At that time she fell down at the feet of Lord Kr□□a with tears in
 her eyes.

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PURPORT

Queen Draupadi had a beautiful bunch of hair which was sanctified in
 the ceremonial function of Rajasiya-yajfia. But when she was lost in the
 bet, Du!t5asana touched her glorified hair to insult her. Draupadi then fell
 down at the lotus feet of Lord Kr□!!a, and Lord Kr□!!a decided that all the
 wives of Du!t5asana and company should have their hair loosened as a
 result of the Battle of Kuruk□etra. Thus after the Battle of Kuruk□etra,
 after all the sons and grandsons of Dhftar□tra died in battle, all the wives
 of the family were obliged to loosen their hair as widows. In other words,
 all the wives of the Kuru family became widows because of Du!t5asana's
 insulting a great devotee of the Lord. The Lord can tolerate insults upon
 Himself by any miscreant because the father tolerates even insults from
 the son. But He never tolerates insults upon His devotees. By insulting a
 great soul, one has to forego all the results of pious acts and benediction
 also.

TEXT II

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EuU114ffl □ f4MII□Hit: lit til

yo no fugopa vana etya duranta-krcchriid

duroiisaso 'ri-racitiid ayutiigrabhug yal;

Siikiinna-s4fam upayujya yatas tri-lokirit

trptiim amamsta salile vinimagna-sanghal;

ya{l-one who; na{l-us; jugopa-gave protection; vana- forest; etya

getting in; duranta-dangerously; krcchrat-trouble; durviisasa{l- of Durvasa

Muni; ari-enemy; racitiit-fabricated by; ayuta-ten thousand; agrabhuk

one who eats before; ya{t-that person; siika-ann a-s4tam-remnants of

foodstuff; upayujya-having accepted; yatal;l.- because; tri-lokim-all the

three worlds; t_rptiim-satisfied; amamsta- thought within the mind; salile

-while in the water; vinimagna-sanghal;-all merged into the water.

TRANSLATION

During our exile, Durvasa Muni, who eats with his ten thousand

disciples, intrigued with our enemies to put us in dangerous trouble. At

Text ll) The P□□avas Retire Timely 781

that time He [Lord Kr□□a], simply by accepting the remnants of food,

saved us. By His accepting food thus, the assembly of munis, while bathing

in the river, felt sumptuously fed. And all the three worlds were also

satisfied.

PURPORT

Duroiisii Muni: A powerful mystic briihmacw determined to observe the

principles of religion with great vows and under strict austerities. His name

is associated with many historical events, and it appears that the great

mystic could be both easily satisfied and easily annoyed like Lord Siva.

When he was satisfied, h(; could do tremendous good to the servitor, but if

he was dissatisfied he could bring about the greatest calamity. Kumari

Kunti, at her father's house, used to minister all kinds of services to all

great briihmaf1as, and being satisfied with her good reception Durvasa

Muni benedicted her with a power to call any demigod she desired. It is

understood that he was a plenary incarnation of Lord Siva, and thus he

could easily be either satisfied or annoyed. He was a great devotee of Lord Siva, and by his order he accepted the priesthood of King Svetaketu because of the King's performance of sacrifice for one hundred years. Sometimes he used to visit the parliamentary assembly of the heavenly kingdom of Indradeva. He could travel in space by his great mystic powers, and it is understood that he travelled a great distance through space, even up to the Vaikuṁṭha planets beyond material space. He travelled all these long distances within one year, during his quarrel with King Ambariṣa, the great devotee and Emperor of the world.

He had about ten thousand disciples, and wherever he visited and became a guest of the great kṣatriya kings, he used to be accompanied by a number of followers. Once he visited the house of Duryodhana, the enemy cousin of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira. Duryodhana was intelligent enough to satisfy the bṛiḥmaṇya by all means, and the great ni wanted to give some benediction to Duryodhana. Duryodhana knew his mystic powers, and he knew also that the mystic bṛiḥmaṇya, if dissatisfied, could cause some havoc also, and thus he designed to engage the bṛiḥmaṇya to show his wrath upon his enemy cousins the pāṇḍavas. When the ni wanted to award some benediction to Duryodhana, the latter wished that he should visit the house of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, who was the eldest and chief among all his cousins. But by his request he would go to him after he had finished his meals with his Queen, Draupadi. Duryodhana knew that after Draupadi's dinner it would be impossible for Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira to receive such a large number of bṛiḥmaṇya guests, and thus the ni would be annoyed and

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would create some trouble for his cousin Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira. That was the plan of Duryodhana. Durviṣṭi Muni agreed to this proposal, and he approached the King in exile according to the plan of Duryodhana after the King and Draupadi had finished their meals.

On his arrival at the door of Mahiṣi Yudhiṣṭhira, he was at once well received, and the King requested him to finish his noontime religious rites in the river and by that time the foodstuff would be prepared. Durviṣṭi

Muni, along with his large number of disciples, went to take a bath in the river, and Mahiirija Yudhiṭhira was in great anxiety for the guests. As long as Draupadi had not taken her meals, food could be served to any number of guests, but the ni, by the plan of Duryodhana, reached there after Draupadi had finished her meals.

When the devotees are put into difficulty, they have an opportunity to recollect the Lord with rapt attention. So Draupadi was thinking of Lord Kṛṣṇa in that dangerous position, and the all-pervading Lord could at once know the dangerous position of His devotees. He therefore came there on the scene and asked Draupadi to give whatever food she might have in her stock. On her being so requested by the Lord, Draupadi was sorrowful because the Supreme Lord asked her for some food and she was unable to supply it at that time. She said to the Lord that the mysterious dish which she had received from the sun-god could supply any amount of food if she herself had not eaten. But on that day she had already taken her meals, and thus they were in danger. By expressing her difficulties she began to cry before the Lord as only a woman would do in such a position. The Lord, however, asked Draupadi to bring up the cooking pots to see if there was any particle of foodstuff left, and on Draupadi's doing so, the Lord found some particle of vegetable sticking to the pot. The Lord at once picked it up and ate it. After doing so, the Lord asked Draupadi to call for her guests, the company of Durvasa.

Bhima was sent to call them from the river. Bhima said, "Why are you delaying, sirs? Come on, the food is ready for you." But the brihmaṇas, because of Lord Kṛṣṇa's accepting a little particle of food, felt sumptuously fed, even while they were in the water. They thought that since Maharaja Yudhiṭhira must have prepared many valuable dishes for them and since they were not hungry and could not eat, the King would feel sorry, so it was better not to go there. Thus they decided to go away.

This incidence proves that the Lord is the greatest mystic, and therefore He is known as yogesvara. Another instruction is that every householder must offer food to the Lord, and the result will be that everyone, even a

company of guests numbering ten thousand, will be satisfied because of the Lord's being satisfied. That is the way of devotional service.

Text 12) The Pāṇavas Retire Timely

TEXT 12

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yat-tejasiitha bhagaviin yudhi sula-piil)-ir

vismiipita ā sa-girijo 'stram adiin nijam me

anye 'pi ciham amunaiva kalevare āJa

priipto mahendra-bhavane mahad iisaniirdham

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yat-by whose; tejasi-.by influence; atha-at one time; bhagavii.n-the Personality of God (Lord Siva); yudhi-in the battle; siila-pii.rifz-one who has a trident in hand; vismii.pitafl-astonished; sa-girijafl-along with the daughter of the Himalayan Mountains; astrom-weapon; adii.t-awarded; nijam-of his own; me-unto me; anye api-so also others; ca-and; aham myself; amunii.-by this; eva-definitely; kalevarerw-by the body; prii.ptafl -obtained; mahii.-indra-bhavane-in the house of Indradeva; mahat-great; iisana-ardham-half-elevated seat.

TRANSLATION

It was by His influence only that in a fight I was able to astonish the Personality of God Lord Siva and his wife, the daughter of Mount Hima laya. Thus he [Lord Siva] became pleased with me and awarded me his own weapon. Other demigods also delivered their respective weapons to me, and in addition I was able to reach the heavenly planets in this present body and was allowed a half-elevated seat.

PURPORT

By the grace of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṇāṇa, all other demigods, including Lord Siva, were pleased with Arjuna. The idea is that one who is favored by Lord Siva or any other demigod may not necessarily

he favored by the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa (Godhead). Ravana was certainly a great devotee of Lord Siva, but he could not be saved from the wrath of the Supreme Personality of Godhead Lord Ramacandra. And there are many instances like that in the histories of the Puranas. But here is an instance where we can see that Lord Siva became pleased even in the 784 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 15

fight with Atjuna. The devotees of the Supreme Lord know how to respect the demigods, but the devotees of the demigods sometimes foolishly think that the Supreme Personality of Godhead is no greater than the demigods. By such a conception, one becomes an offender and ultimately meets with the same end as Ravarta and others. The instances described by Atjuna during his friendly dealings with Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are instructive for all who may be convinced by the lessons that one can achieve all favors simply by pleasing the Supreme Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa while the devotees or the worshipers of other demigods may achieve only partial benefits of life, which are also perishable, just as the demigods themselves are.

Another significance of the present verse is that Arjuna, by the grace of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, was able to reach the heavenly planet even with the selfsame body and was honored by the heavenly demigod Indradeva, being seated with him half elevated. One can reach the heavenly planets by the pious acts recommended in the śāstras in the category of fruitive activities. And as stated in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 9.21), when the reactions of such pious acts are spent, the enjoyer is again degraded to this earthly planet. The moon is also on the level with the heavenly planets, and only persons who have performed virtues only, namely performing sacrifices, giving in charity and undergoing severe austerities, etc., can be allowed to enter into the heavenly planets after the duration of life of the body. Arjuna was allowed to enter into the heavenly planets in the selfsame body simply by the grace of the Lord, otherwise it is not possible to do so. The present attempts to enter into the heavenly planets by the modern scientists will certainly prove futile because such scientists are not on the level of Arjuna. They are ordinary human beings without any assets of sacrifice, charity or

austerities. The material body is influenced by the three modes of material nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. The present population is more or less influenced by the modes of passion and ignorance, and the symptoms for such influence are exhibited in their becoming very lusty and greedy. Such degraded fellows can hardly approach the higher planetary systems. Above the heavenly planets there are many other planets also, which only those who are influenced by goodness can reach. In heavenly and other planets within the universe, the inhabitants are all highly intelligent, many more times than the human beings, and they are all pious in the higher and the highest mode of goodness. They are all devotees of the Lord, and although their goodness is not unadulterated, still they are known as demigods possessing the maximum amount of good qualities possible within the material world.

Text 13] The Paṇḍavas Retire Timely

TEXT 13

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tatraiva me viharato bhuja-da!J.lja-yugmarh

gii"!ltfiva-lak□a"!lam ariiti-vadhiiya devii[l.

sendrii[l. sritii yad-anubhiivitam iijamU}ha

teniiham adya mu□ita[l. puru□e"!la bhu.mnii

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tatra-in that heavenly planet; eva-certainly; me-myself; viharata[l.

while staying as a guest; bhuja-dap.t}.a-yugman-both of my arms; giip.t}.iva

the bow named Ga!!fiva; lakṣap.am-mark; ariiti-a demon named

Nivatakavaca; vadhiiya-for killing; deva[l.-all the demigods;sa-along with;

indra[l.-the heavenly King, Indra; srita[l-taken shelter of;yat-by whose;

anubhavitam-made it possible to be powerful; ajamipha-of the descen

dant of King Ajami□ha; tena-by Him; aham-myself; adya-at the present

moment; muṣitaft-bereft of; puruṣep.a- the Personality; bh iimnii- the

Supreme.

TRANSLATION

When I stayed for some days as a guest in the heavenly planets, all the heavenly demigods, including King Indradeva, took shelter of my arms, which were marked with the Gīṃpiva bow, to kill the demon named Nivatakavaca. O King, descendant of Ajamiṅgha, at the present moment I am bereft of the Supreme Personality of Godhead by whose influence I was so powerful.

PURPORT

The heavenly demigods are certainly more intelligent, powerful and beautiful, and yet they had to take help from Arjuna because of his Gīṃpiva bow, which was empowered by the grace of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa. The Lord is all-powerful, and by His grace His pure devotee also can be as powerful as He may desire, and there is no limit to it. And when the Lord withdraws His power from anyone, he is powerless by the will of the Lord.

TEXT 14

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yad-bandhava□ kuru-baliibdhim ananta-piiram

eko rathena tatara 'ham atirya-sattvam

pratyahrtarh bahu dhanarh ca mayii pare□iirh

tejiis-padarh mar-imayarh ca hrtarh sirobhya[l

yat-biindhava[l-by whose friendship only; kuru-bala-abdhim-the ocean

of the military strength of the Kurus; ananta-piiram-which was insur-

mountable; eka[l-alone; rathena- being seated on the chariot; tatara

was able to cross over; aham-myself; atirya- invincible; sattvam-exis-

tence; pratyiihrtam-drew back; bahu-very large quantity; dhanam

wealth; ca-also; mayii-by me; pare□iim-of the enemy; tejii□-padam

source of brilliance; ma11imayam- bedecked with jewels; ca-also ; hrtam

taken by force; sirobhya[- from their heads.

TRANSLATION

The military strength of the Kauravas was like an ocean in which there dwelled many invincible existences, and thus it was insurmountable. But because of His friendship, I, seated on the chariot, was able to cross over it. And only by His grace was I able to regain the cows and also collect by force many helmets of the kings which were bedecked with jewels that were sources of all brilliance.

PURPORT

On the Kaurava side there were many stalwart commanders like Bhisma, Drona, Kripa and Karna, and their military strength was as insurmountable as the great ocean. And yet it was due to Lord Krishna's grace that Arjuna alone, sitting on the chariot, could manage to vanquish them one after another without difficulty. There were many changes of commanders on the other side, but on the Pandavas' side Arjuna alone on the chariot driven by Lord Krishna could manage the whole responsibility of the great war. Similarly, when the Pandavas were living at the palace of Virata incognito, the Kauravas picked a quarrel with King Virata and decided to take away his large number of cows. Thus while taking away the cows, Arjuna fought with them incognito and was able to regain the cows along with some booty taken by force, the jewels set on the turbans of the royal order. Arjuna remembered that all this was possible by the grace of the Lord.

TEXT 15

ॐ ऋषिर्गुरुः स्यात् ॥

(मन्त्रः १५)

ॐ

ॐ

yo bh4ma-kaf1la-guru-sal ya-camuv adabhra
rojanya-varya-ratha-ma!cJ.ala-mal)lj.itiisu
agrecaro mama vibho ratha-yuthapiiniim

iiyur maniimsi ca drsa saha oja iircchat

ya[l-it is He only; bhiṣma-Bhṛma; kafiḷa-Karpa; guru-Dropacarya;
salya-Salya; camuṣu-in the midst of the military phalanx; adabhra
immense; rojanya-varya-great royal princes; ratha-mar{lala-chain of
chariots; mar{litiisu-being decorated with; agreca ra[l-going forward;
mama-of mine; vibho-o great King; ratha-yuthapiiniim-all the charioteers;
iiyu[l-duration of life or fruitive activities; maniimsi-mental upsurges;
ca-also; drsa-by glance; saha[l-along with; oja[l-strength; iircchat
withdrew.

TRANSLATION

It was He only who withdrew the duration of life from everyone and
who, in the battlefield, withdrew the speculative power and strength of
enthusiasm from the great military phalanx made by the Kauravas headed
by Bṛma, Karpa, Dropa, Satya, etc. Their arrangement was expert and
more than adequate, but He [Lord Sri Kṛṇṇa J , while going forward, did
all this.

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PURPORT

The Absolute Personality of Godhead Lord Sri ṇṇa by His plenary
Paramatma portion expands Himself in everyone's heart, and thus He
directs everyone in the matter of recollection, forgetfulness, knowledge,
the absence of intelligence and all psychological activities (Bg. 15.15). As
the Supreme Lord, He can increase or decrease the duration of life of a
living being. Thus the Lord conducted the Battle of Kuruṇṇetra according
to His own plan. He wanted that battle to establish Yudhiṇṇthira as the
Emperor of this planet, and to facilitate this transcendental business He
killed all who were on the opposite party by His ṇṇ-omnipotent will. The
other party was equipped with all military strength supported by big
generals like Bḷṇṇma, Dropa, Salya, etc., and it would have been physically
impossible for Arjuna to win the battle had the Lord not helped him by
every kind of tactic. Such tactics are generally followed by every statesman,
even in modern warfare, hut they are all done materially by powerful

espionages, military tactics and diplomatic maneuvers. But because Aijuna was the Lord's affectionate devotee, the Lord did all this Himself without personal anxiety by Arjuna. That is the way of devotional service of the Lord.

TEXT 16

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;flqm&□R<a«IW.nuofV• 11□ □□□

yad-dol;l□u mii prartihitam gur u-bh4ma-karfw

naptr-trigarta-5alya-saindhava-bahlikadyail;l

astriirty amogha-mahimiini niriipitiini

nopasprsur nrhari-diisam iviisur□ri

yat-under whose; dop§u-protection of arms; mii p rarih itam-my

self being situated; guru-Dropaciirya; bh'4ma-Bhi□ma; karra-Karpa;

naptr-Bhiir:iSrava; trigarta-King Susarma; salya- Sa lya; saindhava-King

Jayadratha; biihlika-brother of Maharaja Santanu (Bhi□ma's father);

iidyai;/l-etc.; astriiri-weapons; amogha-invincihle; mahimiini-very

powe rful; nirilpitiini-applied; na-not; upaprsul;l-touch; nrhari□diisam-

Text 16] The P□□avas Retire Timely 789

servitor of N rsimhadeva (Prahlada); iva-like; asura!li-weapons applied by the demons.

TRANSLATION

Great generals like B□ma, Dro!la, Kar!la, BhiiriSrava, Su8armii, Salya, Jayadratha, Bahh""ka, etc., all directed their invincible weapons against me.

But by His [Lord □!□-a's] grace they could not even touch a hair of my head. Similarly, Prahlada Maharaja, the supreme devotee of Lord Nrsinna deva, was unaffected by the weapons the demons used against him.

PURPORT

The history of Prahlada Maharaja, the great devotee of Nrsimhadeva, is narrated in the Seventh Canto of Srimad-Bhiigavatam. Prahlada Maharaja, a small child of five years only, became the object of envy of his great

father Hiranyaaksha only for his son's becoming a pure devotee of the Lord. The demon father applied all his weapons to kill the devotee son Prahlada, but by the grace of the Lord he was saved from all sorts of dangerous actions by his father. He was thrown in a fire, in boiling oil, from the top of a hill, underneath the legs of an elephant, and was administered poison. At last the father himself took up a chopper to kill his son, and thus Nrsimhadeva appeared and killed the heinous father before the son. Thus no one can kill the devotee of the Lord. Similarly, Arjuna was also saved by the Lord, although all dangerous weapons were applied by his great opponents like Bhishma.

Krishna: Born of Kunti by the sun-god prior to her marriage with Maharaja Yudhishthira. Krishna took his birth with bangles and earrings, extraordinary signs for an undaunted hero. In the beginning his name was Vasudeva, but when he grew up he presented his natural bangles and earrings to Indradeva, and thenceforward he became known as Vasudevan. After his birth from maiden Kunti, he was thrown in the Ganges. Later he was picked up by Adhirata, and he and his wife Radha brought him up as their own offspring. Krishna was very charitable, especially toward the brahmins. There was nothing which he could not spare for a brahmin. In the same charitable spirit he gave in charity his natural bangles and earrings to Indradeva, who, being very much satisfied with him, gave him in return a great weapon called Sakti. He was admitted as one of the students of Droṇa, and from the very beginning there was some rivalry between him and Arjuna. Seeing his constant rivalry with Arjuna,

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Duryodhana picked him up as his companion, and this gradually grew into greater intimacy. He was also present in the great assembly of Draupadi's svayamvara function, and when he attempted to exhibit his talent in that meeting, Draupadi's brother declared that Krishna could not take part in the competition because of his being the son of a sudra carpenter. Although he was refused in the competition, still when Arjuna was successful in piercing the fish target on the ceiling and Draupadi

bestowed her garland to Arjuna, Kan;w and other disappointed princes offered an unusual stumbling block to Arjuna while he was leaving with Draupadi. Specifically Kar!J.a fought with him very valiantly, but all of them were defeated by Arjuna. Duryodhana was very much pleased with Kar!J.a because of his constant rivalry with Arjuna, and when he was in power, he enthroned Kar!J.a in the state of Anga. Being baffled in his attempt to win Draupadi, he advised Duryodhana to attack King Drupada, for after defeating him both Arjuna and Draupadi could be arrested. But Dro!J.acarya rebuked them for this conspiracy, and they refrained from the action. Kar!J.a was defeated many times, not only by Arjuna but also by Bhimasena. He was the King of the kingdom of Bengal, Orissa and Madras combined. Later on he took an active part in the Rajasiiya sacrifice of Maharaja Yudhi□thira, and when there was gambling between the rival brothers, designed by Sakuni, Kar!J.a took part in the game, and he was very pleased when Draupadi was offered as a bet in the gambling. This fed his old grudge. When Draupadi was in the game he was very enthusiastic to declare the news, and it is he who ordered Du!J.sasana to take away the garments of both the Pii!J.□avas and Draupadi. He asked Draupadi to select another husband because, being lost by the Pa!J.□avas, she was rendered a slave of the Kurus. He was always an enemy of the Pa!J.□avas, and whenever there was an opportunity, he tried to curb them by all means. During the Battle of Kuru□etra, he foresaw the conclusive result, and he expressed his opinion that due to Lord Kr□!ia's being the chariot driver of Arjuna, the battle should be won by him. He always differed with B□ma, and sometimes he was proud enough to say that within five days he could finish up the Pa!J.□avas, if B□ma would not interfere with his plan of action. But he was much mortified when Bhishma died. He killed Ghatotkach with the Sakti weapon obtained from In<kadeva. His son, Brisasena, □as killed by Arjuna. He killed the largest number of Pa!J.□ava soldiers. At last there was a severe fight with Arjuna, and it is he only who was able to knock off the helmet of Arjuna. But it so happened that the wheel of his chariot got stuck in the battlefield mud, and when he got down to set

the wheel right Arjuna took the opportunity and killed him, although he requested Arjuna not to do so.

Text 16) The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 791

Naptri or Bhurisravya: Bhurisravya was the son of Somadutta, a member of the Kuru family. His other brother was Salya. Both the brothers and the father also attended the svayarhvara ceremony of Draupadi. All of them appreciated the wonderful strength of Arjuna due to his being the devotee friend of the Lord, and thus Bhurisravya advised the sons of Dhritrashtra not to pick any quarrel nor to fight with them. All of them also attended the Rajasuya yajna of Maharaja Yudhishthira. He possessed one akshauhiri regiment of army, cavalry, elephants and chariots, and all these were employed in the Battle of Kurukshetra on behalf of Duryodhana's party. He was counted by Bhima as one of the Yuthapatis. In the Battle of Kurukshetra he was especially engaged in a fight with Satyaki, and he killed ten sons of Satyaki. Later on, Arjuna cut off his hands, and he was ultimately killed by Satyaki. After his death he merged into the existence of Visvadeva.

Trigarta or Susarmii: Son of Maharaja Vrddhakshetra and the King of Trigarta Desa, and he was also present in the svayarhvara ceremony of Draupadi. He was one of the allies of Duryodhana, and he advised Duryodhana to attack the Matsyadesa (Darbhanga). During the time of cow-stealing in Viratnagar, he was able to arrest Maharaja Virata, but later on Maharaja Virata was released by Bhima, and in the Battle of Kurukshetra he also fought very valiantly, but at the end he was killed by Arjuna.

Jayadratha: Another son of Maharaja Vrddhakshetra. He was the King of Sindhu (modern Sind Pakistan) Desa. His wife's name was Dushala. He was also present in the svayarhvara ceremony of Draupadi, and he desired very strongly to have her hand, but he failed in the competition. But since then he sought always the opportunity to get in touch with Draupadi.

When he was going to marry in the Salya Desa, on the way to Kamyavan he happened to see Draupadi again and was too much attracted to her.

The Pāṇavas and Draupadi were then in exile, after losing their empire in

gambling, and jayadratha thought it wise to send news to Draupadi in an illicit manner through Kotisa□ya, one of his associates. Draupadi at once refused vehemently the proposal of jayadratha, but being so much attracted by the beauty of Draupadi, he tried again and again. Every time he was refused by Draupadi he tried to take her away forcibly on his chariot, and at first Draupadi gave him a good dashing, and he fell like a cut-root tree. But he was not discouraged, and he was able to force Draupadi to sit on the chariot. This incidence was seen by Dhaumya Muni, and he strongly protested the action of jayadratha. He also followed the chariot, and through Dhatreyak the matter was brought to the notice of Maharaja Yudhi□thira. The Pa!l□avas then attacked the soldiers of Jayadratha and killed them all, and at last Bhima caught hold of Jayadratha and beat him

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very severely, almost dead. Then all but five hairs were cut off his head and he was taken to all the kings and introduced as the slave of Maharaja Yudhi□thira. He was forced to admit himself to be the slave of Maharaja Yudhi□thira before all the princely order, and in the same condition he was brought before Maharaja Yudhi□thira. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was kind enough to order him released, and when he admitted to become a tributary prince under Maharaja Yudhi□thira, Queen Draupadi also desired his release. After this incidence, he was allowed to return to his country. Being so insulted, he went to Gongotri in the Himalayas and undertook a severe type of penance to please Lord Siva. He asked his benediction to defeat all the Pa!l□avas, at least one at a time. Then the Battle of Kuruk□etra began, and he took sides with Duryodhana. In the first day's fight he was engaged with Maharaja Drupada, then with Virata and then with Abhimanyu. While Abhimanyu was being killed, mercilessly surrounded by seven great generals, the Pa!l□avas came to his help, but Jayadratha, by the mercy of Lord Siva, repulsed them with great ability. At this, Arjuna took a vow to kill him, and on hearing this, Jayadratha wanted to leave the warfield and asked permission from the Kauravas for this cowardly action. But he was not allowed to do so. On the contrary, he was obliged

to fight with Arjuna, and while the fight was going on Lord Krishna reminded Arjuna that the benediction of Siva upon Jayadratha was that whoever would cause his head to fall to the ground would die at once. He therefore advised Arjuna to throw the head of Jayadratha directly onto the lap of his father, who was engaged in penances at the Samantapichika pilgrimage. This was actually done by Arjuna. Jayadratha's father was surprised to see a severed head on his lap, and he at once threw it to the ground. The father immediately died, his forehead being cracked in seven pieces.

TEXT 17

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WISkrm'{'kr: 11kr"11

sautye vrtaft kumatina 'tmada isvaro me
yat-pii.da-padmam abhaviya bhajanti bhavyiift
miirh sriinta-viiham arayo rathino bhuv4tham
na priiharan yad-anubhiiva-nirasta-cittiift

Text 17] The Pkrkravas Retire Timely 793

sautye -regarding a chariot driver; vrta- engaged; kumatini-by bad
consciousness; iitmada-one who delivers; iSvara- the Supreme Lord; me
my; yat-whose; piida-padmam-lotus feet; abhaviya-in the matter of
salvation; bhajanti-do render service; bhavyii- the intelligent class of
men; miim- unto me; sriinta-thirsty; viiham-my horses; arayo- the
enemies; rathina- a great general; bhuvi\$tham- while standing on the
ground; na- did not; priiharan- attack; yat-whose; anubhiiva- mercy;
nirasta- being absent; cittii- mind.

TRANSLATION

It was by His mercy only that my enemies neglected to kill me when
I descended from my chariot to get water for my thirsty horses. And it
was due to my lack of esteem for my Lord that I dared engage Him as my
chariot driver, for He is worshiped and offered services by the best men to
attain salvation.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is the object of worship both by impersonalists and by the devotees of the Lord. The impersonalists worship His glowing effulgence, emanating from His transcendental body of eternal form, bliss and knowledge, and the devotees worship Him as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Those who are below even the impersonalists consider Him to be one of the great historical personalities. The Lord, however, descends to attract all by his specific transcendental pastimes, and thus He plays the part of the most perfect master, friend, son and lover. His transcendental relation with Arjuna was in friendship, and the Lord therefore played the part perfectly, as He did with His parents, lovers and wives. While playing in such a perfect transcendental relation, the devotee forgets, by the internal potency of the Lord, that his friend or son is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although sometimes the devotee is bewildered by the acts of the Lord. After the departure of the Lord, Arjuna is conscious of his great friend, but there is no mistake on the part of Arjuna, nor any ill-estimation of the Lord. Intelligent men are attracted by the transcendental acting of the Lord with a pure unalloyed devotee like Arjuna.

In the warfield, scarcity of water is a well-known fact. Water is very rare there, and both the animals and men, working strenuously in the war-

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field, constantly require water to quench their thirst. Especially wounded soldiers and generals feel very thirsty at the time of death, and it sometimes so happens that simply for want of water one has to die unavoidably. But such scarcity of water was solved in the Battle of Kurukṣetra by means of boring the ground. By God's grace, water can be easily obtained from any place if there is facility for boring the ground. The modern system works on the same principle of boring the ground, but modern engineers are still unable to dig immediately wherever necessary. It appears, however, from the history as far back as the days of the Pāṇavas, that big generals like Arjuna could at once supply water even to the horses, and what to speak

of men, by drawing water from underneath the hard ground simply by penetrating the stratum with a sharp arrow, a method still unknown to the modern scientists.

TEXT 18

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narma'{ly u dara-rucira-smita-sobhitani

he piirtha he ,rjuna sakhe kuru-nandaneti

sanjalpitani nara-deva hrdisprnsani

smartur lufhanti hrdayam mama madhavasya

narमीरri-conversation in jokes; udiira-talked very frankly; rucira

pleasing; smita-sobhitiini-decorated with a smiling face; he-note of

address; piirtha-o son of Prtha; he-note of address; a rjuna[l.-Arjuna;

sakhe-friend; kuru-nandana-son of the Kuru dynasty; iti-and so on;

sa ii jalpitiini-such conversations; nara-deva-o King; h.rdi-heart; sp_rsiini

touching; smartufl,-by remembering them; lu thanti-overwhelms; hrdayam

-heart and soul; mama- my; miidhavasya-of Madhava (Kr□Da).

TRANSLATION

o King! His jokings and frank talks were pleasing and beautifully

decorated with smiles. And His addresses unto me as "o son of Pflha, o

friend, o son of the Kuru dynasty," and all such heartiness are now remem

bered by me, and thus I am overwhelmed.

Text 19] The r-ap□avas Retire Timely

TEXT 19

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□ □m. !11\□ it □□□□

sayyiisaniifana-vikatthana-bhojaniid4

aikyad vayasya rtavan iti vipra-labdha{l

sakhyu□ sakheva pitrvat tanayasya sarvam

sehe mahan mahitayii kumater agham me

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sayya-sleeping on one bed; asana-sitting on one seat; afana-walking together; vikatthana-self-adoration; bhojana-dining together; adi□u-and in all such dealings; aikyat-because of oneness; vayasya-O my friend; .rtavan-tru thful; iti-thu s; vipra- labdha[l- misbehaved; sakhyu{l- unto a friend; sakha iva-just like a friend; pit.rvat-just like the father; tanayasya -of a child; sarvam-all; sehe-tolerated; m ahan- great; mahitaya-by glories; kumate[l- of one who is of low mentality; agham- offense; me mine.

TRANSLATION

Generally both of us used to live together, sleep, sit and loiter together. And at the time of advertising for acts of chivalry, sometimes, if there were any irregularity, I used to reproach Him by saying, "My friend, You are very truthful." Even in those hours when His value was minimized, He, being the Supreme Soul, used to tolerate all those utterings of mine, excusing me exactly as a true friend excuses his true friend, or a father excuses his son.

PURPORT

Since the Supreme Lord Sri Kr□!la is all-perfect, His transcendental pastimes with His pure devotees never lack anything in any respect, either as a friend, son or lover. The Lord relishes the reproaches of friends, parents or fiancées more than the Vedic hymns which are offered to Him by great learned scholars and religionists in an official fashion.

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TEXT 20

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[Canto 1, Ch. 15

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so 'harh nrpendra rahital;. puru□ottamena
sakhya priyer.a suhrda hrdayena sunyal;.
adhvany urukrama-parigraham anga rak□an
gopair asadbhir abaleva vinirjito 'smi
sal;.-that; aham-myself; nrpendra-o Emperor; rahital;.-bereft of;
puru□ottamena-by the Supreme Lord; sakhyii-by my friend; priye[la
by my dearmost; suhrdii-by the well-wisher; hrdayena-by the heart and
soul; siinya[l-vacant; adhvani-recently; urukrama-parigraham-the wives
of the all-powerful; anga-bodies; rak§an-while protecting; gopail).-by the
. cowherds; asadbhi[l.-by the infidels; abalii iva- like a weak woman;
vinirjital;. asmi-I have been defeated.

TRANSLATION

o Emperor, now I am separated from my friend and dearmost well
wisher, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and therefore my heart
appears to be void of everything. In His absence I have been defeated by a
number of infidel cowherdmen while I was guarding the bodies of all the
wives of Kr□!la.

PURPORT

The important point in this verse is how it was possible that Arjuna
could be defeated by a gang of ignoble cowherdmen and how such mun-
dane cowherdmen could touch the bodies of the wives of Lord Krsna who
were under the protection of Arjuna. Srila Vi§vanatha Cakravarti.Thakur
has justified the contradiction by research in the Vi§flu Puriifla and Brahma
Puriifla. In these Puriiflas it is said that once the fair denizens of heaven
pleased A□tavakra Muni by their service and were blessed by the Muni to
have the Supreme Lord as their husband. □tavakra Muni was curved
in eight joints of his body, and thus he used to move in a peculiarly
Text 21) The P□«Javas Retire Timely 797
curved manner. The daughters of the demigods could not check their
laughter upon seeing the movements of the Muni, and the Muni, being
angry at them, cursed them that they would be kidnapped by rogues, even
if they would get the Lord as their husband. Later on, the girls again

satisfied the Muni by their prayers, and the Muni blessed them that they would regain their husband even after being robbed by the rogues. So, in order to keep the words of the great Muni, the Lord Himself kidnapped His wives from the protection of Arjuna, otherwise they would have at once vanished from the scene as soon as they were touched by the rogues. Besides that, some of the gopis who prayed to become wives of the Lord returned to their respective positions after their desire was fulfilled. After the departure of Lord Krishna, He wanted all His entourage back to Godhead, and they were called back under different conditions only.

TEXT 21

tad vai dhanus ta śavaṇi. sa ratho hayiṣa te
so 'ham rathī nṛpataya yata īnamanti
sarvaṁ kṣaṇena tad abhūd asaḍ iśa-riktaṁ
bhasmaṁ hutam kuḥaka-raddham ivopamaṁ udam
tat-the same; vai-certainly; dhanuṣ[. te-the same bow; iśavaṇi[. -arrows;
sa-the very same; ratha[. - chariot; hayiṣa[. te-the very same horses; sa
aham-I am the same Arjuna; rathī-the chariot-fighter; nṛpataya[. -all the
kings; yata[. -whom; īnamanti-offered their respects; sarvaṁ-all; kṣaṇena
-at a moment's notice; tat-all those; abhūt-became; asaḍ-useless; iśa
because of the Lord; riktaṁ-being void ; bhasmaṁ-ashes; hutam-offering
butter; kuḥaka-riddham- money created by magical feats; iva-like that;
udam-seed; iiṣyīm-in barren land.

TRANSLATION

I have the very same bow, the same arrows, the same chariot drawn by the same horses, and I use them as the same Arjuna to whom all the kings offered their due respects. But in the absence of Lord Krishna, all of them, at a moment's notice, have become null and void. It is exactly like offering clarified butter on ashes, accumulating money with a magic wand or sowing seeds on barren land.

PURPORT

As we have discussed more than once, one should not be puffed up by

borrowed plumes. All energies and powers are derived from the supreme source, Lord Kṛṣṇa, and they act as long as He desires and cease to function as soon as He withdraws. All electrical energies are received from the powerhouse, and as soon as the powerhouse stops supplying energy, the bulbs are of no use. In a moment's time such energies can be generated or withdrawn by the supreme will of the Lord. Material civilization without the blessing of the Lord is child's play only. As long as the parents allow the child to play, it is all right. As soon as the parents withdraw, the child has to stop. Human civilization and all activities thereof must be dovetailed with the supreme blessing of the Lord, and without this blessing all advancement of human civilization is like decoration on a dead body. It is said here that a dead civilization and its activities are something like clarified butter on ashes, the accumulation of money by a magic wand and the sowing of seeds in barren land.

rajarhs tvayanuprṣṭanarh
suhṛdarh nab- suhṛtpure
vipra-siipa-vimutjhanarh
nighnatarh muḍḍibhir mithafi.
vam'!'-irh madirarh pitva
madonmathita-cetasam
ajanatam ivanyonyarh
catufi. paicavaieṣṭitafi.

Text 24) The Pṛṣṭavas Retire Timely 799

riijan-o King; tvayii-by you; anuprṣṭiiniim-as you inquired; suhṛdiim
of friends and relatives; naḍḍi-our; suhṛtpure-in the city of Dvaraka; vipra
-the bṛiḥmaras; siipa-by the curse of; vimii!lhiiniim-of the befooled;
nighnatiim-of the killed; muḍḍibhifl-with bunches of sticks; mithaḍḍi
among themselves; viirurim-fermented rice; madiriim-wine; pitvii-having
drunk; madonmathita-being intoxicated; cetasiim-of that mental situa
tion; ajiinatiim-of the unrecognized; iva-like; anyonyam-one another;
catuḍḍi-four; panca-five; avaseṣṭiitiḍḍi- now remaining.

TRANSLATION

o King, since you have asked me about our friends and relatives in the city of Dvaraka, I will inform you that all of them were cursed by the brahm̐as, and as a result they all became intoxicated with wine made of purified rice and fought among themselves with sticks, not even recognizing one another. Now all but four or five of them are dead and gone.

TEXT 24

suṣṣij!{llffif {f.fṣṣ 1

f.nṣHtṣ YW44H :q trfflN:JJṣ\ll

priiyertaitad bhagavata

iSvarasya viceṣtitam

mitho nighnanti bhutiini

bhiivayanti ca yan mitha/;1

priiyerta etat-it is almost by; bhagavataṣ-of the Personality of God head; iSvarasya-of the Lord; viceṣtitam-by the will of; mithaṣ- one another; nighnanti-do kill; bhiitiini-the living beings; bhiivayanti-as also protect; ca-also; yat-of whom; mitha/;1-one another.

TRANSLATION

Factually this is all due to the supreme will of the Lord Personality of Godhead. Sometimes people kill one another, and at other times they protect one another.

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PURPORT

According to the anthropologists, there is nature's law of struggle for existence and survival of the fittest. But they do not know that behind the law of nature there is the supreme direction of the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead. In the Bhagavad-gitii it is confirmed that the law of nature is executed under the direction of the Lord. Whenever, therefore, there is peace in the world it must be known that it is due to the good will of the Lord. And whenever there is upheaval in the world, it is also due to the supreme will of the Lord. Not a blade of grass moves without the will of the Lord. Whenever, therefore, there is disobedience of the established rules enacted by the Lord, there is war between men and nations. The

surest way to the path of peace is, therefore, dovetailing everything to the established rule of the Lord. The established rule is that whatever we do, whatever we eat, whatever we sacrifice or whatever we give in charity must be done to the full satisfaction of the Lord. No one should do anything, eat anything, sacrifice anything or give anything in charity against the will of the Lord. Discretion is the better part of valor, and one must learn how to discriminate between actions which may be pleasing to the Lord and those which may not be pleasing to the Lord. An action is thus judged by the Lord's pleasure or displeasure. There is no room for personal whims; we must always be guided by the pleasure of the Lord. Such action is called yoga-karmasya kausalam, or actions performed which are linked with the Supreme Lord. That is the art of doing a thing perfectly.

TEXTS 25-26

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jalaukasiirh jale yadvan

mahiinto 'danty artiyasafi,

durbaliin balino rajan

mahanto balino mithafi,

evarh bal□thair yadubhir

mahadbhir itaran vibhufi,

yadiin yadubhir anyonyam

bhii.bharan saijahara ha

Texts 25-26] The P□□avas Retire Timely 801

jalaukasiim-of the aquatics; jale-in the water; yadvat-as it is;

mahiintafl.-the larger one; adanti-swallows; a11iyasaZ,-smaller ones;

durbaliin-the weak; balinaZ,-the stronger; rijan-o King; mahiinta[t- the

strongest; balinafl.-less strong; mithaZ,- in a duel; evam-thus; bali.ṣtha□

by the strongest; yadubhiZ,-by the descendants of Yadu; mahadbh□-one

who has greater strength; itariin-the common ones; vibhuZ,-the Supreme

Personality of Godhead; yadun-all the Yadus; yadubhiZ,-by the Yadus;
anyonyam-among one another; bhubhiiriin-the burden of the world;
saiijahiira-has unloaded; ha-in the past.

TRANSLATION

O King, as in the ocean the bigger and stronger aquatics swallow up
the smaller and weaker ones, so also the Supreme Personality of Godhead,
to lighten the burden of the earth, has engaged the stronger Y adu to kill
the weaker and the bigger Yadu to kill the smaller.

PURPORT

In the material world the struggle for existence and survival of the
fittest are laws because in the material world there is disparity between
conditioned souls due to everyone's desire to lord it over the material
resources. This very mentality of lording it over the material nature is the
root cause of conditioned life. And to give facility to such imitation lords,
the illusory energy of the Lord has created a disparity between conditioned
living beings by creating the stronger and the weaker in every species of
life. The mentality of lording it over the material nature and the cre
ation has naturally created a disparity and therefore the law of struggle for
existence. In the spiritual world there is no such disparity, nor is there such
a struggle for existence. In the spiritual world there is no struggle for exist
ence because everyone there exists eternally. There is no disparity because
everyone wants to render service to the Supreme Lord, and no one wants
to imitate the Lord in becoming the beneficiary. The Lord, being creator
of everything including the living beings, factually is the proprietor and
enjoyer of everything that be, but in the material world, by the spell of
miiyii or illusion, this eternal relation with the Supreme Personality of
Godhead is forgotten, and so the living being is conditioned under the law
of struggle for existence and survival of the fittest.

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TEXT 27

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desa-kOlartha-yuktani

hrt-tapopasamani ca

haranti smaratas cittam

govindabhihitani me

desa- space; kala-time; artha-importance; yuktani-impregnated with;
hrt- the heart; tapa-burning; upa8amani-extinguishing; ca-and; haranti
are attracting; smarata□-by remembering; cittam-mind; govinda-the
Supreme Personality of pleasure; abhihiitiini-narrated by; me-unto me.

TRANSLATION

Now I am attracted to those instructions imparted to me by the
Personality of Godhead [Govinda] because they are impregnated with
instructions for relieving the burning heart in all circumstances of time
and space.

PURPORT

Herein Arjuna refers to the instruction of the Bhagavad-gitii, which was
imparted to him by the Lord in the Battlefield of Kuruk□etra. The Lord
left behind Him the instructions of the Bhagavad-gita not only for the
benefit of Arjuna alone, but also for all time and in all lands. The Bhagavad
gitii, being spoken by the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the essence
of all Vedic wisdom. It is nicely presented by the Lord Himself for all who
have very little time to go through the vast Vedic literatures like the
Upani.ṣads, Puriiras and Vedanta-sutras. It is put within the study of the
great historical epic Mahabharata, which was especially prepared for the
less intelligent class, namely the women, the laborers and those who are
worthless descendants of the brahmaras , k□atriyas and higher sections of
the vaiSyas. The problem which arose in the heart of Arjuna on the
Battlefield of Kuruk□etra was solved by the teachings of the Bhagavad-gita.
Again, after the departure of the Lord from the vision of earthly people,
when Arjuna was face to face with being vanquished in his acquired power
and prominence, he wanted again to remember the great teachings of the
Bhagavad-gita just to teach all concerned that the Bhagavad-gita could be
consulted in all critical times, not only for solace from all kinds of mental

Text 27] The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 803

agonies, but also for the way out of great entanglements which may embarrass one in some critical hour.

The merciful Lord left behind Him the great teachings of the Bhagavad-gītā so that one can take the instructions of the Lord even when He is not visible to material eyesight. Material senses cannot have any estimation of the Supreme Lord, 'but by His inconceivable power, the Lord can incarnate Himself to the sense perception of the conditioned souls in a suitable manner through the agency of matter, which is also another form of the Lord's manifested energy. Thus the Bhagavad-gītā, or any authentic scriptural sound representation of the Lord, is also the incarnation of the Lord. There is no difference between the sound representation of the Lord and the Lord Himself. One can derive the same benefit from the Bhagavad-gītā as Arjuna did in the personal presence of the Lord.

The faithful human being who is desirous of being liberated from the clutches of material existence can very easily take advantage of the Bhagavad-gītā, and with this in view, the Lord instructed Arjuna as if Arjuna were in need of it. In the Bhagavad-gītā, five important factors of knowledge have been delineated pertaining to 1) the Supreme Lord, 2) the living being, 3) nature, 4) time and space, and 5) the process of activity. Out of these, the Supreme Lord and the living being are qualitatively one. The difference between the two has been analyzed as the difference between the whole and the part and parcel. Nature is inert matter displaying the interaction of three different modes, and eternal time and unlimited space are considered to be beyond the existence of the material nature. Activities of the living being are different varieties of aptitudes which can entrap or liberate the living being within and without material nature. All these subject matters are concisely discussed in the Bhagavad-gītā, and later the subject matters are elaborated in the Srimad-Bhāgavatam for further enlightenment. Out of the five subjects, the Supreme Lord, the living entity, nature and time and space are eternal, but the living entity, nature and time are under the direction of the Supreme Lord, who is

absolute and completely independent of any other control. The Supreme Lord is the supreme controller. The material activity of the living being is beginningless, but it can be rectified by transferral into the spiritual quality. Thus it can cease its material qualitative reactions. Both the Lord and the living entity are cognizant, and both have the sense of identification, of being conscious as a living force. But the living being under the condition of material nature, called mahat-tattva, misidentifies himself as being different from the Lord. The whole scheme of Vedic wisdom is targetted to the aim of eradicating such a misconception and thus liberating the living being from the illusion of material identification. When such an illusion is eradicated by knowledge and renunciation, the living
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beings are responsible actors and enjoyers also. The sense of enjoyment in the Lord is real, but such sense in the living being is a sort of wishful desire only. This difference in consciousness is the distinction of the two identities, namely the Lord and the living being. Otherwise there is no difference between the Lord and the living being. The living being is therefore eternally one and different simultaneously. The whole instruction of the Bhagavad-gitii stands on this principle.

In the Bhagavad-gitii the Lord and the living beings are both described as saniitana, or eternal, and the Lord's abode far beyond the material sky is also described as saniitana. The living being is invited to live in the saniitana existence of the Lord, and the process which can help a living being to approach the Lord's abode, where the liberated activity of the soul is exhibited, is called saniitana-dharma. One cannot, however, reach the eternal abode of the Lord without being free from the misconception of material identification, and the Bhagavad-gitii gives us the clue how to achieve this stage of perfection. The process of being liberated from the misconception of material identification is called, in different stages, fruitive activity, empiric philosophy and devotional service, up to transcendental realization. Such transcendental realization is made possible by dovetailing all the above items in relation with the Lord. Prescribed duties

of the human being, as directed in the Vedas, can gradually purify the sinful mind of the conditioned soul and raise him to the stage of knowledge. The purified stage of acquiring knowledge becomes the basis of devotional service of the Lord. As long as one is engaged in researching the solution of the problems of life, it is called *jñāna*, or purified knowledge, but on realizing the actual solution of life, one becomes situated in the devotional service of the Lord. The Bhagavad-gītā begins with the problems of life by discriminating the soul from the elements of matter and proves by all reason and argument that the soul is indestructible in all circumstances and that the outer covering of matter, the body and the mind, change for another term of material existence which is full of miseries. The Bhagavad-gītā is therefore meant for terminating all different types of miseries, and Arjuna took shelter of this great knowledge which was imparted to him before, during the Kurukṣetra battle.

TEXT 28

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Qt(K•uRI•ni'1 □s□□□:ll□'ll

Text 29) The P□ «Javas Retire Timely

sii.ta uvaca

evam cintayato iṣṭam; l

kṛtā-piṇḍa-sarorūham

sauhārdinatigat)hena

santīṣṭi vimalā matil; l

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suta; l u vāca-Siita Gosvami said; evam-thus; cintayata□-while thinking

of the instructions; jṣṭam□-of the Supreme Personality of Godhead;

krṭā-piṇḍa-the feet of Kṛṣṇa; sarorūham-resembling lotuses; sauhārdina

-by deep friendship; atigat)hena-in great intimacy; sīntī- pacified; īṣṭi- it

so became; vimalā-without any tinge of material contamination; matil; l

mind.

TRANSLATION

Siita Gosvami said: Thus being deeply absorbed in thinking of the instructions of the Lord, which were imparted in the great intimacy of friendship, and in thinking of His lotus feet, Arjuna's mind became pacified and free from all material contamination.

PURPORT

Since the Lord is absolute, deep meditation upon Him is as good as yogic trance. The Lord is nondifferent from His name, form, quality, pastimes, entourage and specific actions. Arjuna began to think of the Lord's instructions to Him on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra. Those instructions only began to eliminate the tinges of material contamination in the mind of Arjuna. The Lord is like the sun; the sun's appearance means immediate dissipation of darkness, or ignorance, and the Lord's appearance within the mind of the devotee can at once drive away the miserable material effects. Lord Caitanya has therefore recommended constant chanting of the name of the Lord for protection from all contamination of the material world. The feeling of separation from the Lord is undoubtedly painful to the devotee, but because it is in connection with the Lord, it has a specific transcendental effect which pacifies the heart. Feelings of separation are also sources of transcendental bliss, and they are never comparable to contaminated material feelings of separation.

TEXT 29

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□ f.r4f'HII□'t4NI*tN'tufl\$R: □□□□□

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viisudeviinghry anudhyiina

paribphhita-ramhasii

bhaktya nirmathitiise□a

k□iia-dh4arto 'rjunal)

[Canto I, Ch. 15

vasudeva-anghri-the lotus feet of the Lord; anudhyiina-by constant remembrance; parib.rhhta-expanded; ramhasa-with great velocity; bhaktya-in devotion; nirmathita-subsided; a5e\$a-unlimited; k□aya-dint;

dh4acw□-conception; arjuna□-Arjuna.

TRANSLATION

Arjuna's constant remembrance of the lotus feet of Lord Sri Krsna rapidly increased his devotion, and as a result all the trash in his thoughts subsided.

PURPORT

Material desires in the mind are the trash of material contamination. By such contamination, the living being is faced with so many compatible and incompatible things that discourage the very existence of spiritual identity. Birth after birth the conditioned soul is entrapped with so many pleasing and displeasing elements which are all false and temporary. They accumulate due to our reaction to material desires, but when we get into touch with the transcendental Lord in His variegated energies by devotion :il service, the naked forms of all material desires become manifest, and the intelligence of the living being is pacified in its true color. As soon as Arjuna turned his attention towards the instructions of the Lord, as they are inculcated in the Bhagavad-gita, his true color of eternal association with the Lord became manifest, and thus he felt freed from all material contaminations.

TEXT 30

lfui 1Pf.m ..-f q_ 6({ t«tUi' {lif.r I
'f*.□ii+fu.tl□ □(Qitl'i€(q: II□ o II
gitam bhagavata jiiānam
yat tat sangrama-miirdhani
kiila-karma-tamo-ruddham
punar adhyagamat prabhu□

Text 30) The P□□avas Retire Timely 807

gitam-instructed; bhagavatii-by the Personality of Godhead;jniinam
transcendental knowledge; yat-which; tat-that; sahagriima-murdhani-in
the midst of battle; kala-karma-time and actions; tama[l.-ruddham
enwrapped by such darkness; puna[!. adhyagamat-revived them again;
prabhu[l.-the lord of his senses.

TRANSLATION

Because of the Lord's pastimes and activities and because of His absence, it appeared that Arjuna forgot the instructions left by the Personality of Godhead. But factually this was not the case, and again he became lord of his senses.

PURPORT

A conditioned soul is enwrapped in his fruitive activities by the force of eternal time. But the Supreme Lord, when He incarnates on the earth, is not influenced by *kiila*, or the material conception of past, present and future. The activities of the Lord are eternal, and they are manifestations of His *iitma-miiyii*, or internal potency. All pastimes or activities of the Lord are spiritual in nature, but to the laymen they appear to be on the same level with material activities. It so appeared that Arjuna and the Lord were engaged on the Battle of Kurukṣetra as the other party was also engaged, but factually the Lord was executing His mission of incarnation in association with His eternal friend Arjuna. Therefore such apparent material activities of Arjuna did not drive him away from his transcendental position, but on the contrary revived his consciousness of the songs of the Lord, as He sang them personally. This revival of consciousness is assured by the Lord in the Bhagavad-gitii as follows:

manmanii bhava mad-bhakto madyiiji miim namaskuru
miim evainasi satyam te pratijiine priyo'si me.

(Bg. 18:65)

One should think of the Lord always; the mind should not forget Him. One should become a devotee of the Lord and offer obeisances unto Him. One who lives in that fashion becomes undoubtedly endowed with the blessing of the Lord by achieving the shelter of His lotus feet. There is nothing to doubt about this eternal truth. Because Arjuna was His confidential friend, the secret was disclosed to him.

Arjuna had no desire to fight with his relatives, but he fought for the mission of the Lord. He was always engaged in the execution of His

mission only, and therefore after His departure he remained in the same transcendental position, even though it appeared that he forgot all the instructions of the Bhagavad-gitii. One should, therefore, adjust the activities of life in pace with the mission of the Lord, and by doing this one is sure to return back home, back to Godhead. This is the highest perfection of life.

TEXT 31

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vi.Soko brahma-sampattyii

sanchinna-dvaita-samsayafi.

una-prakr:ti-nairgu1) yiid

alingatviid asambhavafi.

viSokafl.- free from bereavement; brahma-sampattyii-by possession of spiritual assets; sanchinna- being completely cut off; dvaita-samsayafi. from the doubts of relativity; lina-merged in; prakrti- material nature; nairgu11yiit- due to being in transcendence; alingatviit- because of being devoid of a material body; asambhavafl. - free from birth and death.

TRANSLATION

Because of his possessing spiritual assets, the doubts of duality were completely cut off. Thus he was freed from the three modes of material nature and placed in transcendence. There was no longer any chance of his becoming entangled in birth and death, for he was freed from material form.

PURPORT

Doubts of duality begin from the misconception of the material body, which is accepted as the self by less intelligent persons. The most foolish part of our ignorance is our identifying this material body with the self. Everything in relation with the body is ignorantly accepted as our own. Doubts due to misconceptions of myself and mine, in other words, my body, my relatives, my property, my wife, my children, my wealth, my country, my community, and hundreds and thousands of similar illusory

contemplations, cause bewilderment for the conditioned soul. By assim-

Text 31] The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 809

lating the instructions of the Bhagavad-gītā, one is sure to become released from such bewilderment because real knowledge is to know that the

Supreme Personality of Godhead, Vasudeva, Lord Kṛṣṇa, is everything, including one's self. Everything is a manifestation of His potency as part and parcel. The potency and the potent are nondifferent, so the conception of duality is at once mitigated by attainment of perfect knowledge.

As soon as Arjuna took up the instructions of the Bhagavad-gītā, expert as he was, he could at once eradicate the material conception of Lord Kṛṣṇa, his eternal friend. He could realize that the Lord was still present before him by His instruction, by His form, by His pastimes, by His qualities and everything else related to Him. He could realize that Lord Kṛṣṇa, his friend, was still present before him by His transcendental presence in different nondual energies, and there was no question of attainment of the association of the Lord by another change of body under the influence of time and space. By attainment of absolute knowledge, one can be in association with the Lord constantly, even in this present life, simply by hearing, chanting, thinking of and worshiping the Supreme Lord. One can see Him, one can feel His presence even in this present life simply by understanding the advaya-jñāna Lord, or the Absolute Lord, through the process of devotional service, which begins with hearing about Him.

Lord Caitanya says that simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord one can at once wash off the dust on the mirror of pure consciousness, and as soon as the dust is removed, one is at once freed from all material conditions. To become free from material conditions means to liberate the soul. As soon as one is, therefore, situated in absolute knowledge, his material conception of life is removed or emerges from a false conception of life. Thus the function of the pure soul is revived in spiritual realization.

This practical realization of the living being is made possible due to his becoming free from the reaction of the three modes of material nature, namely goodness, passion and ignorance. By the grace of the Lord, a pure

devotee is at once raised to the place of the Absolute, and there is no chance of the devotee becoming materially entangled again in conditioned life. One is not able to feel the presence of the Lord in all circumstances until one is endowed with the required transcendental vision made possible by devotional service prescribed in the revealed scriptures. Arjuna attained this stage long before on the Battlefield of Kurukṣetra, and when he apparently felt the absence of the Lord, he at once took shelter of the instructions of the Bhagavad-gītā, and thus again he was placed in his original position. This is the position of viśoka, or the stage of being freed from all grief and anxieties.

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TEXT 32

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niSamya bhagavan margam

samstham yadu-kulasya ca

sva□ pathiiya matim cakre

nibhr̥tītmī yudhāthira□

niSamya- deliberating; bhagavat-regarding the Lord; mīl'am- the ways of His appearance and disappearance; samstham- end; yadu-kulasya-of the dynasty of King Yadu; ca-also; sva□-the abode of the Lord; pathaya -on the way of; matim-desire; cakre-gave attention; nibhr̥ta-atmīi lonely and alone; yudhāthira□-King Yudhi□thira.

TRANSLATION

Upon hearing of Lord Kṛṣṇa's returning to His abode, and upon understanding the end of the Y adu dynasty's earthly manifestation, Maharaja Yudhi□thira decided to go back home, back to Godhead.

PURPORT

Maharaja Yudhi□thira also turned his attention to the instructions of the Bhagavad-gītā after hearing about the Lord's departure from the vision of earthly people. He began to deliberate on the Lord's way of appearance and departure. The mission of the Lord's appearance and

disappearance in the mortal universe is completely dependent on His supreme will. He is not forced to appear or disappear by any superior energy, as the living beings appear and disappear, being forced by the laws of nature. Whenever the Lord likes, He can appear Himself from anywhere and everywhere without disturbing His appearance and disappearance in any other place. He is like the sun. The sun appears and disappears on its own accord at any place without disturbing its presence in other places. The sun appears in the morning in India without disappearing from the western hemisphere. The sun is present everywhere and anywhere all over the solar system, but it so appears that in a particular place the sun appears in the morning and also disappears at some fixed time in the evening. The time limitation even of the sun is of no concern, and so what to speak of Text 33] The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 811

the Supreme Lord who is the creator and controller of the sun. Therefore, in the Bhagavad-gītā it is stated that anyone who factually understands the transcendental appearance and disappearance of the Lord by His inconceivable energy becomes liberated from the laws of birth and death and is placed in the eternal spiritual sky where the Vaikuntha planets are. There such liberated persons can eternally live without the pangs of birth, death, old age and disease. In the spiritual sky the Lord and those who are eternally engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord are all eternally young because there is no old age and disease, and there is no death. Because there is no death there is no birth. It is concluded therefore that simply by understanding the Lord's appearance and disappearance in truth, one can attain the perfectional stage of eternal life. Therefore, Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira also began to consider going back to Godhead. The Lord appears on the earth or any other mortal planet along with His associates who live with Him eternally, and the members of the Yadu family who were engaged in supplementing the pastimes of the Lord are no other than His eternal associates and so also Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira and his brothers and mother, etc. Since the appearance and disappearance of the Lord and His eternal associates are transcendental, one should not be

bewildered by the external features of appearance and disappearance. .

TEXT 33

prthiipy anusrutya dhanaiijayoditam

nasam yaduniim bhagavad gatim ca tam

ekiinta-bhaktyii bhagavaty adhok□aje

nivesitiitmoparariima samsrte/;1.

prthii- Kunti; api-also; anusrutya- overhearing; dhanaiijaya-Arjuna;

uditam-uttered by; n ii5am-end; yaduniim- of the Yadu dynasty; bhagavat

-of the Personality of Godhead; gatim- disappearance; ca-also; tam-all

those; eka-anta- unalloyed; bhaktyii-devotion; bhagavati-unto the Su

preme Lord, Sri Kreyqa; adhok □aje-transcendence; nivesita-iitmii-with full

attention; uparariima -became released from; samsrte[l-material existence.

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TRANSLATION

Kunti, after overhearing Arjuna's telling of the end of the Yadu dy

nasty and disappearance of Lord Kr□tta, engaged in the devotional service

of the transcendental Personality of Godhead with full attention and thus

gained release from the course of material existence.

PURPORT

The setting of the sun does not mean the end of the sun. It means that

the sun is out of our sight. Similarly, the end of the mission of the Lord

on a particular planet or universe only means that He is out of our sight.

The end of the Yadu dynasty also does not mean that it is annihilated. It

disappears, along with the Lord, out of our sight. As Maharaja Yudh□thira

decided to prepare to go back to Godhead, so also Kunti decided, and thus

she fully engaged herself in the transcendental devotional service of the

Lord, which guarantees one passport for going back to Godhead after

quitting this present material body. The beginning of devotional service of

the Lord is the beginning of spiritualizing the present body, and thus an

unalloyed devotee of the Lord loses all material contact in the present

body. The abode of the Lord is not a myth, as is thought by the unbelievers

or ignorant people, but one cannot reach there by any material means like

a sputnik or space capsule. But one can certainly reach there after leaving this present body, and one must prepare himself to go back to Godhead by practicing devotional service. That guarantees a passport for going back to Godhead, and Kunti adopted it.

TEXT 34

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yayaharad bhuvo bharam

tam tanurh vijahavajaf.

ka{ltakarh ka{lfakeneva

dvayarh capiSitufr. samam

yaya-that by which; aharat-took away; bhuvafr.-of the world; bhiiram

-burden; tiim-that; tanum-body; vijahau-relinquished; aja□-the un

born; ka!lfakam-thorn; ka{lfakena-by the thorn; iva-like that; dvayam

both; ca-also; api-although; iSitu□-controlling; samam-equal.

Text 34] The P□□avas Retire Timely 813

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Unborn Lord Sri Kr□□a caused the members of theYadu dynasty to relinquish their bodies, and thus He relieved the burden of the world. This action was like picking out a thorn with a thorn, though both are the same to the controller.

PURPORT

Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Thakur suggests that the [§is like Saunaka and others who were hearing Srimad-Bhiigavatam from Suta Gosvami at Naimi□ara□ya were not happy to hear about the Yadus' dying in the madness of intoxication. To give them relief from this mental agony, Suta Gosvami assured them that the Lord caused the members of the Y adu dynasty to relinquish their bodies by which they had to take away the burden of the world. The Lord and His eternal associates appeared on earth to help the administrative demigods in eradicating the burden of the world. He therefore called for some of the confidential demigods to appear in the Yadu family and serve Him in His great mission. After the mission was

fulfilled, the demigods, by the will of the Lord, relinquished their corporeal bodies by fighting amongst themselves in the madness of intoxication. The demigods are accustomed to drinking soma-rasa beverage, and therefore the drinking of wine and intoxication are not unknown to them. Some times they were put into trouble for indulging in intoxication. Once the sons of Kuvera fell in the wrath of Narada for being intoxicated, but afterwards they regained their original forms by the grace of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. We shall find this story in the Tenth Canto. For the Supreme Lord, both the asuras and the demigods are equal, but the demigods are obedient to the Lord, whereas the asuras are not. Therefore, the example of picking out a thorn by another thorn is quite befitting. One thorn, which causes pinpricks on the leg of the Lord, is certainly disturbing to the Lord, and the other thorn, which takes out the disturbing elements, certainly gives service to the Lord. So although every living being is a part and parcel of the Lord, still one who is a pinprick of the Lord is called an asura, and one who is a voluntary servitor of the Lord is called a devatī or demigod. In the material world the devatīs and asuras are always contending, and the devatīs are always saved from the hands of the asuras by the Lord. Both of them are under the control of the Lord. The world is full of two kinds of living beings, and the Lord's mission is always to protect the devatīs and destroy the asuras, whenever there is such need in the world, and to do good to both of them.

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TEXT 35

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yatha matsyadi-riipiirti

dhatte jahyad yatha natafl.

bhubharafl. k□apito yena

jahau tac ca kalevaram

yathii-as much as; matsya-iidi-incarnation as a fish, etc.; rupiirti-forms;

dhatte-eternally accepts; jahyii t-apparently relinquishes; yathii-exactly

like; natalz.-magician; bhubhiirafl.-burden of the world; kṣapitaft-relieved;
yena-by which;jahau-let go; tat-that; ca-also; kalevaram-body.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Lord relinquished the body which He manifested to diminish the burden of the earth. Just like a magician, He relinquishes one body to accept different ones, like the fish incarnation, etc.

PURPORT

The ,Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is neither impersonal nor formless, but His body is nondifferent from Him, and therefore He is known as the embodiment of eternity, knowledge and bliss. In the Brhad-vaiṣṇava Tantra it is clearly mentioned that anyone who considers the form of the Lord Kṛṣṇa to be made of material energy must be ostracized by all means. And if by chance the face of such an infidel is seen, one must clean himself by jumping in the river with his clothing. The Lord is described as amṛta, or deathless, because He has no material body. Under the circumstances, the Lord's dying or quitting His body is like the jugglery of a magician. The magician shows by his tricks that he is cut into pieces, burnt into ashes or made unconscious by hypnotic influences, etc., but all are false shows only. Factually the magician himself is neither burnt into ashes nor is he cut into pieces nor is he dead or unconscious at any stage of his magical demonstration. Similarly, the Lord has His eternal forms of unlimited variety of which the fish incarnation, as was exhibited within this universe, is also one. Because there are innumerable universes, somewhere or other the fish incarnation must be manifesting His pastimes without cessation. In this verse, the particular
fext 36] The Pāc:lavas Retire Timely 815

word dhatte, eternally accepted, (and not the word dhatva, accepted for the occasion) is used. The idea is that the Lord does not create the incarnation of fish; He has eternally such a form, and the appearance and disappearance of such an incarnation serve particular purposes. In the Bhagavad-gītā the Lord says (Bg. 7.24-25), "The impersonalists think that I have no form and that I am formless, but that at present I have accepted

a form to serve a purpose, and now I am manifested. But such speculators are factually without sharp intelligence. Though they may be good scholars in the Vedic literatures, they are practically ignorant of My inconceivable energies and My eternal forms of Personality. The reason is that I reserve the power of not being exposed to the nondevotees by My mystic curtain. The less intelligent fools are therefore unaware of My eternal form, which is never to be vanquished and is unborn." In the Padma Purāṇa it is said that those who are envious and always angry at the Lord are unfit to know the actual and eternal form of the Lord. In the Bhāgavatam also it is said that the Lord appeared like a thunderbolt to those who were wrestlers. Sisupala, at the time of being killed by the Lord, could not see Him as Kṛṣṇa, being dazzled by the glare of the brahmajyoti. Therefore, the temporary manifestation of the Lord as a thunderbolt to the wrestlers appointed by Kamsa, or the glaring appearance of the Lord before Sisupala, etc., were relinquished by the Lord, but the Lord as a magician is eternally existent and is never vanquished in any circumstance. Such forms are temporarily shown to the asuras only, and when such exhibitions are withdrawn, the asuras think that the Lord is no more existent, just as the foolish audience thinks the magician to be burnt to ashes or cut into pieces. The conclusion is that the Lord has no material body, and therefore He is never to be killed or changed by His transcendental body.

TEXT 36

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yada mukundo bhagavan imam mahzrh

jahau sva tanva sraval)tya-satkathaft

tadaharevaprati-b uddha-cetasam

abhadra-hetuft kalir anvavartata

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yada-when; mukunda□-Lord Kṛṣṇa; bhagavan-the Personality of

Godhead; imam-this; mahim- earth; jahau-left; sva tanva-with His self same body; sraviiriya-satkatha - hearing about Him is worthwhile; tada at that time; ahareva-from the very day; aproti-buddha-cetasam-of those whose minds are not sufficiently developed; abhadra-hetu -cause of all ill fortune; kali anvavartata- Kali fully manifested.

TRANSLATION

When the Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṣṇa left this earthly planet in His selfsame form, from that very day Kali, who had appeared partially before, became fully manifest to create inauspicious conditions for those who are endowed with a poor fund of knowledge.

PURPORT

The influence of Kali can be enforced only upon those who are not fully developed in God consciousness. One can neutralize the effects of Kali by keeping oneself fully under the supreme care of the Personality of Godhead. The age of Kali ensued just after the Battle of Kurukṣetra, but it could not exert its influence because of the presence of the Lord. The Lord, however, left this earthly planet in His own transcendental body, and as soon as He left, the symptoms of the Kali-yuga, as were envisioned by Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira prior to Arjuna's arrival from Dvaraka, began to manifest, and Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira rightly conjectured on the departure of the Lord from earth. As we have already explained, the Lord left our sight just as when the sun sets it is out of our sight.

TEXT 37

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yudhiṭhīras tat parisarparam budha

pure ca rtre ca grhe tathīitmani

vibhīivya lobhīinrta-jihma-himsaniidy

m/hnrmn-rnkrnm. tmmn.niivn nnrvndh.iit

Text 37) The Pāavas Retire Timely 817

yudh4thira[l-Maharaja Yudhi□thira;tat-that;parisarpa!l-am-expansion;
budha[t-thoroughly experienced; pure-in the capital; ca-as also; rii\$fre
in the state; ca-and; grhe-at home; tathii-as also; iitmani-in person;
vibhiivya-in creating; lobha-avarice; anrta-untruth; jihma-diplomacy;
hirhsaniidi-violence, envy; adharma-irreligion; cakram-a vicious circle;
gamaniiya-for departure;paryadhiit-dressed himself accordingly.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yudhi□hira was intelligent enough to understand the influence of the age of Kali (characterized by increasing avarice, falsehood, cheating and violence throughout the capital, state and home and among individuals). So he wisely prepared himself to leave home, and he dressed accordingly.

PURPORT

The present age is influenced by the specific qualities of Kali, and since the days of the Battle of Kuruk□etra, about five thousand years ago, the influence of the age of Kali began manifesting, and from authentic scriptures it is learned that the age of Kali is still to run on for 427,000 years. The symptoms of the Kali-yuga, as mentioned above, namely avarice, falsehood, diplomacy, cheating, nepotism, violence and all such things, are already in vogue, and no one can imagine what is going to happen gradually with further increase of the influence of Kali till the day of annihilation. We have already come to know that the influence of the age of Kali is meant for godless so-called civilized man, otherwise those who are under the protection of the Lord have nothing to fear from this horrible age. Maharaja Yudhi□thira was a great devotee of the Lord, and there was no necessity of his being afraid of the age of Kali, but he preferred to retire from active household life and prepare himself to go back home, back to Godhead. The Part□avas are eternal companions of the Lord, and therefore they are more interested in the company of the Lord than anything else. Besides that, being an ideal king, Maharaja Yudhi□thira wanted to retire just to set an example for others. As soon as there is some young fellow to look after the household affairs, one should at once

retire from family life to uplift oneself to spiritual realization. No one should rot in the dark well of household life till one is dragged by the will of Yamaraja. Modern politicians should take lessons from Maharaja Yudhiṭhira about voluntary retirement from active life and should make room for the vounṭer ṭeneration. Also retired old ṭentlemen should take a lesson from him and leave home for spiritual realization before forcefully dragged away to meet death.

TEXT 38

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\ftṭ;ftoq1: qB \ṭ<ṭṭṭ ṭṭṭṭ

svariit pautram vinayinam

atmanaṭ susamam gu"ṭla*

toyanivyiiṭ. patim bhiimer

abhyaṭincad gajahvaye

svariit-the emperor;pautra m--unto the grandson; vinayina m-- properly trained; iitmanafṭ-his own self; susamam-equal in all respects;gurzaiṭ-by the qualities; toyanivyiiṭ- outskirted by the seas;pat im- master; bhiimeṭ of the land; abhyaṭiicat- enthroned; gajihvaye-in the capital of Hastinapura.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, in the capital of Hastinapura, he enthroned his grandson, who was trained and equally qualified, as the emperor and master of all land bordered by the seas.

PURPORT

The total land on the earth bordered by the seas was under the subjugation of the King of Hastinapura. Maharaja Yudhiṭhira trained his grandson Maharaja Parikṭit, who was equally qualified, in state administration in terms of the king's obligation to the citizens. Thus Parikṭit was enthroned on the seat of Maharaja Yudhiṭhira prior to his departure back to Godhead. Concerning Maharaja Parikṭit, the specific word used, vinayinam, is significant. Why was the King of Hastinapura, at least till

the time of Maharaja Pan"kaṁit, accepted as the Emperor of the world? The only reason is that the people of the world were happy because of the good administration of the Emperor. The happiness of the citizens was due to the ample production of natural produce such as grains, fruits, milk, herbs, valuable stones, minerals and everything that the people needed. They

Text 39] The Pāṇavas Retire Timely 819

were even free from all bodily miseries, anxieties of mind, and disturbances caused by natural phenomena and other living beings. Because everyone was happy in all respects, there was no resentment, although there were sometimes battles between the state kings for political reasons and supremacy. Everyone was trained to attain the highest goal of life, and therefore the people were also enlightened enough not to quarrel over trivialities. The influence of the age of Kali gradually infiltrated the good qualities of both the kings and the citizens, and therefore a tense situation developed between the ruler and the ruled, but still even in this age of disparity between the ruler and the ruled, there can be spiritual emolument and God consciousness. That is a special prerogative.

TEXT 39

il'(lqf ṁ ṁ ṁWfqfit ṁ: I

smt..m fwtṁf!'l'11Wifq4ta}q(: IIṁQ..II

mathurayam tatha vajram

surasena-patim tatab,

prafopatyam nirnpyeṁtim

agnin apibat iSvara[l

mathurayam-at Mathura; tatha-also; vajram-Vajra; surasena-patim

King of the Surasenas; tatab,-thereafter; priijapatyiim-Prajapatya sacrifice;

niriipya- having performed; ṁtim-goal; agn in- fire; apibat-placed in

himself; iSvara[l-capable.

TRANSLATION

Then he posted V ajra, the son of Aniruddha (grandson of Lord l(rṁQ.a), at Mathura as the King of Surasena. Afterwards Maharaja Y udhiṁṁhira performed a Prajapati sacrifice and placed in himself the fire for quitting

household life.

PURPORT

Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, after placing Maharaja Parikṣit on the imperial throne of Hastinapura, and after posting Vajra, the great-grandson of Lord Kṛṣṇa, as the King of Mathura, accepted the renounced order of life. The 820 Srimad-Bhagavatam (Canto 1, Ch. 15

system of four orders of life and four castes in terms of quality and work known as varṇāśrama-dharma, is the beginning of real human life, and Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, as the protector of this system of human activities, timely retired from active life as a sannyāsi, handing over the charge of the administration to a trained prince, Maharaja Parikṣit. The scientific system of varṇāśrama-dharma divides the human life in four divisions of occupation and four orders of life. The four orders of life as brahmācārī, grhastha, vānaprastha and sannyāsi are to be followed by all, irrespective of the occupational division. Modern politicians do not wish to retire from active life, even if they are old enough, but Yudhiṣṭhira Maharaja, as an ideal king, voluntarily retired from active administrative life to prepare himself for the next life. Everyone's life must be so arranged that the last stage of life, say at least the last fifteen to twenty years prior to death, can be absolutely devoted to devotional service of the Lord to attain the highest perfection of life. It is really foolishness to engage oneself all the days of one's life in material enjoyment and fruitive activities, because as long as the mind remains absorbed in fruitive work for material enjoyment, there is no chance of getting out from conditioned life or material bondage. No one should follow the suicidal policy of neglecting one's supreme task of attaining the highest perfection of life, namely going back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 40

ṣṭhiṁ kṛtvā parikṣitāṁ v

ṣṭhiṁ kṛtvā parikṣitāṁ v

visrjya tatra tat sarvam

duḥkṣa-valayīdikam

nirmamo nirahankaral).

saiichinniisefla-bandhanal).

vis.rfya-relinquishing; tatra-all those; tat-that; sarvam-everything;

duku la-belt; valayiid ikam-and bangles; ninnama[l- uninterested;

nirahankiira[l-unattached ; saiichinna-perfectly cut off; aSe□a-bandhana[l

-unlimited attachment.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Yudhi□hira at once relinquished all his garments, belt and ornaments of the royal order and became completely disinterested and unattached to everything.

Text 41] The P□□avas Retire Timely 821

PURPORT

To become purified of material contamination is the necessary qualification for becoming one of the associates of the Lord. No one can become an associate of the Lord or can go back to Godhead without such purification. Maharaja Yudhi□thira, therefore, to become spiritually pure, at once gave up his royal opulence by dress and garments. The kasaya or saffron loincloth of a sannyisi indicates freedom from all attractive material garments, and thus he changed his dress accordingly. He became disinterested in his kingdom and family and thus became free from all material contamination_ or material designation. People are generally attached to various kinds of designations, namely the designations of family, society, country, occupation, wealth, position and many others. As long as one is attached to such designations, he is considered materially impure. The so called leaders of men in the modern age are attached by national consciousness, but they do not know that such false consciousness is also another designation of the materially conditioned soul, and one has to relinquish such designations before one can become eligible to go back to Godhead. Foolish people, however, adore such men who die in national consciousness, but here is an example of Maharaja Yudhi□thira, a royal king who prepared himself to leave this world without such national consciousness. And yet he is remembered even today because

he was a great pious king, almost on the same level with the Personality of Godhead Sri Rama. And because people of the world were dominated by such pious kings, they were happy in all respects, and it was quite possible for such great emperors to rule the world.

TEXT 41

ilflf □ 'Rfu □ □ l'f (11{ I

't€ql:tmlwf □ d q□ □ mH II

viicam juhiiva manasi

tat priirta itare ca tam

rru;tyiiv apiinam sotsargam

tam pancatve hy ajohavit

vacam-speeches;juhiiva-relinquished;manasi-into the mind;tat prape
-mind into breathing;itare ca-other senses also;tam-into that;m[tyau
into death; apiinam-breathing;sa-utsa□gam-with all dedication;tam-that;
paicvatve-into the body made of five elements; hi-certainly; ajohavit
amalgamated it.

822 Snmad-Bhigavatun [Canto 1, Ch. 15

TRANSLATION

Then he amalgamated all the sense organs into the mind, then the mind into life, life into breathing, his total existence into the embodiments of the five elements and his body into death. Then as pure self, he became free from the material conception of life.

PURPORT

Maharaja YU<lhi□hira, like his brother Arjuna, began to concentrate and gradually became freed from all material bondage. First of all he concentrated all the actions of the senses amalgamated in the mind, or in other words he turned his mind □owards transcendental service of the Lord. He prayed that all material activities were performed by the mind, actions and reactions of the material senses, and since he was going back to God head, the mind would wind up its material activities and be turned towards the transcendental service of the Lord. There was no longer need for material activities. Actually the activities of the mind cannot be stopped be

cause they are the reflection of the eternal soul, but the quality of the activities can be changed from matter to the transcendental service of the Lord. The material color of the mind is changed by washing it from contaminations of life-breathing and thereby getting it freed from the contamination of repeated births and deaths and getting it situated in pure spiritual life. All is manifested by the temporary embodiment of the material body, which is a production of mind at the time of death, and if the mind is purified by practice of transcendental loving service of the Lord, and the same is constantly engaged in the service of the lotus feet of the Lord, there is no more chance of the mind's producing another material body after death. It will be freed from the absorption of material contamination. The pure soul will be able to return back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 42

□□q□□□S'i□"'f.tt: I

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tritve hutvii ca paicatvam

tac caikatve }uhon muni□

saroam atmany ajuhavid

brahmaCJy atmiinam avyaye

Text 42) The Piif.t□avas Retire Timely 823

tritve-into the three qualities; hutvii-having offered; ca-also;

paicatvam-five elements; t at-that; ca-also; ekatve-in one nescience;

ajuhot-amalgamated; muni[l-the thoughtful; saroam-the sum total;

iitmani-in the soul; ajuhavit-fixed; brahmap.i-unto the spirit; iitmiinam

the soul; avyaye-unto the inexhaustible.

TRANSLATION

Thus annihilating the gross body of five elements into the three qualitative modes of material nature, he merged them in one nescience and then absorbed that nescience in the self, Brahman, which is inexhaustible in all circumstances.

PURPORT

All that is manifested in the material world is the product of the mahat

tattva avyakta, and things that are visible in our material vision are nothing but combinations and permutations of such variegated material products. But the living entity is different from such material products. It is due to the living entity's forgetfulness of his eternal nature as eternal servitor of the Lord, and his false conception of becoming a so-called lord of the material nature, that he is obliged to enter into the existence of false sense enjoyment. Thus a concomitant generation of material energies is the principal cause of the mind's being materially affected. Thus the gross body of five elements is produced. Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira reversed the action and merged the five elements of the body in the three modes of material nature. The qualitative distinction of the body as being good, bad or mediocre is extinguished, and again the qualitative manifestations become merged in material energy, which is produced from a false sense of the pure living being. When one is thus inclined to become an associate of the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead, in one of the innumerable planets of the spiritual sky, especially in Goloka Vrndavana, one has to think always that he is different from the material energy; he has nothing to do with it, and he has to realize himself as pure spirit or Brahman, qualitatively equal with the Supreme Brahman (Paramesvara). Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira, after distributing his kingdom to Panṅkita and Vajra, did not think himself Emperor of the world nor head of the Kuru dynasty. This sense of freedom from material relations, as well as freedom from material encagement of the gross and subtle encirclement, makes one free to act as the servitor of the Lord, even though one is in the material world. This stage is called jivanmukta stage, or the liberated stage, even in the 824 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 15 material world. That is the process of ending material existence. One must not only think that he is Brahman, but he must act like Brahman. One who only thinks himself Brahman is an impersonalist. And one who acts like Brahman is the pure devotee.

TEXT 43

lift«Ril M(I□IU 'I'ttl1e... iffi□: 1

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□ M(411□iluf4+1NU :q'1f1 □□□□□□

c'iravasii nirohiiro

baddhaviin mukta-miirdhaja!J

darsayann iitmano riipam

jafjonmatta-piSacavat

anavek□amiir-o niragiid

asnwan badhiro yathii

ciravasa[l-accepted torn clothing; nirahiiraft-gave up all solid food

stuff; baddhava-stopped talking; mukta-miirdhaja[l-untied his hair;

darsayan-began to show; atmana[l-of himself; riipam-bodily features;

jafja-inert; unmatta-mad; piSacavat-just like an urchin; anavek□amarw[l

-without waiting for; niraga t-was situated; asnwan-wi thout hearing;

badhira[l-just like a deaf man; yatha-as if.

TRANSLATION

After that Maharaja Yud□!hira dressed himself in torn clothing, gave up eating all solid foods, voluntarily became dumb and let his hair hang loose. All this combined to make him look like an urchin or madman with no occupation. He did not depend on his brothers for anything. And, just like a deaf man, he heard nothing.

PURPORT

Thus being freed from all external affairs, he had nothing to do with imperial life or family prestige, and for all practical purposes· he posed himself exactly like an inert mad urchin and did not speak of material

Text44] The Piil)...avas Retire Timely 825

affairs. He had no dependence on his brothers who had all along been helping him. This stage of complete independence from everything is also called the purified stage of fearlessness.

TEXT44

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□ q -R \q1□4ll'4iij □ rm: lt\l\lll

udicirh pravivesasarh

gata-puroarh mahatmabhi"(l

hrdi brahma param dhyiiyan

niivarteta yato gata□

udicim-the northern side; pravivesasam-those who wanted to enter there; gata-purotim-the path accepted by his forefathers; maha-atmabhifi. by the broad-minded; hrdi-within the heart; brahma-the Supreme; param -Godhead; dhyayan- constantly thinking of;na avarteta- passed his days; yatafl-whenever; gatafl-went.

TRANSLATION

He then started towards the North, treading the path which was accepted by his forefathers and great men, to devote himself completely to the thought of the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And he lived in that way wherever he went.

PURPORT

It is understood from this verse that Maharaja Yudhi□thira followed in the footsteps of his forefathers and the great devotees of the Lord. We have discussed many times before that the system of varraJisrama-dharma, as it was strictly followed by the inhabitants of the world, specifically by those who inhabited the Aryavarta province of the world, emphasizes the importance of leaving all household connections at a certain stage of life. The training and education was so imparted, and thus a respectable person like Maharaja Yudhi□thira must leave .all family connection for self realization and going back to Godhead. No king or respectable gentleman would continue family life till the end because that was considered suicidal
826 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 15
and against the interest of the perfection of human life. In order to be free from all family encumbrances and devote oneself cent percent in the devotional service of Lord Kṛṣṇa, this system is always recommended for everyone because it is the path of authority. The Lord instructs in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 18.62) that one must become a devotee of the Lord at least at the last stage of one's life. A sincere soul of the Lord like Maharaja Yu□thira must abide by this instruction of the Lord for his own interest.

The specific words Brahman Param indicate Lord Sri Kṛṇā!J.a. This is corroborated in the Bhagavad-gitā (Bg. 10.12) by Arjuna with reference to great authorities like Asita, Devala, Narada, Vyasa, etc. Thus Maharaja Yudhiṇthira, while leaving home for the North, constantly remembered Lord Sri KṛṇāQa within himself, following in the footsteps of his forefathers as well as the great devotees of all times.

TEXT 45

□ □ □ □ RR: f){'IMJAJ: I

□ r□ ..N□ □ □ 'W: □ □ □ u□ J□ u

saroe tam anunirjagmur

bhriitarafI kṛta-niScayiifI

kaliniidharma mitrerta

d□ tvii spr□ tiifI prajii bhuvi

san,e-all his younger brothers; tam-him; anunirjagmu[l.-left home by following the elder; bhratara[l.-brothers; kṛta-niScaya[l.-decidedly; kalina by the age of Kali; adhama-principle of irreligion; mitrep.a-by the friend; dntva-observing; sprftii[i.-having overtaken; praja[l.-all citizens; bhuvi- on the earth.

TRANSLATION

The younger brothers of Maharaja Yudhiṇthira observed that the age of Kali had already arrived throughout the world and that the citizens of the kingdom were already affected by irreligious practice. Therefore they decided to follow in the footsteps of their elder brother.

PURPORT

The younger brothers of Maharaja Yudhiṇthira were already obedient followers of the great Emperor, and they had sufficiently been trained to know the ultimate goal of life. They therefore decidedly followed their eldest brother in rendering devotional service to Lord Sri Kṛṇā!la. According Text 46] The PiiJ.tcJavas Retire Timely 827

to the principles of saniiitana-dharma, one must retire from family life after half the duration of life is finished and must engage himself in self realization. But the question of engaging oneself is not always decided.

Sometimes retired men are bewildered about how to engage themselves for the last days of life. Here is a decision by authorities like the Paṇḍavas. All of them engaged themselves in culturing favorably the devotional service of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. According to Svāmī Sridhara, dharma, artha, kīma and mokṣa, or fruitive activities, philosophical speculations or salvation, as conceived by several persons, are not the ultimate goal of life. They are more or less practiced by persons who have no information of the ultimate goal of life. The ultimate goal of life is already indicated by the Lord Himself in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 18.64), and the Paṇḍavas were intelligent enough to follow it without hesitation.

TEXT 46

□□□□s□MEIAI€¥1WJ: I

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te siidhu-kṛta-sarvīrthii

jñitvītyantikam iitmanafi.

manasii dharayamiisur

vaikuṭṭha- caraṁ lamb ujam

te-all of them; siidhu-kṛta-having performed everything worthy of a saint; sarva-arthīfi.-that which includes everything worthy; jñitvī-knowing it well; iityantikam-the ultimate; iitmanafi.-of the living being; manasii-within the mind; dhiirayīmiisufi.-sustained; vaikūṭṭha-the Lord of the spiritual sky; caraṁ-lambujam-lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

They all had performed all the principles of religion and as a result rightly decided that the lotus feet of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are the supreme goal of all. Therefore they meditated upon His feet without interruption.

PURPORT

In the Bhagavad-gītā the Lord says (Bg. 7.28) that only those who have done pious deeds in previous lives and have become freed from the results
828 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 15

of all impious acts can concentrate upon the lotus feet of the Supreme

Lord Sri l(p)!la. The Pii!avas, not only in this life but also in their previous lives, had always performed the supreme pious work, and thus they are ever free from all the reactions of impious work. It is quite reasonable, therefore, that they concentrated their minds unto the lotus feet of the Supreme Lord Sri l(p)!la. According to Sri Visvanatha Cakravarti, dharma, artha, kiima and mokṣa principles are accepted by persons who are not free from the results of impious action. Such persons affected with the contaminations of the above four principles cannot at once accept the lotus feet of the Lord in the spiritual sky. The Vaiku!ltha world is situated far beyond the material sky. The material sky is under the management of Durga Devi, or the material enetgy of the Lord, but the Vaiku!ltha world is managed by the personal energy of the Lord.

TEXTS 47-48

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□□ □ Pt□□---□..□q ft 11□□11

tad-dhyanod riktaya bhaktya

viSuddha-dh□a1.1:al!. pare

tasmin naroya"{la-pade

ekanta-matayo gatim

avapur duravapam te

asadbhir v□ayatmabhil!.

vidhiita-kalmaṣa-sthiillam

virajenatmanaiva hi

tat-that; dhyiinot-positive meditation; riktayii-being freed from;

bhaktyii-by a devotional attitude; viSuddha-purified; dhiṣap.ii□- by intel

ligence; pare-unto the transcendence; tasmin-in that; niiriyazta-the

Personality of Godhead Sri Kr□JJJa; pade-unto the lotus feet; ekiinta

mataya□-of those who are fixed in the Supreme, who is one; gatim

destination; aviipu□-attained; duraviipiim-very difficult to obtain; te-by

them; asadbhif!.-by the materialists; viṣaya-iitmabhif!.-absorbed in material

needs; vidhuta-washed off; kalmUṣii-material contaminations; sthiinam abode; virajena-without material passion; iitmanii eva-by the selfsame body; hi-certainly.

Text49] The Piii.u.favas Retire Timely 829

TRANSLATION

Thus by pure consciousness due to constant devotional remembrance, they attained the spiritual sky which is ruled over by the Supreme Narayaṇa Lord Kṛṣṇa. This is attained only by those who meditate upon the one Supreme Lord without deviation. This abode of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, known as Goloka Vṛndavana, cannot be attained by persons who are absorbed in the material conception of life. But the Paṇḍavas, being completely washed of all material contamination, attained that abode in their very same bodies.

PURPORT

According to Srila Jīva Gosvami, a person freed from the three modes of material qualities, namely goodness, passion and ignorance, and situated in transcendence can reach the highest perfection of life without change of body. Srila Sanātana Gosvami in his Hari-bhakti-vilāsa says that a person, whatever he may be, can attain the perfection of a twice-born brāhmaṇa by undergoing the spiritual disciplinary actions under the guidance of a bona fide spiritual master, exactly as a chemist can turn gun metal into gold by chemical manipulation. It is, therefore, the actual guidance that matters in the process of becoming a brāhmaṇa, even without change of body, or in going back to Godhead without change of body. Srila Jīva Gosvami remarks that the word "hi" used in this connection positively affirms this truth, and there is no doubt about this factual position. The Bhagavad-gītā also affirms this statement of Srila Jīva Gosvami when the Lord says (Bg. 14.26) that anyone who executes devotional service systematically without deviation can attain the perfection of Brahman by surpassing the contamination of the three modes of material nature, and when the Brahman perfection is still more advanced by the selfsame execution of devotional service, there is no doubt at all that

one can attain the supreme spiritual planet Goloka Vrndavana without change of body, as we have already discussed in connection with the Lord's returning to His abode without a change of body.

TEXT49

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\1.;11□□'1 □: f□: □ □ □□□□II

830 Srimad-Bhagavatam

viduro 'pi parityajya

prabhiise deham itmanap

kmtiiveserta tac-cittap

pitrbhip sva-k□ayam yayau

[Canto I, Ch. 15

vidurafi.- Vidura (the uncle of Maharaja Yudhi□thira); api-also;
parityajya-after quitting the body; prabhiise-in the place of pilgrimage
at Prabhasa; deham itmanap-his body; knJ]a-the Personality of Godhead;
aveserta- being absorbed in that thought; tat-his; cittap-thoughts and
actions; pitrbhifi.-along with the residents of Pitrloka; sva-k□ayam-his
own abode; yayau-departed.

TRANSLATION

Vidura, while on pilgrimage, left his body at Prabhasa. Because he was absorbed in thought of Lord Kr□!ia, he was received by the denizens of the Pitrloka planet where he returned to his original post.

PURPORT

The difference between the Pali□avas and Vidura is that the Pali□avas are eternal associates of the Lord Personality of Godhead, whereas Vidura is one of the administrative demigods in charge of the Pitrloka planet and is known as Yamaraja. Men are afraid of Yamaraja because it is he only who awards punishment to the miscreants of the material world, but those who are devotees of the Lord have nothing to fear from him. To the devotees he is a cordial friend, but to the nondevotees he is fear personified. As we have already discussed, it is understood that Yamaraja was cursed by Manduka Muni to be degraded as a sudra, and therefore Vidura was an

incarnation of Yamaraja. As eternal servitor of the Lord, he displayed his devotional activities very ardently and lived a life of a pious man, so much so that a materialistic man like Dhrtarastra also got salvation by his instruction. So by his pious activities in devotional service of the Lord he was able to remember always the lotus feet of the Lord, and thus he became washed of all contamination of a sudra-born life. At the end he was again received by the denizens of Piploka and posted in his original position. The demigods are also associates of the Lord without personal touch, whereas the direct associates of the Lord are in constant personal touch with Him. The Lord and His personal associates incarnate in many universes without cessation. The Lord remembers them all, whereas the Text 50] The Pir, u, lavas Retire Timely 831

associates forget due to their being very minute parts and parcels of the Lord; they are apt to forget such incidences due to being infinitesimal.

This is corroborated in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 4.5).

TEXT 50

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 □ □ llif. ff □ U □ Ig'(1'1RH1q □ ll □ oll

draupadi ca tadijiiiiiya

patlniim anapek □ atiim

viisudeve bhagavati

hy ekiinta-matir iipa tam

draupadi-Draupadi (the wife of the Pappavas); ca-and; tadii-at that time; iijniya-knowing Lord :Kn;l}a fully well; patiniim-of the husbands; anapek □ atiim-who did not care for her; vasudeve-unto Lord Vasudeva (:Kn;l}a); bhagavati- the Personality of Godhead; hi-exactly; eka-anta absolutely; matift-concentration; iipa- got; tam-Him (the Lord).

TRANSLATION

Draupadi also saw that her husbands, without caring for her, were leaving home. She knew well about Lord Vasudeva, Kf □ pa, the Personality of Godhead. Both she and Subhadra became absorbed in thoughts of Kf □ pa and attained the same results as their husbands.

PURPORT

When flying an airplane in outer space, one cannot take care of other planes. Everyone has to take care of his own plane, and if there is any danger, no other plane can help another in that condition. Similarly, at the end of life when one has to go back to home, back to Godhead, everyone has to take care of himself without help rendered to another. The help is, however, offered on ground before flying in space. Similarly, the spiritual master, the father, the mother, the relatives, the husband, etc., can all render help during one's lifetime, but while crossing the sea one has to take care of himself and utilize the instructions formerly received. Draupadi: had five husbands, and no one asked Draupadi to come, but Draupadi had to take care of herself without waiting for her great husbands. And because

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she was already trained up, she at once took to the concentration of the lotus feet of Lord Vasudeva, Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead. The wives also got the same result as their husbands in the same manner, that is to say that without changing the body they reached the destination of back to Godhead. Srila Visvanatha Cakravarti Thakur suggests that both Draupadi and Subhadra, although her name is not mentioned herein, got the same result. None of them had to quit the body.

TEXT 51

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□ ro lifuiQqfir fttft'(II' -\□ II

ya□ sraddhayaitad bhagavat-priyiipam

piirt!lo□ sutanam iti samprayiirtam

srooty alam svastyayanam pavitram

labdhva harau bhaktim upaiti siddhim

ya[l-anyone; sraddhaya-with devotion; etat-this; bhagavat-priyapam

of those who are very dear to the Personality of Godhead; pappo[l-of
Pa!J.!fu; sutanam-of the sons; iti-thus; samprayartam-departure for the
ultimate goal; snzoti-hears; alam-only; svastyayanam-good fortune;
pavitram-perfectly pure; labdhva-by obtaining; harau-unto the Supreme
Lord; bhaktim-devotional service; upaiti-gains; siddhim-perfection.

TRANSLATION

The subject of the departure of the sons of Pa□□u for the ultimate goal
of life, back to Godhead, is fully auspicious and is perfectly pure.

Therefore anyone who hears this narration with devotional faith certainly
gains devotional service of the Lord, the highest perfection of life.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhagavatam is a narration about the Personality of Godhead and
of the devotees of the Lord like the Pa!J.!favas and others. The narration
of the Personality of Godhead and His devotees is absolute in itself, and
Text 51] The PiiJ:tc.favas Retire Timely 833

thus to hear it with a devotional attitude is to associate with the Lord and
constant companions of the Lord. By the hearing process of Srimad
Bhiigavatam one can attain the highest perfection of life, namely going
back home, back to Godhead, without failure.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the Fifteenth Chapter, First
Canto, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "The Piir4avas Retire Timely."

CHAPTER SIXTEEN

How Parik\$it Received the Age of Kali

TEXT 1

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ij¥Ufa.□et mr 'l'!}}utmt II □ II

suta uviica

tata□ pan"ksid dvija-varya-sik\$ayii

mahim mahii-bhiigavata□ saiiisa ha

yathii hi siityiim abhijiita-kovidiift
samiidiSan vipra mahad-gurzas tathii
siitaft uvtica-Siita Gosvami said; tataft-thereafter; pan"ksit-Maharaja
Parik□it; dvija-varya-the great twice-born brahmarzas; sikṣayti-by their
instructions; mahim-the earth; mahti-bhiigavataft-the great devotee;
sastisa-ruled; ha-in the past; yathti-as they told it; hi-certainly; siitytim
-at the time of his birth; abhijita-kovidiift-expert astrologers at the time
of birth; samiidiSan- gave their opinions; vipra-o briihmarzas; mahat-gu[la]
-great qualities; tathii-true to that.

TRANSLATION

Suta Gosvami said: o learned brahm□as, Maharaja Pan□it then began
to rule over the world as a great devotee of the Lord under the instructions
of the best of the twice-born brahma□as. He ruled by those great qualities
which were foretold by expert astrologers at the time of his birth.

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PURPORT

At the time of Maharaja Parik□it's birth, the expert astrologer briihmap.as
foretold some of his qualities. Maharaja Parik□it developed all those quali-
ties, being a great devotee of the Lord. The real qualification is to become
a devotee of the Lord, and gradually all the good qualities worthy of
possession develop. Maharaja Parik□it was a mahibhiigavata, or a first-class
devotee, who was not only well versed in the science of devotion but also
able to convert others to become devotees by his transcendental instruc-
tions. Maharaja Panlqit was, therefore, a devotee of the first order, and
thus he used to consult great sages and learned briihmaras who could advise
him by the siistras how to execute the state administration. Such great
kings were more responsible than modern elected executive heads because
they obliged the great authorities by following their instructions left in
Vedic literatures. There was no need to enact daily a new legislative bill by
impractical fools and to alter it again and again conveniently to serve some
purpose. The rules and regulations were already set forth by great sages

like Manu, Yajñavalkya, Parasara and other liberated sages, and the enactments were all suitable for all ages in all places. Therefore the rules and regulations were standard and without flaw or defect. Kings like Maharaja Parikṣit had their council of advisers, and all the members of that council were either great sages or brīhmapada of the first order. They did not accept any salary, nor had they any necessity for such salaries. The state would get the best advice without expenditure. They were themselves samadarsi, equal to everyone, both man and animal. They would not advise the king to give protection to man and instruct him to kill the poor animals. Such council members were not fools or representatives to compose a fool's paradise. They were all self-realized souls, and they knew perfectly well how all living beings in the state would be happy, both in this life and the next. They were not concerned with the hedonistic philosophy of eat, drink, be merry and enjoy. They were philosophers in the real sense, and they knew well what is the mission of human life. Under all these obligations, the advisory council of the king would give correct directions, and the king or executive head, being himself a qualified devotee of the Lord, would scrutinizingly follow them for the welfare of the state. The state in the days of Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira or Maharaja Parikṣit was a welfare state in the real sense of the term because no one was unhappy in that state, be he man or animal. Maharaja Parikṣit was an ideal king for a welfare state of the world.

Text2] How Pṛthivi Received the Age of Kali

TEXT2

□ □ ij..4oJq□'l □Utffl'(I

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sa uttarasya tanayam

upayenta iriivatim

janamejayadims caturas

tasyam utpiidayat sutiin

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salJ,-he; uttarasya-of King Uttara; tanayiim-daugh ter; upayeme-mar

ried; iriivatim-lravati; janamejaya-iidin-headed by Maharaja Janamejaya;
caturalJ,-four in number; tasyam-her; utpadayat-married; sutiin-sons.

TRANSLATION

King Paṇḍit married the daughter of King Uttara and begot four sons
headed by Maharaja Janamejaya.

PURPORT

Maharaja Uttara was the son of Virata and maternal uncle of Maharaja
PanK.ṇḍit. Iravati, being the daughter of Maharaja Uttara, was the cousin
sister of Maharaja Parikṇḍit, but cousin brothers and sisters were allowed to
get married if they did not belong to the same gotra or family. In the
Vedic system of marriage, the importance of the gotra or family was
stressed. Arjuna also married Subhadra, although she was his maternal
cousin sister.

Janamejaya. One of the rajarṇi kings and the famous son of Maharaja
Parikṇḍit. His mother's name is Iravati, or according to some, Madravati.
Maharaja Janamejaya begot two sons of the names Jnatanika and Sanku
kar!J.a. He celebrated several sacrifices in the Kurukṇṭra pilgrimage, and he
had three younger brothers named Srutasena, Ugrasena and Bhimasena II.
He invaded Taxsila (Ajanta), and he decided to avenge the unlawful curse
upon his great father Maharaja Parikṇḍit. He performed a great sacrifice
called Sarpa yajiia to kill the race of serpents, including the Taṇḍaka,
which had bitten his father to death. On request from many influential
demigods and sages, he had to change his decision to kill the race of snakes,
but despite stopping the sacrifice, he satisfied everyone concerned in the
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sacrifice by rewarding them properly and stopping further procedure of the
sacrifice. In the ceremony, Mahamuni Vyasadeva also was present, and he
personally narrated the history of the Battle of Kurukṇṭetra before the
King. Later on by the order of Vyasadeva, his disciple Vaisampayana
narrated before the King the subject matter of Mahiibharata. He was much
affected by his great father's untimely death and was very anxious to see
him again, and he expressed his desire before the great sage Vyasadeva.

Vyasadeva also fulfilled his desire. His father was present before him, and he worshiped both his father and Vyasadeva with great respect and pomp. Being fully satisfied, he made charities most munificently to the briihmar-as present in the sacrifice.

TEXT3

3111;1f(R141ffi!tf41ft;{□Qt'At□ I

□ □ pn □ 4t'Jitfil•it""t(t: II □ II

ijahiimsva-medhams trin

gangiiyim bhiiri-dak□i!lan .

saradvatam gurum krtva

devii yatrok□i-gocarii□

ijahiira-performed;t1Sva-medhiin-horse sacrifices;trin-three;gangiiyim

-the hank of the Ganges; bhuri-sufficiently; dakṣir-iin-rewards;

siiradvatam-unto Kṛpacarya; gurum-spiritual master; krtvii-having se

lected; devii□-the demigods; yatra-wherein; akṣi-eyes; gocarii□-within

the purview.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parikṣit, after having selected Kṛpacarya for guidance as his spiritual master, performed three horse sacrifices on the banks of the Ganges. These were executed with sufficient rewards for the attendants. And at these sacrifices, even the common man could see demigods.

PURPORT

It appears from this verse that interplanetary travel by the denizens of higher planets is easy. In many statements in Bhiigavatam, we have observed that the demigods from heaven used to visit this earth to attend

Text 4] How Parikṣit Received the Age of Kali 839

sacrifices performed by influential kings and emperors. Herein also we find that during the time of the horse sacrifice ceremony of Maharaja Parikṣit, the demigods from other planets were visible even for the common man due to the sacrificial ceremony. The demigods are not generally visible to common men, as the Lord is not visible. But as the Lord also, by His causeless mercy, descends to be visible to the common man, similarly the

demigods also become visible to the common man by their own grace. Although celestial beings are not visible to the naked eyes of the inhabitants of this earth, it was due to the influence of Maharaja Parashita that the demigods also agreed to be visible. The kings used to spend lavishly during such sacrifices, as a cloud distributes rains. A cloud is nothing but another form of water, or, in other words, the waters of the earth transform into clouds. Similarly, the charity made by the kings in such sacrifices are but another form of the taxes collected from the citizens. But, as the rains fall down very lavishly and appear to be more than necessary, the charity made by such kings also seems to be more than what the citizen needs. Satisfied citizens will never organize agitation against the king, and thus there was no need in changing the monarchial state. Even for a king like Maharaja Yudhishthira there was need of a spiritual master for guidance. Without such guidance one cannot make progress in spiritual life. The spiritual master must be bona fide, and one who wants to have self-realization must approach and take shelter of a bona fide spiritual master to achieve real success.

TEXT4

f.li5UIMij(61 if«: □ f(f'At'lt- □ I

i"Rlt□ Sl.(□ •nfict4 □ II \l II

nijagriihaujasii virab.

kalim digvijaye kvacit

m:pa-linga-dharam sii.drarh

ghnantam go-mithunam padii

nijagraha -sufficiently punished; ojas- by prowess; vira[l-valiant hero;

kalim-unto Kali, the master of the age; digvijaye-on his way to conquer

the world; kvacit-once upon a time; nrpa-linga-dharam-one who passes

in the dress of a king; siidram-the lower class; ghnantam.-hurting; go

mithunam-a cow and bull;padii-on the leg.

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TRANSLATION

Once, when Maharaja Parashita was on his way to conquer the world,

he saw the master of Kali-yuga, who was lower than a Siidra, disguised as a king and hurting the legs of a cow and bull. The King at once caught hold of him to deal sufficient punishment.

PURPORT

The purpose of a king's . going out to conquer the world is not for self-aggrandizement. Maharaja Panlqit went out to conquer the world after his ascendance on the throne, but this was not for the purpose of aggression on other states. He was the Emperor of the world, and all small states were already under his regime. His purpose in going out was to see how things were going on in terms of the godly state. The king, being the representative of the Lord, has to execute the will of the Lord duly.

There is no question of self-aggrandizement. Thus as soon as Maharaja Parik□it saw that a lower class man in the dress of a king was hurting the legs of a cow and a bull, at once he arrested and punished him. The king cannot tolerate insults to the most important animal, the cow, nor can he tolerate disrespect for the most important man, the briihmar.a. Human civilization means to advance the cause of brahminical culture, and to maintain it, cow protection is essential. There is a miracle in milk, for it contains all the necessary vitamins to sustain human physiological conditions for higher achievements. Brahminical culture can only be advanced when man is educated to develop the quality of goodness, and for this there is prime necessity of food prepared with milk, fruits and grains. Maharaja PanK.□it was astonished to see that a black sudra, dressed like a ruler, was mistreating a cow, the most important animal in human society. The age of Kali means mismanagement and quarrel. And the root cause of all mismanagement and quarrel is that worthless men with the modes of lower class men, who have no higher ambition in life, come to the helm of the state management. Such men at the post of a king are sure to hurt first the cow and the brahminical culture and thereby to push all society towards hell. Maharaja PanK.□it, trained as he was, got the scent of this root cause of all quarrel in the world. Thus he wanted to stop it in the very beginning.

TEXTS

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Text 5] How Pa□it Received the Age of Kali

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ij□UHtf ¥tCI¥tftl □ □ lilt II

saunaka uvaca

kasya hetor nijagraha

kalim digvijaye nrpa[l

m:deva-cihna-dhrk sudrako

,sau gam ya[l pada-hanat

tat kathyatarh mahii-bhaga ·

yadi krrrw-kathasrayam

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5aunaka[l uviica-Saunaka J112i said; kasya-for what; heto□-reason;
nijagriiha-sufficiently punished; kalim-the master of the age of Kali;
digvijaye-during the time of his world tour; nrpa[l-a king; nrdeva
royal person; cihna-dhrk-decorated like; sudraka□-lowest of the sudras;
asau-he; gam-cow; ya□-one who; padii-hanat-struck on the leg; tat-all
that; kathyatiim-please describe; mahii-bhiiga-o greatly fortunate one;
yadi-if, however; krgw-about Kr12J.la; kathii-iisrayam-related with His
topics.

TRANSLATION

Saunaka □i inquired: Why did Maharaja Pan□it simply punish him,
since he was the lowest of the Siidras, having dressed as a king and harmed
the legs of a cow? Please describe all these incidences as they relate to the
topics of Lord Kr□□a.

PURPORT

Saunaka and the [§is were astonished to hear that the pious Maharaja
Parik!]it simply punished the culprit and did not kill him. This suggests
that a pious king like Maharaja Parik!]it should have at once killed an
offender who wanted to cheat the public, being dressed like a king and at

the same time daring to insult the purest of the animals, a cow! The rāṣṭra is in those days, however, could not even imagine that in the advanced days of the age of Kali the lowest of the sudras will be elected as administrators and will open organized slaughterhouses for killing cows. Anyway, although hearing about a sudra who was a cheat and insulter of a cow was not very interesting to the great ṛṣiṣ, they nevertheless wanted to hear about it to see if the event had any connection with Lord Kṛṣṇa. They were simply interested in the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa, for anything that is dovetailed with the narration of Kṛṣṇa is worth hearing. There are many topics in the Bhāgavatam about sociology, politics, economy, cultural affairs, etc., but all of them are in relation with Kṛṣṇa, and therefore all of them are worth hearing. Kṛṣṇa is the purifying ingredient in all matters, regardless of what they are. In the mundane world, everything is impure due to its being a product of the three mundane qualities. The purifying agent is, however, Kṛṣṇa.

TEXT6

acāṅ «U(l4 qc:aaill:stiiṅ fecf ṅ I
 fti'Iṅ((1G\IṅIṅ(Iffl 44G\(!M44: II ṅ II
 athaviisya padiim-bhoja
 makaranda-lihiim satiim
 kimanyair asad-iiliipair
 iiyuṅ o yad asadvyayaṅ
 athava-otherwise; asya-of His (Lord Kṛṣṇa's); padam-bhoja-lotus
 feet; makaranda-lihiim-of those who lick the honey from such a lotus
 flower; satam-of those who are to exist eternally; kimanyaifl-what is the
 use of anything else; asat-illusory; iiliipairfl-topics; ayuṣafl-of the duration
 of life; yat-that which is; asadvyayafl-unnecessary waste of life.

TRANSLATION

The devotees of the Lord are accustomed to licking up the honey available from the lotus feet of the Lord. What is the use of topics which simply waste one's valuable life?

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṣṇa and His devotees are both on the transcendental plane; therefore the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa or of His pure devotees are equally good. The Battle of Kurukṣetra is full of politics and diplomacy, but because the topics are related with Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Bhagavad-gītā is therefore adored all over the world. There is no need to eradicate politics, economics, sociology, etc., which are mundane to the mundaners. To a pure devotee who is actually related with the Lord, such mundane things are transcendental if dovetailed with the Lord or with His pure devotee.

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We have so far heard and talked about the activities of the Paṇḍavas, and we are dealing with the topics of Maharaja Parikṣit, but because all these topics are related with the Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, they are all transcendental, and pure devotees have great interest in hearing them. We have already discussed this matter in connection with the prayers of Bhiṣmadeva.

Our duration of life is not very long, and there is no certainty when we shall be ordered to leave everything for the next stage. Thus it is our duty to see that not a moment of our life is wasted in topics which are not related with Lord Kṛṣṇa. Any topic, however pleasant, is not worth hearing if it is devoid of its relation of Kṛṣṇa.

The spiritual planet, Goloka Vrndavana, eternal abode of Lord Kṛṣṇa, is shaped like the whorl of a lotus flower. Even when the Lord descends on any one of the mundane planets, He does so by manifesting His own abode as it is. Thus His feet remain always on the same big whorl of lotus flower. His feet are also as beautiful as the lotus flower. Therefore it is said that Lord Kṛṣṇa has lotus feet.

A living being is eternal by constitution. He is, so to speak, in the whirlpool of birth and death due to his contact with material energy. Freed from such material energy, a living entity is liberated and is eligible to return back home, back to Godhead. Those who want to live forever without changing their material body should not waste valuable time with topics other than those relating to Lord Kṛṣṇa and His devotees.

TEXT7

□ 1_•114tW 'f□iwtPFtfit;;Mii(I

((lq({fl □ ": □□ II \9 II

k□udrayu□am nfllim anga

martyanam rtam icchatam

ihopahuto bhagavlin

mrtyu"{l. Siimitra-karma□i

k□udra-very small; iiyuṣiim-of the duration of life; nrpiim-of the

human being; anga-o Siita Gosvami; martyiiniim-of those who are sure

to meet death; .rtam-eternal life; icchatiim-of those who desire it; iha

herein; upahuta"{l.-called for being present; bhagaviin-representing the

Lord; mrtyu□- the controller of death, Yamaraja; siimitra-suppressing;

karmapi-performances.

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TRANSLATION

o Siita Gosvami, there are those amongst men who desire freedom from death and get eternal life. They escape the slaughtering process by calling the controller of death, Yamaraja.

PURPORT

The living entity, as he develops from lower animal life to a higher human being and gradually to higher intelligence, becomes anxious to get freed from the clutches of death. Modern scientists try to avoid death by physiochemical advancement of knowledge, but alas the controller of death, Yamaraja, is so cruel that he does not spare even the very life of the scientist himself. The scientist, who puts forward the theory of stopping death by advancement of scientific knowledge, becomes himself a victim of death when he is called by Yamaraja. What to speak of stopping death, no one can even enhance the short period of life even by a fraction of a moment. The only hope of suspending the cruel slaughtering process of Yamaraja is to call him to hear and chant the holy name of the Lord. Yamaraja is a great devotee of the Lord, and he likes to be invited to kirtanas and sacrifices by the pure devotees who are constantly engaged in

the devotional service of the Lord. Thus the great sages, headed by Saunaka and others, invited Yamaraja to attend the sacrifice performed at Naimiṣṭhira!ya. This was good for those who did not want to die.

TEXTS

;f □□□PiN□ □ ._lqfl:M (tl;(tih: I

□ ft ll&fqte,l(?t: □: I

□ □ □ □□PM ": II □ II

na ka5cin mriyate tii.vad

yii.vad ii.sta ihii.ntakaf

etad-artham hi bhagavii.n

iihutafl paramar□ibhifl

aho nrloke piyeta

hari-lilii.mrtam vacafl

na-not; ka5cit-anyone; mriyate-will die; tiivat-so long; yiivat-as long
as; iiste-is present; iha-herein; antaka[l-one who causes the end of life;

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etat-this; artham-reason; hi-certainly; bhagavan-the representative of
the Lord; ahutafl-invited; parama-r□ibhifl-by the great sages; aho-alas;
nrloke-in human society; piyeta-let them drink; han-lila-transcendental
pastimes of the Lord; amrtam-nectar for eternal life; vacafl-narrations.

TRANSLATION

As long as Yamaraja, who causes everyone's death, is present here, no one shall meet with death. The great sages have invited the controller of death, Yamaraja, who is the representative of the Lord. Living beings who are under his grip should take advantage by hearing the deathless nectar in the form of this narration of the transcendental pastimes of the Lord.

PURPORT

Every human being does not like to meet death, but he does not know how to get rid of death. The surest remedy for avoiding death is to get oneself accustomed to hearing the nectarean pastimes of the Lord as they are systematically narrated in the text of Srimad-Bhīgavatam. It is advised herein, therefore, that any human being who desires freedom from death

should take to this course of life as recommended by the nis headed by
Saunaka. .

TEXT9

□ 'l;a:SI(I(□ 'l;a:lfftl. I

□□rm-□tt.n□□: □□□□□

mandasya manda-prajiiasya

vayo manaayu□aS ca vai

nidraya hriyate naktarh

diva ca vyartha-karmabhil).

mandasya-of the lazy; manda-paltry; prajiiasya-of intelligence; vayaf

-age; manda-short; ayu□afl-of duration of life; ca-and; vai-exactly;

nidraya-by sleeping; hriyate-passes away; naktam-night; diva-daytime;

ca-also; vyartha-for nothing; karmabhifl-by activities.

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TRANSLATION

Lazy human beings with paltry intelligence and a short duration of
life pass the night sleeping and the day performing activities that are for
naught.

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PURPORT

The less intelligent do not know the real value of the human form of
life. The human form is a special gift of material nature in the course of
her enforcing stringent laws of miseries upon the living being. It is a chance
to achieve the highest boon of life, namely to get out of the entanglement
of repeated birth and death. The intelligent take care of this importa□t
gift by strenuously endeavoring to get out of the entanglement. But the
less intelligent are lazy and unable to evaluate the gift of the human body
to achieve liberation from the material bondage; they become more inter
ested in so-called economic development and work very hard throughout
life simply for the sense enjoyment of the temporary body. Sense enjoy
ment is also allowed to the lower animals by the law of nature, and thus a
human being is also destined to a certain amount of sense enjoyment

according to his past or present life. But one should definitely try to understand that sense enjoyment is not the ultimate goal of human life. Herein it is said that during the daytime one works "for nothing" because the aim is nothing but sense enjoyment. We can particularly observe how the human being is engaged for nothing in great cities and industrial towns. There are so many things manufactured by human energy, but they are all meant for sense enjoyment, and not for getting out of the material bondage. And after working hard during the daytime, a tired man either sleeps or engages in sex habits at night. That is the program of materialistic civilized life for the less intelligent. Therefore they are designated herein as lazy, unfortunate and short-lived.

TEXT 10

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suta uviica

yada pan""k□it kuru-]angale 'vasat

kalim praviṣṭam nija-cakravartite

ni.Samya viirtam anatipriyam tatal).

sariisanam samyuga-sau!{iir adade

Text 10] How Parikṣit Received the Age of Kali 847

suta□ uvaca-Siita Gosvami said; yada- when; parik ṣit-Maharaja Parik□it;

kuru-jiingale- in the capital of Kuru's empire; avasat-was residing; kalim

the symptoms of the age of Kali; praviṣṭam-entered; nija-cakravartite

within his jurisdiction; niSamya- thus hearing; viirtiim-news ; anatipriyam

not very palatable; tata□-thereafter; sara-asanam-arrows and bow;

sa myuga-having gotten a chance for; saurt!li□-martial activities; adade

took up.

TRANSLATION

Silta Gosvami said: While Maharaja Pa□it was residing in the capital

of the Kuru empire, the symptoms of the age of Kali began to infiltrate within the jurisdiction of his state. When he learned about this, he did not think the matter very palatable. This did, however, give him a chance to fight. He took up his bow and arrows and prepared himself for military activities.

PURPORT

The state administration of Maharaja Parikṣit was so perfect that he was sitting in his capital peacefully. But he got the news that the symptoms of the age of Kali had already infiltrated into the jurisdiction of his state, and he did not like this news. What are the symptoms of the age of Kali? They are 1) illicit connection with women, 2) indulgence in meat-eating, 3) intoxication, and 4) taking pleasure in gambling. The age of Kali literally means the age of quarrel, and the above-mentioned four symptoms in human society are the root causes for all kinds of quarrel. Maharaja Panīqit heard that some of the people of the state already had taken to those symptoms, and he wanted to take immediate steps against such causes of unrest. This means that at least up to the regime of Maharaja Pṛakṣit, such symptoms of public life were practically unknown, and as soon as they were slightly detected, he wanted to root them out. The news was not palatable for him, but in a way it was because Maharaja Parikṣit got a chance to fight. There was no need to fight with small states because everyone was peacefully under his subordination, but the Kali-yuga miscreants gave his fighting spirit a chance for exhibition. A perfect kṣatriya king is always jubilant as soon as he gets a chance to fight, just as a sportsman is eager when there is a chance for a sporting match. It is no argument that in the age of Kali such symptoms were predestined. If so, then why was there preparation for fighting out such symptoms? Such arguments are offered by lazy and unfortunate men. In the rainy season, 848 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 16

rain is predestined, and yet people take precautions to protect themselves. Similarly, in the age of Kali the symptoms as above mentioned are sure to infiltrate into social life, but it is the duty of the state to save the citizens

from the association of the agents of the age of Kali. Maharaja Parikṣit wanted to punish the miscreants indulging in the symptoms of Kali, and thus save the innocent citizens who were pure in habit by culture of religion. It is the duty of the king to give such protection, and Maharaja Parikṣit was perfectly right when he prepared himself to fight.

TEXT 11

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svalankrtarh syama-turanga-yojitarh

ratharh mrgendra-dhvajam asrital;l puriit

vrto rathasva-dvipapatti-yuktaya

svasenaya digvijayaya nirgata

svalankrtam-very well decorated; syama-black; turanga-horses;

yojitam- tackled; ratham- chariot; mrgendra-lion ; dh vajam- flagged;

asrita- under the protection; purat-from the capital; vrta-surrounded

by; ratha-charioteers; a5va-cavalry; dvipapatti-elephants; yuktayii-thus

being equipped; svasenaya-along with infantry; digvijayaya-for the

purpose of conquering; nirgata-went out.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parikṣit sat on a chariot drawn by black horses. His flag was marked with the sign of a lion. Being so decorated and surrounded by charioteers, cavalry, elephants and infantry soldiers, he left the capital to conquer in all directions.

PURPORT

Maharaja Parikṣit is distinguished from his grandfather Arjuna, for black horses pulled his chariot instead of white horses. He marked his flag with
Text 12] How Paṇḍit Received the Age of Kali 849

the mark of a lion, and his grandfather marked his with the mark of Hanu manji. A royal procession like that of Maharaja Parikṣit surrounded by well-decorated chariots, cavalry, elephants, infantry and band is not only

pleasing to the eyes, but also is a sign of a civilization that is aesthetic even on the fighting front.

TEXT 12

bhadriiSvam ketumiilam ca

bharatam cottaran kuriin

kimpuruṁadlni varṁarzi

vijitya jagr:he balim

bhadrasvam-Bhadrasva; ketumalam-Ketumala; ca-also; bharatam

Bharata; ca-and; uttaran-the northern countries; kuron-the kingdom

of the Kuru dynasty; kimpuruṁa-adini-a country beyond the northern

side of the Himalayas; varṁarzi-parts of the earth planet; vijitya-conquer

ing; jagrhe-exacted; balim-strength.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pṁit then conquered all parts of the earthly planet

Bhadrasva, Ketumiila, B harata, the Northern portion of Kurujaitgala, Kim

puruṁ, etc.-and exacted tributes from their respective rulers.

PURPORT

Bhadrasva: It is an island near Meru Parvata. There is a description of this island in the Mahiibhiirata (Bhiṁma Parva 7/16-18). The description was narrated by Saiijaya to Dhrtaraṁtra.

Maharaja Yudhiṁthira also conquered this island, and thus the province was included within the jurisdiction of his empire. Maharaja Parilqit was formerly declared to be the emperor of all lands ruled by his grandfather, but still he had to establish his supremacy while he was out of his capital to exact tribute from such states.

Ketumiila: This earth planet is divided into seven parts, and according to others it is divided into nine parts. This earth is called Jambiidvipa, and is divided into nine varṁas. Bharatavarṁa is one of the above-mentioned nine
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varṁas. Such varṁas are known as continents in the modern geographical context. Ketumala is described as one of the above varṁas. It is said that in this varṁa, women are the most beautiful. This varṁa was conquered by

Arjuna also. A description of this part of the world is available in the Mahiibhiirata (Sabhii 28.6).

It is said that this part of the world is situated on the western side of the Meru ·Parvata, and inhabitants of this province used to live up to ten thousands of years (Bhiṣma Paroa 6.16.31-32). Human beings living in this part of the globe are of golden color, and the women resemble the angels of heaven. The inhabitants are free from all kinds of diseases and griefs.

Bhīratavarṇa: This part of the world is also one of the nine varṇas of the Jamhīdvīpa or earthly planet. Each planet is also sometimes called a dvīpa because of its being an island in the fathomless outer space. Each planet is factually an island in the airy ocean of outer space. Jambudvīpa is only one of such countless islands in this airy ocean of space. A description of Bharatavarṇa is given in the Mahābhārata (Bhīṣma Parva, Chapters 9 to 10).

Uttariin: According to Sridhara Svanli these parts of the world are called Ilavartavar!a, or the Mediterranean countries of Europe. The description of the Ilavartavar!a is given in the Mahiibhiirata (Sabhii 28.6-7) as follows:

nagaras ca vanarit ca vii nadiS ca vimalodaka□
 puru□iin deva-kalpiirhS ca priya-darsana□
 adrṣṭa-piirvan subhagan sa dadarsa dhanaiijaya□
 sadiiniirit ca subhriirti niiriS ca apsariisam-nibha

It is twice mentioned here that the women are beautiful, and some of them are equal to the apsaras or heavenly women. Therefore the countries mentioned are round about the Mediterranean coast.

Kimpuru□avarṣa: It is stated to be situated beyond the northern side of Darjelling Dhavala Giri and probably may be a country like Nepal, Bhutan, Tibet and China. These parts of the world were also conquered by Arjuna (Sabhii 28/1-2). The Kimpuru□as are descendants of the daughter of Dak□a. "hen Maharaja Yudhi□thira performed a horse sacrifice yajña, the inhabitants of these countries were also present to take part in the festival, and they paid tributes to the emperor. This part of the world is called

Kimpuruāavarāa, or sometimes the Himalayan provinces (Himavafi). It is said that Sukadeva Gosvami was born in these Himalayan provinces, and he came to Bharatavarāa after crossing the Himalayan countries.

Texts 13-15] How Parīit Received the Age of Kali 851

In other words, Maharaja Parīit conquered all the world, namely all the continents adjoining all the seas and oceans in all directions, namely the eastern, western, northern and southern parts of the world.

TEXTS 13-15

tatra tatropasnwiinaft

sva-puroeāiim mahiitmaniim

pragiyamiirwm ca ya.Saft

krārya-miithiit mya-sucakam

iitmiinam ca paritriitam

a5vattiimno 'stra-tejasa/.l

sneham ca vāli-piirthiiniirh

teāiirh bhaktim ca kesave

tebhya/.l parama-santuāafl.

pnty-ujjrmabhita-locanaft

mahii-dhaniini viisiimsi

·dadau hiiriin mahii-manii/.l

tatra tatra-everywhere the King visited; upas.r!lvana[l,- continuously he heard; sva-puroe.sam-about his own forefathers; mahatmanam-who were all great devotees of the Lord; pragiyama!lam-onto those who were thus addressing; ca-also ; yasa[l,- glories; krāa-Lord l(r\$pa; mahatmya-glorious acts; sucakam-indicating ; atmanam-his personal self; ca-also;paritriitam -delivered; asvatthamnal_l-of Asvatthama; astra-weapon; tejasaf,-powerful rays; sneham-affection; ca-also; vnāi-parthanam-between descendants of Vr\$I].i and that of Prtha; te\$iiim-of all of them; bhaktim-devotion; ca-also; kesave-onto Lord l(r\$I].a; tebhya_l- unto them; parama-etremely; santu\$afl.-pleased ; priti-attraction; ujjrmabhita-pleasingly open; locana[l,-one who has such eyes; mahii-dhanani-valuable riches; vasiirhsi-

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clothing; dadau-gave in charity; haran-necklace ; maha- manii{- one who has a broader outlook.

TRANSLATION

Wherever the King visited, he continuously heard the glories of his great forefathers, who were all devotees of the Lord, and also of the glorious acts of Lord Kṛṣṇa. He also heard how he himself had been protected by the Lord from the powerful heat of the weapon of ASvatthama. People also mentioned the great affection between the descendants of Vrṣṇi and Pṛthā due to the latter's great devotion to Lord Kṛṣṇa. The King, being very pleased with the singers of such glories, opened his eyes in great satisfaction. Out of magnanimity he was pleased to award them very valuable necklaces and clothing.

PURPORT

Kings and great personalities of the state are presented with welcome addresses. This is a system from time immemorial, and Maharaja Parikṣit, since he was one of the well-known emperors of the world, was also presented with addresses of welcome in all parts of the world as he visited those places. The subject matter of those welcome addresses was Kṛṣṇa. Kṛṣṇa means Kṛpā and His eternal devotees, as the king means the king and his confidential associates.

Kṛṣṇa and His unalloyed devotees cannot be separated, and therefore glorifying the devotee means glorifying the Lord and vice versa. Maharaja Parikṣit would not have been glad to hear about the glories of his forefathers like Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira and Arjuna, etc., had they not been connected with the acts of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The Lord descends specifically to deliver His devotees (paritrāya sadhinaṁ). The devotees are glorified by the presence of the Lord because they cannot live for a moment without the presence of the Lord and His different energies. The Lord is present for the devotee by His acts and glories, and therefore Maharaja Parikṣit felt the presence of the Lord when He was glorified by His acts, especially when he was saved by the Lord in the womb of his mother. The devotees of the Lord are never in danger, but in the material world which is full of

dangers in every step, the devotees are apparently placed into dangerous positions, and when they are saved by the Lord, the Lord is glorified.

Lord Krishna would not have been glorified as the speaker of the Bhagavad-gītā had His devotees like the Pandavas not been entangled in the Battle-
Text 16] How Parikṣit Received the Age of Kali 853

field of Kurukṣetra. All such acts of the Lord were mentioned in the addresses of welcome, and Maharaja Parikṣit, in full satisfaction, rewarded those who presented such addresses. The difference between the presentation of welcome addresses today and in those days is that formerly the welcome addresses were presented to a person like Maharaja Parikṣit. The welcome addresses were full of facts and figures, and those who presented such addresses were sufficiently rewarded, whereas in the present days the welcome address is presented not always with factual statements but to please the postholder, and often they are full of flattering lies. And rarely are those who present such welcome addresses rewarded by the poor receiver.

TEXT 16

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sarath ya-piira□ada-sevana-sakh ya-dautya

virlisananugamana-stavana-pra!lliman

snigdhe□u pli!lt)□u jagat-pra!latirh ca v4r-or

bhaktirh karoti nrpatih cara!liiravinde

sarathya-acceptance of the post of a chariot driver; piira□ada

acceptance of the presidency in the assembly of the Rajasiiya sacrifice;

sevana-engaging the mind constantly in the service of the Lord; sakhya

to think of the Lord as a friend; dautya- acceptance of the post of a

messenger; vira-asana- acceptance of the post of a watchman with a drawn

sword at night; anugamana-following in the footsteps; stavana-offering

of prayers; prapaman- offering obeisances; snigdhe□u- unto them who are

malleable to the will of the Lord; piip(u)u- unto the sons of Pa(u); jagat the universal; prapatim- one who is obeyed; ca- and; viṣpo- of Vi(u); bhaktim- devotion; karoti- does; n.rpat*- the King; carapa- aravinde- unto His lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parit heard that out of His causeless mercy Lord Kṛṇa [Vi(u)], who is universally obeyed, rendered all kinds of service to the
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malleable sons of Pa(u) by accepting posts ranging from chariot driver to president to messenger, friend, night watchman, etc., according to the will of the Pa(u)s, obeying them like a servant and offering obeisances like one younger in years. When he heard this, Maharaja Parit became overwhelmed with devotion to the lotus feet of the Lord.

PURPORT

Lord Kṛṇa is everything to the unalloyed devotees like the Pa(u)s. The Lord was for them the Supreme Lord, the spiritual master, the worshipable Deity, the guide, the chariot driver, the friend, the servant, the messenger and everything they could conceive of. And thus the Lord also reciprocated the feeling of the Pa(u)s. Maharaja Parit, as a pure devotee of the Lord, could appreciate the Lord's transcendental reciprocation of the feelings of His devotees, and thus he himself also was overwhelmed with the dealings of the Lord. Simply by appreciating the dealings of the Lord with His pure devotees, one can attain salvation. The Lord's dealings with His devotees appear to be ordinary human dealings, but one who knows them in truth becomes at once eligible to go back home, back to Godhead. The Pa(u)s were so malleable to the will of the Lord that they could sacrifice any amount of energy for the service of the Lord, and by such unalloyed determination they could secure the Lord's mercy in any shape they desired.

TEXT 17

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tasyaivam vartamiinasya

piirve□am vrttim anvaham

nlitidiire kiliiScaryam

yad asit tan nibodha me

tasya-of Maharaja Parik!t; it; evam- thus; vartamanasya-remaining ab-
sorbed in such thought;purve□am-of his forefathers; vrttim-good engage-
ment; anvaham-day after day; na-not; atidure-far off; kila-verily;
ascaryam-astonishing; yat-that; iisit-was; tat-which; nibodha-know it;
me-from me.

Text 18] How Par□it Received the Age of Kali 855

TRANSLATION

Now you may have heard from me of what happened while Maharaja
Pan□it was passing his days hearing of the good occupations of his fore-
fathers and being absorbed in thought of them.

TEXT 18

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dharmal;l padaikena caran

vicchiiyam upalabhya giim

prcchati smasru-vadanam

vivatsiim iva miitaram

dharmal[l-the personality of religious principles; pada-leg; ekena-on
one only; caran-wandering; vicchay am-overtaken by the shadow of grief;
upalabhya-having met; gam-the cow; prcchati-asking; sma-with;
asru-vadanam-with tears on the face; vivatsam-one who has lost her off-
spring; iva-like; miitaram-the mother.

TRANSLATION

The personality of religious principles, Dharma, was wandering about
in the form of a bull. And he met the personality of earth in the form of a
cow who appeared to grieve like a mother who had lost her child. She had
tears in her eyes, and the beauty of her body was lost. Thus Dharma
questioned the earth as follows.

PURPORT

The bull is the emblem of the moral principle, and the cow is the representative of the earth. When the bull and the cow are in a joyful mood, it is to be understood that the people of the world are also in a joyful mood. The reason is that the bull helps production of grains in the agricultural field, and the cow delivers milk, the miracle of aggregate food values. The human society, therefore, maintains these two important animals very carefully so that they can wander everywhere in cheerfulness. But at the 856 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 16

present moment in this age of Kali both the bull and the cow are now being slaughtered and eaten up as foodstuff by a class of men who do not know the brahminical culture. The bull and the cow can be protected for the good of all human society simply by spreading brahminical culture as the topmost perfection of all cultural affairs. By advancement of such culture, the morale of society is properly maintained, and so peace and prosperity are also attained without extraneous effort. When brahminical culture deteriorates, the cow and bull are mistreated, and the resultant actions are prominent by the following symptoms.

TEXT 19

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dharmā uviica

kaccid bhadre 'niimayam itmanas te

vicchiiyiisi mliiyate□an mukhena

iilak□aye bhavat[m antariidhim

dure bandhum socasi kancaniimba

dharmā□ uvaca- Dharma inquired; kaccit-whether; bhadre-madam;

anamayam-quite hail and hearty; atmana□-self; te-unto you; vicchaya

asi-appear to be covered with the shadow of grief; mlayata- which darkens; iṣat-slightly ; mukhena-by the face; alakṣaye- you look; bhavatim -unto yourself; antaradhim -some disease within; dure- long distant; bandhum- friend; so caśi- thinking of; kancarw- someone; amba-o mother.

TRANSLATION

Dharma [in the form of a bull) asked: Madam, are you not hail and hearty? Why are you covered with the shadow of grief? It appears by your face that you have become black. Are you suffering from some internal disease, or are you thinking of some relative who is away in a distant place?

Text 20] How Pañcit Received the Age of Kali 857

PURPORT

The people of the world in this age of Kali are always full of anxieties. Everyone is diseased with some kind of ailment. From the very faces of the people of this age, one can find out the index of the mind. Everyone feels the absence of his relative who is away from home. The particular symptom of the age of Kali is that no family is now blessed to live together. To earn <!. livelihood, the father lives at a place far away from the son, or the wife lives far away from the husband and so on. There are sufferings from internal diseases, separation from those near and dear, and anxieties for maintaining the status quo. These are but some important factors which make the people of this age always unhappy.

TEXT 20

piidair nyiinarh socasi maikapīdam

iitmiinarh vii vr̥alair bhok̥yamiiram

iiho suriīdin hrta-yajna-bhīgiin

prajii uta svin maghavaty avar̥ati

piidai[l.- by three legs; nyunam- diminished; socasi-if you are lamenting for that; mii- my; eka-pīdam-only one leg; iitmiinam-own body; vii-or; vr̥ala*-by the unlawful meat-eaters; bhok̥yamiiram-to be exploited; iiho-in sacrifice; suriīdin-the authorized demigods; hrta-yajna-devoid of sacrificial; bhīgiin-share; prajii[l.-the living beings; uta-increasing; suit

whether; maghavati-in famine and scarcity; avarṇati-because of rainlessness.

TRANSLATION

I have lost my three legs and am now standing on one only. Are you lamenting for my state of existence? Or are you in great anxiety because henceforward the unlawful meat-eaters will exploit you? Or are you in a sorry plight because the demigods are now bereft of their share of sacrificial offerings because no sacrifices are being performed at present? Or are you
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grieving for living beings because of their sufferings due to famine and drought?

PURPORT

With the progress of the age of Kali, four things particularly, namely, the duration of life, mercy, the power of recollection, and moral or religious principles, will gradually diminish. Since Dharma, or the principles of religion, would be lost in the proportion of three out of four, the symbolic bull was standing on one leg only. When three fourths of the population of the whole world become irreligious, the situation is converted into hell for the animals. In the age of Kali, godless civilizations will create so many so-called religious societies in which the Personality of Godhead will be directly or indirectly defied. And thus faithless societies of man will make the world uninhabitable for the saner section of people. There are gradations of human beings in terms of proportionate faith in the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The first-class faithful men are the Vaiṣṇavas and the bṛīhmar-as, then the kṣatriyas, then the vaiśyas, then the śūdras, then the mlecchas, the Yāvanas and at last the car-piṇḍas. The degradation of the human instinct begins from the mlecchas, and the car-piṇḍa state of life is the last word in human degradation. All the above terms mentioned in the Vedic literatures are never meant for any particular community or birth. They are different qualifications of human beings in general. There is no question of birthright or community. One can acquire the respective qualifications by one's own efforts, and thus the son of a Vaiṣṇava can

become a mleccha, or the son of a car-piila can become more than a briihmar-a, all in terms of their association and intimate relation with the Supreme Lord.

The meat-eaters are generally called mlecchas. But all meat-eaters are not mlecchas. Those who accept meat in terms of scriptural injunctions are not mlecchas, but those who accept meat without restriction are called mlecchas. Beef is forbidden in the scriptures, and the bulls and cows are offered special protection by followers of the Vedas. But in this age of Kali, people will exploit the body of the bull and the cow as they like, and thus they will invite sufferings of various types.

The people of this age will not perform any sacrifice. The mleccha population will care very little for performances of sacrifices, although performance of sacrifice is essential for persons who are materially engaged in sense enjoyment. In the Bhagavad-gitii performance of sacrifices is strongly recommended (Bg. 3.14-16).

How Pñit Received the Age of Kali 859

The living beings are created by the creator Brahma, and just to maintain the created living being progressively towards the path of back to Godhead, the system of performing sacrifice is also created by him. The system is that living beings live on the produce of grains and vegetables, and by eating such foodstuff they get vital power of the body in the shape of blood and semina, and from blood and semina one living being is able to create other living beings. But the production of grains, grass, etc., becomes possible by rain, and this rain is made to shower properly by performance of recommended sacrifices. Such sacrifices are directed by the rites of the Vedas, namely Siima, Yajus, 1?-k and Atharva. In the Manu smrti it is recommended that by offering sacrifice on the altar of the fire, the sun-god is pleased. When the sun-god is pleased, he properly collects water from the sea, and thus sufficient clouds collect on the horizon and rains fall. After sufficient rains fall, there is sufficient production of grains for men and all animals, and thus there is energy in the living being for progressive activity. The mlecchas, however, make plans to install slaugh

terhouses for killing bulls and cows along with other animals, thinking that they will prosper by increasing the number of factories and live on animal food without caring for performance of sacrifices and production of grains. But they must know that even for the animals they must produce grass and vegetables, otherwise the animals cannot live. And to produce grass for the animals, they must require sufficient rains. Therefore they have to depend ultimately on the mercy of the demigods like the sun-god, Indra, Candra, etc., and such demigods must be satisfied by performances of sacrifice.

This material world is a sort of prison house, as we have several times mentioned. The demigods are servants of the Lord to see to the proper upkeep of the prison house. These demigods want to see that the rebel living beings, who want to survive faithlessly, are gradually turned towards the supreme power of the Lord. Therefore, the system of offering sacrifice is recommended in the scriptures.

The materialistic men want to work hard and enjoy fruitive results for sense enjoyment. Thus they are committing many types of sins at every step of life. Those who are, however, consciously engaged in the devotional service of the Lord are transcendental to all varieties of sin and virtue. Their activities are free from the contamination of the three modes of material nature. For the devotees there is no need for performance of prescribed sacrifices because the very life of the devotee is a symbol of sacrifice. But persons who are engaged in fruitive activities for sense enjoyment must perform the prescribed sacrifices because that is the only

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means to get free from the reaction of all sins committed by the fruitive workers. Sacrifice is the means for counteracting such accumulated sins. The demigods are pleased when such sacrifices are performed, just as prison officers are satisfied when the prisoners are turned into obedient subjects. Lord Caitanya, however, has recommended only one yajña or sacrifice, called the sankirtana-yajña, the chanting of Hare Kṛṣṇa, in which everyone can take part. Thus both devotees and fruitive workers can

derive equal benefit from the performances of smikirtana-yajiia.

TEXT 21

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Ckhi(flua □ teBittl(II□□ II

arak□yamii[liift striya uroi biiliin

socasy atho puruṣiidair iviirtiin

viicam devzm brahma-kule kukarma[ly

abrahma!lye riija-kule kuliigryiin

arakṣyamiifliift-unprotected; striyaft-women; urvi-on the earth; biiliin

-children; socasi- you are feeling compassion; atho-as such; puruṣa-iidaift

-by men;iva-like that; iirtiin-those who are unhappy;viicam-vocabulary;

devim-the goddess; brahma-kule-in the family of the briihma!la; kukar

ma[li-acts against the principles of religion; abrahmartye-persons against

the brahminical culture; riija-kule-in the administrative family; kula

agryiin-most of all the families (the briihmartas).

TRANSLATION

Are you feeling compunction for the unhappy women and children who are left forlorn by unscrupulous persons? Or are you unhappy because the goddess of learning is being handled by brahm3!J.aS addicted to acts against the principles of religion? Or are you sorry to see that the brahma!J.aS have taken shelter of administrative families that do not respect brahminical culture?

Text 22] How P□it Received the Age of Kali 861

PURPORT

In the age of Kali, the women and the children, along with briihma[las and cows, will be grossly neglected and left unprotected. In this age, illicit connection with women will render many women and children uncared for. Circumstantially, the women will try to become independent of the protection of men, and marriage will be performed as a matter of formal agreement between man and woman. In most cases, the children will not

be taken care of properly. The briihma[las are traditionally intelligent men, and thus they will be able to pick up modern education to the top most rank, but as far as moral and religious principles are concerned, they shall be the most fallen. Education and bad character go ill together, but such things will run parallel. The administrative heads as a class will condemn the tenets of Vedic wisdom and will prefer to conduct a so-called secular state, and the so-called educated briihma[laS will be purchased by such unscrupulous administrators. Even a philosopher and writer of many books on religious principles may also accept an exalted post in a government which denies all the moral codes of the siistras. The briihma[las are specifically restricted in accepting such service. But in this age they will not only accept service, but they will do so even if it is of the meanest quality. These are some of the symptoms of the Kali age which are harmful to the general welfare of human society.

TEXT 22

kim k□atra-bandhun kalinopasr□tii.n

ro□traijī vii. tair avaropitii.ni

itas tato vasana-pii.na-vasa□

snii.na-vyavii.yonmu.kha-jiva-lokam

kim-whether; k□atra-bandhun-the unworthy administrators; kalina
by the influence of the age of Kali; upamtan-bewildered ; ra□tra[li- state
affairs; vii-or; tai□-by them; avaropitiini-put into disorder; ita□- here ;
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tata□-there; oo-or; asana- accepting foodstuff; pana-drink; uasa□

residence; snana-bath; vyavaya-sexual intercourse; unmukha-inclined;
jiva-lokam- human society.

TRANSLATION

The so-called administrators are now bewildered by the influence of this age of Kali, and thus they have put all state affairs into disorder. Are you now lamenting this disorder? Now the general populace does not follow the rules and regulations for eating, sleeping, drinking, mating, etc., and they are inclined to perform such anywhere and everywhere. Are you

unhappy because of this?

PURPORT

There are some necessities of life on a par with the lower animals, and they are eating, sleeping, fearing and mating. These bodily demands are both for the human being and the animals. But the human being has to fulfill such desires, not like animals, but like a human being. A dog can mate with a bitch before the public eyes without hesitation, but if a human being does so the act will be considered a public nuisance and the person will be criminally prosecuted. Therefore for the human being there are some rules and regulations, even for fulfilling common demands. The human society avoids such rules and regulations when it is bewildered by the influence of the age of Kali. In this age, people are indulging in such necessities of life without following the rules and regulations, and this deterioration of social and moral rules is certainly lamentable because of the harmful effects of such beastly behavior. In this age, the fathers and the guardians are not happy with the behavior of their wards. They should know that so many innocent children are victims of bad association awarded by the influence of this age of Kali. We know from Srimad Bhagavatam that Ajamila, an innocent son of a brahmar-a, was walking down a road and saw a sudra pair sexually embraced. This attracted the boy, and later on the boy became a victim of all debaucheries. From a pure brahmar-a, he fell down to the position of a wretched urchin, and it was all due to bad association. There was but one victim like Ajamila in those days, but in this age of Kali the poor innocent students are daily victims of cinemas which attract men only for sex indulgence. The so-called administrators are all untrained in the affairs of a kṣatriya. The kṣatriyas are meant for administration, as the brahmar-as are meant for knowledge

Text 23] How Parāit Received the Age of Kali 863

and guidance. The word kṣatriya-bandhu refers to the SO-called administrators or persons promoted to the post of the administrator without proper training by culture and tradition. Nowadays they are promoted to such exalted posts by the votes of people who are themselves fallen in the rules

and regulations of life. How can they select a proper man when they are themselves fallen in the standard of life? Therefore, by the influence of the age of Kali, everywhere, politically, socially or religiously, everything is topsy-turvy, and therefore for the sane man it is all regrettable.

TEXT 23

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yad-viimba te bhii.ri-bhariivatiira

krtiivatiirasya harer dharitri

antarhitasya smarati visr□tii

karmiir-i nirviir-a-vilambitiini

yat-that; vii-may be; amba-o mother; te-your; bhuri-heavy; bhara

load; avatiira- decreasing the load; krta-done; avatiirasya- one who

incarnated; hare[l-of Lord Sri Kr□Qa; dharitri-o earth; antarhitasya-of

Him who is now out of sight; smarati-while thinking of; visr§tii-all that

were performed; karmiir-i-activities; nirviirza-salvation; vilambitani-that

which entails.

TRANSLATION

o mother e□rth, the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Hari, incarnated

Himself as Lord Sri Kr□!!a just to unload your heavy burden. All His

activities here are transcendental, and they cement the path of liberation.

You are now bereft of His presence. You are probably now thinking

of those activities and feeling sorry in their absence.

PURPORT

The activities of the Lord included liberation, but they are more relish

able than the pleasure derived from nirviirw or liberation. According to

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Srila Jiva Gosvami and Visvanatha Cakravarti Thakur, the word used here

is niroii"¶la-vilambitiini, that which mipimizes the value of liberation. To

attain nirvii"¶la or liberation, one has to undergo a severe type of tapasya,

austerities, but the Lord is so merciful that He incarnates to diminish the burden of the earth. Simply by remembering such activities, one can defy the pleasure derived from nirodha and reach the transcendental abode of the Lord to associate with Him, eternally engaged in His blissful loving service.

TEXT 24

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idam mamiicak□va taviidhimulam

vasundhare yena vikarsitiisi

kiilena vii te baliniim baliyasii

suriircitam kim hrtam amba saubhagan

idam-this; mama-unto me; iicak\$va-kindly inform; tava-your; iidhi

mulam-the root cause of your tribulations; vasundhare-the reservoir of

all riches; ye na-by which; vikar\$itii asi-reduced to much weakness;

kiilena-by the influence of time; vii- or; te-your; baliniim-very powerful;

baliyasii-more powerful; sura-arcitam-adored by the demigods; kim

whether; hrtam-taken away; amba-mother; saubhagam-fortune.

TRANSLATION

Mother, you are the reservoir of all riches. Please inform me of the root cause of your tribulations by which you have been reduced to such a weak state. I think that the powerful influence of time, which conquers the most powerful, might have forcibly taken away all your fortune, which was adored even by the demigods.

PURPORT

By the grace of the Lord, each and every planet is created fully equipped.

So this earth is not only fully equipped with all the riches for the main-

Text 25) How P□it Received the Age ·of Kali 865

tenance of the inhabitants, but also when the Lord descends on the earth,

the whole earth becomes so enriched with all kinds of opulences that even

the denizens of heaven worship it with all affection. But by the will of the Lord, the whole earth can at once be changed. He can do and undo a thing at His sweet will. Therefore no one should consider himself to be self sufficient or independent of the Lord.

TEXT 25

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dharo{ly uvaca

bhavan hi veda tat saroam

yan mam dharmanuprcchasi

caturbhir vartase yena

padair loka-sukhavaha*

sri dhara[li uvaca-mother earth replied; bhaviin-your good self; hi certainly; veda-know; tat saroam-all that you have inquired from me; yat that; mam-from me; dharma-o personality of religious principles; anuprcchasi-you have inquired one after another; caturbhi.fi,-by four; vartase-you exist; yena-by which; padai□-by the legs; loka-in each and every planet; sukha-avaha*-increasing the happiness.

TRANSLATION

The earthly deity [in the form of a cow] thus replied to the person ality of religious principles [in the form of a bull] : o Dharma, whatever you have inquired from me shall be known to you. I shall try to reply to all those questions. Once you too were maintained by your four legs and increased happiness all over the universe by the mercy of the Lord.

PURPORT

The principles of religion are laid down by the Lord Himself, and the executor of such laws is Dharmaraja or Yamaraja. Such principles work fully in the age of Satya-yuga; in the Treta-yuga they are reduced by a fraction of one fourth; in the Dvapara they are reduced to one half, and in 866 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch 16 the Kali-yuga they are reduced to one fourth, gradually diminishing to the

zero point, and then deva5tation takes place_ Happiness in the world depends proportionately on the maintenance of the religious principles, individually or collectively. The best part of valor is to maintain the principles despite all kinds of odds. Thus one can be happy during the span of life and ultimately return to Godhead.

TEXTS 26-30

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satyam saucam dayii k□iintis

tyiigafi, santo□a iirjavam

samo damas tapafi. siimyam

titik□oparatifi. srutam

jniinam viraktir aiSvaryam

sauryam tejo balam smrtifi.

sviitantryam kausalam kiintir

dhairyam miirdavam eva ca

priigalbhyam prasrayafi. s'ilam

saha ojo balam bhagafi,

giimbhiryam sthairyam iistikyam

kirtir miino 'nahankrtifi.

ete ciinye ca bhagavan

nityii yatra mahii-gu'(liifi,

priirthyii mahattvam icchadbhir

na viyanti sma karhicit

Texts 26-30] How Pañit Received the Age of Kali

teniiham guṇa-piitrefḷa

sri-niviisena siimpratam

sociimi rahitam lokam

piipmanii kalinekaṇitam

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satyam-truthfulness; saucam-cleanliness; daya-intolerance of others'
unhappiness; k.sant*-self-control even _if there is cause of anger; tyiiga[l
magnanimity; santoṣaṭ-self-satisfaction; arjavam-straightforwardness;
sama[t-fixing of the mind; dama[l-control of the sense organs; tapa[l
trueness to one's responsibility; samyam-indiscrimination of friend and
foe; titikṣii-tolerance of the offenses of others; uparati[l-indifference to
loss and gain;srutam-following scriptural injunctions;ji'ianam-knowledge
(self-realization); virakt*-detachment from sense enjoyment; aisvaryam
leadership; sauryam-chivalry; teja[t-influence; balam-to render possible
that which is impossible; smrti[l-to find one's proper duty;svatantryam
not to depend on others; kausalam-dexterity in all activities; kiinti[!
beauty; dhairyam-freedom from disturbance;mardavam-kindheartedness;
eva-thus; ca-also; priigalbhyam-ingenuity; prasraya[t-gentility; suam
mannerliness;saha-determination;oja[t-perfect knowledge;balam-proper
execution; bhaga[l-object of enjoym«:nt; giimbhi"ryam-joyfulness;
sthairyam-immovability; iistikyam-faithfulness; ki"rti[l-fame; .miina[l
worthy to be worshiped; anaharikrtift-pridelessness; et.e- all these; ca
anye-also many others; ca-and; bhagavan-the Personality of Godhead;
nitya[t-everlastingly; yatra-where;mahii-gurza[l-great qualities; prlirthyii
-worthy to possess; mahattvam-greatness; icchadbhi[l-those who desire
so; na-never; viyanti-deteriorates; sma-ever; karhicit-at any tim.e; tena
-by Him; aham-myself; gurza-piitrerza-the reservoir of all qualities; sri
goddess of fortune; nivasena-by the resting place; sampratam- very
recently; sociimi-I am thinking of; rahitam-bereft of; lokam-planets;
papmanii-by the store of all sins;kalina-by Kali; ikṣitam-is seen.

TRANSLATION

In Him reside I) truthfulness, 2) cleanliness, 3) intolerance of another's unhappiness, 4) the power to control anger, 5) self-satisfaction, 6) straight forwardness, 7) steadiness of mind, 8) control of the sense organs, 9) responsibility, 10) equality, II) tolerance, 12) equanimity, 13) faithfulness, 14) knowledge, 15) absence of sense enjoyment, 16) leadership, 17) chivalry, 18) influence, 19) the power to make everything possible, 20) the discharge of proper duty, 21) complete independence, 22) dexterity, 23) fullness of all beauty, 24) serenity, 25) kindheartedness, 26) ingenuity, 868 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 16

27) gentility, 28) magnanimity, 29) determination, 30) perfection of all knowledge, 31) proper execution, 32) possession of all objects of enjoyment, 33) joyfulness, 34) immovability, 35) fidelity, 36) fame, 37) worship, 38) pridelessness, 39) being (as the Personality of Godhead), 40) eternity, and many other transcendental qualities which are eternally present and never to be separated from Him. That Personality of Godhead, the reservoir of all goodness and beauty, Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, has now closed His transcendental pastimes on the face of the earth. In His absence the age of Kali has spread its influence everywhere, so I am sorry to see this condition of existence.

PURPORT

Even if it were possible to count the atoms after smashing the earth into powder, still it is not possible to estimate the unfathomed transcendental qualities of the Lord. It is said that Lord Anantadeva has tried to expostulate the transcendental qualities of the Supreme Lord with his numberless tongues, and that for numberless years together it has been impossible to estimate the qualities of the Lord. The above statement of the qualities of the Lord is just to estimate His qualities as far as a human being is able to see Him. But even if it is so, the above qualities can also be divided into many subheadings. According to Śrī Jīva Gosvāmī, item No. 3 can be subdivided into 1) protection of the surrendered souls, and 2) well wishes for the devotees. In the Bhagavad-gītā the Lord states that He wants every

soul to surrender unto Him only, and by doing so He assures everyone that He will give protection from the reactions of all sins. Therefore unsundered souls are not devotees of the Lord, and thus there is no particular protection for everyone in general. For the devotees He has all good wishes, and for those who are actually engaged in the loving transcendental service of the Lord, He gives particular attention. He gives direction to such pure devotees to help them discharge their responsibilities on the path back to Godhead. By equality (10), the Lord is equally kind to everyone, as the sun is equal in distributing its rays over everyone. Yet there are many who are unable to take advantage of the sun rays. Similarly, the Lord says that surrendering unto Him is the guarantee for all protection from Him, but unfortunate persons are unable to accept this proposition, and therefore they suffer from all material miseries. So even though the Lord is equally well wishing to everyone, the unfortunate living being, due to bad association only, is unable to accept His instructions in toto, and for this the

Texts 26-30] How Pñt Received the Age of Kali 869

Lord is never to be blamed_ He is called the well-wisher for the devotees only. He appears to be partial to His devotees, but factually the matter rests on the living being to accept or reject equal treatment by the Lord. The Lord never deviates from His word of honor. When He gives assurance for protection, the promise is executed in all circumstances. It is the duty of the pure devotee to be fixed up in the discharge of duty entrusted to him by the Lord or the Lord's bona fide representative, the spiritual master. The rest is carried on by the Lord without a break.

Responsibility of the Lord is also unique. The Lord has no responsibility because all His work is done by His different appointed energies. But still He accepts voluntary responsibilities in displaying different roles in His transcendental pastimes. As a boy, He was playing the part of a cowboy. As the son of Nanda Maharaja, He discharged responsibility perfectly. Similarly, when He was playing the part of a kṣatriya as the son of Maharaja Vasudeva, He displayed all the skill of a martially spirited kṣatriya. In almost all cases, the kṣatriya king has to secure a wife by fighting or

kidnapping. This sort of behavior for a kṣatriya is praiseworthy in the sense that a kṣatriya must show his power of chivalry before his would-be wife so that the daughter of a kṣatriya can see the valor of her would-be husband. Even the Personality of Godhead Sri Rama displayed such a spirit of chivalry during His marriage. He broke the strongest bow, called Haradhanu, and achieved the hand of Sita Devi, the mother of . all opulence. The kṣatriya spirit is displayed during marriage festivals, and there is nothing wrong in such fighting. Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa discharged such responsibility fully because although He had more than 16,000 wives, in each and every case He fought like a chivalrous kṣatriya and thus secured a wife. To fight 16,000 times to secure 16,000 wives is certainly only possible by the Supreme Personality of Godhead. Similarly, He displayed full responsibility in every action of His different transcendental pastimes.

Item No. 14, knowledge, can be further extended into five subheadings, namely 1) intelligence, 2) gratefulness, 3) power of understanding the circumstantial environments of place, object and time, 4) perfect knowledge of everything, and 5) knowledge of the self. Only fools are ungrateful to their benefactors. The Lord, however, does not require benefit from anyone. besides Himself because He is full in Himself; still He feels benefited by the unalloyed services of His devotees. The Lord feels grateful to His devotees for such unsophisticated, unconditional service and tries to reciprocate it by rendering service, although the devotee also has no such desire in his heart. The transcendental service of the Lord is itself a transcendental benefit for the devotee, and therefore the devotee has nothing

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to expect from the Lord. On the assertion of the Vedic aphorism, saroam khalv idam brahma, we can understand that the Lord, by the omnipresent rays of His effulgence, called brahmajyoti, is all-pervading inside or outside of everything, like the omnipresent material sky, and thus He is also omniscient.

As far as the beauty of the Lord is concerned, He has some special features distinguished from all other living beings, and over and above that

He has some special attractive beautiful features by which He attracts the mind of even Radhara!Jl, the supermost beautiful creation of the Lord. He is known, therefore, as Madana-Mohana, or one who attracts the mind even of Cupid. Sn,a .Jlva Gosvami Prabhu has scrutinizingly analyzed other transcendental qualities of the Lord and affirms that Lord Sri Kr□!la is the Absolute Supreme Personality of Godhead (Param Brahman). He is omnipotent by His inconceivable energies, and therefore He is the Yogesvara or the supreme master of all mystic powers. Being the Yoge8vara, His eternal form is spiritual, a combination of eternity, bliss and knowledge. The nondevotee class cannot understand the dynamic nature of His knowledge because they are satisfied to reach up to His eternal form of knowledge. All great souls aspire to be equal in knowledge with Him. This means that all other knowledge is ever insufficient, flexible and measurable, whereas the knowledge of the Lord is ever fixed and unfathomable. Srila Siita Gosvami affirms in the Bhiigavatam that although He was observed by the citizens of Dvaraka every day, they were ever increasingly anxious to see Him again and again. The living being can appreciate the qualities of the Lord as the ultimate goal, but they cannot attain the status quo of such equality. This material world is a product of the mahat-tattva, which is a state of the Lord's dreaming condition in His Yoga-nidrii mystic slumber in the Causal Ocean, and yet the whole creation appears to be a factual presentation of His creation. This means that the Lord's dreaming conditions are also factual manifestations. He can therefore bring everything under His transcendental control, and thus whenever and wherever He does appear, He does so in His fullness.

The Lord, being all that is described above, maintains the affairs of the creation, and by His so doing He gives salvation even to His enemies who are killed by Him. He is attractive even to the topmost liberated soul, and thus He is worshipable even by Brahma and Siva, the greatest of all demi gods. Even in His incarnation of Puru□avatara He is the Lord of the creative energy. The creative material energy is working under His direction, as it is confirmed in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 9.10). He is the control switch of

the material energy, and to control the material energy in the innumerable
Text 31] How Parilq;it Received the Age of Kali 871
universes, He is the root cause of innumerable incarnations in all the uni-
verses. There are more than 500,000 incarnations of Manu in only one
universe, besides other incarnations in different universes. In the spiritual
world, however, beyond the mahat-tattva, there is no question of incarna-
tions, but there are plenary expansions of the Lord in the different Vai-
kuṇṭha. The planets in the spiritual sky are at least three times the number
of those within the innumerable universes in the mahat-tattva. And all the
Narayana forms of the Lord are but expansions of His Vasudeva feature,
and thus He is Vasudeva, Narayana and Kṛṣṇa simultaneously. He is "sri-
kṛṣṇa govinda hare murārī, he nītha nīriya [!a viisudeva," all in one. His
qualities, therefore, cannot be counted by anyone, however great one may
be.

TEXT 31

īitmiinam ciinusociimi

bhavantam ciimarottamam

deviin pit[n-r: in siidhun

saroīin var[!iims tathii "sramiin

īitmanam-myself; ca-also; anusocami-lamenting; bhavantam-yourself;

ca-as well as; amara-uttamam-the best amongst the demigods; deviin

about the demigods; pitfn- about the denizens of the Pitrloka planet;

nin-about the sages; sadhun-about the devotees; sarvan-all of them;

vaqliin-sections; tatha-as also; asraman-orders of human society.

TRANSLATION

I am thinking about myself and also, o best amongst the demigods,
about yourself, as well as about all the demigods, sages, denizens of the
Pitrloka, devotees of the Lord and all men obedient to the system of varṇa
and asrama in human society.

PURPORT

To effect the perfection of human life there is cooperation between
men and demigods, sages, denizens of the Pitrloka, devotees of the Lord

and the scientific system of *vaq̣w* and *iiSrama* orders of life. Distinction of human life and animal life therefore begins with the scientific system of *va'la* and *iisrama*, guided by the experience of the sages in relation with the demigods, gradually rising to the summit of reestablishing our eternal relation with the Supreme Absolute Truth Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa. When God-made *va'liisrama-dharma*, which is strictly meant for developing animal consciousness into human consciousness and human consciousness into godly consciousness, is broken by advancement of foolishness, the whole system of peaceful and progressive life is at once disturbed. In the age of Kali, the first attack of the venomous snake is struck against the God-made *va'liisrama-dharma*, and thus a person properly qualified as a *briihmar-a* is called a *sudra*, and a *sudra* by qualification is passing as a *briihmar-a*, all on a false birthright claim. To become a *briihmar-a* by a birthright claim is not at all bona fide, although it may be a fulfillment of one of the conditions. But the real qualification of a *briihmar-a* is to control the mind and the senses, and to cultivate tolerance, simplicity, cleanliness, knowledge, truthfulness, devotion and faith in the Vedic wisdom. In the present age, consideration of the necessary qualification is being neglected, and the false birthright claim is being supported even by a popular, sophisticated poet and author of *Riimacarita-manas*. This is all due to the influence of the age of Kali. Thus mother earth, represented as a cow, was lamenting the regrettable condition.

TEXTS 32-33

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brahmiidayo bahutitham yad-āpīḥga-mokṣa
kīmiis-tapaft samacaran bhagavat-prapannīft
sī sn"l sva-vīsam aravinda-vanam vihīya
yat-pīqa-saubhagam alam bhajate 'nuraktī
Texts 32-33] How Paṇit Received the Age of Kali
tasyaham abja-kulīSankusa-ketu-ketai)
śrīmat-padair bhagavatafi. samalank[taṅgi
trin aty aroca up alabhya tato vibhutim
lokan sa mīm vyasrjad utsmayatm tadante
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brahmtī-iidayafi.-demigods such as Brahma; bahutitham -for many days;
yat-of Lakṣmī, the goddess of fortune; aptīṅga-mokṣa-glance of grace;
ktīmtīfi.-being desirous of; tapafti.-penances; samacaran-executing;
bhagavat-unto the Personality of Godhead; prapannafi.-surrendered; sa
she (the goddess of fortune); sn't-Lakṣmī; sva-vtīsam-her own abode;
aravinda-vanam-the forest of lotus flowers; vihtīya-leaving aside; yat
whose; ptīda-feet; saubhagam-all-blissful; alam-without hesitation;
bhajate-worships; anurokṭti-being attached; tasya-His; aham -myself;
abja-lotus flower; kulīSa-thunderbolt; ankusa-rod for driving elephants;
ketu-flag; ketaifi.-impressions; śrīmat-the owner of all opulence;padaifi.
-by the soles of the feet; bhagavataṇ-of the Personality of Godhead;
simalankṛta-angi-one whose body is so decorated; trin-three; utī-super
seding; aroce-beautifully decorated; upalabhya-having obtained; tatafi.
thereafter; vibhutim- specific powers; loktīn-planetary systems; safī.-He;
mam-me; vyasrjat-gave up; utsmayatim- while feeling proud;tadante
at the end.

TRANSLATION

Lakṣmī, the goddess of fortune, whose glance of grace was sought
by demigods like Brahma and others and for whom they surrendered many
a day unto the Personality of Godhead, gave up her own abode in the
forest of lotus flowers and engaged herself in the service of the lotus feet
of the Lord. I was endowed with specific powers to supersede the fortune

of all the three planetary systems by being decorated with the impressions of the flag, thunderbolt, elephant driving rod and lotus flower, which are signs of the lotus feet of the Lord. But at the end, when I felt I was so fortunate, the Lord left me.

PURPORT

The beauty and opulence of the world can be enhanced by the grace of the Lord and not by any manmade planning. When the Lord Sri Kṁta was present on this earth, the impressions of the special signs of His lotus feet were stamped on the dust, and as a result of this specific grace, the whole earth was made as perfect as possible. In other words, the rivers, the seas, the forests, the hills and the mines, which are the supplying agents for the

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necessities of men and animals, were fully discharging their respective duties. Therefore the riches of the world surpassed all the riches of all other planets in the three planetary systems of the universe. One should, therefore, ask that the grace of the Lord always be present on earth so that we may be favored with His causeless mercy and be happy, having all necessities of life. One may ask how we can detain the Supreme Lord on this earth after His mission is fulfilled and He has left this earth for His own abode. The answer is that there is no need to detain the Lord. The Lord, being omnipresent, can be present with us if we want Him at all. By His omnipresence, He can always be with us if we are attached to His devotional service by hearing, chanting, remembering, etc.

There is nothing in the world with which the Lord is disconnected. The only thing we must learn is to excavate the source of connection and thus be linked with Him by offenseless service. We can be connected with Him by the transcendental sound representation of the Lord. The holy name of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical, and one who chants the holy name of the Lord in an offenseless manner can at once realize that the Lord is present before him. Even by the vibration of radio sound, we can partially realize sound relativity, and by resounding the sound of transcendence we can verily feel the presence of the Lord. In this age, when

everything is polluted by the contamination of Kali, it is instructed in the scriptures and preached by Lord Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu that by chanting the holy name of the Lord, we can at once be free from contamination and gradually rise to the status of transcendence and go back to Godhead. The offenseless chanter of the holy name of the Lord is as auspicious as the Lord Himself, and the movement of pure devotees of the Lord all over the world can at once change the troublesome face of the world. Only by the propagation of the chanting of the holy name of the Lord can we be immune from all effects of the age of Kali.

TEXT 34

□ □ ¥4¥41Rt¥4(¥tlij(tt□i(l(l-
 □f(uo□(1¥4qt□aJ:J□¥46;sa:
 m□:□\-.qa>□ q□
 Qi41□□1.□<+i4¥4NWG>ti(ll□'clll
 yo vai mamiitibharam iisura-varhsa-riijiiiim
 ak□auhir.i-satam apiinudad iitmatantra[l
 tviiirh du[lstham unapadam iitmani pauru□er-a
 sampiidayan yadu□u ramyam abibhrad angam

Text 35) How Parilq;it Received the Age of Kali 875

ya[l-He who; uai-certainly; mama-mine; atibharam-too burdensome;
 asura-uarhsa-unbelievers; riijnam-of the kings; ak\$auhi[li-one military
 division* j satam-hundreds of such divisions; apanudat-extirpated;atma
 tantraft-self-sufficient; tvam-unto you; duftstham-put into difficulty;
 unapadam-devoid of strength to stand; iitmani-internal; pauru\$epa-by
 dint of energy; sampiidayan-for executing;yadu\$u-in the Yadu dynasty;
 ramyam-transcendentally beautiful j abibhrat-accepted;an gam-body.

TRANSLATION

O personality of religion, I was greatly overburdened by the undue military phalanx arranged by atheistic kings, and I was relieved by the grace of the Personality of Godhead. Similarly you were also in a distressed condition, weakened by your standing strength, and thus He also incarnated by His internal energy in the family of the Yadus to relieve you.

PURPORT

The asuras want to enjoy a life of sense gratification, even at the cost of others' happiness. In order to fulfill this ambition, the asuras, especially atheistic kings or state executive heads, try to equip themselves with all kinds of deadly weapons to bring about a war in a peaceful society. They have no ambition other than personal aggrandizement, and thus mother earth feels overburdened by such undue increases of military strength. By increase of the asuric population, those who follow the principles of religion become unhappy, especially the devotees or devas.

Only in such a situation the Personality of Godhead incarnates to vanquish the unwanted asuras and to reestablish the true principles of religion. This was the mission of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, and He fulfilled it.

TEXT 35

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□'WC□Hi□Nd□C3€f□j□□:

□ (1'41□'4M□¥41fwtwt1•d

u.tltti€1t□□□eM ff4;;:ftC31□i: II □'-\11"

ka va saheta viraham puruṣottamasya

pre mavaloka-rue ira-smita-valgu-jalpait

sthairyam samanam aharan madhu-manininam

romotsavo mama yad anghri vitahkitayalt

* An akṣauhirti phalanx consists of 21,870 chariots, 21,870 elephants, 106,950 infantrymen, and 65,600 cavalrymen.

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kii-who; txi-either; saheta-can tolerate; viraham-separation;

puruṣottamasya-of the Supreme Personality of Godhead; premii-loving;

avaloka-glancing; rue ira-smita-pleasing smile; valgu-jalpaifl-hearty ap

peals; sthairyam-gravity; samiinam-along with passionate wrath; aharat

conquered; madhu-sweethearts; miinininiim-women such as Satyahhama;

roma-utsavafl-hair standing on end out of pleasure; mama--mine; yat

whose; anghri-feet; vi tankitayafl-imprinted with.

TRANSLATION

Who can, therefore, tolerate the pangs of separation from that Supreme Personality of Godhead? He could conquer the gravity and passionate wrath of His sweethearts like Satyahhama and others by His sweet smile of love, pleasing glance and hearty appeals. When He traversed my [earth's] surface, I would be immersed in the dust of His lotus feet and thus would be sumptuously covered with grass which appeared like hairs standing on me out of pleasure.

PURPORT

There were chances of separation between the Lord and His thousands of queens because of the Lord's being absent from home, but as far as His connection with earth was concerned, the Lord would traverse the earth with His lotus feet, and therefore there was no chance of separation. When the Lord left the surface of the earth to return to His spiritual abode, the earth's feelings of separation were therefore more acute.

TEXT 36

tayor evam kathayatofl
prthivi-dharmayos tadii
pan""k□in-niima-riija11ifl
priipta□ priicim sarasvatim
tayoft-between them; evam-thus; kathayato{l-engaged in conversation;
prth ivi-earth; dharmayo□-and the personality of religion; tadii-at that
time; pan""k§it-King Parik□?it; nii.ma-of the name; riijar§ifl-a saint amongst

Text 36] How Panklzit Received the Age of Kali 877

kings; priiptafl- arrived ; priicim- flowing towards the East; sarasvatim
River Sarasvati.

TRANSLATION

While the earth and personality of religion were thus engaged in conversation, the saintly King Maharaja Parik!zit reached the shore of the Sarasvati River, which flowed towards the East.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Sixteenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled "How Pan""k§it Received the Age of Kali."

CHAPTER SEVENTEEN

Punishment and Reward of Kali

TEXT 1

□□

□ titf□ oo (944YU•UI□ I

(at(□ :q □ □ tqeiSUwt(II □ II

suta uvaca

tatra go-mithunam raja

hanyamanam anathavat

dar4a-hastam ca vr□alam

dadrse nrpa-liiichanam

sri suta□ uvaca-Srī Suta Gosvami said; tatra-thereupon;go-mithunam
a cow and a bull; rajii-the King; hanyamanam-being beaten; aniithavat
appearing to be bereft of their owner; da(l{ia-hastam-with a club in
hand; ca-also; vr□alam-lower caste siidra; dadrse-observed; nrpa-a king;
liiichanam-dressed like.

TRANSLATION

Suta Gosvami said: Mter reaching that place, Maharaja Pa□it ob
served that a lower caste Siidra, dressed like a king, was beating a cow and
a bull with a club, as if they had no owner.

PURPORT

The principal sign of the age of Kali is that lower caste sudras, i.e. men
without brahminical culture and spiritual initiation, will be dressed like
administrators or kings, and the principal business of such non-k□atriya
rulers will be to kill the innocent animals, especially the cows and the bulls

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who shall be unprotected by their masters, the bona fide vai.Syas, or the
mercantile community. In the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 18.44), it is said that the
vaisyas are meant to deal in agriculture, cow protection and trade. In the
age of Kali, the degraded vai.Syas, or the mercantile men, are engaged in
supplying cows to slaughterhouses. The k□atriyas are meant to protect the

citizens of the state, whereas the vaiSyas are meant to protect the cows and bulls and utilize them to produce grains and milk. The cow is meant to deliver milk, and the bull is meant to produce grains. But in the age of Kali, the sudra class of men are in the posts of administrators, and the cows and bulls, or the mothers and the fathers, unprotected by the vaiSyas, are subjected to the slaughterhouses organized by the sudra administrators.

TEXT 2

vr̥am mrrliila-dhavalam

mehantam iva bibhyatam

vepamiinam padaikena

sidantam sii.dra-tiit;litam

vr̥am- the bull; mrrtiila-dhavalam-as white as a white lotus; mehantam urinating; iva-as if; bibhyatam- being too afraid; vepamiinam-trembling; padii ekena-standing on only one leg; sidantam- terrified; sii.dra-tiit;litam being beaten by a sii.dra.

TRANSLATION

The bull was as white as a white lotus flower. He was terrified of the Siidra who was beating him, and he was so afraid that he was standing on one leg, trembling and urinating.

PURPORT

The next symptom of the age of Kali is that principles of religion, which are all spotlessly white, like the white lotus flower, will be attacked by the uncultured sudm population of the age. They may be descendants of briihmaṇḍa or kṣatriya forefathers, but in the age of Kali, for want of sufficient education and culture of Vedic wisdom, such sudra-like population will defy the principles of religion, and persons who are religiously endowed will be terrified by such men. They will declare themselves as adhering to no religious principles, and many 'isms' and cults will spring up in Kali-yuga only to kill the spotless bull of religion. The state will be declared to be secular, or without any particular principle of religion, and as a result there will be total indifference to the principles of religion. The

Text3) Punishment and Reward of Kali 881

citizens will be free to act as they like, without respect for siidhu, siistra and guru. The bull standing on one leg indicates that the principles of religion are gradually diminishing. Even the fragmental existence of religious principles will be embarrassed by so many obstacles as if in the trembling condition of falling down at any time.

TEXT₃

t1f l1il \t□ □ □ UlqiiJC:<tiJ{ I

f'l□hn□□□ qqQfic□□ 11 □ 11

giirit ca dharma-dughiirit di:niirit

bhrsarit sii.dra-padiihatiim

vivatsiirits iiSru-vadaniim

k□iimiirit yavasam-icchatim

giim-the cow; ca-also; dharma-dughiim-beneficial because one can draw religion from her; di:niim- now rendered poor; bhrsam- distressed; sii.dra-the lower caste; padiihatiim-beaten on the legs; vivatsiim-without any calf; iiSru-vadaniim-with tears in her eyes; k□iimiim-very weak; yavasam-grass; icchatim-as if desiring to have some grass to eat.

TRANSLATION

Although the cow is beneficial because one can draw religious principles from her, she was now rendered poor and calfless. Her legs were being beaten by a Siidra. There were tears in her eyes, and she was distressed and weak. She was hankering after some grass in the field.

PURPORT

The next symptom of the age of Kali is the distressed condition of the cow. Milking the cow means drawing the principles of religion in a liquid form. The great nis and munis would live only on milk. Srila Sukadeva 882 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 17

Gosvami would go to a householder while he was milking a cow, and he would simply take a little quantity of it for subsistence. Even fifty years ago, no one would deprive a siidhu of a quart or two of milk, and every householder would give milk like water. For a saniitanist (the follower of Vedic principles) it is the duty of every householder to have cows and

bulls as household paraphernalia, not only for drinking milk, but also for deriving religious principles. The Sanatanists worship cows on religious principles and respects Brahmanas. The cow's milk is required for the sacrificial fire, and by performing sacrifices the householder can be happy. The cow's calf is not only beautiful to look at, but also gives satisfaction to the cow, and so she delivers as much milk as possible. But in the Kali-yuga, the calves are separated from the cow as early as possible for purposes which may not be mentioned in these pages of Srimad-Bhagavatam. The cow stands with tears in her eyes, and the milkman draws milk from the cow artificially, and when there is no milk the cow is sent to be slaughtered. These greatly sinful acts are responsible for all the troubles in present society. They do not know what they are doing in the name of economic development. The influence of Kali will keep them in the darkness of ignorance, and despite all endeavors for peace and prosperity, they must try to see the cows and the bulls happy in all respects. Foolish people do not know how happiness is earned by making the cows and bulls happy, but it is a fact by the law of nature. Let us take it from the authority of Srimad-Bhagavatam and adopt the principles for the total happiness of humanity.

TEXT 4

□ □ Y11 □ (: Y1J (q < '4 Ro6o □ f (I
iN • awf \ (□ 1 i1R1 4.1'11itN6Y1t.: II □ II

papraccha ratham arii, Phal)

kartasvara-paricchadam

megha-gambhiraya vaca

samaropita-karmukal)

papraccha- inquired ; ratham- chariot ; aru{hlal) - seated on; kartasvara
gold; paricchadam- embossed with; megha- cloud; gambhirayii- exonerat-
ing; viicii-sound; samiiropita- well equipped; kiirmukaft-arrows and
bow.

Text 5] Punishment and Reward of Kali 883

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pan"K□it, well equipped with arrows and bow and seated on a gold embossed chariot, spoke to him [the Siidra] with a deep voice sounding like thunder.

PURPORT

An administrative head or king like Maharaja Pan"K□it, with full majestic authority, well equipped with weapons to chastise miscreants, can challenge the agents of the age of Kali . Then only will it be possible to counteract the degraded age. And in the absence of such strong executive heads, there is always disruption of tranquility. The elected show bottle executive head, as representative of a degraded public, cannot be equal with a strong king like Maharaja Pan"K□it. The dress or style of royal order does not count. It is one's actions which are counted.

TEXTS

□ tt□ □ t□el□'l□l'(.ret 1

□sfr □ it&ii4□□anf□: II □ II

kas tvarh mac-chara[le loke

baliid-dharhsy-abaliin bali:

naradevo sivefie[la

natavat-karma[liidvija□

ka□-who are; tvam-you; mat-my; sara[le- under protection; loke-in

this world; baliit-by force; harhsi- killing; abaliin-those who are helpless;

bal"l-although full of strength; nara-deva□-man-god; asi-appear to be;

vefie[IU- by your dress; natavat- like a theatrical player; karma[lii- by deeds;

advija□-a man not twice-born by culture.

TRANSLATION

O who are you? You appear to be strong, and yet you dare kill, within my protection, those who are helpless? By your dress you pose yourself to be a godly man [king], but by your deeds you are opposing the principles of the twice-born □atriyas.

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PURPORT

The brii.hmar-as, kṣatriyas and vaiśyas are called twice-born because for

these higher classes of men there is one birth by parental conjugation and there is another birth of cultural rejuvenation by spiritual initiation from the bona fide ii.cii.rya or spiritual master. So a kṣatriya is also twice-born like a brii.hmar-a, and his duty is to give protection to the helpless. The kṣatriya king is considered to be the representative of God to give protection to the helpless and chastise the miscreants. Whenever there are anomalies in this routine work by the administrators, there is an incarnation of the Lord to reestablish the principles of a godly kingdom. In the age of Kali, the poor helpless animals, especially the cows, which are meant to receive all sorts of protection from the administrative heads, are killed without restriction. Thus the administrative heads, under whose nose such things happen, are so-called representatives of God. Such powerful administrators are rulers of the poor citizens by dress or office only, but factually they are worthless, lower class men without the cultural assets of the twice-born. No one can expect justice or equality of treatment from once-born (without spiritual culture) lower class men. Therefore in the age of Kali everyone is unhappy due to the maladministration of the state. The modern human society is not twice-born by spiritual culture. Therefore the people's government, by the people who are not twice-born, must be a government of Kali in which everyone is unhappy.

TEXT6

m p1 □ tt □ t□Am□., 1

tUl□S(CI\Il□l(«ftt'□□ II□ II

yas tvarh kr□'!e gate diirarh

saha giir-tJiva-dhanvanii

socyo 'sy asocyiin rahasi

praharan vadham arhasi

yafi, - on account of; tvam-you rogue; kHTJe-Lord Kr□Qa; gate-having gone away; diiram-out of sight; saha- along with;gar-t}l"va-the bow named Gal)□va; dhanvanii-the carrier; socyafi,- culprit; asi- you are considered; a5ocyan-innocent ; rahasi-in a secluded place; praharan-beating ; vadham to be killed; arhasi- deserve.

Text 7) Punishment and Reward of Kali 885

TRANSLATION

You rogue, do you dare beat an innocent cow because Lord Kṛṣṇa and Arjuna, the carrier of the Gāṇḍivā bow, are out of sight? Since you are beating the innocent in a secluded place, you are considered a culprit and therefore deserve to be killed.

PURPORT

In a civilization where God is conspicuously banished and there is no devotee warrior like Arjuna, the associates of the age of Kali take advantage of this lawless kingdom and arrange to kill innocent animals like the cow in secluded slaughterhouses. Such murderers of animals stand to be condemned to death by the order of a pious king like Maharaja Parīkṣit. For a pious king, the culprit who kills an animal in a secluded place is punishable by the death penalty, exactly like a murderer who kills an innocent child in a secluded place.

TEXT 7

‘fī t’līlf4q: : I

11o1 fit : qf((41:\tfi II \9 II

tvam vii mrniila-dhavalal

piidair n yiina[l padii caran

vrṣa-riipe!la kim kascid

devo nal parikhedayan

tvam-yourself; vii-either; mrniila-dhavalal-as white as a lotus; piidai[l

of three legs; nyiina[l-being deprived; padii- on one leg; caran-moving;

vrṣa-bull; riipe!la-in the form of; kim-whether; kascit-someone; deva[t

demigod; nal-us; parikhedayan-causing grief.

TRANSLATION

Then he [Maharaja Parīkṣit] asked the bull: o, who are you? Are you a bull as white as a white lotus or demigod? You have lost your three legs and are only moving on one. Are you some demigod causing us grief in the form of a bull?

PURPORT

At least up to the time of Maharaja Parikṣit, no one could imagine the wretched conditions of the cow and the bull. Maharaja Parikṣit was, therefore, astonished to see such a horrible scene. He inquired, therefore, whether the bull was not a demigod assuming such a wretched condition to indicate the future of the cow and the bull.

TEXTS

if □ Etfi(□fi:IUii □qqf{dY:□ I

□saccij□qRat'{f?fon□snfUiwti □:u □ 11

na ja.tu karuavendraru"irit

dordar-!la-parirambhite

bhutale 'nupatanty asmin

vinii te priir-iniim suca□

na- not; jītu- at any time; kauravendriirtiim-of the kings in the Kuru dynasty; dordar-□a-strength of arms; parirambhite-protected by; bhu tale-on the surface of the earth; anupatanti-grieving; asmin- up till now; vinii-save and except; te-you; priir-iniim-of the living being; suca□ tears in the eyes.

TRANSLATION

Now for the first time in a kingdom well protected by the arms of the kings of the Kuru dynasty, I see you grieving with tears in your eyes. Up till now no one on earth has ever shed tears because of royal negligence.

PURPORT

The protection of the lives of both the human being and the animals is the first and foremost duty of a government. A government must not discriminate in such principles. It is simply horrible for a purehearted soul to see organized animal killing by the state in this age of Kali. Maharaja Parikṣit was lamenting for the tears in the eyes of the bull, and he was astonished to see such an unprecedented thing in his good kingdom. Both men and animals were equally protected as far as life was concerned. That is the way in God's kingdom.

Text9] Punishment and Reward of Kali

TEXT9

□ □ □ □ IPI?JI"iil □ □ □ □ I

□ (l(l(MC lft□ □ □ □ II□ II

mii saurabheyyitra iuco

vyetu te vr□aliid bhayam

mii rod"ir amba bhadrarh te

khaliiniirh mayi iistari

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mii-do not; saurabheya-o son of Surabhi; atra-in my kingdom;

iuca□- lamentation; vyetu-let there be no; te-your; vr□aliit-by the iudra;

bhayam-cause of fear; mii-do not; rodiJ:t- cry; amba-mother cow;

bhadram-all good; te-unto you; khaliiniim-of the envious; mayi-while I

am living; iistari-the ruler or subduer.

TRANSLATION

o son of Surabhi, you need lament no longer now. There is no need to fear this low-class siidra. And, o mother cow, as long as I am living as the ruler and subduer of all envious men, there is no cause for you to cry. Everything will be good for you.

PURPORT

Protection of bulls and cows and all other animals can only be possible when there is a state ruled by an executive head like Maharaja Parik□it. Maharaja Pan"ka□it addresses the cow as mother for he is a cultured twice born k□atriya king- Surabhi is the name of the cows which exist in the spiritual planets and are especially reared by Lord Sri Kr□pa Himself_ As men are made after the form and features of the Supreme Lord, so also the cows are made after the form and features of the surabhi cows in the spiritual kingdom. In the material world the human society gives all protection to the human being, but there is no law to protect the descendants of Surabhi who can give all protection to men by supplying the miracle food milk. But Maharaja Parik□it and the Pap□avas were fully conscious of the importance of the cow and bull, and they were prepared to punish the cow-killer with all chastisement, including death. There has

sometimes been agitation for the protection of the cow, but for want of pious executive heads and suitable laws, the cow and the bull are not
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given protection. The human society should recognize the importance of the cow and the bull and thus give all protection to these important animals, following in the footsteps of Maharaja Parikṣit. By protecting the cow and brahminical culture, the Lord, who is very kind to the cow and the bṛīhmar-as (go-bṛīhmar-a-hitīya), will be pleased with us and will bestow upon us real peace.

TEXTS 10-11

□□□:□□t□□□m.□□-Hu□: 1

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□ □ 1fU □ Glijliti+uMf9is.(: 1

□ □ □ k□□(1□+t(1l□□ll

yasya riiṣṭre prajii/:t sarviis

trasyante siidhvvy asiidhubhi/:t

tasya mattasya nasyanti

kzrtir iiyur bhago gati/:t

□ṣa riijniim paro dharmo

hy iirtiiniim iirti-nigraha/:t

ata enam vadhiṣyimi

bhiita-druham asattamam

yasya-one whose; riiṣṭre- in the state; prajii/:t-living beings; sarvii/:t-one

and all; trasyante-are terrified; siidhvi-o chaste one; asiidhubhi/:t-by the

miscreants; tasya-his; mattasya-of the illusioned; nasyanti- vanishes;

kzrti/:t- fame; iiyu/:t-duration of life; bhaga/:t-fortune; gati/:t- good rebirth;

eṣa-these are; riijniim-of the kings; parab,-superior; dharmab,- occupa

tion; hi-certainly; iirtiiniim-of the sufferers; iirti-sufferings; nigraha/:t

subdual; ata1;t-therefore; enam-this man; vadhiniimi-I shall kill; bhiita

dru ham-revolter against other living beings; asattamam-the most

wretched.

TRANSLATION

o chaste one, the king's good name, duration of life and good rebirth vanish when all kinds of living beings are terrified by miscreants in his kingdom. It is certainly the prime duty of the king to subdue first the
[Texts 10-11] Punishment and Reward of Kali 889

sufferings of those who suffer. Therefore I must kill this most wretched man because he is violent against other living beings.

PURPORT

When there is some disturbance caused by wild animals in a village or town, the police or others take action to kill them. Similarly, it is the duty of the government to kill at once all bad social elements such as thieves, dacoits, murderers, etc. The same punishment is also due to animal-killers because the animals of the state are also the prajii. Prajii means one who has taken birth in the state and includes both men and animals. Any living being who takes birth in a state has the primary right to live under the protection of the king. The jungle animals also are subject to the king, and they have a right to live also. So what to speak of domestic animals like the cows and bulls.

Any living being, if he terrifies other living beings, is a most wretched subject, and the king should at once kill such a disturbing element. As the wild animal is killed when it creates disturbances, similarly any man who unnecessarily kills or terrifies the jungle animals or other animals must be punished at once. By the law of the Supreme Lord, all living beings, in whatsoever shape they may be, are the sons of the Lord, and no one has any right to kill another animal, unless it is so ordered by the codes of natural law. The tiger can kill a lower animal for his subsistence, but a man cannot kill an animal for his subsistence. That is the law of God, who has created the law that a living being subsists by eating another living being. Thus the vegetarians are also living by eating other living beings. Therefore, the law is that one should live only by eating specific living beings, as ordained by the law of God. The Isopanīad directs that one should live by the direction of the Lord and not at one's sweet will. A man can subsist on varieties of grains, fruits and milk ordained by God, and there is no

need of animal food, save and except in particular cases.

The illusioned king or the executive head, even though sometimes advertised as a great philosopher and learned scholar, will allow slaughter houses in the state without knowing that torturing poor animals clears the way to hell for such foolish kings or executive heads. The executive head always must be alert to the safety of the prajis, both man and animal, and inquire whether a particular living being is harassed at any place by another living being. The harassing living being must at once be caught and put to death, as shown by Maharaja Panikhet.

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The people's government, or government by the people, should not allow killing innocent animals by the sweet will of foolish government men. They must know the codes of God, as mentioned in the revealed scriptures. Maharaja Panikhet quotes here that in the codes of God the irresponsible king or state executive jeopardizes his good name, duration of life, power and strength and ultimately his progressive march towards a better life or salvation after death. Such foolish men do not even believe in existence in the next life.

While commenting on this particular verse, we have in our presence the statement of a great modern politician who has recently died and left his will, which discloses his poor fund of knowledge of the codes of God mentioned by Maharaja Panikhet. The politician was so ignorant of the codes of God that he writes: "I do not believe in any such ceremonies and to submit to them, even as a matter of form would be hypocrisy and an attempt to delude ourselves and others ...I have no religious sentiment in the matter."

Contrasting these statements of a great politician in the modern age with that of Maharaja Panikhet, we find a vast difference. Maharaja Panikhet was pious according to the scriptural codes, whereas the modern politician goes by his personal belief and sentiments. Any great man of the material world is after all a conditioned soul. He is bound up by his hands and feet by the ropes of material nature, and still the foolish conditioned soul

thinks of himself as free to act by his whimsical sentiments. The conclusion is that people in the time of Maharaja Parikṣit were happy, and the animals were given proper protection because the executive head was not whimsical nor ignorant of God's law. Foolish faithless creatures try to avoid the existence of the Lord and proclaim themselves secular at the cost of valuable human life. The human life is especially meant for knowing the science of God, but foolish creatures, especially in this age of Kali, instead of knowing God scientifically, make propaganda against religious belief as well as the existence of God, even though they are always bound by the laws of God by the symptoms of birth, death, old age and disease.

TEXT 12

kaṣṭhaḥ (R qli::iḥ'laḥ C: I
 kaḥ\kaḥ%«tiḥPIIḥ'iḥM'li'(IIḥ IIḥ
 ko 'vrscat tava piidiims trzn
 saurabheya catuḥ-pada
 mii bhiivams tviidsii riiḥtre
 riijniim krṣṇajinuvartiniim

Text 13) Punishment and Reward of Kali 891

kaḥ- who is he; avricat-cut off; tava-your; padiin-legs; trin-three;
 saurabheya-o son of Surabhi; catuḥ-pada- you are four-legged; mii-never
 to be; bhiivan-it so happened; tviidriaḥ-as yourself; riiḥ(re-in the state;
 riijfiim-of the kings; kHTJa- anuvartiniim-those who follow the codes of
 I<{kaḥQa, the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

He [Maharaja Parikṣit] repeatedly addressed and questioned the bull
 thus: o son of Surabhi, who has cut off your three legs? In the state of
 the kings who are obedient to the laws of the Supreme Personality of
 Godhead, Krṣṇa, there is no one as unhappy as you.

PURPORT

The kings or the executive heads of all states must know the codes of
 Lord Krṣṇa (generally Bhagavad-gītā and Śnmad-Bhīgavatam) and must
 act accordingly in order to fulfill the mission 'of human life, which is to

make an end to all miseries of material conditions. One who knows the codes of Lord Kṛṣṇa can achieve this end without any difficulty. In the Bhagavad-gītā in a synopsis -we can understand the codes of Godhead, and in the Śnmad-Bhīgavatam the same codes are explained further.

In a state where the codes of Kṛṣṇa are followed, no one is unhappy.

Where such codes are not followed, the first sign is that three legs of the representative of religion are cut off, and thereby all miseries follow.

When Kṛṣṇa was personally present, the codes of Kṛṣṇa were being followed without question, but in His absence such codes are presented in the pages of Śnmad-Bhīgavatam for the guidance of the blind persons who happen to be at the helm of all affairs.

TEXT 13

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31f□tM□Eikti(□;d ..aMt,OI(II□ □II

iikhyihi vr□a bhadram va□

siidhuniim akrtiigasiim

iitma-vairiipya-kartiirarit

piirthiiniim kirti-du□ar-am

iikhyihi-just let me know; vr□a-o bull; bhadram-good; vafz-for you;

siidhuniim-of the honest; akrtā-agasiim-of those who are offenseless;

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iitma-vairupya-deformation of the self; kartiiram-the doer; piirthiiniim

of the sons of Prtha; kirti-du□ar;wm-blackmailing the reputation.

TltANSLATION

O bull, you are offenseless and thoroughly honest; therefore I wish all good to you. Please tell me of the perpetrator of these mutilations which blackmail the reputation of the sons of Prtha.

PURPORT

The reputation of the reign of Maharaja Ramacandra and that of the kings who followed in the footsteps of Maharaja Ramacandra, like the Paṇḍavas and their descendants, are never to be forgotten because in their kingdom offenseless and honest living beings were never in trouble. The

bull and the cow are the symbols of the most offenseless living beings because even the stool and urine of these animals are utilized to benefit human society. The descendants of the sons of Pṛthvī, like Maharaja Parikṣit and others, were afraid of losing their reputations, but in the modern days they are not even afraid of killing such offenseless animals. Herein lies the difference between the reign of those pious kings and the modern states ruled by irresponsible executive heads without knowledge in the codes of God.

TEXT 14

सुखं त्रिपुण्ड्रं पश्यन्निगस्य अघमयुञ्जन्

सर्वतोऽप्यत्र भयं मादधुनि भद्रमेवासीदधुदमनं कृतं

jane 'niigasy agham yunjan

sarvato 'sya ca mad-bhayam

siidhuniim bhadram eva syiid

asiidhu-damane krte

jane-to the living beings; aniigasi-those who are offenseless; agham sufferings; yunjan-by applying; sarvata[al-anywhere and everywhere; asya-of such offenders; ca-and; mat-bhayam-fear me; siidhuniim- of the honest persons; bhadram-good fortune; eva-certainly; syiit-will take place; asiidhu-dishonest miscreants; damane-curbed down; krte-being so done.

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TRANSLATION

Whoever causes offenseless living beings to suffer must fear me anywhere and everywhere in the world. By curbing dishonest miscreants, one automatically benefits the offenseless.

PURPORT

Dishonest miscreants flourish because of cowardly and impotent executive heads of state. But when such executive heads are strong enough to curb all sorts of dishonest miscreants, in any part of the state, certainly they cannot flourish. When the miscreants are punished in an exemplary manner, automatically all good fortune follows. As said before, it is the

prime duty of the king or the executive head to give protection in all respects to the peaceful offenseless citizens of the state. The devotees of the Lord are by nature peaceful and offenseless, and therefore it is the prime duty of the state to arrange to convert everyone to become a devotee of the Lord, and thus automatically there will be peaceful offenseless citizens. Then the only duty of the king will be to curb the dishonest miscreants. That will bring about peace and harmony all over human society.

TEXT 15

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aniigafl.Sv iha bhii.tefiu

ya iigaskrn nirankusafi.

iihartiismi bhujarh siikfiid

amartyasyiipi siingadam

aniigafi,su iha- to the offenseless; bhii.tefiu- living beings;yaf!.- the person; iigaskrt- commits offense; nirankusafi,- upstart; iiharta asmi-I shall bring forth; bhujam- arms;siikfiit-directly; amartyasya api-even one who is a demigod; siingadam-with decorations and armor.

TRANSLATION

An upstart living being who commits offenses by torturing those who are offenseless shall be directly uprooted by me, even though he be a denizen of heaven with armor and decorations.

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PURPORT

The denizens of the heavenly kingdom are called amaras, or deathless, due to their possessing a long span of life, far greater than that of the human beings. For a human being, who has only a maximum one hundred year duration of life, a span of life spreading over millions of years is certainly considered to be deathless. For example, from the Bhagavad-gitii we learn that on the Brahmaloka planet, the duration of one day is calculated to be 4,300,000 x 1,000 solar years. Similarly, in other heavenly

planets one day is calculated to be six months of this planet, and they get a life of ten million of their years. Therefore, in all higher planets, since the span of life is far greater than that of the human being, the denizens are called deathless by imagination, although actually no one within the material universe is deathless. ·

Maharaja Pan""k□it challenges even such denizens of heaven if they torture the offenseless. This means that the state executive head must be as strong as Maharaja Pa□it so that he may be determined to punish the strongest offenders. It should be the principle of a state executive head that the offender of the codes of God is always punished.

TEXT 16

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'lijffls;:ql;s: :qql\ll(l'lwtlqQ□qqlfwt' II□ □II\.:I

riijno hi paramo dharma[l

sva-dharma-s thii nupiilanam

Siisato 'nyiin yathii-siistram

aniipady utpathiin iha

riijna[l.-of the king or the executive head; hi-certainly; parama[l.

supreme; dharma[!.-occupational duty; sva-dharma-stha-one who is faithful to his prescribed duty; anupiilanam-giving protection always; siisata[l. while ruling over; anyiin-others; yathii-accordingly ; Siistram-rulings of scriptures; aniipadi-without danger; utpathiin-persons going astray; iha as a matter of fact.

TRANSLATION

It is the supreme duty of the ruling king to give all protection to law-abiding persons and to chastise those who stray from the ordinances of the scriptures in ordinary times, when there is no emergency.

Text 17) Punishment and Reward of Kali 895

PURPORT

In the scriptures there is mention of iipad-dharma, or occupational duty at times of extraordinary happenings. It is said sometimes that the great sage Visvamitra had to live on the flesh of dogs in some extraordinary

dangerous position. In cases of emergency, one may be allowed to live on the flesh of animals of all description, but that does not mean that there should be regular slaughterhouses to feed the animal eaters and that this system should be encouraged by the state. No one should try to live on flesh in ordinary times simply for the sake of the palate. If anyone does so, the king or the executive head should punish him for gross enjoyment. There are regular scriptural injunctions for different persons engaged in different occupational duties, and one who follows them is called sva-dharma-stha, or faithful in one's prescribed duties. In the Bhagavad gītā also (Bg. 18.48) it is advised that one should not give up his occupational prescribed duties, even if they are not always flawless. Such sva-dharma might be violated in cases of emergency, if one is forced by circumstances, but they cannot be violated in the ordinary times. The state executive head is to see that such sva-dharma is not changed by the follower, whatever it may be, and he should give all protection to the follower of sva-dharma. The violator is subject to punishment in terms of the śāstra, and it is the duty of the king to see that everyone strictly follows his occupational duty, as prescribed in the scripture.

TEXT 17

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dharma uviica

etat va[t piir-t)aveyiiniim

yuktam iirtiibhayam vaca[t

ye□iim gur-a-gar-aift kr\$TJ.O

dautyiidau bhagaviin kṛta[t

dharma[□, uviica- the personality of religion said; etat-all these; va[t-by

you; piir-t)aveyiiniim-of those who are in the Parp;lava dynasty; yuktam

just befitting; iirta- the sufferer; abhayam-freedom from all fears; vaca[l

speeches; ye□iim-those; gur-a-gar-ai[t-by the qualifications; kr\$TJ.aft-even

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Lord Kṛṣṇa; dautya-iidau- the duty of a messenger, etc.; bhagaviin- the Personality of Godhead; kṛtaḥ-performed.

TRANSLATION

The personality of religion said: These words just spoken by you befit a person of the Pāṇḍava dynasty. Captivated by the devotional qualities of the Pāṇḍavas, even Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, performed duties as a messenger.

PURPORT

The assurances and challenges made by Mahārāja Parīkṣit are never exaggerations of his real power. The Maharaja said that even the denizens of heaven could not escape his stringent government if they were violators of religious principles. He was not proud falsely because a devotee of the Lord is equally or sometimes more powerful than the Lord by His grace, and any promise made by a devotee, though it may be ordinarily very difficult to fulfill, is properly executed by the grace of the Lord. The Pāṇḍavas, by their unalloyed devotional service and full surrender unto the Lord, made it possible for the Lord to become a chariot driver or sometimes their letter messenger. Such duties executed by the Lord for His devotee are always very pleasing to the Lord because the Lord wants to render service to His unalloyed devotee whose life has no other engagement than to serve the Lord with full love and devotion. Mahārāja Parīkṣit, grandson of Arjuna, the celebrated friendly servitor of the Lord, was a pure devotee of the Lord like his grandfather, and therefore the Lord was always with him, even from the time when he was helplessly lying in the womb of his mother and was attacked by the blazing Brahmiṣṭra weapon of Aśvatthama. A devotee is always under the protection of the Lord, and therefore the assurance of protection by Mahārāja Paṇḍita could never be without meaning. The personality of religion accepted this fact and thus thanked the King for his being true to his exalted position.

TEXT 18

Text 18] Punishment and Reward of Kali

na vayam klesa-bljiini
yatal) syul) puruṣarṣabha
puruṣarh tam vijiinimo
viikya-bheda-vimohjtiil)

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na-not; vayam-we; klesa-bijiini-the root cause of sufferings; yatal)
wherefrom; syufl-it so happens; puruṣa-rṣabha-o greatest of all human
beings; puruṣam-the person; tam-that; vijiinimaṣ-know; viikya-bheda
difference of opinion; vimohitiiṣ-bewildered by.

TRANSLATION

o greatest among human beings, it is very difficult to ascertain the
particular miscreant who has caused our sufferings because we are bewil-
dered by all the different opinions of theoretical philosophers.

PURPORT

There are many theoretical philosophers in the world who put forward
their own theory of cause and effect especially about the cause of suffering
and its effect on different living beings. Generally there are six great
philosophers: Kaṣiida, the author of Vaisṣika philosophy; Gautama, the
author of logic; Pataijali, the author of mystic yoga; Kapila, the author
of Sankhya philosophy; Jaimini, the author of Karma-mimiirilsa; and
Vyasadeva, the author of Vedanta Darsana.

Although the bull, or the personality of religion, and the cow, the
personality of the earth, knew perfectly well that the personality of Kali
was the direct cause of their sufferings, still, as devotees of the Lord, they
knew well also that without the sanction of the Lord no one could inflict
trouble upon them. According to the Padma Puriirw, our present trouble
is due to the fructifying of seedling sins, but even those seedling sins also
gradually fade away by execution of pure devotional service. Thus even if
the devotees see the mischiefmongers, they do not accuse them for the
sufferings inflicted. They take it for granted that the mischiefmonger is
made to act by some indirect cause, and therefore they tolerate the
sufferings, thinking them to be God-given in small doses only, otherwise

the sufferings should have been greater.

Maharaja Parilubhita wanted to get a statement of accusation against the direct mischief monger, but they declined to give it on the above-mentioned grounds. Speculative philosophers, however, do not recognize the sanction of the Lord, but they try to find out the cause of sufferings in their own way, as will be described in the following verses. According to Śrī Jiva Gosvāmī, such speculators are themselves bewildered, and thus they cannot know that the ultimate cause of all causes is the Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead.

TEXT 19

□ M\$Nq('("fl 311\(\l□ +tl"ll'R'R! I

□□s□ □ □ □□□□□□□

kecid vikalpa-vasanii

iihur iitmiinam iitmanal;t

daivam anye pare karma

svabhiivam apare prabhum

kecit-some of them; vikalpa-vasaniil;t-those who deny all kinds of duality; iihul;t-declare; iitmiinam-own self; iitmanal;t-of the self; daivam superhuman; anye-others; apare-someone else; karma-activity; svabhiivam- material nature; apare-many other; prabhum-authorities.

TRANSLATION

Some of the philosophers, who deny all sorts of duality, declare that one's own self is responsible for his personal happiness and distress. Others say that superhuman powers are responsible, while yet others say that activity is responsible, and the gross materialists maintain that nature is the ultimate cause.

PURPORT

As referred to above, philosophers like Jaimini and his followers establish that fruitive activity is the root cause of all distress and happiness, and even if there is a superior authority, some superhuman powerful God or gods, He or they are also under the influence of fruitive activity because

they reward result according to one's action, and action is not independent because action is performed by some performer; therefore the performer himself is the cause of his own happiness or distress. In the Bhagavad-gitii Text 20) Punishment and Reward of Kali 899

also it is confirmed (Bg. 6.5) that by one's mind, freed from material affection, one can deliver himself from the sufferings of material pangs. So one should not entangle oneself in matter by the mind's material affections. Thus one's own mind is one's friend or enemy in one's material happiness and distress.

Atheistic materialistic Sankhyaite conclude that material nature is the cause of all causes. According to them, combinations of material elements are the causes of material happiness and distress, and disintegration of matter is the cause of freedom from all material pangs. Gautama and Kaṇvada find out that the atomic combination is the cause of everything, and impersonalists like Al'tavarkra discover that the spiritual effulgence of Brahman is the cause of all causes. But in the Bhagavad-gita the Lord Himself declares that He is the source of impersonal Brahman also, and therefore He, the Personality of Godhead, is the ultimate cause of all causes. It is also confirmed in the Brahma-sarhkhita that Lord Krṇṇa is the ultimate cause of all causes.

TEXT 20

3(S\ij'Hi-G>Mṇṇ·RJṇ ṇ RfṇFt: I

31SIIṇṇ ṇṇ ((1Y4"1l'tṇl llṇoll

apratarkyiid anirdesyiid

iti keṇv api niScaya{l.

atriinuruparh riijarṣe

vimrsa sva-maniṇayii

apratarkyit-beyond the power of reasoning; ani rdesyit-beyond the power of thinking; iti-thus; keṇu-someone ; api-also; niscaya{l.-definite ly concluded; atra-herein; anumpam-which of them is right; riijarṣe-o sage amongst the kings; vimrsa-judge yourself; sva-by your own; manlṣayii- power of intelligence.

TRANSLATION

There are also some thinkers who believe that no one can ascertain the cause of distress by argumentation, nor can one know it by imagination, nor can it be expressed by words. O sage amongst kings, judge for yourself by thinking over all this with your own intelligence.

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PURPORT

The Vaiṣṇavas or the devotees of the Lord do believe, as above explained, that nothing can take place without the sanction of the Supreme Lord. He is the supreme director, for He confirms in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 15.15) that He, as all-pervading Paramatma, stays in each and every one's heart and keeps vigilance over all actions and witnesses all activities. The argument of the atheist that one cannot be punished for one's misdeeds, unless proved before a qualified justice, is refuted herein, for we accept the perpetual witness and constant companion of the living being. A living being may forget all that he might have done in his past or present life, but one must know that in the same tree of the material body, the individual soul and the Supreme Soul as Paramatma are sitting like two birds. One of them, the living being, is enjoying¹ the fruits of the tree, whereas the Supreme Being is there to witness the activities. Therefore the Paramatma feature or the Supreme Soul is actually the witness of all activities of the living being, and by His direction only the living being can remember or forget what he might have done in the past. He is, therefore, both the all-pervading impersonal Brahman and the localized Paramatma in everyone's heart. He is the knower of all past, present and future, and nothing can be concealed from Him. The devotees know this truth, and therefore they discharge their duties sincerely, without being overly anxious for rewards. Besides that, one cannot estimate the Lord's reactions either by speculation or by scholarship. Why does He put some into difficulty and not others? He is the supreme knower of the Vedic knowledge, and thus He is the factual Vedantist. At the same time He is the compiler of the Vedānta. No one is independent of Him, and everyone is

engaged in His service in different ways. In the conditioned state, such services are rendered by the living being under force by the material nature, whereas in the liberated state the living being is helped by the spiritual nature in the voluntary loving service of the Lord. There is no incongruity or inebriety in His actions. All are on the path of Absolute Truth.

Bhlmadeva correctly estimated the inconceivable actions of the Lord. The conclusion is, therefore, that the sufferings of the representative of religion and the representative of the earth, as present before Maharaja PankJ?it, are planned in order to prove that Maharaja Pa□it was the ideal executive head, for he knew well how to give protection to the cows (the earth) and the briihma!las (religious principles), the two pillars of spiritual advancement. Everyone is under the full control of the Lord_ He is quite correct in His action when He desires something to be done by someone, irrespective of the consideration of the particular case. Maharaja PankJ?it Text 22) Punishment and Reward of Kali 901

was thus put to test for his greatness. Now let us see how he solves it by his sagacious mind.

TEXT 21

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(1+uf'-ijwt +r.m1 □: □□ □II□□ II

siita uviica

evam dharme p ravadati

sa samraf} dvija-sattamiifl

samiihitena manasii

vikhedafl paryaca□ta tam

siitafl uviica- Suta Gosvam! said; evam- so; dharme-the personality of religion; pravadati- thus having spoken; safl-he ; samriit-the Emperor; dvija-sattamiifl-o best among the briihmaras; samiihite na-with proper attention; manasii-by the mind; vikhedafl- without any mistake; paryaca□ta- coun terreplied; tam-unto him.

TRANSLATION

Suta Gosvami said: o best amongst the brahmanas, the Emperor
Pṛthvī, thus hearing the personality of religion speak, was fully satisfied,
and without mistake or regret he gave his reply.

PURPORT

The statement of the bull, the personality of religion, was full of
philosophy and knowledge, and the King was satisfied, since he could
understand that the suffering bull was not an ordinary one. Unless one is
perfectly conversant with the law of the Supreme Lord, one cannot speak
such things touching philosophical truths. The Emperor, being also on an
equal level of sagacity, replied to the point, without doubts or mistakes.

TEXT 22

o bull! you know

the religion and its principles

and you are speaking on the principles that if one knows

the location of irreligious acts,

one will know the perpetrator.

You are no other than the personality of religion.

[Canto I, Ch. 17

o bull! you know the religion and its principles; as you speak;

like one who knows the codes of religion; the

personality of religion; you are; in the disguise of a

bull; whatever; one who acts irreligiously; the

place; of the identifier; also; that; becomes.

TRANSLATION

The King said: o you, who are in the form of a bull! You know the
truth of religion, and you are speaking on the principles that if one knows
the location of irreligious acts, one will know the perpetrator. You are no
other than the personality of religion.

PURPORT

A devotee's conclusion is that no one is directly responsible to become a benefactor or mischiefmonger without the sanction of the Lord; therefore he does not consider anyone to be directly responsible for such action. But in both the cases he takes it for granted that either benefit or loss is God-sent, and thus it is His grace. In case of benefit, no one will deny it is God-sent, but in case of loss or reverses it becomes doubtful how the Lord could be so unkind to His devotee as to put him in great difficulty. Jesus Christ was seemingly put into such great difficulty, being crucified by the ignorant, but he was never angry at the mischiefmongers. That is the way of accepting a thing, either favorable or unfavorable. Thus for a devotee the identifier is equally a sinner, like the mischiefmonger. By God's grace, the devotee tolerates all reverses, and Maharaja Pañit observed this, and therefore he could understand that the bull was no other than the personality of religion himself. In other words, a devotee has no suffering at all because so-called suffering is also God's grace for a devotee who sees God in everything. They never placed any complaint before the King for being tortured by the personality of Kali, although everyone lodges such complaints before the state authorities. The extraordinary behavior of the bull made the King conclude that the bull was

Text 23) Punishment and Reward of Kali 903

certainly the personality of religion, otherwise no one could understand the finer intricacies of the codes of religion.

TEXT 23

Sl1m \Etid□•□• □ •a□(ino;cu 1

□ □.mq \ (61wtlfitkt □: □□□□II

athavii deva-miiyii.yii.

niinarh gati agocarii.

cetaso vacasas cii.pi

bhutiiniim iti niScaya□

athavii.-alternatively; deva-the Lord; miiyiiyii□-energies; nunam - very little; gati□-movement; agocarii- inconceivable; cetasa□-either by the mind; vacasa□-by words; ca-or; api-also; bhiitiniim-of aU living beings;

iti- thus; niScaya□- concluded.

TRANSLATION

Thus it is concluded that the Lord's energies are inconceivable. No one can estimate them by mental speculation or by word jugglery.

PURPORT

A question may be raised as to why a devotee should refrain from identifying an actor, although he knows definitely that the Lord is the ultimate doer of everything. Knowing the ultimate doer, one should not pose himself as ignorant of the actual performer. To answer this doubt, the reply is that the Lord is also not directly responsible because everything is done by His deputed miyyi-sakti, or material energy. The material energy is always provoking doubts about the supreme authority of the Lord. The personality of religion knew perfectly well that nothing can take place without the sanction of the Supreme Lord, and still he was put into doubts by the deluding energy, and thus he refrained from mentioning the supreme cause. This doubtfulness was due to the contamination of both Kali and the material energy. The whole atmosphere of the age of Kali is magnified by the deluding energy, and the proportion of measurement is inexplicable.

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TEXT 24

□cr.□□ (1□fIM qm: □ i(n: I

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tapa[!. saucarit daya satyam

iti padiifl. krte krta'{l.

adharmaritsais trayo bhagna[l.

smaya-sanga-madai's tava

tapafi,-austerity; saucam-cleanliness; daya-mercy; satyam-truthful

ness; iti-thus; padafi.-legs; krte-in the age of Satya; krta[!.-established;

adharma- irreligiosity; aritsai[l.-by the parts; trayafi.-three combined;

bhagna[l.-broken;smaya-pride; sanga-too much association with women;

madai[!.-intoxication; tava-your.

TRANSLATION

In the age of Satya [truthfulness] your four legs were established by the four principles of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. But it appears that three of your legs are broken due to rampant irreligion in the form of pride, lust for women, and intoxication.

PURPORT

The deluding energy, or material nature, can act upon the living beings proportionately in terms of the living beings' falling prey to the deluding attraction of miiyii. Moths are captivated by the glaring brightness of light, and thus they become a prey to the fire. Similarly, the deluding energy is always captivating the conditioned souls to become a prey to the fire of delusion, and the Vedic scriptures warn the conditioned souls not to become a prey to delusion but to get rid of it. The Vedas warn us not to go to the darkness of ignorance but to the progressive path of light. The Lord Himself also warns that the deluding power of material energy is too powerful to overcome, but one who completely surrenders unto the Lord can easily do so. But to surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord is also not very easy. Such surrender is possible by persons of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. These four principles of advanced civilization were remarkable features in the age of Satya. In that age, every human being was practically a qualified briihma[la of the Text 25) Punishment and Reward of Kali 905

highest order, and in the social orders of life they were all paramaharhsas, or the topmost in the renounced order. By cultural standing, the human beings were not at all subjected to the deluding energy. Such strong men of character were competent enough to get away from the clutches of miiyii. But gradually, and as the basic principles of brahminical culture, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, became curtailed by proportionate development of pride, attachment for women and intoxication, the path of salvation or the path of transcendental bliss retreated far, far away from the human society. With the progression of the age of Kali, people are becoming very proud, and attached to women

and intoxication. By the influence of the age of Kali, even a pauper is proud of his penny, the women are always dressed in an overly attractive fashion to victimize the minds of men, and the man is addicted to drinking wine, smoking, drinking tea and chewing tobacco, etc. All these habits, or so-called advancement of civilization, are the root causes of all irreligiosities, and therefore it is not possible to check corruption, bribery and nepotism. Man cannot check all these evils simply by statutory acts and police vigilance, but he can cure the disease of the mind by the proper medicine, namely advocating the principles of brahminical culture or the principles of austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. Modern civilization and economic development are creating a new situation of poverty and scarcity with the result of blackmailing the consumer's commodities. If the leaders and the rich men of the society spend fifty percent of their accumulated wealth mercifully for the misled mass of people and educate them in God consciousness or in the knowledge of Bhiigavatam, certainly the age of Kali will be defeated in its attempt to entrap the conditioned souls. We must always remember that false pride, or too high an estimation of one's own values of life, undue attachment to women or association with them, and intoxication will divert the human civilization from the path of peace, however much the people clamor for peace in the world. The preaching of the Bhiigavatam principles will automatically render all men practiced to austerity, clean both inside and outside, merciful to the suffering, and truthful in daily behavior. That is the way of correcting the flaws of human society which are very prominently exhibited at the present moment.

TEXT 25

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906 Srimad-Bhagavatam

idiinim dharma piidas te

satyam nirvartayed yata□

tam jighrk□aty adharmo 'yam

anrtenaidhita□ kali□

[Canto I, Ch. 17

idiinim-at the present moment; dharma-o personality of religion;
piidalt-legs; te-of you; satyam-truthfulness; nirvartayet-hobbling along
somehow or other; yataalt-whereby; tam-that; jighrk□ati-trying to
destroy; adharmalt-the personality of irreligion; ayam-this; anrtena-by
deceit; edhitalt-flourishing; kalilt-quarrel personified.

TRANSLATION

You are now standing on one leg only, which is your truthfulness, and
you are somehow or other hobbling along. But quarrel personified [Kali],
flourishing by deceit, is also trying to destroy that leg.

PURPORT

The principles of religion do not stand on some dogmas or manmade
formulas, but they stand on four primary regulative observances, namely
austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. The mass of people must be
educated to practice these principles from childhood. Austerity means to
accept voluntarily things which may not be very comfortable for the body
but are conducive for spiritual realization, for example, fasting. Fasting
twice or four times a month is a sort of austerity which may be voluntarily
accepted for spiritual realization only, and not for any other purposes,
political or otherwise. Fastings which are not meant for self-realization
but for some other purposes are condemned in the Bhagavad-gitii (Bg. 17.
56). Similarly, cleanliness is necessary both for the mind and the body.
Simply bodily cleanliness may help to some extent, but cleanliness of the
mind is necessary, and it is effected by glorifying the Supreme Lord. No
one can cleanse the accumulated mental dust without glorifying the Su
preme Lord. A godless civilization cannot cleanse the mind because it has
no idea of God, and for this simple reason people under such a civilization
cannot have good qualifications, however they may be materially equipped.
We have to see things by their resultant action. The resultant action of
human civilization in the age of Kali is dissatisfaction, so everyone is
anxious to get peace of mind. This peace of mind was complete in the Satya

Age because of the existence of the above-mentioned attributes of the human being. Gradually these attributes have diminished in the Treta-yuga Text 27] Punishment and Reward of Kali 907

to three fourths, in the Dvīpara to half, and in this age of Kali they are diminished to one fourth, which is also gradually diminishing on account of prevailing untruthfulness. By pride, either artificial or real, the resultant action of austerity is spoiled; by too much affection for female association, cleanliness is spoiled; by too much addiction to intoxication, mercifulness is spoiled; and by too much lying propaganda, truthfulness is spoiled. The revival of Bhīṣmavata-dharma can save the human civilization from falling a prey to evils of all description.

TEXT 26

□ □ i{fl□ ;:q•Ri□ □ m 1
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iyam ca bhiimir bhagavatī

nyīṣitoru-bharī sat!:

sr"imadbhis tat-padanyīṣai

sarvatab- kṛta-kautukī

iyam- this; ca-and; bhiimī□ - surface of the earth; bhagavatī-by the Personality of Godhead; nyīṣita- being performed personally as well as by others; urn-great; bhariī-burden; sat!:-being so done; sr"imadbhib--by the all-auspicious; tat-that; padanyīṣaib--footprints; sarvatab--all around; kṛta-done; kautukī-good fortune.

TRANSLATION

The burden of the earth was certainly diminished by the Personality of Godhead and by others as well. When He was present as an incarnation, all good was performed because of His auspicious footprints.

TEXT 27

□ □ □i\l□ijlijffl I
3UUAo:ql tqo□'II'SU: □□□ 'ltfffff.1□\91

socaty asru-kalī ṣīdhv"i

durbhagevojhitī sat!:

abrahmaJJyii nrpa-vyiiiii

siidrii bhok□yanti miim iti

908 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 17

socati-lamenting; asru-kalii--with tears in the eyes; siidhvz-the chaste;
durbhagii-as if the most unfortunate; iva-like; iijjhitii-forlorn; sati- being
so done; abrah ma!lyii[]- devoid of brahminical culture; nrpa-vyiiiii[] - posed
as the ruler; siidriilz-lower class; bhok□yanti-would enjoy; miim- me; iti
thus.

TRANSLATION

Now she, the chaste one, being unfortunately forsaken, as it were,
by the Personality of Godhead, laments her future with tears in her eyes,
for now she is being ruled and enjoyed by lower class men who pose as
rulers.

PURPORT

The kṣatriya, or the man who is qualified to protect the sufferers, is
meant to rule the state. Untrained lower class men, or men without
ambition to protect the sufferers, cannot be placed on the seat of an
administrator. Unfortunately, in the age of Kali the lower class men,
without training, occupy the post of a ruler by strength of popular
votes, and instead of protecting the sufferers, such men create a situation
quite intolerable for everyone. Such rulers illegally gratify themselves at
the cost of all comforts of the citizens, and thus the chaste mother earth
cries to see the pitiable condition of her sons, both men and animals. That
is the future of the world in the age of Kali when irreligiosity prevails
most prominently. And in the absence of a suitable king to curb irreligious
tendencies, educating the people systematically in the teaching of Srimad
Bhagavatam will clear up the hazy atmosphere of corruption, bribery,
blackmailing, etc.

TEXT28

□ □ 'ift □ (ii□N□I □: I

f;atalil'i□□ u w□silli□□ □□□□□□

iti dharmam mahzm caiva

siintvayitvii mahii-rathalz

niSiitam iidade khangarh

kalaye 'dharma-hetave

iti-thus; dharmam-the personality of religion; mahim-the earth; ca

also; eva-as; siintvayitvii-after pacifying; mahii-ratha□-the general who

Text 29] Punishment and Reward of Kali 909

could fight alone with thousands of enemies; n isiitam-sharp; iidade-took

up; khmigam-sword; kalaye-to kill the personified Kali; adharma

irreligion; hetave-the root cause.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pa□it, who could fight one thousand enemies single

handedly, thus pacified the personality of religion and the earth. Then he

took up his sharp sword to kill the personality of Kali, who is the cause

of all irreligion.

PURPORT

As described above, the personality of Kali is he who deliberately

commits all kinds of sinful acts which are forbidden in the revealed

scriptures. This age of Kali will certainly be full of all activities of Kali,

but this does not mean that the leaders of society, the executive heads,

the learned and intelligent men, or above all the devotees of the Lord

shall sit down tight and become callous to the reactions of the age of

Kali. In the rainy season certainly there will be profuse rainfalls, but that

does not mean that men should not take means to protect themselves

from the rains. It is the duty of the executive heads of state and others

to take all necessary actions against the activities of Kali or the persons

influenced by the age of Kali; and Maharaja Pan□it is the ideal executive

head of the state, for he became at once ready to kill the personality of

Kali with his sharp sword. The administrators should not simply pass

resolutions for anticorruptional steps, but they must be ready with sharp

sword to kill the persons creating corruptions from the angle of vision of

the recognized Siistras. The administrators cannot prevent corrupt activities

by allowing wine shops. They must at once close all shops of intoxicating

drugs and wine and force punishment even by death for those who indulge in the habit of intoxication of all description. That is the way of stopping the activities of Kali, as exhibited herein by Maharaja Parikṣit, the mahii-ratha.

TEXT29

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tarh jighii.rhsum abhipretya

vihii.ya nrpa-liinchanam

tat-pii.da-miilam sirasii.

samagii.d bhaya-vihvala□

[Canto 1, Ch. 17

tam- him; jighiirhsu m- willing to kill; abhipretya- knowing it well;
vihiiya- leaving aside; nrpa-liinchanam-the dress of a king; tat-pii.da
miilam-at his feet; sirasii - by the head; samagiit-fully surrendered;
bhaya- vihvala□- under pressure of fearfulness.

TRANSLATION

When the personality of Kali rmdrstood that the King was willing to kill him, he at once abandoned the dress of a king, and, under pressure of fear, completely surrendered to him, bowing his head.

PURPORT

The royal dress of the personality of Kali is artificial. The royal dress is suitable for a king or kṣatriya, but when a lower class man artificially dresses himself as a king, his real identity is disclosed by the challenge of a bona fide kṣatriya like Maharaja Parikṣit. A real kṣatriya never surrenders. He accepts the challenge of his rival kṣatriya, and he fights either to die or to win. Surrender is unknown to a real kṣatriya. In the age of Kali there are so many pretenders dressed and posed like administrators or executive heads, but their real identity is disclosed when they are challenged by a real kṣatriya. Therefore when the artificially dressed personality of Kali saw that to fight Maharaja Panṣit was beyond his capacity, he bowed

down his head like a subordinate and gave up his royal dress.

TEXT 30

qftffl QIGA1+ft(: fJRI (\..4«te: I

□□Q□□□□□oll"

patitam piidayor v"ira□

krpayii. dlina-vatsala□

sarar-yo niivadh"ic chlokya

aha cedam hasann iva

Text 31) Punishment and Reward of Kali 911

patitam-fallen down; piidayo□-at the feet; vira□-the hero; krpayii

out of compassion; dlina- vatsala□- kind to the poor; sara[Lya□-one who is

qualified to accept surrender; na-not; avadhit-did kill; slokya□-one who

is worthy of being sung; iiha-said; ca-also; idam- this; hasan-smiling;

iva- like.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Pa□it, who was qualified to accept surrender and worthy

of being sung in history, did not kill the poor surrendered and fallen Kali,

but smiled compassionately, for he was kind to the poor.

PURPORT

Even an ordinary kṣatriya does not kill a surrendered person, and what

to speak of Maharaja Pa□it, who was by nature compassionate and kind

to the poor. He was smiling because the artificially dressed Kali disclosed

his identity as a lower class man, and he was thinking how ironic it was

that no one was saved from his sharp sword when he desired to kill, but the

poor lower class Kali was spared by his timely surrender. Maharaja Pa□it's

glory and kindness is therefore sung in history. He was a kind and com

passionate emperor, fully worthy of accepting surrender even from his

enemy. Thus the personality of Kali was saved by the will of Providence.

TEXT 31

riijo viica

na te gu!liikesa-yaio-dharii[Liim

baddhiiiijaler vai bhayam asti kiicit'

na vartitavyam bhavatii kathancana

kṣetre madlye tvam adharma-bandhuḥ

912 Snmad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 17

sri raja uvaca- the King said; na-not; te-your ; guṇakesa-Arjuna; yaia[
dharli!-lim-of you who inherited the fame; baddhanjale[1-one with folded
hands; vai-certainly; bhayam-fear; asti-there is; kincit-even a slight;
na-neither; vartitavyam-can be allowed to live; bhavata-by you;
kathancana-by all means; kṣetre-in the land; madiye-in my kingdom;
tvam-you; adharma-bandhu[1-the friend of irreligion.

TRANSLATION

The King thus said: We have inherited the fame of Arjuna; therefore
since you have surrendered yourself with folded hands you need not fear
for your life. But you cannot remain in my kingdom, for you are the friend
of irreligion.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali, who is the friend of all kinds of irreligiosities,
may be excused if he surrenders, but in all circumstances he cannot be
allowed to live as a citizen in any part of a welfare state. The Papavas
were entrusted representatives of the Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛpā,
who practically brought into being the Battle of Kuruṣetra, but not for
any personal interest. He wanted that an ideal King like Maharaja
Yudhiṣṭhira and his descendants like Maharaja Palāṅkita should rule the
world, and therefore a responsible king like Maharaja Palāṅkita cannot allow
the friend of irreligiosity to flourish in his kingdom at the cost of the good
fame of the Papavas. That is the way of wiping out corruption in the state,
and not otherwise. The friends of irreligiosity should be banished from the
state, and that will save the state from corruption.

TEXT 32

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iiimJ ḥ +t1ll1 ḥ ḥ: IIḥ ḥII

tvīm vartamlinam nara-deva-dehe□v

anupravṛtto 'yam adharma-piiga[l

lobho 'nṛtam cauryam anāryam arhho

jyeṣṭha ca maya kalahas ca dambha[l

Text 33] Punishment and Reward of Kali 913

tvam- you; vartamanam-while present; nara-deva-a man-god, or a king; deheṣu- in the body; anupravṛtta□- beginning all over; ayam-all these; adharma- irreligious principles; piiga□- in the masses; lobha□ greed; anṛtam- falsity; cauryam- robbery; anāryam-incivility; arhha□ treachery; jyeṣṭha- misfortune; ca- and; maya-cheating; kalaha□ - quarrel; ca-and; dambha□ - vanity.

TRANSLATION

If the personality of Kali or irreligion is allowed to act as a man-god or an executive head, certainly irreligious principles like greed, falsehood, robbery, incivility, treachery, misfortune, cheating, quarrel and vanity will abound.

PURPORT

The principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, as we have already discussed, may be followed by the follower of any faith. There is no need of turning the coat of a Hindu to Mohammedan to Christian or some other faith and thus become a renegade without following the principles of religion. The Bhīṣmavataṁ religion urges following the principles of religion. The principles of religion are not the dogmas or regulative principles of a certain faith. Such regulative principles may be different in terms of the time and place concerned. One has to see whether the aims of religion have been achieved. Sticking to the dogmas and formulas without attaining the real principles is no good. A secular state may be impartial to any particular type of faith, but the state cannot be indifferent to the principles of religion as above mentioned. But in the age of Kali, the executive heads of state will be indifferent to such religious principles, and therefore under their patronage the opponents of religious principles, namely greed, falsehood, cheating, pilfering, etc., will naturally

follow, and so there is no meaning in a propaganda crying to stop corruption in the state.

TEXT 33

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914 Srimad-Bhigav atam

na vartitavyarh tad adharma-bandh o

darmerta satyena ca vartitavye

brahmiivarte yatra yajanti yajiiair

yajiiiesvararh yajiiia-vitiina-vijiiiitt

[Canto 1, Ch. 17

na-not; vartitavyam-deserve to remain; tat-therefore; adharma
irreligiosity; bandho-friend; dharmerta-with religion; satyena-with
truth; ca-also; vartitavye-being situated in; brahmiivarte-place where
sacrifice is performed; yatra-where; yajanti-duly perform; yajiiiaitt-by
sacrifices or devotional services; yajiiiesvaram- unto the Supreme Lord, the
Personality of Godhead; yajiiia-sacrifice; vitiina- spreading; vijiiiifr.-experts.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, o friend of irreligion, you do not deserve to remain in a
place where experts perform sacrifices according to truth and religious
principles for the satisfaction of the Supreme Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Yajiiesvara, or the Supreme Personality of Godhead, is the beneficiary
of all kinds of sacrificial ceremonies. Such sacrificial ceremonies are pre-
scribed differently in the scriptures for different ages. In other words,
sacrifice means to accept the supremacy of the Lord and-thereby perform
acts by which the Lord may be satisfied in all respects. The atheists do not
believe in the existence of God, and they do not perform any sacrifice for
the satisfaction of the Lord. Any place or country where the supremacy
of the Lord is accepted and thus sacrifice is performed is called brahmiivar

ta. There are different countries in different parts of the world, and each and every country may have different types of sacrifice to please the Supreme Lord, but the central point in pleasing Him is ascertained in the Bhiigavatam, and it is truthfulness. The basic principle of religion is truthfulness, and the ultimate goal of all religions is to satisfy the Lord. In this age of Kali, the greatest common formula of sacrifice is the sankirtarw yajiia. That is the opinion of the experts who know how to propagate the process of yajiia. Lord Caitanya preached this method of yajiia, and it is understood from this verse that anywhere and everywhere the sacrificial method of sankirtana-yajiia may be performed in order to drive a way the Text 34] Punishment and Reward of Kali 915

personality of Kali and save the human society from falling prey to the influence of the age.

TEXT 34

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cmr-□□ M(&f¥\RI-

"R□□ftit1□□" 3lmR 11□\111

yasmin harir bhagaviin iyyamiina

ijyitma-murtir yajatiim sam tanoti

kiimiin amoghiin sthira-jangamiiniim

an tar bahir viiyur-iva□a iitmii

yasmin-in such sacrificial ceremonies; hari□- the Supreme Lord;

bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead; iyyamiina□-being worshiped;

ijya-iitma- the soul of all worshipable deities; murti□-in the forms;

yajatiim-those who worship; Sam-welfare; tanoti-spreads; kiimiin-de

sires; amoghiin-inviolable; sthira-jangamiiniim-of all the moving and the

unmoving; anta□- within; bahi□-outside; viiyu□- air; iva-like; e□a□-of all of them; iitmii-spirit soul.

TRANSLATION

In all sacrificial ceremonies, although sometimes a demigod is worshiped, the Supreme Lord Personality of Godhead is worshiped because

He is the Supersoul of everyone, and exists both inside and outside like the air. Thus it is He only who awards all welfare to the worshiper.

PURPORT

It is even sometimes seen that demigods like Indra, Candra, etc., are worshiped and offered sacrificial awards, yet the rewards of all such sacrifices are awarded to the worshiper by the Supreme Lord, and it is the Lord only who can offer all welfare to the worshiper. The demigods, although worshiped, cannot do anything without the sanction of the Lord because the Lord is the Supersoul of everyone, both moving and nonmoving.

916 Srimad-Bhagavatam

TEXT 35

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[Canto 1, Ch. 17

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□an&WaQa(□□□□□□

sri suta uviica

panlc□itaivam iid□ ta{l

sa kalir jiita-vepathu{l

tam udyatiisim iihedarh

da"!lpa-pii"!lim ivodyatam

sri suta{l uviica- Sri Siita Gosvami said; pan7c□itii-by Maharaja Parik□it; evam-thus; iid□tafl-being ordered; sa{l-he; kali{l-the personality of Kali; jiita-there was; vepathu{l- trembling; tam-him; udyatii- raised up; asim sword; iiha-said; idam-thus; da[lpa-pii"!lim-Yamaraja, the personality of death; iva-like; udyatam-almost ready.

TRANSLATION

Sri Suta Gosvami said: The personality of Kali, thus being ordered by Maharaja Pa□it, began to tremble in fear. Seeing the King before him like Yamaraja, ready to kill him, Kali spoke to the King as follows.

PURPORT

The King was ready to kill him at once as soon as the personality of Kali would disobey his order. Otherwise the King had no objection to allow him to prolong his life. The personality of Kali also, after attempting to get rid of the punishment in various ways, decided that he must surrender unto him, and thus he began to tremble in fear of his life. The King, or the executive head, must be so strong as to stand before the personality of Kali as the personality of death, Yamaraja. The King's order must be obeyed, otherwise the culprit's life is in risk. That is the way to rule the personalities of Kali who create disturbance in the normal life of the state citizens.

TEXT 36

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Text 37] Punishment and Reward of Kali

kalir uviica

yatra kva viitha vatsyiimi

siirva-bhauma taviijnayii

lak□aye tatra tatriipi

tviiim iitte□u-sariisanam

917

kalifi. uviica-the personality of Kali said; yatra-anywhere; kva-and everywhere; vii-either; atha-thereof; vatsyiimi-1 shall reside; siirva bhauma-o Lord (or Emperor) of the earth; tava-your; ajnayii-by the order;lak□aye-1 see; tatra-anywhere and everywhere; tatriipi-also; tviiim your Majesty; iitta-taken over; i□u-arrows; sariisanam- bows.

TRANSLATION

o Your Majesty, though I may live anywhere and everywhere under your order, I shall but see you with bow and arrows wherever I look.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali could see that Maharaja Parik□it was the emperor of all lands all over the world, and thus anywhere he might live he would

have to meet with the same. The personality of Kali was meant for mischief, and Maharaja Pāṇit was meant for subduing all kinds of mischiefmongers, especially the personality of Kali. It was better, therefore, for the personality of Kali to have been killed by the King then and there instead of being killed elsewhere. He was, after all, a surrendered soul before the King, and it was for the King to do what was required.

TEXT 37

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tan me dharma-bhrtiim sretha

sthiinam nirde tum arhasi

yatraiva niyato vatsya

iiti thams te 'nusiisan6m

tat-therefore; me-me; dharma-bhrtiim-of all the protectors of religion;

sretha-the chief; sthiinam-place; nirde tum-fix; arhasi-may you do so;.

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yatra-where; eva-certainly; niyata[t-always; vatsye-can reside; ati fhan

permanently situated; te-your; anuslisanam-under your rule.

TRANSLATION

Therefore, O chief amongst the protectors of religion, please fix some place for me where I can live permanently under the protection of your government.

PURPORT

The personality of Kali addressed Maharaja Pāṇit as the chief amongst the protectors of religiosity because the King refrained from killing a person who surrendered unto him. A surrendered soul should be given all protection, even though he may be an enemy. That is the principle of religion. And we can just imagine what sort of protection is given by the Personality of Godhead to the person who surrenders unto Him, not as an enemy but as a devoted servitor. The Lord protects the surrendered soul from all sins and all resultant reactions of sinful acts. (Bg. 18.66)

TEXT 38

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□ qr.f □: Qffl □□□: II □□II

siita uviica

abhyarthitas tādii tasmai

sthiiniini kalaye dadau

dyiitarh piinarh striya[l siinii

yatriidharma.S catur-vidha[l

siitafl uviica-Sii ta Gosvarrii said; abhyarthitafl-thus being petitioned;
tādii-at that time; tasmai-unto him; sthiiniini-places; kalaye-to .the
personality of Kali; dadau- gave him permission; dyiitam- gambling;
piinam-drinking; striya[t-illicit association of women; siiniip-animal
slaughter; yatra-whenever; adharmap-sinful activi ties; catur-vidhafl-four
kinds of.

Text 38) Punishment and Reward of Kali 919

TRANSLATION

Siita Gosvimi said: Maharaja Parik. !jit, thus being petitioned by the
personality of Kali, gave him permission to reside in places where gambling,
drinking, prostitution and animal s laughter were performed.

PURPORT

The basic principles of irreligiosity, such as pride, prostitution, intoxica
tion and falsehood, counteract the four principles of religion, namely
austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness. The personality of Kali was
given permission to live in four places particularly mentioned by the King,
namely the place of gambling, the place of prostitution, the place of
drinking and the place of animal slaughter.

Srila Jiva Gosvami directs that drinking against the principles of scrip
tures, such as the Sautriima!li-yajii.a, etc., association with women outside
marriage, and killing animals against the injunctions of scripture, are
irreligious. In the Vedas two different types of injunctions are there for
the pravrttas, or those who are engaged in material enjoyment, and for the
nivrttas, or those who are liberated from material bondage. The Vedic

injunction for the pravrttas is to gradually regulate their activities towards the path of liberation. Therefore, for those who are in the lowest stage of ignorance and indulge in wine, woman and flesh, drinking by performing Sautriimari-yajña, association of woman by marriage and flesh-eating by sacrifices are sometimes recommended. But such recommendations in the Vedic literature are meant for a particular class of men, and not for all. But because there are injunctions of the Vedas for particular types of persons, such activities by the pravrttas are not considered adharmas. One man's food may be poison for others; similarly, what is recommended for those in the modes of ignorance may be poison for those in the modes of goodness. Srila Jiva Gosvami Prabhu, therefore, affirms that recommendations in the scriptures for a certain class of men are never to be considered adharmas, or irreligious. But such activities are factually adharmas, and they are never to be encouraged. The recommendations in the scriptures are not meant for encouragement of such adharmas, but for regulating the necessary adharmas gradually toward the path of dharma.

Following in the footsteps of Maharaja Panit, it is the duty of all executive heads of states to see that the principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, are established in the state

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and the principles of irreligion, namely pride, illicit female association or prostitution, intoxication and falsity be checked by all means. And to make the best use of a bad bargain, -the personality of Kali may be transferred to places of gambling, drinking, prostitution and slaughterhouses, if there are any places like that. Those who are addicted to these irreligious habits may be regulated by the injunctions of the scripture. In all circumstances they should not be encouraged by any state. In other words, the state should categorically stop all sorts of gambling, drinking, prostitution and falsity. The state which wants to eradicate corruption by majority may introduce the principles of religion in the following manner:

1. Two compulsory fasting days in a month, if not more (austerity).

Even from the economic point of view, such two fasting days in a month

in the state will save tons of food, and the system will also act very favorably on the general health of the citizens.

2. There must be compulsory marriage of young boys and girls attaining twenty-four years of age and sixteen years of age respectively. There is no harm in coeducation in the schools and colleges provided the boys and girls are duly married, and in case there is any intimate connection between a male and female student, they should be married properly without illicit relation. The divorce act is encouraging prostitution, and this should be abolished.

3. The citizens of the state must give in charity up to fifty percent of their income for the purpose of creating a spiritual atmosphere in the state or in the human society, both individually and collectively. They should preach the principles of Bhiigavatam by a) karma-yoga or doing everything for the satisfaction of the Lord, b) regular hearing of the Srimad Bhiigavatam from authorized persons or realized souls, c) chanting of the glories of the Lord congregationally at home or at places of worship, d) rendering all kinds of service to Bhiigavatas engaged in preaching Srimad Bhiigavatam, and e) residing in a place where the atmosphere is saturated with God consciousness. If the state is regulated by the above process, naturally there will be God consciousness everywhere.

Gambling of all description, even speculative business enterprises, is considered to be degrading, and by encouraging gambling in the state, there is a complete disappearance of truthfulness. Allowing young boys and girls to remain unmarried more than the above-mentioned ages and license for animal slaughter houses of all description should be at once prohibited. The flesh-eaters may be allowed to take flesh as is mentioned in the scriptures, and not otherwise. Intoxication of all description, even the smoking of cigarettes, the chewing of tobacco or drinking of tea, must be prohibited.

Text 39] Punishment and Reward of Kali

TEXT 39

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puna.S ca yiicamiiniiya

jiita-rupam adiit prabhuf

tato 'nrtam madam kiimam

rajo vairam ca paicamam

921

punaft-again; ca-also; yiicamiiniiya-to the beggar; jiita-riipam-gold;
adiit-gave away; prabhuf-the king; tataft- whereby; anrtam-falsehood;
madam-intoxication; kiimam-lust; raja"ft-on account of a passionate
mood; vairam-enmity; ca-also; paicamam-the fifth one.

TRANSLATION

The personality of Kali asked for something more, and because of his
begging, the King gave him permission to live where there is gold because
wherever there is gold there is also falsity, intoxication, lust, envy and
enmity.

PURPORT

Although Maharaja Pan""kl?it gave Kali permission to live in four places,
it was very difficult for him to find the places because during the reign of
Maharaja P□it there were no such places. Therefore Kali asked the King
to give him something practical which could be utilized for his nefarious
purposes. Maharaja Pan""kl?it thus gave him permission to live in a place
where there is gold, because wherever there is gold there are all the above
mentioned four things, and over and above them there is enmity also.

So the personality of Kali became gold standardized. According to Srimad
Bhiigavatam, gold encourages falsity, intoxication, prostitution, envy and
enmity. Even a gold standard exchange and currency is bad. Gold standard
currency is based on falsehood because currency is not on a par with the
reserved gold. The basic principle is falsity because currency notes are
issued more in value than the actual reserved gold. This artificial inflation
of currency by the authorities encourages prostitution of state economy.
The price of commodities becomes artificially inflated because of bad
money or artificial currency notes. Bad money drives away good money.

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Instead of paper currency, actual gold coins should be used for exchange, and this will stop prostitution of gold. Gold ornaments for women may be allowed by control, not by quality, but by quantity. This will discourage lust, envy and enmity. When there is actual gold currency in the form of coins, the influence of gold in producing falsity, prostitution; etc., will automatically cease. There will be no need of an anticorruption ministry for another term of prostitution and falsity of purpose.

TEXT₄₀

qf.l qif □f.l alilhi¥1□: □: 1

an□{□oa □ □□Q((<□NT<□i((ll\loll

amuni paiica sthiiniini hy

adharmā-prabhavaly. kalily.

auttareye[la dattiini

nyavasat tan-nidesakrt

amuni-all those; panca-five; sthiiniini- places; hi-certainly; adharmā
irreligious principles; prabhavaly.-encouraging; kalily.-the age of Kali;
auttareye[la-by the son of Uttara; dattiini- delivered; nyavasat-dwelt;
tat-by him; niddakrt- directed.

TRANSLATION

Thus the personality of Kali, by the directions of Maharaja Par□it,
the son of Uttara, was allowed to live in those five places.

PURPORT

Thus the age of Kali began with gold standardization, and therefore
falsity, intoxication, animal slaughter and prostitution are rampant all over
the world, and the saner section is eager to drive out corruption. The
counteracting process is suggested above, and everyone can take advantage
of this suggestion.

TEXT₄₁

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Text 41] Punishment and Reward of Kali

athaitiini na seveta

bubhii□ul;l puru□al;l kvacit

viSe□ato dharma-suo

riijii loka-patir gurul;l

923

atha-therefore; etani-all these; na- never; seveta- come in contact;

bubhilfiu□- those who desire well-being; purufia□-person; kvacit-in any

circumstances; viS efiata □- specifically; dha rma -sllal;l-those who are on the

progressive path of liberation; riijii-the king; loka-patil;l-public leader;

gum□-the brtihmafi-as and the sannytisis.

TRANSLATION

Therefore whoever desires progressive well-being, especially kings, religionists, public leaders, brahma!las and sanniyasis, should never come in contact with the four above-mentioned irreligious principles.

PURPORT

The briihmafla is the religious preceptor for all other castes, and the sanniyiis are the spiritual masters for all the castes and orders of society. So also are the king and the public leaders who are responsible for the material welfare of all people. The progressive religionists and those who are responsible human beings or those who do not want to spoil their valuable human lives should refrain from all the principles of irreligiosity, especially from illicit connection with women. If a briihmafla is not truth ful, all his claims as a brahmafi.a at once become null and void. If a sanniyasi is illicitly connected with women, all his claims as a sanniyisi at once become false. Similarly, if the king and the public le□der are unnecessarily proud or habituated to drinking and smoking, certainly they become disqualified to discharge public welfare activities. Truthfulness is the basic principle for all religions. The four leaders of the human society, namely the sanniyisi, the brtihmafla, the king and the public leader, must be tested crucially by their character and qualification. Before one can be accepted as a spiritual or material master of society, he must be tested by the above-mentioned criteria of character. Such public leaders may be

less qualified in academic qualifications, but it is necessary primarily that they are free from the contamination of the four disqualifications, namely gambling, drinking, prostitution and animal slaughter.

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TEXT₄₂

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stRt□ « 311\IIW -'ltf =if eYHtit□d\ □□□□U

vr□asya □tams trin padiin

tapafI saucam dayam iti

pratisandadha asvasya

mah1m ca samavardhayat

vr\$asya-of the hull (the personality of religiosity); na\$tan-lost; bin three; padiin- legs ; tapafI- austerity ; saucam- cleanliness ; dayam- mercy ; iti- etc.; pratisandadhe- reestablished; asvasya- by encouraging activities; mah1m-the earth; ca- and; samavardhayat-perfectly improved.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter the King reestablished the lost legs of the personality of religion [the bull], and by encouraging activities he sufficiently improved the condition of the earth.

PURPORT

By designating particular places for the personality of Kali, Maharaja Parik□?it practically cheated Kali. In the presence of Kali, Dharma (in the shape of a hull), and the earth (in the shape of a cow), he could actually estimate the general condition of his kingdom, and therefore he at once took proper steps to reestablish the legs of the hull, namely austerity, cleanliness and mercy. And for the general benefit of the people of the world, he saw .that the gold stock might he employed for stabilization. Gold is certainly a generator of falsity, intoxication, prostitution, enmity and violence, hut under the guidance of a proper king or public leader or a briihmar-a or sannyyiis□ the same gold can he properly utilized to reestablish the lost legs of the bull, the personality of religion.

Maharaja P□it, therefore, like his grandfather Arjuna, collected all

illicit gold kept for the propensities of Kali and employed it in the sankirtana-yajña, as per instruction of the Srimad-Bhāgavatam. As we have suggested before, one's accumulated wealth may be divided in three parts for distribution, namely fifty percent for the service of the Lord, twenty five percent for the family members and twenty-five percent for personal necessities. Spending fifty percent for the service of the Lord or for propagation of spiritual knowledge in society by way of the sankirtana yajña is the maximum display of human mercy. People of the world are generally in darkness regarding spiritual knowledge, especially in regard to devotional service of the Lord, and therefore to propagate the systematic transcendental knowledge of devotional service is the greatest mercy that one can show in this world. When everyone is taught to sacrifice fifty percent of his accumulated gold for the Lord's service, certainly austerity, cleanliness and mercy automatically ensue, and thus the lost three legs of the personality of religion are automatically established. When there is sufficient austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, naturally mother earth is completely satisfied, and there is very little chance for Kali to infiltrate the structure of human society.

TEXTS 43-44

tī kṛtīṣv itīṣv itīṣv itīṣv I
 fcmqt;flq (l\$1(w.f
 ii: itlee' (1
 11111 u1a: 11111
 sa eṣa etarhy adhyiṣṭa
 iṣṇam pīrthivocitā
 pīṭimāhenopanyastam
 rījīrīryam vivikṣatī
 iṣṭe 'dhunī sa rījarṣ*
 kauravendra-sriyollāsan
 gajīhvaye mahī-bhaga
 cakravartī brhac-chravī

sa□-he; eṣa□-this; etarhi-at the present; adhyiiste-is ruling over;
iisanam-the throne; piirthiva-ucitam-just befitting a king; pitiimahena
by the grandfather; upanyastam-being handed over; riijfiii-by the king;
araryam-forest; vivik}atii-desiring; iiste-is there; adhunii-at present;
sa[l-that; riijar□ip-the sage amongst the kings; kauravendra-the chief
amongst the Kuru kings; .Sriyii-glories; ullasan-spreading; gajiihvaye-in
Hastinapura; mahii-bhiigap-the most fortunate; cakravarti-the Emperor;
brhat-sravii[l-highly famous.

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TRANSLATION

The most fortunate Emperor Maharaja Pa□it, who was entrusted
with the kingdom of Hastinapura by Maharaja Yu□thira when he desired
to retire to the forest, is now ruling the world with great success due to his
being glorified by the deeds of the kings of the Kuru dynasty.

PURPORT

The prolonged sacrificial ceremonies undertaken by the sages of
Naimi□ara□ya were begun a very little after the demise of Maharaja
Pan□it. The sacrifice was to continue for one thousand years, and it is
understood that in the beginning some of the contemporaries of Baladeva,
the elder brother of Lord Kr□□a, also visited the sacrificial place. According
to some authorities, the present tense is also used to indicate the nearest
margin of time from the past. In that sense, the present tense is applied to
the reign of Maharaja Parikl?it here. For a continuous fact, also, present
tense can be used. The principles of Maharaja Pan"□it can be still continued,
and human society can still be improved if there is determination by the
authorities. We can still purge out from the state all the activities of
immorality introduced by the personality of Kali if we are determined to
take action like Maharaja Parik□it. He allotted some place for Kali, but in
fact Kali could not find such places in the world at all because Maharaja
Pan□it was strictly vigilant to see that there were no places for gambling,
drinking, prostitution and animal slaughter. Modern administrators want
to banish corruption from the state, but fools as they are, they do not

know how to do it. They want to issue licenses for gambling houses, wine and other intoxicating drug houses, brothels and hotel prostitution and cinema houses, and falsity in every dealing, even in their own, and they want at the same time to drive out corruption from the state. They want the kingdom of God without God consciousness. How can it be possible to adjust two contradictory matters? If we want to drive out corruption from the state, we must first of all organize society to accept the principles of religion, namely austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, and to make the condition favorable we must close all places of gambling, drinking, prostitution and falsity. These are some of the practical lessons from the pages of Srimad-Bhagavatam.

TEXT 45

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□ q□: □ Ti □ <Of□: ll'd'-\11

Text 45) Punishment and Reward of Kali

ittham-bhiitanubhiivo 'yam

abhimanyu-suto nrpa□

yasya piilayata□ k□au{lim

yiiyam satriiya dik□itii□

927

ittham-bhiita-being thus; anubhiiva□-experience; ayam-of this;

abhimanyu-suta□-son of Abhimanyu; nrpa□-the king; yasya-whose;

piilayata□-on account of his ruling; k□au{lim-on the earth; yiiyam-you

all; satriiya-in performing sacrifices; dik□ita□-initiated.

TRANSLATION

Ma haraja Pan□t, the son of Abhimanyu, is so experienced that by dint of his expert administration and patronage, it has been possible for you to perform a sacrifice such as this.

PURPORT

The brāhmaṇas and the sannyāsīs are expert in spiritual advancement of society, whereas the kṣātriyas or the administrators are expert in the material peace and prosperity of human society. Both of them are the

pillars of all happiness, and therefore they are meant for full cooperation for common welfare. Maharaja Panini was experienced enough to drive away Kali from his field of activities and thereby make the state receptive to spiritual enlightenment. If the common people are not receptive, it is very difficult to impress upon them the necessity of spiritual enlightenment. Austerity, cleanliness, mercy and truthfulness, the basic principles of religion, prepare the ground for the reception of advancement of spiritual knowledge, and Maharaja Panini made this favorable condition possible. Thus the sages of Naimisharanya were able to perform the sacrifices for a thousand years. In other words, without state support, no doctrines of philosophy or religious principles can progressively advance. There should be complete cooperation between the brahmanas and the ksatriyas for this common good. Even up to Maharaja Asoka, the same spirit was prevailing. Lord Buddha was sufficiently supported by King Asoka, and thus his particular cult of knowledge was spread all over the world. Thus end the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Seventeenth Chapter, of the Srimad-Bhagavatam, entitled «Punishment and Reward of Kali."

CHAPTER EIGHTEEN

Maharaja Parikṣit cursed by a Brahmaa Boy

TEXT I

śrī :acr

śrī śrī śrī wt(lfin it śrī 'ldē\l śrī 1

q śrī śrī : t;WI śrī I&ij4iaiut: II śrī II

siita uviica

yo vai drau[ty-astra-viplufito

na miitur udare mrta

anugrahiid bhagavata

krfirtasyiidbhuta-karmarta

siita[l. uvaca- Sri Suta Gosvami said; ya[l.-one who; vai-certainly;

draupi-astra-by the weapon of the son of Droṇa; viplu[tafl.-burnt by;

na-never; matu[l.-of the mother; udare-in the womb of; mrta[l.-met his

death; anugraha-by the mercy of; bhagavata[l.-of the Personality of Godhead; kn1Jasya-of l<f□a;adbhuta-karmartafl.-of one who acts wonderfully.

TRANSLATION

Sri Suta Gosvami said: Due to the mercy of the Personality of Godhead Sri l<rF!□a, who acts wonderfully, Maharaja P ar□it, though struck by the weapon of the son of Dro□a in his mother's womb, could not be burnt.

PURPORT

The sages of Naimi□araJ;tya became struck with wonder after hearing about the wonderful administration of Maharaja Parik□it, especially with reference to his punishing the personality of Kali and making him completely unable to do any harm within the kingdom. Suta Gosvami was

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equally anxious to describe Maharaja Pari:k:flit's wonderful birth and death, and this verse is stated by Siita Gosvami to increase the interest of the sages of Naimi□araJ;tya.

TEXT2

brahma-kopotthitiid yas tu

tak□akiit priir-a-viplaviit

na sammumohorubhayiid

bhagavaty arpitiisaya□

brahma-kopa-fury of a briihmarza; utthitiit-caused by;yalt-what was;

tu-but; tak§akiit-by the snake-bird; priirza-viplaviit-from dissolution of

life; na-never; sammumoha- became overwhelmed; uru- bhayiit- great fear

fulness; bhagavati- unto the Personality of Godhead; mpita-surrendered;

iiSaya[l.-consciousness.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, Maharaja Pa□it was always consciously surrendered to the Personality of Godhead, and therefore he was neither afraid nor overwhelmed by fear due to a snake-bird which was to bite him because of the fury of a brahm□a boy.

PURPORT

A self-surrendered devotee of the Lord is called Narayat:□a-pariiyafla. Such a person is never afraid of any place or person, not even of death. For him nothing is as important as the Supreme Lord, and thus he gives equal importance both to heaven and hell. He knows well that both heaven and hell are creations of the Lord, and similarly life and death are different conditions of existence created by the Lord. But in all conditions and in all circumstances, remembrance of Narayat□a is essential. The NarayaJ;ta pariiyafla practices this constantly. Maharaja Parik□it was such a pure devotee. He was wrongfully cursed by an inexperienced son of a briihma11a who was under the influence of Kali, and Maharaja Parik□it took this to be sent by Narayat:Ja. He knew that Narayat:Ja (Lord Kr□!Qa) saved him when he was

Text3) Maharaja Par□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 931

burnt in the womb of his mother, and if he were to be killed by a snake bite, it would also take place by the will of the Lord. The devotee never goes against the will of the Lord; therefore anything sent by God is a blessing for the devotee. Therefore Maharaja Pan"ka□it was neither afraid of nor bewildered by such things. That is the sign of a pure devotee of the Lord.

TEXT3

i3t(l\iil w.fu: q H!(lldl□<t4□Rt: I

□4{Hi□J(i □ □ □ □□6H(II □ II

utsrjya sarvatafz sangam

vijiiiitijita-samsthitifz

vaiyiisaker jahau si\$yo

gangiiyiim svam kalevaram

uts.rjya- after leaving aside; sarvatafz-all around; sangam-association;

vijiiata-being understood; ajita-one who is never conquered (the Personality of Godhead); samsthitifz-actual position; vaiyasakeft-onto the son of Vyasa; jahau-gave up; s□yafz-as a disciple; gangayam-on the bank of the Ganges; svam-his son; kalevaram-material body.

TRANSLATION

Furthermore, after leaving all his associates, the King surrendered

himself as a disciple to the son of Vyasa [Sukadeva Gosvami), and thus he was able to understand the actual position of the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

The word ajita is significant here. The Personality of Godhead Sri Kṛṣṇa is known as Ajita, or unconquerable, and He is so in every respect. No one can know His actual position. He is unconquerable by knowledge also. We have heard about His dhama, or place, eternal Goloka Vrndavana, but there are many scholars who interpret this abode in different ways. But by the grace of a spiritual master like Sukadeva Gosvami, unto whom the King gave himself up as a most humble disciple, one is able to understand the actual position of the Lord, His eternal abode, and His transcendental paraphernalia in that dhama or abode. Knowing the transcendental position of the Lord and the transcendental method by which one can approach that transcendental dhiima,. the King was confident about his ultimate destination, and by knowing this he could leave aside everything material, even his own body, without any difficulty of attachment. In the Bhagavad-gītā, it is stated, param dṛṣṭvī nivartate, or one can give up all connection of the material attachment when one is able to see the param, or the superior quality of things. We understand the superior quality of energy of the Lord and the material quality of material energy from the Bhagavad-gītā and by the grace of a bona fide spiritual master like Sukadeva Gosvami. It is quite possible to know everything of the superior energy of the Lord by which the Lord manifests His eternal name, quality, pastimes, paraphernalia and variegatedness. Unless one thoroughly understands this superior or eternal energy of the Lord, it is not possible to leave the material energy, however one may theoretically speculate on the true nature of the Absolute Truth. By the grace of Lord Kṛṣṇa, Maharaja Parikṣit was able to receive the mercy of a personality like Sukadeva Gosvami, and thus he was able to know the actual position of the unconquerable Lord. It is very difficult to find the Lord from the Vedic literatures, but it is very easy to know Him by the mercy of a liberated devotee

like Sukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT₄

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□U;:ijHi14lsw:t¥1□sf'l □ 6t:qdJ"ilit'(ll'll'l

nottamasloka-viirtiiniirh

ju□atiirh tat-kathiimrtam

syiit sambhramo 'nta-kiile 'pi

smaratiirh tat padambu-jam

na-never; uttama-sloka-the Personality of Godhead, who is sung of by the Vedic hymns; viirtiiniim-of those who live on them;ju□atiim-of those who are engaged in; tat-His; kathii-amrtam-transcendental topics about Him; syiit-it so happens; sambhramtJb-misconception; anta-at the end; kiile-in time; api-also; smaratiim-remembering; tat-His; pada-ambu-jam lotus feet.

TRANSLATION

This was so because those who have dedicated their lives to the transcendental topics of the Personality of Godhead, of whom the Vedic hymns Text 5) Maharaja P□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 933 sing, and who are constantly engaged in remembering the lotus feet of the Lord, do not run the risk of having misconceptions at the last moment of their lives.

PURPORT

The highest perfection of life is attained by remembering the transcendental nature of the Lord at the last moment of one's life. This perfection of life is made possible by one who has learned the actual transcendental nature of the Lord from the Vedic hymns sung by a liberated soul like Sukadeva Gosvami or someone in that line of disciplic succession. There is no gain in hearing the Vedic hymns from some mental speculator. When the same is heard from an actual self-realized soul and is properly understood by service and submission, everything becomes transparently clear. Thus a submissive disciple is able to live transcendently and continue to the end of life. By scientific adaptation, one is able to remember the Lord

even at the end of life when the power of remembrance is slackened due to derangement of bodily membranes. For a common man, it is very difficult to remember things as they are at the time of death, but by the grace of the Lord and His bona fide devotees, the spiritual masters, one can get this opportunity without difficulty. And it was done in the case of Maharaja Panāit.

TEXTS

tiivat kalir na prabhavet

pravifi to 'plha sarvata(l

yiivad iSo mahiin urvyiim

iibhimanyava eka-riit

tiivat-so long; kalir- the personality of Kali; na- cannot; prabhavet flourish; prav41afl-entered in; api-even though; iha-here; sarvatafl-every where; yiivat-as long as; iSafl- the Lord; mahan-great; urvyiim- powerful ; iibhimanyavafl-the son of Abhimanyu; eka-riit-the one emperor.

TRANSLATION

As long as the great, powerful son of Abhimanyu remains the Emperor of the world, there is no chance of the Personality of Kali flourishing.

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PURPORT

As we have already explained, the personality of Kali had entered the jurisdiction of this earth long ago, and he was looking for an opportunity to spread his influence all over the world. But he could not do so satisfactorily due to the presence of Mahara.ja Parilujit. That is the way of good government. The disturbing elements like the personality of Kali will always try to extend their nefarious activities, but it is the duty of the able state to check them by all means. Although Maharaja Panāit allotted places for the personality of Kali, at the same time he gave no chance to the citizens to be swayed by the personality of Kali.

TEXT6

□M'Itf.t qiR ¥f4MIS«1(1J □I

-. □:11□11

yasminn ahani yarhy eva

bhagaviin utsasarja giim

tadaivehiinuvrtto 'siiv

adharma-prabhavafl kali"fl

yasmin-on that; ahani-very day; yarhi eva-in the very moment;

bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead; utsasarja-left aside; giim-the

earth; tadii-at that time; eva-certainly; iha-in this world; anuvrtta[l

followed;asuu-he;adharma-irreligion;prabhava"fl-accelerating; kali"fl-the

personality of quarrel.

TRANSLATION

The very day and moment the Personality of Godhead Lord Sri Kr!?"a left this earth, the personality of Kali, who promotes all kinds of irreligious activities, came into this world.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead and His holy name, qualities, etc., are all identical. The personality of Kali was not able to enter the jurisdiction of the earth due to the presence of the Personality of Godhead. And similarly, if there is an arrangement for the constant chanting of the holy Text7] Maharaja P"it Cursed by a B rahm"a Boy 935 names, qualities, etc., of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, there is no chance at all for the personality of Kali to enter. That is the technique of driving away the personality of Kali from the world. In modernized human society there are great advancements of material science, and they have invented the radio to distribute sound in the air. So instead of vibrating some nuisance sound for sense enjoyment, if the state arranges to distribute transcendental sound by resounding the holy name, fame and activities of the Lord, as they are authorized in the Bhagavad-gitii or Srimad Bhiigavatam, then a favorable condition will be created, and the principles of religion in the world will be reestablished, and thus the executive heads, who are so anxious to drive away corruption from the world, will be successful. Nothing is bad if properly used for the service of the Lord.

TEXT7

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niinudve□ti kalim samriit

siiranga iva siira-bhuk

kusaliiny iisu siddhyanti

netariir-i krtiini yat

na-never; anudve□ti-envious; kalim-unto the personality of Kali; sam
rat-the Emperor; siiranga-realist, like the bees; iva-like; siira-bhuk-one
who accepts the substance;kusaliini-auspicious objects; iisu-immediately;
siddhyanti-become successful; na-never; itariir-i-which are inauspicious;
krtiini-being performed;yat-as much as.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja P□t was a realist, like the bees who only accept the
essence [of a flower] . He knew perfectly well that in this age of Kali,
auspicious things produce good effects immediately, whereas inauspicious
acts must be actually performed [to render effects]. So he was never
envious of the personality of Kali.

PURPORT

The age of Kali is called the fallen age. In this fallen age, because of the
living beings' being in an awkward position, the Supreme Lord has given
some special facilities to them. So by the will of the Lord, a living being
936 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 18

does not become a victim of a sinful act until the act is actually performed.

In other ages, simply by thinking of performing a sinful act, one used to
become a victim of the act. On the contrary, a living being, in this age, is
awarded with the results of pious acts simply by thinking of them.

Maharaja Parik□it, being the most learned and experienced king by the
grace of the Lord, was not unnecessarily envious of the personality of
Kali because he did not intend to give him any chance to perform any
sinful act. He protected his subjects from falling prey to the sinful acts of
the age of Kali, and at the same time he gave full facility to the age of
Kali by allotting him some particular places. At the end of the Srimad

Bhagavatam it is said that even though all nefarious activities of the personality of Kali are present, there is a great advantage in the age of Kali. One can attain salvation simply by chanting the holy name of the Lord. Thus Maharaja Parikṣit made an organized effort to propagate chanting of the Lord's holy name, and thus he saved the citizens from the clutches of Kali. It is for this advantage only that great sages sometimes wish all good for the age of Kali. In the Vedas also it is said that by discourse on Lord Kṛṣṇa's activities, one can get rid of all the disadvantages of the age of Kali. In the beginning of the Srimad-Bhagavatam it is also said that by the recitation of Srimad-Bhagavatam, the Supreme Lord becomes at once arrested within one's heart. These are some of the great advantages of the age of Kali, and Maharaja Parikṣit took all the advantages and did not think any ill of the age of the Kali, true to his Vaiṣṇava cult.

TEXTS

101 ॥ ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय ॥

ॐ नमो भगवते वासुदेवाय ॥

kim nu baleṣu surer-a

kalina dhira-bhirur-ii

apramattaḥ, pramattaṣu

yo vrko nr̥ṣu vartate

kim-what; nu-may be; baleṣu-among the less intelligent persons;

surer-a-by the powerful; kalina-by the personality of Kali; dhira- self

controlled; bhirur-ii-by one who is afraid of; apramattaḥ,- one who is

careful; pramattaṣu-among the careless; yafi,-one who; vrkaḥ,-tiger ;

nr̥ṣu-among men; vartate-exists.

Text 9] Maharaja Parikṣit Cursed by a Brahmin; 1st Chapter 937

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parikṣit considered that less intelligent men might find the personality of Kali to be very powerful, but that those who are self controlled would have nothing to fear. The King was powerful like a tiger and took care for the foolish, careless persons.

PURPORT

Those who are not devotees of the Lord are careless and unintelligent.
 Unless one is thoroughly intelligent, one cannot be a devotee of the Lord.
 Those who are not devotees of the Lord fall prey to the actions of Kali. It
 will not be possible to bring about a saner condition in society unless we
 are prepared to accept the modes of action adopted by Maharaja Parikṣit,
 i.e., propagation of devotional service of the Lord to the common man.

TEXT 9

aqcdft<til<i'l'H □ qaftfttd INTi
 +4GO'l'"o<i II □ IIctlij□ct□q<JY(R□t4
 upavarritam etad vafi.
 purtyam parlkṣitam mayii
 viisudeva-kathopetam
 iikh yinam yad aprcchata
 upavarritam-almost everything described; etad-all these; vafi.-unto
 you; pu[tyam-pious; parlkṣitam-about Maharaja Parikṣit; mayii-by me;
 viisudeva-of Lord KpJJ)a; kathii-narrations; upetam-in connection with;
 iikhyinam-statements;yat-what;aprcchata-you asked from me.

TRANSLATION

O sages, as you did ask me, now I have almost described everything
 regarding the narrations about Lord Kṛṣṇa in connection with the history
 of the pious Maharaja Parikṣit.

PURPORT

Srimad-Bhāgavatam is the history of the activities of the Lord. And the
 activities of the Lord are performed in relation with the devotees of the
 938 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 18
 Lord. Therefore, the history of the devotees is not different from the
 history of Lord Kṛṣṇa's activities. A devotee of the Lord regards both the
 activities of the Lord and those of His pure devotees on an equal level, for
 they are all transcendental.

TEXT 10

□ □: cpn l11FRJ: CfitlwU□Wqol: I
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yii yiiḥ, kathii bhagavataḥ,
 kathaniyorukarmartaḥ
 gu[La-karmiisrayiiḥ, pumbhiḥ,
 samsevyiis tii bubhiiṣubhiḥ,
 yii□-whatever; yiiḥ!,-and whatsoever; kathii□-topics; bhagavataḥ,
 about the Personality of Godhead; kathaniya-were to be spoken by me;
 urukarmartaḥ-of Him who acts wonderfully; gu[ta-transcendental quali-
 ties; karma-uncommon deeds; asrayaḥ!,-involving; pumbhiḥ-by persons;
 samsevyiiḥ,-ought to be heard by; tii-all of them; bubhiiṣubhiḥ,-by those
 who want their own welfare.

TRANSLATION

Those who are desirous of achieving complete perfection in life must
 submissively hear all topics that are connected with the transcendental
 activities and qualities of the Personality of Godhead, who acts wonder-
 fully.

PURPORT

The systematic hearing of the transcendental activities, qualities and
 names of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa pushes one toward eternal life. Systematic hearing
 means to know Him gradually in truth and fact, and this knowing Him in
 truth and fact means to attain eternal life, as it is stated in the Bhagavad
 gita. Such transcendental glorified activities of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa are the
 prescribed remedy for counteracting the process of birth, death, old age
 and disease, which are considered to be material awards for the condi-
 tioned living being. The culmination of such a perfectional stage of life is
 the goal of human life and the attainment of transcendental bliss.

Text 11) Maharaja Paṇḍita Cursed by a Brahmṇa Boy

TEXT 11

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□wm □'k'!li..PI'ii□ ;J: □□□□□□

r□aya ucufḥ

suta fiva samiḥḥ saumya

siisvat'ir viSadam yasafI
yas tvam samsasi krṣṇasya
martyiiniim amrtam hi nafl

939

sr'i nayafI ucufI- the good sages said; suta-o Suta Gosvami; fiva-we
wish you life for; samiifI-many years; saumya-grave; siisvat'ifI- eternal;
viSadam-particularly; yaṣafI-in fame; yafI tvam-because you; samsasi
speaking nicely; krṣṇasya-of Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa; martyiiniim-of those who
die; amrtam- eternity of life; hi-certainly; nafl-our.

TRANSLATION

The good sages said: O grave Sita Gosvami! May you live many years
and have eternal fame, for you are speaking very nicely about the activities
of Lord Kṛṣṇa the Personality of Godhead. This is just like nectar for
mortal beings like us.

PURPORT

When we hear about the transcendental qualities and activities of the
Personality of Godhead, we may always remember what has been spoken
by the Lord Himself in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 4.9). His acts, even when
He acts in human society, are all transcendental, for they are all accen-
tuated by the spiritual energy of the Lord, which is distinguished from His
material energy. As stated in the Bhagavad-gītā, such acts are called
divyam. This means that He does not act or take His birth like an ordinary
living being under the custody of material energy. Nor is His body material
nor changeable like that of ordinary living beings. And one who under-
stands this fact, either from the Lord or from authorized sources, is not
reborn after leaving the present material body. Such an enlightened soul is
940 Srimad-Bhāgavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 18

admitted into the spiritual realm of the Lord and engages in the transcen-
dental loving service of the Lord. Therefore, the more we hear about the
transcendental activities of the Lord, as they are stated in the Bhagavad-
gītā and Srimad-Bhāgavatam, the more we can know about His transcen-
dental nature and thus make definite progress on the path back to

Godhead.

TEXT 12

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karma!y asminn aniiSviise

dhuma-dhumriitmaniim bhaviin

iippiyayati govinda

piida-padmiisavam madhu

karma!li-performance of; asmin-in this; aniisuase-without certainty;
dhuma-smoke; dhumra-itiitmaniim-tinged body and mind; bhaviin- your
good self; iippiyayati-very much pleasing; govinda-the Personality of
Godhead; piida-feet; pad mii-iisavam-nectar of the lotus flower; madhu
honey.

TRANSLATION

We have just begun performance of this fruitive act ivity, a sacrificial
f ire, without certainty of its result due to the many imperfections in our
action. Our bodies have become black from the smoke, but we are factually
pleased by the nectar of the lotus feet of the Personality of Godhead
Govinda, which you are distributing.

PURPORT

The sacrificial fire kindled by the sages of Nai□ar□ya was certainly
full of smoke and doubts because of so many flaws. The first flaw is that
there is an acute scarcity of expert briihmap.as able to carry out such per
formances successfully in this age of Kali. Any discrepancy in such sacri
fices spoils the whole show, and the result is uncertain, like agricultural
enterprises. The good result of tilling the paddy field depends on provi
dential rain, and therefore the result is uncertain. Similarly, performance
Text 13) Maharaja Pa□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 941
of any kind of sacrifice in this age of Kali is also uncertain. Unscrupulous
greedy briihmarws of the age of Kali induce the innocent public to such
uncertain sacrificial shows without disclosing the scriptural injunction that
in the age of Kali there is no fruitful sacrificiai performance but the sacri

fice of the congregational chanting of the holy name of the Lord. Siita Gosvami was narrating the transcendental activities of the Lord before the congregation of sages, and they were factually perceiving the result of hearing these transcendental activities. One can feel this practically, as one can feel the result of eating food. Spiritual realization acts in that way. The sages of Naimiṣaraṇya were practically sufferers from the smoke of a sacrificial fire and were doubtful about the result, but by hearing from a realized person like Siita Gosvami, they were fully satisfied. In the Brahma Vaivarta Purāṇa, Viṣṇu tells Siva that in the age of Kali, men full of anxieties of various kinds can vainly labor in fruitive activity and philosophical speculations, but when they are engaged in devotional service, the result is sure and certain, and there is no loss of energy. In other words, nothing performed for spiritual realization or for material benefit can be successful without devotional service of the Lord.

TEXT 13

UMiil e-•nA ;r • □ I

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tulayiima laveniipi

na svargam niipunar-bhavam

bhagavat-sangi-sangasya

martyiiniim kim-utii.Siṣafi.

tulayiima-to be balanced with; lavena-by a moment; api-even; na never; svargam-heavenly planets; na -neither;apunafi.-bhavam-liberation from matter; bhagavat-sangi- devotee of the Lord; sangasya-of the association; martyiiniim-those who are meant for death; kim-what is there; uta to speak of; iisiṣafi.-worldly benediction.

TRANSLATION

The value of a moment's association with the devotee of the Lord cannot even be compared to the attainment of heavenly planets or liberation from matter, and what to speak of worldly benedictions in the form of material prosperity, which is for those who are meant for death.

PURPORT

When there are some similar points, it is possible to compare one thing to another. One cannot compare the association of a pure devotee to any thing material. Men who are addicted to material happiness aspire to reach the heavenly planets like the moon, Venus, Indraloka, etc., and those who are advanced in material philosophical speculations aspire after liberation from all material bondage. When one becomes frustrated in all kinds of material advancement, one desires the opposite type of liberation, which is called *apunar-bhava*, or no rebirth. But the pure devotees of the Lord do not aspire after the happiness obtained in the heavenly kingdom, nor do they aspire after liberation from material bondage. In other words, for the pure devotees of the Lord, the material pleasures obtainable in the heavenly planets are like phantasmagoria, and because they are already liberated from all material conceptions of pleasure and distress, they are factually liberated even in the material world. This means that the pure devotees of the Lord are engaged in a transcendental existence, namely, in the loving service of the Lord, both in the material world and in the spiritual world. As a government servant is always the same, either in the office or at home or at any place, so a devotee has nothing to do with anything material, for he is exclusively engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord. Since he has nothing to do with anything material, what pleasure can he derive from material benedictions like kingship or other overlordships, which are finished quickly with the end of the body? Devotional service is eternal, and it has no end because it is spiritual. Therefore, since the assets of a pure devotee are completely different from material assets, there is no comparison between the two. Śrī Caitanya Gosvami was a pure devotee of the Lord, and therefore his association with the *rāgīs* in the Naimiṣāraṇya is unique. In the material world, association with gross materialists is veritably condemned. The materialist is called *yosit-sangi*, or one who is much attached to material entanglement (women and other paraphernalia). Such attachment is conditioned because it drives away the benedictions of life and prosperity. And just the opposite is *bhīṣmavata-sangi*, or one who is

always in the association with the Lord's name, form, qualities, etc. Such association is always desirable; it is worshipable, it is praiseworthy, and one may accept it as the highest goal of life.

Text 14] Maharaja Pṛthvī Cursed by a Brahmin Boy

TEXT 14

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ko niima trpyed rasavit kathiiyīm

mahattamaikiinta pariiyar-asya

niintam gur-iiniim agur-asya jagmur

yogesvarī ye bhava-pīdma-mukhyī□

943

kaḥ—who is he; nama-specifically; trpyet-get full satisfaction; rasavit expert in relishing mellow nectar; kathiiyīm- in the topics of; mahattama the greatest amongst the living being; ekiinta-exclusively; pariiyar-asya-of one who is the shelter of; na-never; antam-end; gur-iiniim-of attributes; agur-asya-of the Transcendence; jagmuḥ-could ascertain; yogesvarī□ the lords of mystic power; ye-all they; bhava-Lord Siva; pīdma-Lord Brahma; mukhyīḥ-heads.

TRANSLATION

The Personality of Godhead Lord Kṛṇa [Govinda] is the exclusive shelter for all great living beings, and His transcendental attributes cannot even be measured by such masters of mystic powers as Lord Siva and Lord Brahma. Can anyone who is expert in relishing nectar [rasa] ever be fully satiated by hearing topics about Him?

PURPORT

Lord Siva and Lord Brahma are two chiefs of the demigods. They are full of mystic powers. For example, Lord Siva drank an ocean of poison of which one drop is sufficient to kill an ordinary living being. Similarly, Brahma could create many powerful demigods, including Lord

Siva. So they are isvaras, or lords of the universe. But they are not the supreme powerful. The supreme powerful is Govinda, Lord Kṛṣṇa. He is transcendence, and His transcendental attributes cannot be measured even by such powerful iSvaras as Siva and Brahma. Therefore Lord Kṛṣṇa is the
944 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 18

exclusive shelter of the greatest of all living beings. Brahma is counted amongst the living beings, but he is the greatest of all of us. And why is the greatest of all the living beings so much attached to the transcendental topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa? Because He is the reservoir of all enjoyment. Every one wants to relish some kind of taste from everything, but one who is engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord can derive unlimited pleasure from such engagement. The Lord is unlimited, and His name, attributes, pastimes, entourage, variegatedness, etc., are unlimited, and those who relish them can do so unlimitedly and still not feel satiated. This fact is confirmed in the Padma Purāṇa.

There is no end of such transcendental discourses. In mundane affairs there is the law of satiation, but in transcendence there is no such satiation. Suta Gosvami desired to continue the topics of Lord Kṛṣṇa before the sages of Naimiśārāya, and the sages also expressed their readiness to hear from him continually. Since the Lord is transcendence and His attributes are transcendental, such discourses increase the receptive mood of the purified audience.

TEXT 15

krīṣṇaḥ parataraḥ śarīra-śāstrināṃ

ij('Etāṁ EīiW{fq(Iṁ UIṁ

«l(S(R ṁ ṁ

ṁ .n Hijft« ftt;t uṁṁṁṁ

tan no bhaviin vai bhagavat-pradhiino

mahattamaikiinta-pariīyaf! .asya

harer udiirarh caritarh viSuddharh

susriīṣatiirh no vitanotu vidvan

tat-therefore; naft- of us; bhaviin- your good self; vai- certainly;

bhagavat-in relation with the Personality of Godhead; pradhiinaft chiefly; mahattama-the greatest of all greats; ekiinta-exclusively; pariiya□asya-of the shelter; hareft-of the Lord; udiiram-im partial; caritam activities; viSuddham- transcendental; susriiṣatiim- those who are receptive; naft-ourselves; vitanotu-kindly describe; vidvan-o learned one.

TRANSLATION

o Siita Gosvami, you are a learned and pure devotee of the Lord because the Personality of Godhead is your chief object of service. There-
Text 16) Maharaja Pa□it Cursed by a Brahml!la Boy 945
fore please describe to us the pastimes of the Lord, which are above all material conception, for we are anxious to receive such messages.

PURPORT

The speaker on the transcendental activities of the Lord should have only one object of worship and service, Lord Kr□l)a, the Supreme Personality of Godhead. And the audience for such topics should be anxious to hear about Him. When such a combination is possible, namely a qualified speaker and a qualified audience, it is then ari.d there very much congenial to continue discourses on the transcendence. Professional speakers and a materially absorbed audience cannot derive real benefit from such discourses. Professional speakers make a show of Bhiigavata-saptaha for the sake of family maintenance, and the materially disposed audience hears such discourses of Bhiigavata-saptaha for some material benefit, namely religiosity, wealth, gratification of the senses, or liberation. Such Bhiigavata discourses are not purified from the contamination of the material qualities. But the discourses between the saints of Naimi□aral)ya and Sri Suta Gosvami are on the transcendental level. There is no motive for material gain. In such discourses, unlimited transcendental pleasure is relished both by the audience and the speaker, and therefore they can continue the topics for many thousands of years. Now Bhiigavata-saptahas are held for seven days only, and after finishing the show, both the audience and the speaker become engaged in material activities as usual. They can do so because the speaker is not Bhiigavata-pradhiina, and the

audience is not susrii.ṣatiim, as explained above.

TEXT 16

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□ (CtiR:iiCNfqiG>'ṣa(II□ □11

sa vai mahii-bhiigavata/;1 parlkṣid

yeniipavargiikh yam adabhra-buddhil)

jfliinena vaiyiisaki-sabditena

bheje khagendra-dhvaja-piida-mii.lam

sal)- he; vai- certainly; mahii-bhiigavata/;1-first-class devotee; panK□it

the King; yena-by which; apavarga-iikhyam-by the name of liberation;

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adabhra-fixed; buddhifi.-intelligence; jniinena-by knowledge; vaiyiisaki

the son of Vyasa; sabditena-vibrated by; bheje-taken to; khagendra

Garw;la, the king of the birds; dhvaja-flag;piida-miilam-soles of the feet

TRANSLATION

o Siita Gosvami, please describe those topics of the Lord by which

Maharaja Pa□it, whose intelligence was fixed on liberation, attained the

lotus feet of the Lord, who is the shelter of Garu□a, the king of birds.

Those topics were vibrated by the son of Vyasa [Sn1.a Sukadeva].

PURPORT

There is some controversy amongst the students on the path of liberation.

Such transcendental students are known as impersonalists and devotees of

the Lord. The devotee of the Lord worships the transcendental form of

the Lord, whereas the impersonalist meditates upon the glaring effulgence

or the bodily ray of the Lord, known as the brahmajyoti. Here in this

verse it is said that Maharaja Pan□it attained the lotus feet of the Lord by

instructions in knowledge delivered by the son of Vyasadeva, Sn1.a Suka

deva Gosvami. Sukadeva Gosvami was also an impersonalist in the begin

ning, as he has admitted himself in the Bhiigavatam (2.1.9), but later on

he was attracted by the transcendental pastimes of the Lord and thus

became a devotee. Such devotees with perfect knowledge are called mahii bhiigavata, or first-class devotees. There are three classes of devotees, namely the prakṛta, madhyam, and mahii-bhiigavata. The prakṛta or third class devotees are temple worshipers without specific knowledge of the Lord and the Lord's devotees. The madhyam, or the second-class devotee, knows well the Lord, the Lord's devotee, the neophytes, and the nondevotees also. But the mahii-bhiigavata, or the first-class devotee, sees everything in relation with the Lord and the Lord present in everyone's relation. The mahii-bhiigavata, therefore, does not make any distinction, particularly between a devotee and nondevotee. Maharaja Parikṣit was such a mahii-bhiigavata devotee because he was initiated by a mahii-bhiigavata devotee, Sukadeva Gosvami. He was equally kind, even to the personality of Kali, and what to speak of others.

So there are many instances in the transcendental histories of the world of an impersonalist who has later become a devotee. But a devotee has never become an impersonalist. This very fact proves that on the transcendental steps, the step occupied by a devotee is higher than the step

Text 17) Maharaja Parikṣit Cursed by a Brahmin Boy 947

occupied by an impersonalist. It is also stated in the Bhagavad-gītā (Bg. 12.5) that persons stuck on the impersonal step undergo more sufferings than achievement of reality. Therefore knowledge imparted by Sukadeva Gosvami unto Maharaja Parikṣit helped him attain the service of the Lord. And to attain to this stage of perfection is called apavarga, or the perfect stage of liberation. Simple knowledge of liberation is material knowledge. Actual freedom from material bondage is called liberation, but to attain the transcendental service of the Lord is called the perfect stage of liberation. Such a stage is attained by knowledge and renunciation, as we have already explained (Bhii. 1.2.12), and perfect knowledge, as delivered by Srila Sukadeva Gosvami, results in the attainment of transcendental service of the Lord.

TEXT 17

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tan nal) pararh purtyam asarhvr̥tīrtham

iikhyiinam aty adbhuta-yogan□tham

·iikhyiihy-anantiicaritopapannarh

piirik□itarh bhiigavatiibhiriimam

tat-therefore; nal)-untQ us; param-su preme; pu[tyam-purifying;

asariwrtīrtham-as it is; iikhyiinam-narration; ati-very; adbhuta-wonder

ful; yogan□tham-compact in bhakti-yoga; iikhyiīhi-describe; ananta-the

Unlimited; iicarita-activities; upapannam-full of; piin"ḥṣitam-spoken to

Maharaja Parik□it; bhiigavata-of the pure devotees; abhiriimam-particu

larly very dear.

TRANSLATION

Thus please narrate to us the narrations of the Unlimited, for they are purifying and supreme. They were spoken to Maharaja Pan□it, and they are very dear to the pure devotees, being full of bhakti-yoga.

PURPORT

What was spoken to Maharaja Pan□it and what is very dear to the pure devotees is Srimad-Bhiigavatam. Srimad-Bhiigavatam is mainly full of the narrations of the activities of the Supreme Unlimited, and therefore it is 948 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch_ 18

the science of bhakti-yoga, or devotional service of the Lord. Thus it is para, or supreme, because although it is enriched with all knowledge and religion, it is specifically enriched with the devotional service of the Lord.

TEXT18

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siita uviica

aho vayarh janma-bhrto'dya hiisma
 vrddhiinuvrttyipi viloma-jiitii□
 dau□kulyam iidhirh vidhunoti szghrarh
 mahattamiiniim abhidhiina-yoga□
 siitafi. uvaca- Suta Gosvamī said; aho-how; vayam-we;janma-bhrtafi.
 promoted in birth; adya-today; ha-clearly; asma-have become; vrddha
 anuvrttyii-by serving those who are advanced in knowledge; api-although;
 viloma-jiita[l.-born in a mixed caste; dau□kulyam-disqualification of
 birth; iidhim-sufferings; vidhunoti-purifies; szghram-very soon;
 mahattamcinam-of those who are great; abhidhana- conversation; yoga[l.
 connection.

TRANSLATION

Sri Siita Gosvami said: O God, although we are born in a mixed caste,
 we are still promoted in birthright simply by serving and following the
 great who are advanced in knowledge- Even by conversing with such great
 souls, one can without delay clean up all disqualifications resulting from
 lower births.

PURPORT

Suta Gosvami did not take his birth in a brāhmaṇa family. He was born
 in a family of mixed caste, or an uncultured low family. But because of
 higher association, like Sri Sukadeva Gosvami and the great ṛṣis of Naimi
 śaraṇa, certainly the disqualification of inferior birth was washed off.

Text 18] Maharaja Parīkṣit Cursed by a Brahman Boy 949

Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu followed this principle in pursuance of the
 Vedic usages, and by His transcendental association He elevated many low
 born, or those disqualified by birth or action, to the status of devotional
 service and established them in the position of śikṣiṇya, or authorities. He
 clearly stated that any man, whatever he may be, whether a brāhmaṇa or
 śūdra by birth, or a householder or mendicant in the order of society, if
 he is conversant with the science of Kṛṣṇa, he can be accepted as an
 śikṣiṇya or guru, a spiritual master.

Suta Gosvami learned the science of Kṛṣṇa from great ṛṣis and authorities

ties like Sukadeva, Vyasadeva, etc., and he was so qualified that even the sages of Naimiṣaraṇya eagerly wanted to hear from him the science of Kṛṣṇa in the form of Srimad-Bhāgavatam. So he had the double association: of great souls by hearing and preaching. Transcendental science or the science of Kṛṣṇa has to be learned from the authorities, and when one preaches the science, he becomes still more qualified. So Suta Gosvami had both the advantages, and thus undoubtedly he was completely freed from all disqualifications of low birth and mental agonies. This verse definitely proves that neither Srila Sukadeva Gosvami refused to teach Suta Gosvami about the transcendental science, nor the sages of the Naimiṣaraṇya refused to hear lessons from him because of his inferior birth. This means that thousands of years ago there was no bar in learning or preaching the transcendental science because of inferior birth. The rigidity of the so called caste system in Hindu society became prominent within only one hundred years or so when the number of dvija-bandhus, or disqualified men in the families of higher castes, increased. Lord Sri Caitanya revived the original Vedic system, and He elevated Thakur Haridasa to the position of namacarya, or the authority in the preaching of the glories of the holy name of the Lord, although His Holiness Srila Haridasa Thakur was pleased to appear in a family of Mohammedans.

Such is the power of pure devotees of the Lord. The Ganges water is accepted as pure, and one can become purified after taking a bath in the waters of the Ganges. But as far as the great devotees of the Lord are concerned, they can purify a degraded soul even by being seen by the low born, and what to speak of association. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahāprabhu wanted to purify the whole atmosphere of the polluted world by sending qualified preachers all over the world, and it remains with the Indians to take up this task scientifically and thus to do the best kind of humanitarian work. The mental diseases of the present generation are more acute than bodily diseases; it is quite fit and proper to take up the preaching of Srimad-Bhāgavatam all over the world without delay. Mahātmanam

Abhidhiina also means dictionary of great devotees, or a book full of the words of great devotees. Such a dictionary of the words of great devotees and that of the Lord are in the Vedas and allied literatures, specifically the S nmad-Bhiigavatam. .

TEXT 19

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q)s;w;::aijRfi□I'EIIwtwt;:Jl

'□«!"•□11{ :qqwwra'llt:

kutalt punar gro-ato niima tasya

mahattanwikiinta-pariiyapasya

yo 'nanta-sak tir bhagaviin ananto

mahad-gu!latviid yam anantam-iihult

kutalt-what to say; punafi.-again; g_□ataft-one who chants; nama

holy name; tasya-His; mahattama-great devotees; e kiinta-ex clusive;

pariiyartasya-of one who is shelter of; yaft-He who; ananta-is the

Unlimited; 5aktilt-potency; bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead;

anantafi.-immeasurable; mahat-great; gurtatviit-on account of such

attributes; yam-whom; anantam-by the name ananta; iihult-is called.

TRANSLATION

And what to speak of those who are under the direction of the great devotees, chanting the holy name of the Unlimited who has unlimited potency? The Personality of Godhead, unlimited in potency and transcendental by attributes, is called the ananta [Unlimited].

PURPORT

The dvija-bandhu, or the less intelligent uncultured men born of higher castes, put forward many arguments against the lower caste men becoming briihmartas in this life. They argue that birth in the family of sudros or less than sudras is made possible by one's previous sinful acts, and therefore one has to complete the terms of disadvantages due to lower birth. And to answer these false logicians, Srimad-Bhiigavatam asserts that one who

Text 20] Maharaja Par□it Cursed by a Brahm3.!1a Boy 951

chants the holy name of the Lord under the direction of a pure devotee can at once get free from the disadvantages due to lower caste birth. A pure devotee of the Lord does not commit any offense while chanting the holy name of the Lord. There are ten different offenses in the chanting of the holy name of the Lord. To chant the holy name under the direction of a pure devotee is offenseless chanting. Offenseless chanting of the holy name of the Lord is transcendental, and, therefore, such chanting can at once purify one from the effects of all kinds of previous sins. This offenseless chanting indicates that one has fully understood the transcendental nature of the holy name and has thus surrendered unto the Lord. Transcendentally the holy name of the Lord and the Lord Himself are identical, being absolute. The holy name of the Lord is as powerful as the Lord. The Lord is the all-powerful Personality of Godhead, and He has innumerable names, which are all nondifferent from Him and are equally powerful also. In the last word of the Bhagavad-gitii the Lord asserts that one who surrenders fully unto Him is protected from all sins by the grace of the Lord. Since His name and He Himself are identical, the holy name of the Lord can protect the devotee from all effects of sins. The chanting of the holy name of the Lord can undoubtedly deliver one from the disadvantages of a lower caste birth. The Lord's unlimited power is extended on and on by the unlimited expansion of the devotees and incarnations, and thus every devotee of the Lord and incarnations also can be equally surcharged with the potency of the Lord. Since the devotee is surcharged with the potency of the Lord, even fractionally, the disqualification due to lower birth can not stand in the way.

TEXT 20

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etiivatiilarh nanu sucitena

guruzir as iimyiinatiSiiyanasya

hitvetariin priirthayato vibhutir

yasyiinghri rer-um juṣate 'nabhipso

etiivata-so far; alam-unnecessary; nanu-if at all; sucitena- by descrip

tion; gurai- by attributes; asiimya-immeasurable ; anati.Siiyanasya-of

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one who is unexcelled; hitoo-leaving aside; itariin-others;priirthayatafl

of those who ask for; vibhiUi{l-favor of the goddess of fortune; yasya

one whose; anghri-feet; repum-dust; juṣate-serves; anabhipso[l.-of one

who is unwilling.

TRANSLATION

It is now ascertained that He [the Personality of Godhead] is unlimited . and there is none equal to Him. Consequently no one can speak of Him adequately. Great demigods cannot obtain the favor of the goddess of fortune even by prayers, but this very goddess renders service unto the Lord, although He is unwilling to have such service.

PURPORT

The Personality of Godhead, or theParamesvara Param Brahma, according to the sriitis, has nothing to do. He has no equal. Nor does anyone excel Him. He has unlimited potencies, and His every action is carried out systematically in His natural and perfect ways. Thus the Supreme Personality of Godhead is full in Himself, and He has nothing to accept from anyone else, including the great demigods like Brahma. Others ask for the favor of the goddess of fortune, and despite such prayers she declines to award such favors. But still she renders service unto the Supreme Personality of Godhead, although He has nothing to accept from her. The Personality of Godhead in His l\laha-Viṣṇu feature begets Brahma, the first created person in the material world, from His naval lotus stem and not in the womb of the goddess of fortune who is eternally engaged in His service. These are some of the instances of His complete independence and perfection. That He has nothing to do does not mean that He is impersonal. He is transcendently so full of inconceivable potencies that simply by His willing,

everything is done without physical or personal endeavor. He is called, therefore, yogesvara, or the Lord of all mystic powers.

TEXT 21

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Text 21) Maharaja P□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy

athiipi yat-piidanakhiivasntam

jagad virincopahrthirhar-iimbha□

sesam puniity anyatamo mukundiit

ko niima loke bhagavat-padiirtha□

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atha-therefore; api-certainly; yat-whose; piida-nakha-nails of the feet; avasntam-emanating; jagat-the whole universe; virinca- Brahmaji; upahrta-collected ;arhar-a-worship; ambha□-water ;sa-along with; !.Sam Lord Siva; puniiti-purifie□; anyatama□-who else; mukundiit-besides the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṇ}a; ka□-who; niima-name; loke-within the world; bhagavat-Supreme Lord ; pada-position; artha□-worth.

TRANSLATION

Who can be worthy of the name of the Supreme Lord but the Personality of Godhead Sri Kṇ}a? Brahmaji collected the water emanating from the nails of His feet in order to award it to Lord Siva as a worshipful welcome. This very water [the Ganges] is purifying the whole universe, including Lord Siva.

PURPORT

The conception of many gods in the Vedic literatures by the ignorant is completely wrong. The Lord is one without a second, but He expands Himself in many ways, and this is confirmed in the Vedas. Such expansions of the Lord are limitless, but some of them are the living entities. The living entities are not as powerful as the Lord's plenary expansions, and therefore there are two different types of expansions. Lord Brahma is

generally one of the living entities, and Lord Siva is the via medium between the Lord and the living entities. In other words, even demigods like Lord Brahma and Lord Siva, who are the chief amongst all demigods, are never equal to or greater than Lord Viṣṇu the Supreme Personality of Godhead. The goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī and all-powerful demigods like Brahma and Siva are engaged in the worship of Viṣṇu or Lord Kṛṣṇa; therefore who can be more powerful than Mukunda (Lord Kṛṣṇa) to be factually called the Supreme Personality of Godhead? The goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī, Lord Brahma and Lord Siva are not independently powerful, but they are powerful as expansions of the Supreme Lord, and all of them are engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Lord, and so also are the living entities. There are four sects of worshipful devotees of the Lord, and the

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chief amongst them are the Brahma-sampradaya, Rudra-sampradaya and Sri-sampradaya, descending directly from Lord Brahma, Lord Siva and the goddess of fortune, Lakṣmī, respectively. Besides the above-mentioned three sampradaiyas, there is the Kumara-sampradaya, descending from Sanatkumara. All of the four original sampradaiyas are still scrupulously engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord up to date, and they all declare that Lord Kṛṣṇa Mukunda is the Supreme Personality of Godhead, and no other personality is equal to Him or greater than Him.

TEXT 22

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yatriinuraktii□ sahasaiva dhirii

vyapohya dehiidiṣu sangam ii□ham

vrajanti tat piirama-harhsyam antyarth

yasminn ahirhsopasama□ sva-dharma□

yatra-unto whom; anuraktii[z-firmly attached;sahasii-all of a sudden;

eva-certainly; dhirii!z-self-controlled; vyapohya-leaving aside; deha-the

gross and subtle mind; iid□u-relating to; sangam-attachment; ii□ham taken to; vrajanti-go away; tat-that;piirama-harhsyam-the highest stage of perfection; antyam-and beyond that; yasmin-in which; ahimsii-non violence; upasama□-and renunciation; sva-dharma□-consequential occupation.

TRANSLATION

Self-controlled persons who are attached to the Supreme Lord Sri Kr□□a can all of a sudden give up the world of material attachment, including the gross body and subtle mind, and go away to attain the highest perfection of the renounced order of life, by which nonviolence and renunciation are consequential.

PURPORT

Only the self-controlled can gradually be attached to the Supreme Person;□li ty of Godhead. Self-controlled means not indulging in sense enjoyment more than is necessary. And those who are not self-controlled are
Text 23] Maharaja Pa□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 955
given over to sense enjoyment. Dry philosophical speculation is a subtle sense enjoyment of the mind. Sense enjoyment leads one to the path of darkness. Those who are self-controlled can make progress on the path of liberation from the conditional life of material existence. The Vedas, therefore, enjoin that one should not go on the path of darkness but should make a progressive march towards the path of light or liberation. Self control is actually achieved not by artificially stopping the senses from material enjoyment, but by becoming factually attached to the Supreme Lord by engaging one's unalloyed senses in the transcendental service of the Lord. The senses cannot be forcibly curbed, but they can be given proper engagement. Purified senses are, therefore, always engaged in the transcendental service of the Lord. This perfectional stage of sense engagement is called bhakti-yoga. So those who are attached to the means of bhakti-yoga are factually self-controlled and can all of a sudden give up their homely or bodily attachment for the service of the Lord. This is called the paramahamsa stage. Hamsas, or swans, accept only milk out of a mix-

ture of milk and water. Similarly, those who accept the service of the Lord instead of miiyii's service are called the paramahamsas. They are naturally qualified with all the good attributes, such as pridelessness, freedom from vanity, nonviolence, tolerance, simplicity, respectability, worship, devotion and sincerity. All these godly qualities exist in the devotee of the Lord spontaneously. Such paramahamsas, who are completely given up to the service of the Lord, are very rare. They are very rare even amongst the liberated souls. Real nonviolence means not to be envious. In this world everyone is envious of his fellow being. But a perfect paramahamsa, being completely given up to the service of the Lord, is perfectly nonenvious. He loves every living being in relation with the Supreme Lord. Real renunciation means to have perfect dependence on God. Every living being is dependent on someone else because he is so made. Actually everyone is dependent on the mercy of the Supreme Lord, but when one forgets his relation with the Lord, he becomes dependent on the conditions of material nature and thus becomes completely dependent on the mercy of the Lord. Real independence means to have complete faith in the mercy of the Lord without being dependent on the conditions of matter. This paramaharhsa stage is the highest perfectional stage in bhakti-yoga, the process of devotional service to the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 23

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aham hi pnto'ryama!lo bhavadbhir

iicak□a iitmiivagamo'tra yiiviin

nabhafl patanty iitmasamam patattri!las

tathii samam v□!lu-gatim vipa5citafl

aham-my humble self;hi-certainly;pf\$lafl-asked by you;aryamapa[l

as powerful as the sun; bhavadbhi[l-by you; iicak\$e- may describe; iitma

avagama[l-as far as my knowledge is concerned; atra-herein; yiiviin-so
 far; nabha[l-sky; patanti- fly on; itma-samam-as far as it can; patattripa[l
 the birds; tathii-thus; samam-similarly; viṣṇu-gatim-knowledge of Viṣṇu;
 vipaścitā[l-even though learned.

TRANSLATION

O rā. who are as powerfully pure as the sun, I shall try to describe to
 you the transcendental pastimes of Vṛndā as far as my knowledge is
 concerned. As the birds fly in the sky as far as their capacity allows, so do
 the learned devotees describe the Lord as far as their realization allows.

PURPORT

The Supreme Absolute Truth is unlimited. No living being can know
 about the unlimited by his limited capacity. The Lord is impersonal,
 personal and localized. By His impersonal feature He is all-pervading
 Brahman, by His localized feature He is present in everyone's heart as the
 Supreme Soul, and by His ultimate personal feature He is the object of
 transcendental loving service by His fortunate associates the pure devotees.
 The pastimes of the Lord in different features can only be estimated partly
 by the great learned devotees. So Śrīla Śiṭa Gosvami has rightly taken this
 position in describing the pastimes of the Lord as far as he has realized.
 Factually only the Lord Himself can describe Himself, and His learned
 devotee also can describe Him as far as the Lord gives him the power
 of description.

TEXT 24 TEXT 25

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 Maharaja Par□it Cursed by a Brahm□qta Boy
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 □ ufeff.rnl;f □ □□6□...N._(11□'-\11
 ekadii dhanur udyamya
 vicaran mrgayiim vane
 mrgiin anugata□ sriinta□
 kṣudhitas t□ito bhṛsam

jaliisayam acakṣiirw□

pravivda tam iiSramam

dadarsa munim iisinam

siintam milita-locanam

957

ekadii-once upon a time; dhanu□-arrows and bow; udyamya-taking firmly; vi caran-following; mrgayiim-hunting excursion; vane-in the forest; mrgiin-stags; anugata□-while following; sriinta□-fatigued; kṣudhita□-hungry; trṣita□-being thirsty; bhram- extremely; jaliisayam- reservoir of water; acakṣiirza□- while finding out; pravivda-entered into; tam that famous; iisramam- hermitage of □amika J;t□i; dadarsa- saw; munim the sage; iis ina m-seated; siintam-all silent; milita-closed; locana m-eyes.

TRANSLATION

Once upon a time Maharaja Par□it, while engaged in hunting in the forest with bow and arrows, became extremely fatigued, hungry and thirsty while following the stags. While searching for a reservoir of water, he entered the hermitage of the well-known Samika □□ and saw the sage sitting silently with closed eyes.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord is so kind to His pure devotees that in proper time He calls such devotees up to Him and thus creates a circumstance auspicious for the devotee. Maharaja Parikṣit was a pure devotee of the Lord, and there was no reason for him to become extremely fatigued, hungry and thirsty because a devotee of the Lord never becomes perturbed by such bodily demands. But by the desire of the Lord, even such a devotee can become apparently fatigued and thirsty just to create a situation favorable for his renunciation of worldly activities. One has to give up all attachment for worldly relations before one is able to go back to Godhead, and thus

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when a devotee is too much absorbed in worldly affairs, the Lord creates a situation to cause indifference. The Supreme Lord never forgets His pure devotee, even though he may be engaged in so-called worldly affairs.

Sometimes He creates an awkward situation, and the devotee becomes obliged to renounce all worldly affairs. The devotee can understand by the signal of the Lord, but others take it to be unfavorable and frustrating. Maharaja Panit was to become the medium for the revelation of Srimad Bhiigavatam by Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa, as his grandfather Arjuna was the medium for the Bhagavad-gītā. Had Arjuna not been taken up with an illusion of family affection by the will of the Lord, the Bhagavad-gītā would not have been spoken by the Lord Himself for the good of all concerned. Similarly, had Maharaja Panit not been fatigued, hungry and thirsty at this time, Srimad-Bhiigavatam would not have been spoken by Śrīla Sukadeva Gosvāmī, the prime authority of Srimad-Bhiigavatam. So this is a prelude to the circumstances under which Srimad-Bhiigavatam was spoken for the benefit of all concerned. The prelude, therefore, begins with the words "Once upon a time."

TEXT 26

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□1.."441□□ smt Qlt1'4□fifi4'(□□□□□□

pratiruddhendriya-prii.lla

manobuddhim upii.ratam

sthii.na-trayii.t param prii.ptam

brahma-bhiitam avikriyam

pratiruddha-restrained; indriya-the sense organs; prara-air of respiration; manafl- the mind; buddhim-intelligence; upiiratam-inactive; sthiin places; trayiit-from the three; param-transcendental; priiptam-achieved; brahma-bhiitam-qualitatively equal with the Supreme Absolute; avikriyam- unaffected.

TRANSLATION

The Muni's sense organs, breath, mind and intelligence were all restrained from material activities, and he was situated in a trance apart from the three [wakefulness, dream and unconsciousness] , having achieved a transcendental position qualitatively equal with the Supreme Absolute.

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PURPORT

It appears that the Muni, in whose hermitage the King entered, was in yogic trance. The transcendental position is attained by three processes, namely the process of jñāna, or theoretical knowledge of transcendence, the process of yoga, or factual realization of trance by manipulation of the physiological and psychological functions of the body, and the most approved process of bhakti-yoga, or the engagement of senses in the devotional service of the Lord. In the Bhagavad-gītā also we have the information of the gradual development of perception from matter to a living entity. Our material mind and body develop from the living entity, the soul, and being influenced by the three qualities of matter, we forget our real identity. The jñāna process theoretically speculates about the reality of the soul. But bhakti-yoga factually engages the spirit soul in activities. The perception of matter is transcended to still subtler states of the senses. The senses are transcended to the subtler mind, and then to breathing activities and gradually to intelligence. Beyond the intelligence, the living soul is realized by the mechanical activities of the yoga system, or practice of meditation restraining the senses, regulating the breathing system and applying intelligence to rise up to the transcendental position. This trance stops all material activities of the body. The King saw the Muni in that position. He also saw the Muni as follows.

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TEXT 27

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viprak"irr-a-jatīcchannarh

rauraver-ījīnena ca

vi.Su□yat-tīlur udakarh

tathīi-bhīitam ayīcata

viprak i""!a- all scattered; jata-iicchannam-covered with compressed, elongated hair; rauraver-a-by the skin of a stag; ajinena-by the skin;

ca- also; vi.Suṣyat-dried up; tiilu[l-palate; udakam- water; tathii-bhiitam
in that state; ayiicata-asked for.

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TRANSLATION

The sage, in meditation, was covered by the skin of a stag, and elongated, compressed hair was scattered all over him. The King, whose palate was dry from thirst, asked him for water.

PURPORT

The King, being thirsty, asked the sage for water. That such a great devotee and King asked for water from a sage absorbed in trance was certainly providential. Otherwise there was no chance of such a unique happening. Maharaja Panā it was thus placed in an awkward position so that gradually Srimad-Bhagavatam could be revealed.

TEXT 28

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alabdha-tnw-bhumy-iidir

asampriiptiirghya-sunrta"fl.

avajniitam ivii.tmiinam

manyamii.nas cukopa ha

alabdha-having not received; tnw-seat of straw; bhumi-place; ii.difl

asampriipta- not properly received; arghya-water for reception; sunrta"fl.

sweet words; avajniitam-thus being neglected; iva-like that; ii.tmiinam

personally; manyamii.nafi.- thinking like that; cukopa- became angry; ha

in that way.

TRANSLATION

The King, not received by any formal welcome by means of being offered a seat, place, water and sweet addresses, considered himself neglected, and so thinking he became angry.

PURPORT

The law of reception in the codes of the Vedic principles states that even if an enemy is received at home, he must be received with all

Text 29) Maharaja Parikṣit Cursed by a Brihmadva Boy 961

respects. He should not be given a chance to understand that he has come into the house of an enemy. When Lord Kṛṣṇa, accompanied by Arjuna and Bhima, approached Jarliṣandha in Magadha, the respectable enemies were given a royal reception by King Jarasandha. The guest enemy, namely Bhima, was to fight with Jarasandha, and yet they were given a grand reception. At night they used to sit down together as friends and guests, and in the day they used to fight, risking life and death. That was the law of reception. The reception law enjoins that a poor man, who has nothing to offer his guest, should be good enough to offer a straw mat for sitting, a glass of water for drinking and some sweet words. Therefore, to receive a guest, either friend or foe, there is no expense. It is only a question of good manners.

When Maharaja Parikṣit entered the door of Samikāśṭhi, he did not expect a royal reception by the śṭhi because he knew that saints and nis are not materially rich men. But he never expected that a seat of straw, a glass of water and some sweet words would be denied to him. He was not an ordinary guest, nor was he an enemy of the śṭhi, and therefore the cold reception by the śṭhi astonished the King greatly. As a matter of fact, the King was right to get angry with the śṭhi when he needed a glass of water very badly. To become angry in such a grave situation was not unnatural for the King, but because the King himself was not less than a great saint, his becoming angry and taking action were astonishing. So it must be accepted that it was so ordained by the supreme will of the Lord. The King was a great devotee of the Lord, and the saint was also as good as the King. But by the will of the Lord, the circumstances were so created that they became ways to the King's becoming unattached to family connection and governmental activities and thus becoming a completely surrendered soul unto the lotus feet of Lord Kṛṣṇa. The merciful Lord sometimes creates such awkward positions for his pure devotees in order to drag them towards Himself from the mire of material existence. But outwardly the situations appear to be frustrating to the devotees. The devotees of the

Lord are always under the protection of the Lord, and in any condition, frustration or success, the Lord is the supreme guide for the devotees. The pure devotees, therefore, accept all conditions of frustration as blessings from the Lord.

TEXT 29

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abhiita-piirval), sahasii

k□ut-tnlbhyiim ardititmanal),

briihmar-am praty abhiid brahman

matsaro'manyur eva ca

[Canto 1, Ch. 18

abhu ta-puroal),-unprecedented; sahasa- circumstantially; k§ut-hunger;

tnlbhyam-as well as by thirst; ardita- being distressed; atmana[l-of his

self; briihmartam-unto a brahmarta; prati-against; abhu t-became;

brahman-o briihmartas; matsarafl-envious; manyufl-angry; eva-thus;

ca-and.

TRANSLATION

o hrahm□as, the King's anger and envy, directed toward the brahm□a sage, were unprecedented, being that circumstances had made him hungry and thirsty.

PURPORT

For a king like Maharaja Parik□it to become angry and envious, especially at a sage and briihmarta, was undoubtedly unprecedented□d. The King knew well that briihmar-as, sages, children, women and old men are always beyond the jurisdiction of punishment. Similarly, the king, even though he commits a great mistake, is never to be considered a wrongdoer. But in this case, Maharaja Parik□it became angry and envious at the sage due to his thirst and hunger, by the will of the Lord. The King was right to punish his subject for coldly receiving him or neglecting him, but because the culprit was a sage and a brahmar-a, it was unprecedented. As the Lord is

never envious of anyone, so also the Lord's devotee is never envious of anyone. The only justification for Maharaja Parikṣit's behavior is that it was ordained by the Lord.

TEXT 30

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RAqoo..□□□>.UI □ □(+fttlj: JI□oll

sa tu brahma-r□er amse

gatiisum uragam ru□ii

vinirgacchan dhanu□kotyii

nidhiya puram iigatal}

Text 31) Maharaja Parikṣit Cursed by a Brahman Boy 963

sa□- the King; tu-however; brahma-rṣe□-of the briihma!a sage; amse on the shoulder; gatiisum-lifeless; uragam-snake; ruṣii-in anger; vinirgacchan-while leaving; dhanu□-kotya-with the front part of the bow; nidhiya-by placing it; puram-palace; iigata□-returned.

TRANSLATION

While leaving, the King, being so insulted, picked up a lifeless snake with his bow and angrily placed it on the shoulder of the sage. Then he returned to his palace.

PURPORT

The King thus treated the sage tit for tat, although he was never accustomed to such silly actions. By the will of the Lord, the King, while going away, found a dead snake in front of him, and he thought that the sage, who had coldly received him, thus might be coldly rewarded by being offered a garland of a dead snake. In the ordinary course of dealing, this was not very unnatural, but in the case of Maharaja Parikṣit's dealing with a briihmarta sage, this was certainly unprecedented. It so happened by the will of the Lord.

TEXT 31

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'l'UQ'IINOitfulffi ?1 □: 11□□11

eṣa kim nibhrtiise□a

kararto militekṣafla□

mrṣii-samiidhir iiho-svit

kim nu syiit kṣatra-bandhubhi□

eYtfl-this; him-whether; nibhrta-ase□a-meditative mood; harartaft
senses; milita-closed; ikṣaraṇi.-eyes; mrṣii-false; samiidhifi.-trance; iiho
remains; svit-if it is so; kim-either; nu-but ; syiit-may be; kṣatra-ban
dhubhifi.-by the lower kṣatriya.

TRANSLATION

Upon returning, he began to contemplate and argue within himself
whether the sage had been actually in meditation with senses concentrated
964 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 18
and eyes closed or whet her he had just been feigning trance just to avoid
receiving a lower □atriya.

PURPORT

The King, being a devotee of the Lord, did not approve of his own
action, and thus he began to wonder whether the sage was really in a
trance or was just pretending in order to avoid receiving the King, who was
kṣatriya and therefore lower in rank. Repentance comes in the mind of
a good soul as soon as he commits something wrong. Srila Vi.Svanatha
Cakravarti Thakur, as well as Snla Jiva Gosvami, do not believe that the
King's action was due to his past misdeeds. The arrangement was so
made by the Lord just to call the King back home, back to Godhead.
According to Srila ViSvanatha Cakravarti, the plan was made by
the will of the Lord, and by the will of the Lord the situation of
frustration was created. The plan was that by his so-called misdeed,
the King could be cursed by an inexperienced briihmap.a boy infected
by the influence of Kali, and thus the King would leave his hearth
and home for good. His connections with Srila Sukadeva Gosvanii would
enable the presentation of the great Srimad-Bhiigavatam, which is con-
sidered to be the book incarnation of the Lord. This book incarnation
of the Lord gives much fascinating information of the transcendental
pastimes of the Lord, like His riisa-b.lii with the spiritual cowherd damsels

of Vrajabhiimi. This specific pastime of the Lord has a special significance because anyone who properly learns about this particular pastime of the Lord will certainly be dissuaded from mundane sex desire and be placed on the path of sublime devotional service to the Lord. The pure devotee's mundane frustration is meant to elevate the devotee to a higher transcendental position. By placing Arjuna or the Pāṇavas in frustration due to the intrigue of their cousin brothers, the prelude of the Battle of Kurukṣetra was created by the Lord. This was to incarnate the sound representative of the Lord, Bhagavad-gītā. So by placing King Paṇḍita in an awkward position, the incarnation of Srimad-Bhāgavatam was created by the will of the Lord. Being distressed by hunger and thirst was only show, because the King endured much, even in the womb of his mother. He was never disturbed by the glaring heat of the Brahmastra struck by Aśvatthama. The King's distressed condition was certainly unprecedented. The devotees like Maharaja Paṇḍita are powerful enough to forbear such distresses, by the will of the Lord, and they are never disturbed. The situation, in this case, is therefore all planned by the Lord.

Text 33) Mahārāja Paṇḍita Cursed by a Brahmin Boy

TEXT 32

śrīmadbhagavad-gītā:

śrīmadbhagavad-gītā (10.40)

tasya putro'ti tejasvī

viharaṇaṁ bīlakaṁ 'rbhakaṁ

rojanīyaṁ priipitam tītam

śrutvā tatredam abravīt

965

tasya-his (the sage's); putraṁ-son; uti-extremely; tejasvī- powerful;

viharaṇaṁ-while playing; bīlakaṁ-with boys; arbhakaṁ-who were all

childish; rojanīyaṁ-by the King; agham-distress ; priipitam- made to have;

tītam-the father; śrutvā-by hearing; tatra-then and there; idam-all

these; abravīt-spoke.

TRANSLATION

The sage had a son who was very powerful, being a brahmaṇṣa's son. While he was playing with inexperienced boys, he heard of his father's distress, which was occasioned by the King. Then and there the boy spoke as follows.

PURPORT

Due to Maharaja Paṇḍita's good government, even a boy of tender age, who was playing with other inexperienced boys, could become as powerful as a qualified brahmārta. This boy was known as Śrīgi, and he achieved good training in brahmācārya by his father so that he could be as powerful as a brahmārta, even at that age. But because the age of Kali was seeking an opportunity to spoil the cultural heritage of the four orders of life, the inexperienced boy gave a chance for the age of Kali to enter into the field of Vedic culture. Hatred of the lower orders of life began from this brahmārta boy, under the influence of Kali, and thus cultural life began to dwindle day after day. The first victim of brahminical injustice was Maharaja Parikṣit, and thus the protection given by the King against the onslaught of Kali was slackened.

TEXT 33

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aho adharma[l. piṇiṇīrha

pivnīrha bali-bhujīm iva

svīminīy agharha yad dīsiṇīrha

dviira-piṇiṇīrha sunīm iva

[Canto 1, Ch. 18

aho-just look at; adharma[l.-irreligion; piṇiṇīim-of the rulers; pivnīm
-of one who is brought up; bali- bhujīm- like the crows; iva-like; svīmini
-unto the master; agham-sin; yat-what is; dīsiṇīim-of the servants;
dviira- piṇiṇīim-keeping watch at the door; sunīm-of the dogs; iva-like.

TRANSLATION

[The brahmaṇṣa's son, Śrīgi, said:] O just look at the sins of the rulers

who, like crows and watchdogs at the door, perpetrate sins against their masters, contrary to the principles governing servants.

PURPORT

The brāhmaṇas are considered to be the head and brains of the social body, and the kṣatriyas are considered to be the arms of the social body. The arms are required to protect the body from all harms, but the arms must act according to the directions of the head and brain. That is a natural arrangement made by the supreme order, for it is confirmed in the Bhagavad-gītā that four social orders or castes, namely the brāhmaṇas, the kṣatriyas, the vaiśyas and the śūdras are set up according to quality and work done by them. Naturally the son of a brāhmaṇa has a good chance to become a brāhmaṇa by the direction of his qualified father, as a son of a medical practitioner has very good chance to become a qualified medical practitioner. So the caste system is quite scientific. The son must take advantage of the father's qualification and thus become a brāhmaṇa or medical practitioner, and not otherwise. Without being qualified, one cannot become a brāhmaṇa or medical practitioner, and that is the verdict of all scriptures and social orders. Herein Śrī Kṛṣṇa, a qualified son of a great brāhmaṇa, attained the required brahminical power both by birth and training, but he was lacking in culture because he was an inexperienced boy. By the influence of Kālī, the son of a brāhmaṇa became puffed up with brahminical power and thus wrongly compared Maharaja Parīkṣit to crows and watchdogs. The King is certainly the watchdog of the state in the sense that he keeps vigilant eyes over the border of the state for its protection and defense, but to address him as a watchdog is the sign of a less cultured boy. Thus the downfall of the brahminical powers began as

Text 34] Maharaja Parīkṣit Cursed by a Brahmin's Boy 967

they gave importance to birthright without culture. The downfall of the brāhmaṇa caste began in the age of Kālī. And since brāhmaṇas are the heads of the social order, all other orders of society also began to deteriorate. This beginning of brahminical deterioration was highly deplored by the father of Śrī Kṛṣṇa, as we will find.

TEXT 34

briihma[Lai[z kṣatra-bandhur hi
grha-piilo niriipita[l.

sa katham tad-grhe dviifi,sthafi.

sa-bhii[l!lam bhoktum arhati

briihmaraifi.-by the brahminical order; kṣatra-bandhufl.-the sons of the
kṣatriyas; hi-certainly; grha-piilajl- the watchdog; nirupita[t- designated;
safl.-he ; katham-on what grounds; tat-grhe- in the home of him (the
master); dviifl.sthafl.-keeping at the door; sa-bhii[l□am-in the same pot;
bhoktum-to eat; arhati-deserves.

TRANSLATION

The descendants of the kingly orders are definitely designated as
watchdogs, and they must keep themselves at the door. On what grounds
can dogs enter the house and claim to dine with the master on the
same plate?

PURPORT

The inexperienced briihma[La boy certainly knew that the King asked
for water from his father and the father did not respond. He tried to
explain away his father's inhospitality in an impertinent manner befitting
an uncultured boy. He was not at all sorry for the King's not being well
received. On the contrary, he justified the wrong act in a way characteristic
of the briihma[Las of Kali-yuga. He compared the King to a watchdog, and
so it was wrong for the King to enter the home of a briihma[La and ask for
water from the same pot. The dog is certainly reared by its master, but that
does not mean that the dog shall claim to dine and drink from the same
pot. This mentality of false prestige is the cause of the downfall of the
968 Srimad-Bhigavatam [Canto I, Ch. 18

perfect social order, and we can see that in the beginning it was started by
the inexperienced son of a briihmarta. As the dog is never allowed to enter
within the room and hearth, although it is reared by the master, similarly,
according to S!'flgi, the King had no right to enter the house of Kau□ika l_t□i.
According to the boy's opinion, the King was on the wrong side and not

his father, and thus he justified his silent father.

TEXT 35

kmw gate bhagavati

siistary utpatha-giiminiim

tad bhinna-setun adyiiham

siismi pa5yata me balam

k_r□l]e-Lord Kr□qa; gate-having departed from this world; bhagavati the Personality of Godhead; sastari-the supreme ruler; utpatha-giiminam of those who are upstarts; tat bhinna- being separated; setiin-the protector; adya-today; aham- myself; siismi-shall punish; pasyata-just see; me-my; balam-prowess.

TRANSLATION

After the departure of Lord Sri □□a the Personality of Godhead and supreme ruler of everyone, these upstarts have flourished, our protector being gone. Therefore I myself shall take up this matter and punish them. Just witness my power.

PURPORT

The inexperienced briihmarta, puffed up by a little brahma-teja, became influenced by the spell of Kali-yuga. Maharaja Pa□it gave license to Kali to live in four places as mentioned herein before, but by his very expert government the personality of Kali could hardly find the places allotted him. The personality of Kali-yuga was, therefore, seeking the opportunity to establish authority, and by the grace of the Lord he found a hole in the puffed up inexperienced son of a briihmarta. The little briihmarta wanted to show his prowess in destruction, and he had the audacity to punish a great king like Maharaja Pa□it. He wanted to take the place of Lord
Text 36] Maharaja Pa□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 969

Kr□□a after His departure. These are the principal signs of upstarts who want to take the place of Sri Kr□□a under the influence of the age of Kali. An upstart with a little power wants to become an incarnation of the Lord. There are many false incarnations after the departure of Lord Kr□□a from the face of the globe, and they are misleading the innocent public by

accepting the spiritual obedience of the general mass of people to maintain false prestige. In other words, the personality of Kali got the opportunity to reign through this son of a briihmar-a, Spigi.

TEXT 36

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etin□ □□ qpq"if fccijijJ (11□'11
ity uktvii ro□atiimriik□o
vayasyiin ni-biilakafī
kausiky iipa upasprsyā
viig vajram visasarja ha
iti- thus; uktva-saying; ro□a-tamra-ak□a[l-with red-hot eyes due to
being angry; vayasyan- unto the playmates; [ṣi-balakafī- the son of a [ṣi;
kausiki-the river Kausika; iipa[l-water; upasprsyā-hy touching; vak
words; vajram-thunderbolt; visasarja-threw; ha-in the past.

TRANSLATION

The son of the r□, his eyes red-hot with anger, touched the water of the River Kausika while speaking to his playmates and discharged the following thunderbolt of words.

PURPORT

The circumstances under which Maharaja Parilqit was cursed were simply childish, as it appears from this verse. Srngi was showing his impudency amongst his playmates, who were innocent. Any sane man would have prevented him from doing such great harm to all human society. By killing a king like Maharaja Parik;it, just to make a show of acquired brahminical powers, the inexperienced son of a briihmar-a committed a great mistake.

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TEXT 37

□ □□□·ij+f4:it□ □: mS(i"'wr ,
□□ □ t□□ :q(fa.al it□□ 11□\911
iti lnnghita-maryiidam
tak□akafi. sap tame 'hani

dank□yati sma kuliingiiram

codito me tata-druham

iti-thus; langhita-surpassing; maryiidam- etiquette; takṣak af!.-sn ake

bird; saptame-on the seventh; ahani- day; dankṣyati-will bite; sma

certainly; kuln-an giiram- the wretched of the dynasty; coditafi.- having

done; me-by; tata-druham-enmity towards the father.

TRANSLATION

The brahma!la's son cursed the King thus: On the seventh day from

today a snake-bird will bite the most wretched one of that dynasty

[Maharaja Pan□t] because of his having broken the laws of etiquette by insulting my father.

PURPORT

Thus the beginning of the misuse of brahminical power began, and

gradually the briihmartas in the age of Kali became devoid of both

brahminical powers and culture. The briihmarta boy considered Maharaja

Pan"□it to be kuliingiira, or the wretched of the dynasty, but factually the

briihmarta boy himself was so because from him only the briihmarta caste

became powerless, like the snake whose poisoned teeth are broken. The

snake is fearful as long as his poison teeth are there, otherwise he is fearful

only to children. The personality of Kali conquered the briihmarta boy

first, and gradually the other castes. Thus the whole scientific system of the

orders of society in this age has assumed the form of a vitiated caste sys

tem which is now being uprooted by another class of men similarly in

fluenced by the age of Kali. One should see to the root cause of vitiation

and not try to condemn the system as it is, without knowledge of its

scientific value.

Text 39) Maharaja Pa□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy

TEXT 38

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ttm □□□ □:m umm1 □ (□□□□□□

tato'bhyetyiisramam biilo

gale-sarpa□kalevaram

pitaram v"ikṣya dul)khiirto

mukta-ka!ltho ruroda ha

971

tata[t- thereafter; abhyetya- after entering into; ii.Sramam- the hermitage;
biilal)-boy; gale-sarpa- the snake on the shoulder; kalevaram-body;
pitaram-unto the father; v"ikṣya-having seen; duflkhiirtafl-in a sorry
plight; mukta-kaflthafl-loudly; ruroda-cried; ha-in the past.

TRANSLATION

Thereafter, when the boy returned to the hermitage, he saw a snake on
his father's shoulder, and out of his grief he cried very loudly.

PURPORT

The boy was not happy because he committed a great mistake, and he
wanted to be relieved of the burden on his heart by crying. So after enter-
ing the hermitage and seeing his father in that condition, he cried loudly
so that he might be relieved. But it was too late. The father regretted the
whole incidence.

TEXT 39

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sa vii iingiraso brahman

srutvii suta-viliipanam

unmuya sanakair netre

drṭvii ciimse mrtoragam

sal)-he ; vai-also; iingirasafl- the rṭi hom in the family of Angini;

brahman-o Saunaka; srutvii-on hearing; suta-his son; viliipanam-crying

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in distress; unmilya-opening; sanakaip-gradually; netre-by the eyes;

drṭlvii-by seeing; ca-also; amse-on the shoulder; mrta-dead; uragam
snake.

TRANSLATION

o brahmaJ.las, the rṭi, who was born in the family of Arigira Muni,
hearing his son crying, gradually opened his eyes and saw the dead snake

around his neck.

TEXT40

□ □ □ m□fi: UAA 1

□ en aS\t' #; < I □ ES □: U At □ (q { ltVoU

vis.rjya tan ca papraccha

vatsa kasmiidd hi rod□i

kena vii te 'pakrtam

ity ukta□ sa nyavedayat

uis.rjya- throwing aside; tam-that; ca-also; papraccha-asked; vatsa....:

my dear son; kasmat-what for; hi-certainly; rod□i- crying; kena-by

whom; uti-otherwise; te-they; apakrtam-misbehaved; iti-thus; ukta[.

being asked; sa[!.-the boy; nyavedayat-informed of everything.

TRANSLATION

He threw the dead snake aside and asked his son why he was crying, whether anyone had done him harm. On hearing this, the son explained to him what happened.

PURPORT

The father did not take the dead snake on his neck very seriously. He simply threw it away. Actually there was nothing seriously wrong in Maharaja Parik□it's act, but the foolish son took it very seriously, and being influenced by Kali he cursed the King and thus ended a chapter of happy history.

TEXT41

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□ QlaR WIR*I□ +i4WI;(((I

Text 41] Maharaja Par□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy

niSamya saptam atadarham narendram

sa briihma!JO natmajam abhyanandat

aho batamho mahad adya te krtam

alpiyasi droha urur damo dhrta□

973

niSamya- after hearing; saptam-cursed; atadarham-never to be con

demned; nara-indram-unto the King, best of humankind; safl- that;
 briihmaflalz-briihmafla [ši; na-not; iitma-jam-his own son; abhyanandat
 congratulated; aho- alas; bata-distressing; amhalz-sins; mahat- great;
 adya-today; te-yourself; krtam-performed; alpiyasi-insignificant;
 drohe-offense; urulz-very great; damafz-punishment; dhrtalz-awarded.

TRANSLATION

The father heard from his son that the King had been cursed, although he should never have been condemned for he was the best amongst all human beings. The □i did not congratulate his son but, on the contrary, began to repent, saying: Alas! What a great sinful act was performed by my son. He has awarded heavy punishment for an insignificant offense.

PURPORT

The king is the □est of all human beings. He is the representative of God, and he is never to be condemned for any of his actions. In other words, the king can do no wrong. The king may order hanging of a culprit son of a briihmapa, but he does not become sinful for killing a briihmafla. Even if there is something wrong with the king, he is never to be condemned. A medical practitioner may kill a patient by mistaken treatment, but such a killer is never condemned to death. So what to speak of a good and pious king like Maharaja Pañit? In the Vedic way of life, the king is trained to become a riija'ši, or a great saint, although he is ruling as king. It is the king only by whose good government the citizens can live peacefully and without any fear. The riija'šis would manage their kingdom so nicely and piously that their subjects would respect them as if they were the Lord. That is the instruction of the Vedas. The king is called narendra, or the best amongst the human beings. How then could a king like Mahara-
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raJa Pañit be condemned by an inexperienced puffed up son of a briihmarza, even though he attained the powers of a qualified briihmarza? The Samlk Jñi, since he was an experienced good briihmarza, did not approve of the actions of his condemned son. He began to lament for all that his son had done. The king was beyond the jurisdiction of curses as a

general rule, and what to speak of a good king like Maharaja Parikṣit. The offense of the King was most insignificant, and his being condemned to death was certainly a very great sin for Śrī. Therefore the Śrī Saniik regretted the whole incidence.

TEXT42

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na vai nrbhir nara-devam pariikhyam

sammiiitum arhasy avipakva-buddhe

yat-tejasii durviśaherza guptii

vindanti bhadrii[ly akutobhayiifi. prajii॥

na-never; vai-as a matter of fact; nrbhiḥ-by any man; nara-devam

unto a man-god; pariikhyam-who is transcendental; sammatum-place on

equal footing; arhasi-deserve; avipakva-unripe or immature; buddhe

intelligence; yat-by whose; tejasii-by the prowess; durvīśaḥ[La-unsur

passable; gupta[l-protected; vindanti-enjoys; bhadriirzi-all prosperity;

akutaḥ-bhayii॥-completely defended; prajiiḥ- the subjects.

TRANSLATION

O my boy, your intelligence is immature, and therefore you have no knowledge that the King, who is the best amongst human beings, is as good as the Personality of Godhead. Therefore he is never to be placed on an equal footing with common men. The citizens of the state live in prosperity, being protected by his unsurpassable prowess.

TEXT43

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Text 43] Maharaja Paṇḍit Cursed by a Brahmat;ta Boy

alakṣyaṁniir-e nara-deva-niimni

rathiihga-piir-iiv ayam ariga lokafi.
tadii hi caura-pracuro vinahk.syaty
arakṣyamiir-o 'vivaruthavat kṣartiit

975

alakuamiir-e-being abolished; nara-deva-monarchical; niimni-of the
name; ratha-ahga-piir-au-the representative of the Lord; ayam- this;
anga-o my boy; lokafi.-this world; tadii hi-at once; caura-thieves;
pracurafi.-too much; vinankṣyati-vanquishes; arakṣyamiir-afi.-being pro
tec ted; avivariithavat-like lambs; kṣar-iit-at once__

TRANSLATION

My dear boy, the Lord, who carries the wheel of a chariot, is represented
by the monarchical regime, and when this regime is abolished the whole
world becomes filled with thieves, who then at once vanquish the
unprotected subjects like scattered lambs__

PURPORT

According to Srimad-Bhīgavatam the monarchical regime represents the
Supreme Lord, the Personality of Godhead. The king is said to be the
representative of the Absolute Personality of Godhead because he is trained
to acquire the qualities of God to protect the living beings. The Battle of
Kurukṣetra was planned by the Lord to establish the real representative of
the Lord, Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira. An ideal king thoroughly trained by
culture and devotional service with the martial spirit makes a perfect king.
Such a personal monarchy is far better than the so-called democracy of no
training and responsibility. The thieves and rogues of modern democracy
seek election by malrepresentation of votes, and the successful rogues and
thieves devour the mass of population. One trained monarch is far better
than hundreds of useless ministerial rogues, and it is hinted herein that by
abolition of a monarchical regime like that of Maharaja Parīkṣit, the mass
of people become open to many attacks of the age of Kali. They are never
happy in an overly advertised form of democracy. The result of such a
kingless administration is described in the following verses.

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TEXT44

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"Wl m□□□□q' □:II\∕\∕"

tad adya nafl piipam upaity ananvayam

yan naṣṭa-niithasya vasor vilumpakiit

parasparam ghnanti sapanti vrñjate

pasiin -striyo 'rthiin puru-dasyavo janiifl

tat-for this reason;adya- from this day;nafz-upon us;papam-reaction

of sin; upaiti-will overtake; ananvayam- disruption;yat- because ; naṣṭa

abolished; nathasya-of the monarchy; vaso{z- of wealth; vilumpakat

being plundered; parasparam-between one another; ghnanti-will kill;

sapanti-will do harm; v,mñjate-will steal;pasun-animals; striyafl- women;

arthiin-riches;puru- greatly ;dasyavafl- thieves; janiifz- the mass of people.

TRANSLATION

Due to the termination of the monarchical regimes and the plundering of the people's wealth by rogues and thieves, there will be great social disruptions. People will be killed and injured, and animals and women will be stolen. And for all these sins we shall be responsible.

PURPORT

The word nafz (we) is very significant in this verse. The sage rightly takes the responsibility of the brihmapm as a community for killing monarchical government and thus giving an opportunity to the so-called democrats, who are generally plunderers of the wealth of the state subjects. The so-called democrats capture the administrative machine without assuming responsibility for the prosperous condition of the citizens. Every one captures the post for personal gratification, and thus instead of one king, a number of irresponsible kings grow up to tax the citizens. It is foretold herein that in the absence of good monarchical government, everyone will be the cause of disturbance for others by plundering riches, animals, women, etc.

Text 45] Maharaja P[it Cursed by a Brahm[a Boy

TEXT45

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[+til+tiMfwA[ijl<: +t•d

wit *ticflwtlfltq qofdi!M:! [[[[[[[[

tadiirya-dharmafl praviliyate nrrtiirh

varfilsramiiciira-yutas trayi-mayafl

tato 'rtha-kiimiibhinivesitiitmaniirh

sunirh kapiniim iva varrta-sankarafl

977

tadii-at that time; iirya-progressive civilization; dharmafll-engagement;
praviliyate-is systematically vanquished; nrrtiim-of humankind; varrta
caste;iiSrama-orders of society; iiciira-yutafl-composed in a good manner;
trayi-mayafl-in terms of the Vedic injunction; tatafl-thereafter; artha
economic development; kiima-abhinivesita-fully absorbed in sense gratifi
cation; itmaniim-of men; suniim-like dogs; kapiniim-like monkeys;
iva-thus; varyw-sankaraft -unwanted population__

TRANSLATION

At that time the people in general will fall systematically from the
path of a progressive civilization in respect to the qualitative engagements
of the castes and the orders of society and the Vedic injunctions. Thus
they will be more attracted to economic development for sense gratifica
tion, and as a result there will be an unwanted population on the level of
dogs and monkeys.

PURPORT

It is foretold herein that in the absence of a monarchical regime, the
general mass of people will be an unwanted population like dogs and mon
keys. As the monkeys are too sexually inclined and dogs are shameless in
sexual intercourse, the general mass of population born of illegitimate
connection will systematically go astray from the Vedic way of good
manners and qualitative engagements in the castes and orders of life__

The Vedic way of life is the progressive march of the civilization of the Aryans_ The Aryans are progressive in Vedic civilization_ The Vedic civilization's destination is to go back to Godhead, back home, where there is no birth, no death, no old age and no disease. The Vedas direct everyone not to remain in the darkness of the material world but to go towards the light of the spiritual kingdom far beyond the material sky. The qualitative caste system and the orders of life are scientifically planned by the Lord and His representatives, the great sages. The perfect way of life gives all sorts of instruction in the things both material and spiritual. The Vedic way of life does not allow any man to be like the monkeys and dogs. A degraded civilization of sense gratification and economic development is the by-product of a godless or kingless government of the people, by the people, and for the people. The people should not, therefore, begrudge the poor administrations they themselves elect.

TEXT 46
Ril : U(J'\-u tcn: 1
l"t(lfltlil I
-- iill41'i&SN+i(ftr'u\l
dharma-piilo nara-pati"fl.
sa tu samrii{l brhac-chraviift
siikṣiin mahii-bhiigavato
riijarir haya-medhayiit
kṣut-trt-srama-yuto dino
naiviismac chiipam arhati
dharma-piila"fl.-the protector of religion; nara-pati"fl.-the King; sa"fl.-he;
tu-but; samriit-Emperor; brhat- highly; sravii"fl.-celebrated; siikṣiit
directly; mahii-bhiigavata"fl.-the first-class devotee of the Lord; riijar#ft
saint amongst the royal order; haya-medhayiit-great performer of horse
sacrifices; kṣut-hunger; trt-thirst; srama-yuta"fl.-tired and fatigued; dina"fl.
stricken; na-never; eva-thus; asmat-by us; siipam-curse ;arhati-deserves.

TEXT 46

Ril : U(J'\-u tcn: 1

l"t(lfltlil I

-- iill41'i&SN+i(ftr'u\l

dharma-piilo nara-pati"fl.

sa tu samrii{l brhac-chraviift

siikṣiin mahii-bhiigavato

riijarir haya-medhayiit

kṣut-trt-srama-yuto dino

naiviismac chiipam arhati

dharma-piila"fl.-the protector of religion; nara-pati"fl.-the King; sa"fl.-he;

tu-but; samriit-Emperor; brhat- highly; sravii"fl.-celebrated; siikṣiit

directly; mahii-bhiigavata"fl.-the first-class devotee of the Lord; riijar#ft

saint amongst the royal order; haya-medhayiit-great performer of horse

sacrifices; kṣut-hunger; trt-thirst; srama-yuta"fl.-tired and fatigued; dina"fl.

stricken; na-never; eva-thus; asmat-by us; siipam-curse ;arhati-deserves.

TRANSLATION

child; apakva-who is immature; buddhina-by intelligence; piipam
sinful act; krtam-has been done; tat bhagavan-therefore the Personality
of Godhead; sarva-tltmii-who is all-pervading; kṣantum-just to pardon;
arhati-deserve.

TRANSLATION

Then the rāi prayed to the all-pervading Personality of Godhead to
pardon his immature boy who had no intelligence and who committed the
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great sin of cursing a person who was completely free from all sins, who
was subordinate and who deserved to be protected.

PURPORT

Everyone is responsible for his own action, either pious or sinful. The
Jtāi Samik could foresee that his son had committed a great sin by cursing
Maharaja Panīit, who deserved to be protected by the briihmaczas, for he
was a pious ruler and completely free from all sins because of his being a
first-class devotee of the Lord. When an offense is done unto the devotee
of the Lord, it is very difficult to overcome the reaction. The briihmapas,
being at the head of the social orders, are meant to give protection to their
subordinates and not to curse them. There are occasions when a briihmapa
may furiously curse a subordinate kṣatriya or vaiśya, etc., but in the case
of Maharaja Panīit there was no grounds as already explained. The
foolish boy had done it out of sheer vanity in being a briihmapa's son, and
thus he became liable to be punished by the law of God. The Lord never
forgives a person who condemns His pure devotee. Therefore the foolish
Srngi had not only committed a sin by cursing a king, but also the greatest
offense. Therefore the rāi could foresee that only the Supreme Personality
of Godhead could save his boy from his sinful act. He therefore directly
prayed for pardon from the Supreme Lord who alone can undo a thing
which is impossible to change. The appeal was made in the name of a
foolish boy who had developed no intelligence at all.

A question may be raised herein that since it was the desire of the Lord
that Panīit Maharaja was put into that awkward position so that he might

be delivered from material existence, then why was a briihmacza's son made responsible for this offensive act? The answer is that the offensive act was performed by a child only so that he could be excused very easily, and thus the prayer of the father was accepted. But if the question is raised why the briihmapa community as a whole was made responsible for allowing Kali into the world affairs, the answer is given in the Variiha Purora that the demons who acted inimically toward the Personality of Godhead but were not killed by the Lord were allowed to take birth in the families of the briihmaczas to take advantage of the age of Kali. The all-merciful Lord gave them a chance to have their births in the families of the pious briihmaczas so that they could progress toward salvation. But the demons, instead of utilizing the good opportunity, misused the brahminical culture due to being puffed-up by vanity in becoming briihmaczas. The typical example is the son of Samik J;t□i, and all the foolish sons of briihmaczas are warned Text48) Maharaja Par□it Cursed by a Brahm□a Boy 981

hereby not to become as Srrigi and be always on guard against the demoniac qualities which they had in their previous births. The foolish boy was, of course, excused by the Lord, but others, who may not have a father like Samik □i, will be put into great difficulty if they misuse the advantages obtained by birth in a brtihmarta family.

TEXT48

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tiras-krtii vipralabdhii fl

saptii[t k.siptii hatii api

niisya tat pratikurvanti

tad-bhaktii fl prabhavo'pi hi

tirafl-krtii fl-being defamed; vipralabdhii fl-being cheated; saptii ft-being cursed; k\$iptii ft-disturbed by negligence; hatii fl-or even being killed; api-also; na-never; asya-for all these acts; tat- them; pratikurvanti counteract; tat-the Lord's; bhaktii fl-devotees; prabhava fl-powerful; api-although; hi-certainly.

TRANSLATION

The devotees of the Lord are so forbearing that even though they are defamed, cheated, cursed, disturbed, neglected or even killed, they are never inclined to avenge themselves.

PURPORT

Śaṅkara also knew that the Lord does not forgive a person who has committed an offense at the feet of a devotee. The Lord can only give direction to take shelter of the devotee only. He thought within himself that if Maharaja Parīkṣit would counter-curse the boy, he might be saved. But he knew also that a pure devotee is callous about worldly advantages or reverses. As such, the devotees are never inclined to counteract personal defamation, curses, negligences, etc. As far as such things are concerned, in personal affairs the devotees do not care for them. But in case of their being performed against the Lord and his devotees, then the devotee takes very strong action. It was a personal affair, and therefore Śaṅkara knew that the King would not take counteraction. Thus there was no other alternative than to place an appeal to the Lord for the immature boy.

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It is not that only the brahmarṣis are powerful enough to award curses or blessings upon the subordinates, but the devotee of the Lord, even though he may not be a brahmarṣi, is more powerful than a brahmarṣi. But a powerful devotee never misuses the power for personal benefit. Whatever power the devotee may have is always utilized in service towards the Lord and His devotees only.

TEXT 49

iti putra-kṛtiḥ
so 'nutapto mahī-munī,
svayam viprakṛto rījñī
na viiṅgham tad acintayat

iti putra-kṛtiḥ

so 'nutapto mahī-munī,

svayam viprakṛto rījñī

na viiṅgham tad acintayat

iti-Lhus; putra-son; kṛta-done by; aghena-by the sin; saḥ- he, the

muni; anutaptaJ:r,-regretting; mahii-munifr,-the sage; svayam-personally;
viprakrtafr,-being so insulted; riijiiii-the King; na-not; eva- certainly ;
angham-the sin; tat-that; acintayat- thought of it.

TRANSLATION

The sage thus regretted the sin committed by his own son. He did not
take the insult paid by the King very seriously_

PURPORT

The whole incidence is now cleared up. Maharaja Parikṣit's garlanding
the sage with a dead snake was not at all a very serious offense, but Spigi's
cursing the King was a serious offense. The serious offense was committed
by a foolish child only; therefore he deserved to be pardoned by the Su
preme Lord, although it was not possible to get free from the sinful reac
tion. Maharaja Parikṣit also did not mind the curse offered to him by a
foolish briihmarza. On the contrary, he took full advantage of the awkward
situation, and by the great will of the Lord, Maharaja Pṣit achieved the
highest perfection of life through the grace of Srila Sukadeva Gosvami.
Actually it was the desire of the Lord, and Maharaja Pṣit, J;tṣi Sarm"k
and his son Spi.gi were all instrumental in fulfilling the desire of the
Lord. So none of them were put into difficulty because everything was
done in relation with the Supreme Person.

Text 50] Maharaja Parṣit Cursed by a Brahma!la Boy

TEXT 50

priiyasafl siidhavo loke
parair dvandveṣu yojitiifl
na vyathanti na hrṣyanti
yata iitmii'gurtiisrayafl

983

prayasaṣ-generally; sadhavaṣ-saints ; loke-in this world; paraiṣ- by
others; dvandveṣu-in duality; yojitaṣ- being engaged; na-never; vyathan
ti-distressed; na-nor; hrṣyanti-takes pleasure; yataṣ!-because ; alma
self; aguu.u- asrayaṣ -transcendental.

TRANSLATION

Generally the transcendentalists, even though engaged by others in the dualities of the material world, are not distressed. Nor do they take pleasure [in worldly things], for they are transcendently engaged.

PURPORT

The transcendentalists are the- empiric philosophers, mystics and the devotees of the Lord. Empiric philosophers aim at the perfection of merging into the being of tile Absolute, the mystics aim at perceiving- the all pervading Supersoul, and the devotees of the Lord are engaged in the transcendental loving service of the Personality of Godhead. Since Brahman, Paramatma, or Bhagavan are different phases of the same Transcendence, all these transcendentalists are beyond the three modes of material nature. Material distresses and happinesses are products of the three modes, and therefore the causes of such material distress and happiness have nothing to do with the transcendentalists. The King was a devotee, and the [ṣi was a mystic. Therefore both of them were unattached to the accidentaJ in cidence created by the supreme will. The playful child was an instrument in fulfilling the Lord's will.

Thus end the Bhaktivedanta Purports of the First Canto, Eighteenth Chapter, of the Srlmad-Bhagavatam, entitled "Maharaja PanKṣit Cursed by a Briihmafla Boy."

CHAPTER NINETEEN

Appearance of sukadeva Gosvaml

TEXT I

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am □ wft:q'i•u4tt□d

M(I•IM ;mfur □m II □ 11

siita uvaca

mahi-patis tv atha tat-karma garhyam

vicintayann atma-krtam sudurmanalt

aho maya nicam anarya-vat krtam

niragasi brahmar-i gii{lha-tejasi

siita{t uvaca-Suta Gosvamī said; mahi-pati{t-the King; tu-but; atha
thus (while coming back home); tat-that; karma-act; garhyam-abomi
nable; vicintayan-thus thinking; atma-krtam-done by himself; sudur
mana{t-very much depressed; aho-alas; maya-by me; n"icam-heinous;
aniirya-uncivilized; vat-like; krtam-done ; niragasi-onto one who is fault
less; brahmar-i-onto a brahmar-a; gu{iha-grave; tejasi-onto the powerful.

TRANSLATION

Sri Siita Gosvami said: While returning home, the King [Maharaja
Pa□it) felt that the act he had committed against the faultless and
powerful brahma!U was heinous and uncivilized. Consequently he was
distressed.

PURPORT

The pious King regretted his accidental impr oper treatment of the
powerful briihma"(la who was faultless. Suc h repentance is natural for a
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good man like the King, and such repentance delivers a devotee from all
kinds of sins accidentally committed. The devotees are naturally faultless.
Accidental sins committed by a devotee are sincerely regretted, and by the
grace of the Lord all sins unwillingly committed by a devotee are b urnt in
the fire of repentance.

TEXT₂

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dhruvam tato me kṛta-deva-helaniid

duratyayam vyaśanam niiti-dirghii

tad astu kiimam hy agha-niṣkṛtīya me

yathii na kuryiim punar evaṁ addhii

dhruvam-sure and certain;tatal).-therefore;me-my;kṛta-deva-helaniit

because of disobeying the orders of the Lord;duratyayam-very difficult;
vyasanam-calamity; na-not;ati- greatly; dirghiit-far off; tat-that; astu
let it be; kiimam-desire without reservations; hi-certainly; agha-sins;
niṣkrtiia-for getting free; me-my; yathii-so that; na-never; kuryiim
shall I do it;punal).-again; evam-as I have done;addhii-directly.

TRANSLATION

[King Parikṣit thought:] Due to my neglecting the injunctions of the
Supreme Lord I must certainly expect some difficulty to overcome me in
the near future. I now desire without reservation that the calamity come
now, for in this way I may be freed of the sinful action and not commit
such an offense again.

PURPORT

The Supreme Lord enjoins that bṛiḥmapas and cows must be given all
protection. The Lord is Himself very much inclined to do good to
bṛiḥmapas and cows (go-brohmaṇa-hitiya ca). Maharaja Parikṣit knew all
this, and thus he concluded that his insulting a powerful bṛiḥmapa was
Text3] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 987
certainly to be punished by the laws of the Lord, and he was expecting
something very difficult in the very near future. He therefore desired the
imminent calamity to fall on him and not on his family members. A man's
personal misconduct affects all family members. Therefore Maharaja
Parikṣit desired the calamity to fall on him alone. By suffering personally he
would be restrained from future sins, and at the same time the sin which
he had committed would be counteracted so that his descendants would
not suffer. That is the way a responsible devotee thinks. The family mem-
bers of a devotee also share the effects of a devotee's service unto the
Lord. Maharaja Prahlada saved his demon father by his personal devotional
service. A devotee son in the family is the greatest boon or blessing of
the Lord.

TEXT3

adyaiva riijyam balam rddha-kosam
prakopita-brahma-kuliinalo me

dahatv abhadrasya punar na me ,bhiit
piipi"yasi dhir dvija-deva-gobhyafi,
adya-this day; eva-on the very; rajyam-kingdom; balam rddha
strength and riches; kosam-treasury; prakopita-ignited by; brahma-kula
by the brahmarza community; anala[l.-fire; me dahatu-let it burn me;
abhadrasya-inauspiciousness;puna[l.- again;na- not;me- unto me;abhiit
may occur; papiyasi'□sinful; dhilt-intelligence; dvija-brahmarzas; deva
the Supreme Lord; gobhya[l.-and the cows.

TRANSLATION

I am uncivilized and sinful due to my neglect of brahminical culture,
God consciousness and cow protection. Therefore I wish that my king dom,
strength and riches burn up immediately by the fire of the brahma□a's
wrath so that in the future I may not be guided by such inauspicious
attitudes.

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PURPORT

Progressive human civilization is based on brahminical culture, God
consciousness and protection of cows. All economic development of the
state by trade, commerce, agriculture and indust ries must be fully utilized
in relation to the above principles, otherwise all so-called economic
development becomes a source of degradation. Cow protection means
feeding the brahminical culture which leads towards God consciousness,
and thus perfection of human civilization is achieved. The age of Kali
aims at killing the higher principles of life, and although Maharaja Pa□it
strongly resisted the domination of the personality of Kali within the world,
the influence of the age of Kali came at an opportune moment, and even a
strong king like Maharaja Pan"K□it was induced to disregard the brahminical
culture due to a slight provocation of hunger and thirst. Maharaja Parik□it
lamented the accidental incidence, and he desired that all his kingdom,
strength and accumulation of wealth would be burnt up for not being
engaged in brahminical culture, etc.

Providentially also, where wealth and strength are not engaged in the

advancement of brahminical culture, God consciousness and cow protection, the state and home are surely doomed. If we want peace and prosperity in the world, we should take lessons from this verse; every state and every home must endeavor to advance the cause of brahminical culture for self-purification, God consciousness for self-realization and cow protection for getting sufficient milk and the best food to continue a perfect civilization.

TEXT4

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sa cintayann ittham athasrrwd yathii
munel). sutokto nirrtis tak\$akiikhya).

sa siidhu mene na cirerta tak\$akii

nam prasaktasya virakti-kiirartam

sal).-he, the King; cintayan-thinking; ittham-like this; atha-now;

asrrtot- heard; yathii-as; munel).-of the sage; suta-ukta[l-uttered by the

Text 4) Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 989

son; nirrtift-death; tak□aka-iikhyaf-in relation with the snake-bird; sap

he (the King); siidhu-well and good; mene-accepted; na-not; cirerza

very long time; tak□aka-snake-bird; analam-fire; prasaktasya-for one who

is too attached; virakti-indifference; kiirarzam-cause.

TRANSLATION

While the King was thus repenting, he received news of his imminent death, which would be due to the bite of a snake-bird, occasioned by the curse spoken by the sage's son. The King accepted this as good news, for it would be the cause of his indifference towards worldly things.

PURPORT

Real happiness is achieved by spiritual existence or by cessation of the repetition of birth and death. The repetition of birth and death can be stopped only by going back to Godhead. In the material world, even by

attaining the topmost planet (Brahmaloka), one cannot get rid of the conditions of repeated birth and death, but we do not accept the path of attaining perfection. The path of perfection frees one from all material attachments, and thus one becomes fit to enter into the spiritual kingdom. Therefore, those who are materially poverty-stricken are better candidates than those who are materially prosperous. Maharaja Parikṣit was a great devotee of the Lord and a bona fide candidate for entering into the kingdom of God, but even though he was so, his material assets as the Emperor of the world were setbacks to perfect attainment of his rightful status as one of the associates of the Lord in the spiritual sky. As a devotee of the Lord, he could understand that the cursing of the brihmarw boy, although unwise, was a blessing upon him, being the cause of detachment from worldly affairs, both political and social. Samika Muni also, after regretting the incidence, conveyed the news to the King as a matter of duty so that the King would be able to prepare himself to go back to Godhead. Samika Muni sent news to the King that foolish Spigi, his son, although a powerful brihmarza boy, unfortunately had misused his spiritual power by cursing the King unwarrantedly. The incidence of the King's garlanding the muni was not sufficient cause for being cursed to death, but since there was no way to retract the curse, the King was informed to prepare for death within a week. Both Samika Muni and the King were self-realized souls. Samika Muni was a mystic, and Maharaja Parikṣit was a devotee. Therefore there was no difference between them in self realization. Neither of them was afraid of meeting death. Maharaja

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Paṇḍita could have gone to the muni to beg his pardon, but the news of imminent death was conveyed to the King with so much regret by the muni that the King did not want to shame the muni further by his presence there. He decided to prepare himself for his imminent death and find out the way to go back to Godhead.

The life of a human being is a chance to prepare himself to go back to Godhead, or to get rid of the material existence, the repetition of birth

and death. Thus in the system of varp.iiSrama-dharma every man and woman is trained up for this purpose. In other words, the system of varp.iisrama dharma is known also as saniitana-dharma, or eternal occupation. The system of varr-asrama-dharma prepares a man for going back to Godhead, and thus a householder is ordered to go to the forest as viinaprastha to acquire complete knowledge and then to take sannyyiisa prior to his inevitable death. Pariksit Maharaja was fortunate to get a seven-day notice to meet his inevitable death. But for the common man there is no definite notice, although death is inevitable for all. Foolish men forget this sure fact of death and neglect the duty of preparing themselves for going back to Godhead. They spoil their lives in animal propensities to eat, drink, be merry and enjoy. Such an irresponsible life is adopted by the people in the age of Kali because of a sinful desire to condemn brahminical culture, God consciousness and cow protection, for which the state is responsible. The state must employ revenue to advance these three items and thus educate the populace to prepare for death. The state which does so is the real welfare state. The state of India should better follow the examples of Maharaja Pariksit, the ideal executive head, than to imitate other materialistic states which have no idea of the kingdom of Godhead, the ultimate goal of human life. Deterioration of the ideals of Indian civilization has brought about the deterioration of civic life, not only in India but also abroad.

TEXTS

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atho vihiyemam amurh ca lokarh

vimarsitau heyatayii purastiit

kr□TJiinghri-seviim adhimanyamiina

upiiViSat priiyam amartya-nadyiim

Text 5] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvarni 991

atho-thus;vihiiya-giving up;imam-this;amum-and the next;ca-also;

lokam-planets; vimariitau-all of them being judged; heyatayi.i._because of inferiority; purastat-hereinbefore; k."§T}U-{lñghri-lotus feet of the Lord, Sr! Kf□Qa; sevam-transcendental lqving service; adhimanyamanafl-one who thinks of the greatest of all achievements; upaviSat-sat down firmly; prayam-for fasting; amartya-nadyam-on the bank of the transcendental river (the Ganges or the Yamuna:).

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Par□it sat down firmly on the banks of the Ganges to concentrate his mind in Kr□□a consciousness, rejecting all other practices of self-realization, because transcendental loving service of Kr□Qa is the greatest achievement, superseding all other methods.

PURPORT

For a devotee like Maharaja Par□it, none of the material planets, even the topmost Brahmaloka, is as desirable as Goloka Vrñdavana, the abode of Lord Sri Kr□□a, the primeval Lord and Original Personality of Godhead. This earth is one of the innumerable material planets within the universe, and there are innumerable universes also within the compass of the mahat tattva. The devotees are told by the Lord and His representatives, the spiritual masters or acaryas, that not one of the planets within all the innumerable universes is suitable for the residential purposes of a devotee. The devotee always desires to go back home, back to Godhead, just to become one of the associates of the Lord in the capacity of servitor, friend, parent or conjugal lover of the Lord, either in one of the innumerable Vaikuñṭha planets or in the Goloka Vrñdavana, the planet of Lord Sri Kr□!ia. All these planets are eternally situated in the spiritual sky, the Paravyoma, which is on the other side of the Causal Ocean within the mahat-tattva. Maharaja Parik□it was already aware of all this information due to his accumulated piety and birth in a high family of devotees, the V aif?!la vas, and thus he was not at all interested in the material planets. Modern scientists are very eager to reach the moon by material arrangements, but they cannot conceive of the highest planet of this universe. But a devotee like Maharaja PanK.f?it does not care a fig for the moon or,

for that matter, any of the material planets. So when he was assured of his death on a fixed date, he became more determined in the transcendental loving service of the Lord Kṛṣṇa by complete fasting on the bank of
992 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

the transcendental River Yamuna which flows down by the capital of Hastinapura (in the Delhi state). Both the Ganges and the Yamuna are amartya (transcendental) rivers, and Yamuna is still more sanctified for the following reasons.

TEXT6

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ya vai lasac-chr"i-tulas"i-vimisra-

kn rJanghri-rer-v-abhyadhikambu-netr"i

punati lokan ubhayatra sesiin

kas tam na seveta mariṣyamiir-a"ft

ya-the river which; vai- always; lasat-floating with; sr"i-tulas"i- tulasi leaves; vimiSra-mixed; kr□r-a-anghri- lotus feet of the Lord, Sri Kṛṣṇa; rer-u-dust; abhyadhika-auspicious; ambu-water; netn-that which is carrying; puniiti-sanctifies ; lokan-planets ; ubhayatra-both the upper and lower or inside and outside; sa-"isan-along with Lord Siva ; ka"fl-who else; tam-that river; na-does not; seveta-worship; mariṣyamiir-a"ft-one who is to die at any moment.

TRANSLATION

The river [Ganges, by which the King sat to fast] carries the most auspicious water, which is mixed with the dust of the lotus feet of the Lord and tulasi leaves. Therefore that water sanctifies the three worlds inside and outside and even sanctifies Lord Siva and other demigods. Consequently everyone who is destined to die must take shelter of this river.

PURPORT

Maharaja Pan"kaṭ, just after receiving the news of his death within seven

days, at once retired from family life and shifted himself to the sacred bank of the Yamuna River. Generally it is said that the King took shelter on the bank of the Ganges, but according to Srila Jiva Gosvami, the King took shelter on the bank of the Yamuna. Srila Jiva Gosvami's statement [Text 7] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 993

appears to be more accurate because of the geographical situation.

Maharaja Panita resided in his capital Hastinapura, situated near present Delhi, and the River Yamuna flows down past the city. Naturally the King would take shelter of the River Yamuna because she was flowing past his place door. And as far as sanctity is concerned, the River Yamuna is more directly connected with Lord Krishna than the Ganges. The Lord sanctified the River Yamuna from the beginning of His transcendental pastimes in the world. While His father Vasudeva was crossing the Yamuna with the baby Lord Krishna for a safe place at Gokula on the other bank of the river from Mathura, the Lord fell down in the river, and by the dust of His lotus feet the river at once became sanctified. It is especially mentioned herein that Maharaja Panita took shelter of that particular river which is beautifully flowing, carrying the dust of the lotus feet of Lord Krishna, mixed with tulasi leaves. Lord Krishna's lotus feet are always besmeared with the tulasi leaves, and thus as soon as His lotus feet are contacted with the water of the Ganges and the Yamuna, the rivers become at once sanctified. The Lord, however, contacted the River Yamuna more than the Ganges. According to the Varaha Purana, as quoted by Srila Jiva Gosvami, there is no difference between the water of the Ganges and the Yamuna, but when the water of the Ganges is sanctified one hundred times, it is called the Yamuna. Similarly, it is said in the scriptures that one thousand names of Vishnu are equal to one name of Rama, and three names of Lord Rama are equal to one name of Krishna.

TEXT 7

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iti vyavacchidya sa pii"l{iaveyafl

priiyopavesam prati v□rtu-padyiim

dadhau mukundiinghrim ananya-bhiivo

· muni-vrato mukta-samasta-sangafl

iti-thus; vyavacchidya-having decided; safl-the King; pii"l{iaveyafl

worthy descendant of the PaJ;u.}avas; priiya-upavesam-for fasting until

death; prati- towards ; v□"l{u-padyiim-on the bank of the Ganges (emanat-

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ing from the lotus feet of Lord Vi□J;!U); dadhau-gave himself up; mukunda

anghrim-onto the lotus feet of Lmd Kf□J;ia; ananya-without deviation;

b/uiva□-spirit; muni-vrata□-with the vows of a sage; mukta-liherated

from; samasta-all kinds of; sanga□-association.

TRANSLATION

·Thus the King, the worthy descendant of the P□□avas, decided once

and for all and sat on the Ganges' banks to fast until death and give

himself up to the lotus feet of Lord Kr□□a, who alone is able to award

liberation. So, freeing himself from all kinds of associations and attach

ments, he accepted the vows of a sage.

PURPORT

The water of the Ganges sanctifies all the three worlds, including the

gods and the demigods, because it emanates from the lotus feet of the

Personality of Godhead V□□u. Lord Kr□!la is the fountainhead of the

principle of Vi□J;lu-tattva, and therefore shelter of His lotus feet can deliver

one from all sins, including an offense which was committed by the King

unto a briihmarw. Maharaja Pan""k□it, therefore, decided to meditate upon

the lotus feet of Lord Sri Kr□!J.a, who is Mukunda, or the giver of libera

tions of all description. The hanks of the Ganges or the Yamuna give one

a chance to remember the Lord continuously. Maharaja Pan□it freed

himself from all sorts of material association and meditated upon the

lotus feet of Lord Kr□!J.a, and that is the way of liberation. To be free

from all material association means to cease completely from committing

any further sins. To meditate upon the lotus feet of the Lord means to become free from the effects of all previous sins. The conditions of the material world are so made that one has to commit sins willingly or unwillingly, and the best example is Maharaja Pan"it himself, who was a recognized sinless pious king. But he also became a victim of an offense, even though he was ever unwilling to commit such a mistake. And he was cursed also, hut because he was a great devotee of the Lord, even such reverses of life became favorable. The principle is that one should not willingly commit any sin in his life and should constantly remember the lotus feet of the Lord without deviation. In such a mood only the Lord will help the devotee to make regular progress towards the path of liberation and thus attain the lotus feet of the Lord. Even if there are accidental

Text 8] Appearance of Sukadev a Gosvami 995

sins committed by the devotee, the Lord saves the surrendered soul from all sins, as it is confirmed in all scriptures.

svapiidamularh bhajata□ priyasya tyaktiinyabhiivasya hari□ paresa□
vikarma yaccotpatitarh kathancid dhunoti sarvam h,rdi sannivi□.ta.h
(Bhiig. 11.5.42)

TEXTS

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tatropajagmur bhuvanam puniini
mahiinubhiivii munayafi. sa-si\$yiifi.
priiyer.a tirthiibhigamiipadesaifi.
svayam hi tirthiini punanti santafi.

tatra-there; upajagmufi.-arrived; bhuvanam- the universe; puniiniifi.
those who can sanctify; mahii-anubhiivifi,-great minds; munayafi.-thinkers;
sa-s□yiifi.-along with their disciples; prayer-a-almost; tirtha-place of
pilgrimage; abhigama-journey; apadesaifi.-on the plea of; svayam-person
ally; hi-certainly; tirthiini-all the places of pilgrimage; punanti-sanctify;

santafi.-sages.

TRANSLATION

At that time all the great minds and thinkers, accompanied by their disciples, and sages who could verily sanctify a place of pilgrimage just by their presence, arrived there on the plea of making a pilgrim's journey.

PURPORT

When Maharaja Parīṭ sat down on the bank of the Ganges, the news spread in all directions of the universe, and the great-minded sages, who could follow the importance of the occasion, all arrived there on the plea of pilgrimage. Actually they came to meet Maharaja Parīṭ and not to take a bath of pilgrimage because all of them were competent enough to

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sanctify the pilgrimages. Common men go to pilgrimage sites to get themselves purified of all sins. Thus the place of pilgrimage becomes overburdened with the sins of others. But when such sages visit overburdened places of pilgrimage, they sanctify the place by their presence. Therefore the sages who came to meet Maharaja Parīṭ were not very much interested in getting themselves purified like other common men, but on the plea of taking a bath in that place they came to meet Maharaja Parīṭ because they could foresee that Srimad-Bhagavatam would be spoken by Sukadeva Gosvami. All of them wanted to take advantage of the great occasion.

TEXTS 9-10

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atrir vas□thas cyavana□ saradvii

ari□tanemir bhr̥gur angiriis ca
 pariisaro giidhi-suto 'tha riima
 utath ya indrapramadedhmaviihau
 medhiitithir devala iir□□e!lo
 bhiiradviijo gautama□ pippaliida□
 maitreya aurva□ kava□a□ kumbhayonir
 dvaipiiyano bhagaviin niiradas ca
 atri to nt'irada-all names of the different saintly personalities who arrived
 there from different parts of the universe.

TRANSLATION

From different parts of the universe there arrived great sage& like
 Atri, Cyavana, Saradviin, □1anemi, Bh□, Vas□ha, Parasara, V i8vlimitra,
 Texts 9-10] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvimi 997
 Ari.girii, Para8urama, Utathya, Indrapramada, Idhmavahu, Medhatithi,
 Devala, Ar□ti□□a, Bharadvaja, Gautama, Pippalada, Maitreya, Aurva,
 Kav□a, Kumhhayoni, Dvaipayana and the great personality Narada_

PURPORT

Cyavana: A great sage and one of the sons of Bh̥gu Muni. He was born
 prematurely when his pregnant mother was kidnapped. Cyavana is one of
 the six sons of his father.

Bh̥gu: When Brahmaji was performing a great sacrifice on behalf of
 Varu□a, Mahar□i Bh̥gu was born from the sacrificial fire. He was a great
 sage, and his very dear wife was Puloma. He could travel in space like
 Durvasa, Narada and others, and he used to visit all planets of the
 universe. Before the Battle of Kuru□etra, he tried to stop the battle.
 Sometimes he instructed Bharadvaja Muni about astronomical evolution,
 and he is the author of the gr.eat Bh̥gu-samhitii, the astrological calcula
 tion. He explained how air, fire, water and earth are generated from ether.
 He explained how the air in the stomach works and regulates the intestines.
 As a great philosopher, he logically established the eternity of the living
 entity (Mahiibhiirata, Siinti, Ch. 87). He was also a great anthropologist,
 and the theory of evolution was long ago explained by him. He was a

scientific propounder of the four divisions and orders of human society known as the varṇāśrama institution. He converted the kṣatriya king Bitahavyak to become a brahmar-a. .

Parīśara: He is the grandson of Vasīṣṭha Muni and father of Vyāsa-deva. He is the son of Mahādevī Sakti, and his mother's name was Adrisyanti. He was in the womb of his mother when she was only twelve years old. And from within the womb of his mother he learned the Vedas. His father was killed by a demon, Kalmāspada, and to avenge this he wanted to annihilate the whole world. He was, however, restrained by his grandfather Vasīṣṭha. He then performed a Rākṣas-killing yajna, but Mahārāṣi Pulasta restrained him. He begot Vyāsa-deva, being attracted by Satyawati, who was to become the wife of Maharaja Santanu. By the blessings of Parasara, Satyawati became fragrant for miles. He was present also during the time of Bhīṣma's death. He was spiritual master of Maharaja Janaka and a great devotee of Lord Siva. He is the author of many Vedic scriptures and sociological directions.

Gandhī-suta or Viśvāmitra: A great sage of austerity and mystic power.

He is famous as Gandhī-suta because his father was Gandhī, a powerful king of the province of Kanyakubja (part of Uttar Pradesh). Although he was a kṣatriya by birth, he became a brahmar-a in the very same body by 998 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 19

the power of his spiritual achievements. He picked a quarrel with Vasīṣṭha Muni when he was a kṣatriya king, and performed a great sacrifice in cooperation with Matanga Muni and thus was able to vanquish the sons of Vasīṣṭha. He became a great yogi, and yet he failed to check his senses and thus was obliged to become the father of Sakuntalā, the beauty queen of world history. Once, when he was a kṣatriya king, he visited the hermitage of Vasīṣṭha Muni, and he was given a royal reception. Visvāmitra wanted from Vasīṣṭha a cow named Nandini, and the Muni refused to deliver it. He stole the cow, and thus there was a quarrel between the sage and the King. Visvāmitra was defeated by the spiritual strength of Vasīṣṭha, and thus the King decided to become a brahmarta. Before becoming a brah

marta he underwent severe austerity on the bank of the Kausika. He was also one who tried to stop the Kurukṣetra war.

Angirī: He is one of the six mental sons of Brahma and the father of Brhaspati, the great learned priest of the demigods in the heavenly planets. He is horn of the semen of Brahmaji given to a cinder of fire. Utthato and Samvarta are his sons. It is said that he is still performing austerity and chanting the holy name of the Lord at a place known as Alokānanda on the banks of the Ganges.

Utathya: One of the three sons of Maharṣi Atri. He was the spiritual master of Maharaja Mandhata. He married Bhadrī, the daughter of Soma (Moon). Varuṇa kidnapped his wife Bhadrī, and to retaliate the offense of the god of water, he drank all the water of the world.

Medhātithi: An old sage of yore. An assembly member of the heavenly King Indradeva. His son was Kanva Muni, who brought up Sakuntala in the forest. He was promoted to the heavenly planet by strictly following the principles of retired life (vīnaprastha).

Devala: A great authority like Nārada Muni and Vyāsadeva. His good name is on the list of authorities mentioned in the Bhagavad-gītā when Arjuna acknowledged Lord Kṛṣṇa as the Supreme Personality of Godhead. He met Maharaja Yudhiṣṭhira after the Battle of Kurukṣetra, and he is the elder brother of Dhāmya, the priest of the Pīṇava family. Like the kṣātriyas, he also allowed his daughter to select her own husband in a svayamvara meeting, and at that ceremony all the bachelor sons of the ṛṣis were invited. According to some, he is not .Aṁita Devala.

Gautama: One of the seven great sages of the universe. Saradvan Gautama is one of his sons. Persons in the Gautama-gotra (dynasty) today are either his family descendants or in his disciplic succession. The brāhmaṇas who profess Gautama-gotra are generally family descendants, and the kṣātriyas and vaiśyas who profess Gautama-gotra are all in the line

Text 11] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 999

of his disciplic succession. He is the husband of the famous Ahalya who turned into stone, and Indradeva the King of the heaven molested her.

Ahalya was delivered by Lord Ramacandra. He is the grandfather of Kṛpacarya, one of the heroes of the Battle of Kuruṁetra.

Maitreya: A great ṛṣi of yore. He was spiritual master of Vidura and a great religious authority. He advised Dhṛtaraṁtra to keep good relations with the Paṇḍavas. Duryodhana disagreed and thus was cursed by him. He met Vyasaḍeva and had religious discourses with him.

TEXT 11

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anye ca devarṣi-brahmar□i-varyii

riijarṣi-varyii aru[liidayas ca

niiniirṣeya-pravariin same tiin

abhyarcya riijii sirasii vavande

anye-many others; ca-also; devar□i-saintly demigods; brahmar□i

saintly briihma[&as; varyiifl-topmost; riijar□i- varyiifl- topmost saintly kings;

arupa iidayafI-a special rank of riijar□is; ca-and; niinii- many others;

iir□eya-pravariin-chief amongst the dynasties of the sages; sametiin

assembled together; abhyarcya-by worshiping; riija- the Emperor;

sirasii-bowed his head to the ground; vavande-welcomed.

TRANSLATION

'There were also many other saintly demigods, kings and special royal orders called □adayas [a special rank of rajar□is] from different dynasties of sages. When they all assembled to gether to meet the Emperor [Pari□t], he received them properly and bowed his head to the ground.

PURPORT

The system of bowing the head to the ground to show respect to superiors is an excellent etiquette which obliges the honored guest deep into the heart. -Even the first-grade offender is excused simply by this 1000 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19 process, and Maharaja Pari4it, although honored by all the .riJis and kings,

welcomed all the big men in that humble etiquette in order to be excused from any offenses. Generally at the last stage of one's life this humble method is adopted by every sensible man in order to be excused before departure. In this way Maharaja Parikṣit implored everyone's good will for going back home, back to Godhead.

TEXT 12

□I

□□□□II

sukhopav□te□v atha te□u bhiiyab,
krta-pra!liimab, sva-cik"irṣitam yat
vijiiipayimiisa viviktacetii
upasthito ,gre ,bhi.grhṛta-pii!lil
sukha-happily; upaviṣṭeṣu-all sitting down; atka-thereupon; teṣu
unto them (the visitors); bhu yafi. -again; k_rta-pra!liimafi.-having offered
obeisances; sva-his own; cikirṣitam-decision of fasting; yat- who;
vijiiipayimiisa-submitted; vivikta-cetiifi.-one whose mind is detached from
worldly affairs; upas thitafi.-being present; agre-before them; abhigrhita
piirifi.-humbly with folded hands.

TRANSLATION

Mter all the □s and others had seated themselves comfortably, the King, humbly standing before them with folded hands, told them of his decision to fast until death.

PURPORT

Although the King had already decided to fast until death on the bank of the Ganges, still he humbly expressed his decision to elicit the opinions of the great authorities present there. Any decision, however important, should be confirmed by some authority. That makes the matter perfect. This means that the monarchs who ruled the earth in those days were not irresponsible dictators. They scrupulously followed the authoritative deci-
Text 13] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1001
sions of the saints and sages in terms of Vedic injunction. Maharaja Parikṣit, as a perfect king, followed the principles by consulting the

authorities, even up to the last days of his life.

TEXT 13

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riijoviica

aho vayarh dhanyatamii nrpiirtiirh

mahattamiinugrahartiya-filiifl

riijiiiirh kularh briihmarta-piida-sauciid

· diiriid visr\$tarh bata garhya-karma

sn ro1a uvaca-the fortunate King said; aho-ah; vayam-we; dhanya

tamafl-most thankful; nrpiirtam-of all the kings; mahattama-of the great

souls; anugrahartiya-s'iliifl-trained to get favors; riijiiam- of the royal;

kulam-orders; briihmarta-pada-feet of the brahma[ta]; sauciit-refuse after

cleaning; diirat-at a distance; visr\$tam- always left out; bata-on account

of; garhya- condemnable; karma- activities.

TRANSLATION

The fortunate King said: We are the most grateful of all the kings

who are trained to get favors from the great souls. Generally you [sages]

consider royalty as refuse to be rejected and left in a distant place.

PURPORT

According to religious principle, stool, urine, wash water, etc., must be

left out at a long distance. Attached bath rooms, urinals, etc., may be very

convenient amenities of modern civilization, but they are ordered to be

situated at a distance from residential quarters. That very example is cited

herein in relation to the kingly order for those who are progressively

marching back to Godhead. Lord Sri Caitanya Mahaprabhu said that

to be in intimate touch with dollars and cents men, or the kingly

1002 Srimad-Bhigavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

order, is worse than suicide for one who desires to go back to Godhead. In

other words, the transcendentalists do. not generally associate with inen who are too enamored by the external beauty of God's creation. By advanced knowledge in spiritual realization, the transcendentalist knows that this beautiful material world is nothing but a shadowy reflection of the reality, the kingdom of God. They are not, therefore, very much captivated by royal opulence or anything like that. But in the case of Maharaja PanK.□it, the situation was different. Apparently the King was condemned to death by an inexperienced briihmal)a boy, but factually he was called by the Lord to return to Him. Other transcendentalists, the great sages and mystics who assembled together because of Maharaja Parik□it's fasting unto death, were quite anxious to see him, for he was going back to Godhead. Maharaja Parik□it also could understand that the great sages' who assembled there were all kind to his f orefathers, the Pa□□avas, because of their devotional service of the Lord. He felt, therefore, grateful to the sages for being present there at the last stage of his life, and he felt that it was all due to the greatness of his late forefathers or grandfathers. He felt proud, therefore, that he happened to be the descendant of such great devotees. Such pride for the devotees of the Lord is certainly not equal to the puffed up sense of vanity for material prosperity. The first is reality, whereas the other is false and vain.

TEXT 14

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tasyaiva me 'ghasya pariivareso

vyiisakta-cittasya grhe□v abhik□l)am

nirveda-mulo dvija-siipa-riipo

yatra prasakto bhayam iisu dhatte

tasya-his; eva-certainly; me-mine; aghasya-of the sinful; parii-tran

scendental;avara-mundane; isa[l-controller, the Supreme Lord; vyiisakta

overly attached; cittasya-of the mind; grhe□u-to family affairs;

abhiṣam-always; nirveda-mula[1-the.source of detachment; dvija-siipa
cursing by the brihmal)a; rupa[1- form of; yatra-whereupon; prasakta[1-
Text 15] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1003

one who is affected; bhayam-fearlessness; iisu-very soon; dhatte-take
place.

TRANSLATION

The Supreme Personality of Godhead, the controller of both the
transcendental and mundane worlds, has graciously overtaken me in the
form of a brahmin's curse. Due to my being too much attached to family
life, the Lord, in order to save me, has appeared before me in such a way
that out of fear only I will detach myself from the world.

PURPORT

Maharaja Parikṣit, although born in a family of great devotees, the
Paṇḍavas, and although securely trained in transcendental attachment for
the association of the Lord, still found the allurements of mundane family
life so strong that he had to be detached by a plan of the Lord. Such
direct action is taken up by the Lord in the case of a special devotee.
Maharaja Parikṣit could understand this by the presence of the topmost
transcendentalists in the universe. The Lord resides with His devotees, and
therefore the presence of the great saints indicated the presence of the
Lord. The King therefore welcomed the presence of the great rṣis as a
mark of favor of the Supreme Lord.

TEXT 15

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tam mopayiitam pratiyantu viprii

gangii ca devi dhrta-cittam iSe

dvijopasrfitaf. kuhakas takṣako vii

dasatv alam giyata vi.ṣ!lu-giithiifl.

tam-for that reason; mii-me; upayiitam-taken shelter of; pratiyantu

just accept me; vipriifi,-o briihma!J.as; gangii- mother Ganges; ca-also;
 deui-direct representative of the Lord; dhrta-taken into; cittam-heart;
 iSe-unto the Lord; dvija-upasntafl.-created by the briihma!J.a; kuhakafl-
 1004 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19
 something magical; tak□k□-the snake-bird; vii-either; dasatu-let it bite;
 alam-without further delay; gayata-please go on singing; V□'(tu-gatha/:1-
 narration of the deeds of Vi□□;tu.

TRANSLATION

o brahma!138, just accept me as a completely surrendered soul, and
 let mother Ganges, the representative of the Lord, also accept me in that
 way, for I have already taken the lotus feet of the Lord into my heart. Let
 the snake-bird-or whatever magical thing the brahm□a created-bite me
 at once. I only desire that you all continue singing the deeds of Lord Vi□□;tu.

PURPORT

As soon as one is given up completely unto the lotus feet of the Supreme
 Lord, he is not at all afraid of death. The atmosphere created by the
 presence of great devotees of the Lord on the bank of the Ganges and
 Maharaja Pan"□it's complete acceptance of the Lord's lotus feet were
 sufficient guarantee to the King for going back to Godhead. He thus
 became absolutely free from all fear of death.

TEXT 16

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puna5 ca bhiiyad bhagavatya anante

ratil;l prasangas ca tad-iisrayeṣu

mahatsu yam yam upayami sr□tim

maitry astu sarvatra namo dvijebhya/:1

punal)-again;ca-and;bhiiyat-let it be;bhagavati-unto Lord Sri Kp:IJ.a;

anante-who has unlimited potency; ratil;l-attracting; prasang□-associa

tion; ca-also; tat-His; asraye□u-with those who are His devotees;

mahatsu-within the material creation; yam yam-whichever; upayami-1
 may take; sntim-my birth; maitri-friendly relation; astu-let it be;
 saroatra-everywhere; nam- my obeisances; dvijebhya/:1-unto the
 brahma'(las.

Text 17) Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1005

TRANSLATION

Again, offering obeisances unto all you brahma-as, I pray that if I
 should again take my birth in the material world I will have complete
 attachment to the unlimited Lord a, association with His devotees
 and friendly relations with all living beings.

PURPORT

That a devotee of the Lord is the only perfect living being is explained
 herein by Mahariija Pariksit. A devotee of the Lord is no one's enemy,
 although there may be many enemies of a devotee. A devotee of the Lord
 does not like to associate with non-devotees, although he has no enmity
 with them. He desires association with the devotees of the Lord. This is
 perfectly natural because birds of the same feather mix together. And the
 most important function of a devotee is to have complete attachment for
 Lord Sri Krishna, the father of all living beings. As a good son of the father
 behaves friendly with all his other brothers, so also the devotee of the
 Lord, being a good son of the supreme father, Lord Krishna, sees all other
 living beings in relation with the supreme father. He tries to bring back the
 upstart souls of the father to a saner stage and to get them to accept the
 supreme fatherhood of God. Maharaja Pariksit was certainly going back to
 Godhead, but even if he were not to go back, he prayed for a pattern of
 life which is the most perfect way in the material world. A pure devotee
 does not desire the company of a personality as great as Brahma, but he
 prefers the association of a petty living being, provided he is a devotee of
 the Lord.

TEXT 17

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 ('lflJ\'4□1: ((1Wf;q(ijYU(: II □"II
 iti sma riijidhyavasaya-yuktafi.
 priicina-miile□u kuse□u dhirafi.
 udanmukho dak□i!la-kiila iiste
 samudra-patnyiifi. sva-suta-nyasta-bhiirafi.

1006 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

iti-thus; sma-as in the past; raja-the King; adhyavasaya-perseverance;
 yukta□-being engaged; priicina-eastern; mule□u-with the root; kuse□u
 on a seat made of kusa straw; dhi"ra[l-self-controlled; udanmuk ha[l - facing
 the northern side; dak□irw- on the southern; kula-bank; aste-situated;
 samudra-the sea; patnya□-wife of (the Ganges); sva-own; suta-son ;
 nyasta-given over; bhiira□-the charge of administration.

TRANSLATION

In perfect self-control Maharaja Pan□it sat down on a seat of straw,
 with straw-roots facing the east, placed on the southern bank of the
 Ganges, and he himself faced the north. Just previously he had given
 charge of his kingdom over to his sons.

PURPORT

The River Ganges is celebrated as the wife of the sea. The seat of kusa
 straw is considered to be sanctified if the straw is taken out of the earth
 complete with root, and if the root is pointed towards the east it is
 considered to be auspicious. Facing the north is still more favorable for
 attaining spiritual success. Maharaja Pan"□it handed over the charge of
 administration to his son before leaving home. He was thus fully equipped
 for all favorable conditions.

TEXT 18

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 □ Ql□tt □: II□ □II

evam ca tasmin nara-deva-deve

priiyopaviṣṭe divi deva-sanghii□

prasasya bhumau vyakiran prasunair

muda muhur dundubhaya5ca nedu□

evam-thus; ca-and; tasmin-in that; nara-deva-deve-upon the King's;

praya-upavi□te-being engaged in fasting to death; divi-in the sky; deva

demigods; sangha□-all of them; prasasya-having praised the action;

Text 19) Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1007

bhiimau-on the earth; vyakiran-scattered; prasiin ai□-with flowers; mudii

in pleasure; muhuft-continually; dundubhayafl-celestial drums; ca-also;

nedufl-beaten.

TRANSLATION

Thus the King, Maharaja Paṇḍit, sat to fast until death. All the demigods of the higher planets praised the King's actions and in pleasure continually scattered flowers over the earth and beat celestial drums.

PURPORT

Even up to the time of Maharaja Paṇḍit there were interplanetary communications, and the news of Maharaja Paṇḍit's fasting unto death to attain salvation reached the higher planets in the sky where the intelligent demigods live. The demigods are more luxurious than human beings, but all of them are obedient to the orders of the Supreme Lord. There is no one in the heavenly planets who is an atheist nonbeliever. Thus any devotee of the Lord on the surface of the earth is always praised by them, and in the case of Maharaja Paṇḍit they were greatly delighted and thus gave tokens of honor by scattering flowers over the earth and by beating celestial drums. A demigod takes pleasure in seeing someone go back to Godhead. He is always pleased with a devotee of the Lord, so much so that by his adhidaivic powers he may help the devotees in all respects. And by their actions, the Lord is pleased with them. There is an invisible chain of complete cooperation between the Lord, the demigods and the devotee of the Lord on earth.

TEXT 19

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maharṣayo vai samupīgatī ye

prasasya siidhv ity anumodamiiniḥ

iicūḥ prajīnugraha-slla-sīri

yad uttama-sloka-gur.iibhīrīpam

1008 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

maharṣayaft-the great sages; vai-as a matter of course; samupīgatiift
assembled there; ye-;-those who; prasasya-by praising; .siidhu-quite all
right; iti- thus; anumodamiiniift-all approving; ucūḥ-said; prajīnugraha
doing good to the living being; s'īla-sīriiḥ-qualitatively powerful; yat
because; uttama-sloka-one who is praised by selected poems; gur.a
abhirupam-as beautiful as godly qualities.

TRANSLATION

All the great sages who were assembled there also praised the decision
of Maharaja Paṇḍit and they expressed their approval by saying, "Very
good." Naturally the sages are inclined to do good to common men, for
they have all the qualitative powers of the Supreme Lord. Therefore they
were very much pleased to see Maharaja Pṇḍit, a devotee of the Lord,
and they spoke as follows.

PURPORT

The natural beauty of a living being is enhanced by rising up to the
platform of devotional service. Maharaja Paṇḍit was absorbed in attach-
ment for Lord Kṛṇḍa. Seeing this, the great sages assembled were very
pleased, and they expressed their approval by saying, "Very good." Such
sages are naturally inclined to do good to the common man, and when
they see a personality like Maharaja Paṇḍit advance in devotional service,
their pleasure knows no bound, and they offer all blessings in their power.
Devotional service of the Lord is so auspicious that all demigods and sages,
up to the Lord Himself, become pleased with the devotee, and therefore
the devotee finds everything auspicious. All inauspicious matters are

removed from the path of a progressive devotee. Meeting all the great sages at the time of death was certainly auspicious for Maharaja Parikṣit, and thus he was blessed by the so-called curse of a brahmin's boy.

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TEXT 20

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Text 20) Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami

na vii idam riijar□i-varya citram

bhavatsu kr□f!am samanuvrate□u

ye 'dhyiisanam riija-kirita-ju□tam

sadyo jahur bhagavat-piirsva-kiimiib,

1009

na-neither; vii-like this; idam-this; riijarṣi-saintly king; varya-the chief; citram-astonishing; bhavatsu-unto you all; kf\$1Jam-Lord Kp□Qa; samanuvrate\$u-unto those who are strictly in the line of; ye-who; adhyiisanam-seated on the throne; raja-kinta-helmets of kings; ju\$tam decorated; sadyab,-immediately;jahub,-gave up; bhagavat-the Personality of Godhead;piirsva-kiimiib,-desiring to achieve association.

TRANSLATION

[The sages said:] o chief of all the saintly kings of the P□□u dynasty who are strictly in the line of Lord Sri Kr□a! It is not at all astonishing that you give up your throne, which is decorated with the helmets of many kings, to achieve eternal association with the Personality of Godhead.

PURPORT

Foolish politicians who hold political administrative posts think that the temporary posts they occupy are the highest material gain of life, and

therefore they stick to that post even up to the last moment of life without knowing that achievement of liberation as one of the associates of the Lord in His eternal abode is the highest gain of life. The human life is meant for achieving this end. The Lord has assured us in the Bhagavad-gitii many times that going back to Godhead, His eternal abode, is the highest achievement. PrahHida Maharaja, while praying to Lord Nrsimha, said, "O my Lord, I am very much afraid of the materialistic way of life, and I am not the least afraid of Your present ghastly ferocious feature as Nrsirhhadeva. This materialistic way of life is something like a grinding stone, and we are being crushed by it. We have fallen into this horrible whirlpool of the tossing waves of life, and thus, my Lord, I pray at Your lotus feet to call me back to Your eternal abode as one of Your servitors. This is the summit liberation of this materialistic way of life. I have very bitter experience of the materialistic way of life. In whichever species of life I have taken birth, compelled by the force of my own activities, I have very painfully experienced two things, namely separation from my beloved and meeting with 1010 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 19

what is not wanted. And to counteract them, the remedies which I undertook were more dangerous than the disease itself. So I drift from one point to another birth after birth, and I pray to You therefore to give me a shelter at Your lotus feet." -

The Pap.ava kings, who are more than many saints of the world, know the bitter results of the materialistic way of life. They are never captivated by the glare of the imperial throne they occupy, and they seek always the opportunity of being called by the Lord to associate with Him eternally.

Maharaja Pariksit was the worthy grandson of Maharaja Yudhishira.

Maharaja Yudhishira gave up the imperial throne to his grandson, and similarly Maharaja Pandit, the grandson of Maharaja Yudhishira, gave up the imperial throne to his son Janamejaya. That is the way of all the kings in the dynasty because they are all strictly in the line of Lord Krishna. Thus the devotees of the Lord are never enchanted by the glare of materialistic life, and they live impartially, unattached to the objects of the false illusory

materialistic way of life.

TEXT 21

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saroe vayam tiivad ihiismahe 'tha

kalevaram yiivad asau vihiya

lokam param viraja.skam viSokam

yiisyaty ayam bhiigavata-pradhiinafl

sarve-all; vayam-of us; tiivat-as long as; iha-at this place; asmahe

shall stay; atka-hereafter; kalevaram-the body; yiivat-so long; asau-the

King; vihiya-giving up; lokam-the planet; param-the supreme;

virajaskam-completely free from mundane contamination; visokam

completely freed from all kinds of lamentation; yasyati-returns; ayam

this; bhiigavata-devotee; pradhiinafl-the foremost.

TRANSLATION

We shall all wait here until the foremost devotee of the Lord,

Maharaja Pan□t, returns to the supreme planet, which is completely free

from all mundane contamination and all kinds of lamentation.

Text 22] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvimi lOll

PURPORT

Beyond the limitation of the material creation, which is compared to

the cloud in the sky, there is the Paravyoma, or the spiritual sky, full of

planets called Vaiku!lthas. Such V aiku!ltha planets are also differently

known as the Puru□ottamaloka, Acyutaloka, Trivikramaloka, Hr□kesa

loka, Kesavaloka, Aniruddhaloka, Madhavaloka, Pradyumnaloka,

Sankar□aJ;□aloka, Sr!dharaloka, V asudevaloka, Ayodhyaloka, Dvaraka

loka, and many other millions of spiritual lokas wherein the Personality

of Godhead predominates; and all the living entities there are liberated

souls with spiritual bodies as good as that of the Lord. There is no material

contamination; everything there is spiritual, and therefore there is nothing

objectively lamentable. They are full of transcendental bliss, and are

without birth, death, old age and disease. And amongst all the above mentioned Vaikuṇṭhalokas, there is one supreme loka called Goloka Vrndavana, which is the abode of the Lord Sri Kṛṣṇa and His specific associates. Maharaja Parikṣit was destined to achieve this particular loka, and the great ṛṣis assembled there could foresee this. All of them consulted amongst themselves about the great departure of the great King, and they wanted to see him up to the last moment because they would no more be able to see such a great devotee of the Lord. When a great devotee of the Lord passes away, there is nothing to be lamented because the devotee is destined to enter into the kingdom of God. But the sorry plight is that such great devotees leave our sight, and therefore there is every reason to be sorry. As the Lord is rarely to be seen by our present eyes, so also are the great devotees. The great ṛṣis, therefore, correctly decided to remain on the spot till the last moment.

TEXT 22

ṛṣiḥ 6tA•toatṛṣiḥ:q: tR\ fṛṣiḥ(l_

ṛṣiḥ ṛṣiḥ ṛṣiḥ "qlotlṛṣiḥliti(I

3[Tqjqa;nW1fliW1;:q ṛṣiḥ

ṛṣiḥR6tM fṛṣiḥ: ṛṣiḥṛṣiḥṛṣiḥṛṣiḥ

ii.Srutya tad rṛṣi-gar.a-vacafl. parikṛṣit

samam madhu-cyud guru cii.vyalikam

ii.bh(4atainii.n abhinandya yuktii.n

susriiṛṣamiir.a.S ca'ritiini vṛṣr-ofl.

1012 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 19

asrutya-just after hearing; tat-that; !ṣi-ga(la-the sages assembled;

vacafz-speaking; parikṣit-Maharaja Parikṣit; samam-impartial; madhu

cyut-sweet to hear; guru-grave; ca-also; avyalikam-perfectly true;

abhiiṣata-said; enan-all of them; abhinandya-congratulated; yuktiin

appropriately presented; susriiṣamii!lafz-being desirous; caritiini-activities

of; viṣ!lO!z-the Personality of Godhead.

TRANSLATION

All that was spoken by the great sages wru> very sweet to hear, full of

meaning and appropriately presented as perfectly true. So after hearing them, Maharaja Parikṣit, desiring to hear of the activities of Lord Śrī Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, congratulated the great sages.

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TEXT 23

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samagata!z sarvata eva sarve

veda yatha murti-dharas tri-prṣṭhe

nehatha namutra ca kascanartha

rte paranugraham atma-sllam

samiigata!z-assembled; sarvata!z-from all directions; eva-certainly;

sarve-all of you; vediifz-supreme knowledge; yatha-as; miirti-dharii/l

personified; tri-p!ṣṭhe-on the ·planet of Brahma (which is situated above

the three planetary systems, namely the upper, intermediate and lower

worlds); na-not; iha-in this world; atka-thereafter; na-nor; amutra-in

the other world; ca-also; kascana-any other; artha/l-interest; rte-save

and except; para-others; anugraham-doing good to; atma-sllam-own

nature.

TRANSLATION

The King said: o great sages, you have all very kindly assembled

here, having come from all parts of the universe. You are all as good as

supreme knowledge personified, who resides in the planet above the three

Text 24] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosviimi 1013

worlds [Satyaloka]. Consequently you are naturally inclined to do good to

others, and but for this you have no interest, either in this life or the next.

PURPORT

Six kinds of opulences, namely wealth, strength, fame, beauty, know

ledge and renunciation, are all originally the different attributes pertaining to the Absolute Personality of Godhead_ The living beings, who are part and parcel entities of the Supreme Being, have all these attributes partially, up to the full strength of seventy-eight percent. In the material world these attributes (up to seventy-eight percent of the Lord's attributes) are covered by the material energy, as the sun is covered by a cloud. The covered strength of the sun is very dim, compared to the original glare, and similarly living beings with such attributes become almost extinct from their original color_ There are three planetary systems, namely the lower worlds, the intermediate worlds and the upper worlds_ The human beings on earth are situated at the beginning of the intermediate worlds, but living beings like Brahma and his contemporaries live in the upper worlds, of which the topmost is Satyaloka. In Satyaloka the inhabitants are fully cognizant of Vedic wisdom, and thus the mystic cloud of material energy is cleared, and therefore they are known as the Vedas personified. Such persons, being fully a ware of knowledge both mundane and transcendental, have no interest in either the mundane or transcendental worlds. They are practically desireless devotees. In the mundane world they have nothing to achieve, and in the transcendental world they are full in themselves_ Then why do they come to the mundane world? They descend on different planets as messiahs by the order of the Lord to deliver the fallen souls. On the earth they come down and do good to the people of the world in different circumstances under different climatic influences. They have nothing to do in this world save and except reclaim the fallen souls rotting in material existence, deluded by material energy.

TEXT 24

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1014 Srimad-Bhagavatam

tatas ca val} prccham imam viprcche

viSrabhya viprii iti krtyatiiyim
sarviitmanii mriyamiirwis ca krtyam
suddham ca tatriimrsatiibhiyuktiil;l

[Canto 1, Ch. 19

tatal}-as such; ca-and; val;l-unto you; prcchya-that which is to be
asked; imam-this; viprcche-beg to ask you; viSrabhya-trustworthy;
vipriil;l-briihmarws; iti-thus; krtyatiiyim-out of all different duties;
sarva-iitmanii-by every one; mriyamii!'lail;l-especially those who are just
about to die; ca-and; krtyam-dutiful; suddham-perfectly correct; ca
and; tatra-therein; iimrsata-by complete deliberation; abhiyuktiil;l-just
befitting.

TRANSLATION

O trustworthy briihmaJas, I now ask you about my immediate duty.
Please, after proper deliberation, tell me of the unalloyed duty of everyone
in ail circumstances, and specifically of those who are just about to die.

PURPORT

In this verse the King has placed two questions before the learned
sages. The first question is what is the duty of everyone in all circum-
stances, and the second question is what is the specific duty of one who is
to die very shortly. Out of the two, the question relating to the dying man
is most important because everyone is a dying man, either very shortly or
after one hundred years. The dura tion of life is immaterial, but the duty
of a dying man is very important. Maharaja PanK.□it placed these two
questions before Sukadeva Gosvami also on his arrival, and practically the
whole of the Srimad-Bhiigavatam, beginning from the Second Canto up to
the last Twelfth Canto, deals with these two questions. The c onclusion
arrived at thereof is that devotional service of the Lord Sri Kr□p.a, as i t is
confirmed by the Lord Himself in the last phases of the Bhagavad-gitii, is
the last word in relation to everyone's permanent duty in life. Maharaja
Parik□it was already aware of this fact, but he wanted the great sages
assembled there to unanimously give their verdict on his conviction so
that he might be able to go on with his confirmed duty •without contro

versy. He has especially mentioned the word suddha, or perfectly correct. For transcendental realization or self-realization, many processes are recommended by various classes of philosophers. Some of them are first-class methods, and some of them are second- or third-class methods. The first-
 Text 25) Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1015
 class method demands that one give up all other methods and surrender unto the lotus feet of the Lord and thus be saved from all sins and their reactions.

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TEXT 25

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tatriibhavad bhagaviin vyīsa-putro

yadr̥cchayī giim atamiino 'napek□a□

alak□ya-lingo nija-liibha-tu□to

vr̥tas ca biilair avadhiita-ve□aft

tatra-there; abhavat-appeared; bhagaviin-powerful; vyīsa-putra□-son

of Vyasadeva;yadr̥-is as; icchayī-one desires;giim-the earth; atamiina□

while traveling; anapek□a□-disinterested; alak□ya-unmanifested; linga□

symptoms; nija-liibha-self-realized; tu□tafi--satisfied; vr̥ta□-surrounded

by; ca-and; biila*-by children; avadhiita-neglected by others; ve□a□

dressed.

TRANSLATION

At that moment there appeared the powerful son of Vyasadeva who traveled over the earth disinterested and satisfied with himself. He did not manifest any symptoms of belonging to any social order or status of life. He was surrounded with women and children, and he dressed as if others

had neglected him.

PURPORT

The word Bhagaviin is sometimes used in relation with some of the great devotees of the Lord, like Sukadeva Gosviimi. Such liberated souls are disinterested in the affairs of this material world because they are self satisfied by the great achievements of devotional service. As explained before, Sukadeva Gosvam'i never accepted any formal spiritual master, nor did he undergo any formal reformatory performances. His father, Vyasadeva, was his natural spiritual master because he heard Srimad Bhiigavatam from him. After this, he became completely self-satisfied.

1016 Srlmad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

Thus he was not dependent on any formal process. The formal processes are necessary for those who are expected to reach the stage of complete liberation, but Sri Sukadeva Gosvam.i was already in that status by the grace of his father. As a young boy he was expected to be properly dressed, but he went about naked and was disinterested in social customs. He was neglected by the general populace, and inquisitive boys and women surrounded him as if he were a madman. He thus appears on the scene while traveling on the earth on his own accord. It appears that to the inquiry of Maharaja Pan□it, the great sages were not unanimous in their decision as to what was to be done. For spiritual salvation there were many prescriptions according to the different modes of different persons. But the ultimate aim of life is to attain the highest pedectional stage of devotional service of the Lord. As doctors differ, so also sages differ in their different prescriptions. While such things were going on, the great powerful son of Vyasadeva appeared on the scene.

TEXT 26

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tam d vyfYta-var□am su-kumiira-piida

karoru-biihv-arhsa-kapoln-giitram

ciirv-iiyatiik□onnasa-tulya-karrw
subhrv-iinanam kambu-sujiita-ka!ltham
tam-him; duyfŷta-sixteen; var□am-years; su-kumiira-delicate; piida
legs; kara-hands; urn-thighs; biihu-arms; arhsa-shoulders ; kapola-fore
head; giitram-body ; ciiru-beautiful; iiyata-broad; ak□a-eyes; unnasa
high nose; tulya-similar; kaT'la-ears; subhru-nice brows; iinanam-face;
kambu-conchshell; sujiita-nicely built; ka!ltham-neck.

TRANSLATION

This son of Vyasadeva was only sixteen years old. His legs, hands,
thighs, arms, shoulders, forehead and the other parts of his body were all
Text 27] Appearance of □ukadeva Gosvami 1017
delicately formed. His eyes were beautifully wide, and his nose and ears
were highly raised. He had a very attractive face, and his neck was well
formed and beautiful like a conchshell.

PURPORT

A respectable personality is described beginning with the legs, and this
honored system is observed here with Sukadeva Gosvami. He was only
sixteen years of age. A person is honored for his achievements and not for
advanced age. A person can be older by experience and not by age. Sri
Sukadeva Gosvami, who is described herein as the son of Vyasadeva, was
by his knowledge more experienced than all the sages present there, al
though he was only sixteen years old.

TEXT 27

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SR□ŷ'ililI□ ((4ŷt(htŷt1+11(II □\911
nigii{la-jatrum prthu-tunga-vakṣasam
iivarta-niibhim vali-valgiidarani ca
dig-ambaram vaktra-vikir'la-kesam
pralamba-biihum svamarottamiibham
nigii{iha-covered; jatrum-collarb one; prthu-broad; tunga-swollen;

vakṣasam-chest; iivarta-whirled; niibhim-navel; vali-valgu-striped;
udaram-abd omen; ca-also; dik-ambaram-dressed by all directions (naked);
vaktra-curved; vikir'ḥ-la-scattered; kesam-hair; pralamba-elongated;
biihum-hands; su-amara-uttama-the best amongst the gods (Krīṣṇa) ;
iibham-hue.

TRANSLATION

His collarbone was fleshy, his chest broad and thick, his navel deep and
his abdomen beautifully striped. His arms were long, and curly hair was
strewn over his beautiful face. He was naked, and the hue of his body
reflected that of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

1018 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto I, Ch. 19

PURPORT

His bodily features indicate him to be different from common men. All
the signs described in connection with the bodily features of Sukadeva
Gosvāmī are uncommon symptoms, typical of great personalities, according
to physiognomical calculations. His bodily hue resembled that of Lord
Kṛṣṇa, who is the Supreme amongst the gods, demigods, and all living
beings.

TEXT 28

syiimam sadiipivya-vayo 'nga-lakṣmyii
strīuim mano-jnam rucira-smitena
pratyutthitiis te munayafi. sviisanebhyas
tal-lakṣa!la-jna api gii!lha-varcasam
syiimam-blackish; sadii-always; apivya-excessively; vayafi, -age ; anga
symptoms; lakṣmyii-by the opulence of; strīiim-of the fair sex; mana
jiim- attractive; rucira-beautiful; smitena-smiling ; pratyutth itiiifi.-stood
up; te- all of them ; munayafi.-the great sages ; sva- own; iisanebhyas,- from
the seats; tat-those; lakṣarta-jiiifi.-expert in the art of physiognomy;
api-even; gii!lha-varcasam-covered glories.

TRANSLATION

He was dark and very beautiful due to his youth. Because of the
glamor of his body and his attractive smiles, he was pleasing to women.

Though he tried to cover his natural glories, the great sages present there were all expert in the art of physiognomy, and so they honored him by rising from their seats.

TEXT 29

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Text-30] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvimi

m□□:□□

□ □qf?t□ tmr: □□□□□□

sa V□flU-riito •tithaya iigatiiya

tasmai saparyiim sirasijahiira

tato nivrttii hy abudhii□ striyo ·rbhakii

mahiisane sopavivesa piijita□

1019

sa□-he;vi,s!'u-riitaf!.-Maharaja Parik□it (who is always protected by Lord Vi□J;m); atithaye-to become a guest; iigatiiya-one who arrived there; tasmai-unto him; saparyiim-with the whole body; sirasii-with bowed head; iijahiira-offered obeisances; tata□-thereafter; nivrttiib--- ceased; hi certainly;abudhii□-less intelligent; striyatL-women ;arbhakiib--boys;□ahii asan e- exalted seat; sa-he; upavivesa-sat down; piijita[l.-being respected.

TRANSLATION

Maharaja Parilq;it, who is also known as Vi□□urata [one who is always protected by Vi□□u], bowed his head to receive the chief guest, Sukadeva Gosvami. At that time all the ignorant women and boys ceased following Srila Sukadeva. Receiving respect from all, Sukadeva Gosvami took his exalted seat.

PURPORT

On Sukadeva Gosvami's arrival at the meeting, everyone, except Srila Vyasadeva, Nirada and a few others, stood up, and Maharaja Parilqit, who was glad to receive a great devotee of the Lord, bowed down before him with all the limbs of his body. Sukadeva Gosviimi also exchanged the greetings and reception by embrace, shaking of hand<;, nodding and bowing

down, especially before his father and Narada Muni. Thus he was offered the presidential seat at the meeting. When he was so received by the king and sages, the street boys and le□s intelligent women who followed him were struck with wonder and fear. So they retired from their frivolous activities, and everything was full of gravity and calm.

TEXT 30

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1020 Srimad-Bhigavatam

sa sariwrtas tatra mahiin mah"iyasam

brahmarṣi-riijarṣi-devarṣi-sanghaifr.

vyarocatiilam bhagaviin yathendur

grahark□a-tarii-nikaraifr. par"itafr.

[Canto 1, Ch. 19

safr.-Sri Sukadeva Gosvami; samvrtafr.-surrounded by; tatra-there;

mahan-great; mah"iyasiim-of the greatest; brahmar□i-saint among the

briihmartas; riijarfii-saint among the kings; devarṣi-saint among the demi

gods; sanghaifr.□by the assembly of; vyarocata-well deserved; alam-able;

bhagaviin-powerful; yathii-as; indufr.-the moon; graha-planets; rkṣa

heavenly bodies; tiirii-stars; nikaraifr.- by the assembly of; pantafr.

surrounded by.

TRANSLATION

Sukadeva Gosvami was then surrou nded by saintly sages and demigods

just as the moon is surrou nded by stars, planets and other heavenly bodies.

His presence was gor geous, and he was respected by all.

PURPORT

In the great assembly of saintly personalities, there was Vyasadeva the brahmar□i, Narada the devarfii, Parasurama the great ruler of the k.satriya kings, etc. Some of them were powerful incarnations of the Lord. Sukadeva Gosvami was not known as brahmar_si, riijarṣi or devarṣ□ nor was he an incarnation like Narada, Vyasa or Para8urama, etc. And yet he excelled them in respects paid. This means that the devotee of the Lord is more

honored in the world than the Lord Himself. One should, therefore, never minimize the importance of a devotee like Sukadeva Gosvami.

TEXT 31

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Text 31] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami

pra5iintam iisinam aku!ltha-medhasam

munim nrpo bhiigavato ,bhyupetya

pra"{lamya miirdhniivahital) krtiinjalir

natvii girii siinrtayiinvaprcchat

1021

pra5iintam-perfectly pacified; iisinam-sitting; aku"{lfha-without hesitation; medhasam-one who has sufficient intelligence; munim-onto the great sage; nrpal)-the. King (Maharaja Parik□it); bhiigavatal)-the great devotee; abhyupetya-approaching him; pra"{lamya- bowing down; miirdhnii-his head; avahital)-properly; krta-anjalil)-with folded hands; natvii-politely, by words; girii siinrtaya-in sweet voices; anvaprcchat-inquired.

TRANSLATION

The sage Sri Sukadeva Gosvami sat perfectly pacified, intelligent and ready to answer any question without hesitation. The great devotee, Maharaja Pa□t, approached him, offered his respects by bowing before him, and politely inquired with sweet words and folded hands.

PURPORT

The gesture now adopted by Maharaja Parik□it of questioning a master is quite befitting in terms of scriptural injunctions. The scriptural injunction is that one should humbly approach a spiritual master to understand the transcendental science. Maharaja P□it was now prepared for meeting his death, and within the very short time of seven days he was to know the process of entering the kingdom of God. In such important cases, one is

required to approach a spiritual master. There is no necessity of approaching a spiritual master unless one is in need of solving the problems of life. One who does not know how to put questions before the spiritual master has no business to see him. And the qualification of the spiritual master is perfectly manifested in the person of Sukadeva Gosvami. Both the spiritual master and the disciple, namely Sri Sukadeva Gosvami and Maharaja Parikṣit, attained perfection through the medium of Srimad-Bhāgavatam. Sukadeva Gosvami learned Srimad-Bhāgavatam from his father Vyasadeva, but he had no chance to recite it. Before Maharaja Parikṣit he recited Srimad-Bhāgavatam and answered the questions of Maharaja Parikṣit unhesitatingly, and thus both the master and the disciple got salvation.

1022 Srimad-Bhagavatam

TEXT 32

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[Canto I, Ch. 19

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panlc□id uviica

aho adya vayam brahman

sat-sevyiif!. k□atra-bandhavaf!.

krpayiitithi-riiperta

bhavadbhis tirthakiif!. krtiif!.

parikṣit uvaca-the fortunate Maharaja Parikṣit said; aho-ah; adya today; vayam-we; brahman-o brahmin; sat-sevyiif!-eligible to serve the devotee; k□atra-the ruling class; bandhava□-friends; krpayii-by your mercy; atithi-rii.perta-in the manner of the great; bhavadbhis!-by your good self; tirthakii□-qualified for being places of pilgrimage; krtiif!-done by you.

TRANSLATION

The fortunate King Paṇḍit said: o brahmin! la, by your mercy only you have sanctified us, making us like unto places of pilgrimage, all by your presence here as my guest. By your mercy, we, who are but unworthy

royalty, become eligible to serve the devotee.

PURPORT

Saintly devotees like Sukadeva Gosvami generally do not approach worldly enjoyers, especially those in royal orders. Maharaja Prataparudra was a follower of Lord Caitanya, but when he wanted to see the Lord, the Lord refused to see him because he was a king. For a devotee who desires to go back to Godhead, two things are strictly prohibited: worldly enjoyers and women. Therefore, devotees of the standard of Sukadeva Gosvami are never interested in seeing kings. Maharaja Parikṣit was, of course, a different case. He was a great devotee, although a king, and therefore Sukadeva Gosvami came to see him in his last stage of life. Maharaja Parikṣit, out of his devotional humility, felt himself an unworthy descendant of his great kṣatriya forefathers, although he was as great as his predecessors. The unworthy sons of the royal orders are "Called kṣatra-bandhavas, as the unworthy sons of the brāhminas are called dvija-bandhus or brahma-Text33] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1023

bandhus. Maharaja Parikṣit was greatly encouraged by the presence of Sukadeva Gosvami. He felt himself sanctified by the presence of the great saint whose presence turns any place into a place of pilgrimage.

TEXT33

yeṣāṁ sarhsmaraṇaṁ purhṣiṁ

sadyaḥ śuddhyanti vai gṛhīṇaḥ

kim punar darsana-sparsa

pada-sauciṣaṇḍibhiḥ

yeṣāṁ-of whom; sarhsmaraṇaṁ-by remembrance; purhṣiṁ-of a person;

sadyaḥ-instantly; śuddhyanti-cleanses; vai-certainly; gṛhīṇaḥ-all

houses; kim-what; punaḥ-then; dad ana- meeting; spada- touching; piida

-the feet; sauca- washing; iṣaṇḍibhiḥ-by offering a seat, etc.

TRANSLATION

Simply by remembering you our houses become instantly sanctified.

And what to speak of seeing you, touching you, washing your holy feet

and offering you a seat in our home?

PURPORT

The importance of holy places of pilgrimage is due to the presence of great sages and saints. It is said that sinful persons go to the holy places and leave their sins there to accumulate. But the presence of the great saints disinfects the accumulated sins, and thus the holy places continue to remain sanctified by the grace of the devotees and saints present there. If such saints appear in the homes of worldly people, certainly the accumulated sins of such worldly enjoyers become neutralized. Therefore, the holy saints actually have no self-interest with the householders. The only aim of such saints is to sanctify the houses of the householders, and the householders therefore should feel grateful when such saints and sages appear at their doors. A householder who dishonors such holy orders is a great offender. It is enjoined, therefore, that a householder who does not bow down before a saint at once must undergo fasting for the day in order to neutralize the great offense.

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TEXT 34

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siinnidhyiit te mahii-yogin

piitakiini mahiinty api

sadyo nasyanti vai pumsiim

viṣṭrwr iva suretarii[]

siinnidhyiit-on account of the presence; te-your; mahii-yogin-o great mystic; piitakiini-sins; mahiinti-invulnerable; api□in spite of; sadya[] immediately; nasyanti-vanquished; vai-certainly; pumsiim-of a person; viṣṭ!Jo□-like the presence of the Personality of Godhead; iva-like; sura itarii□-other than the demigods.

TRANSLATION

Just as the atheist cannot remain in the presence of the Personality of Godhead, so also the invulnerable sins of a man are immediately vanquished in your presence, o saint! o great mystic!

PURPORT

There are two classes of human beings, namely the atheist and the devotee of the Lord. The devotee of the Lord, because of manifesting godly qualities, is called a demigod, whereas the atheist is called a demon. The demon cannot stand the presence of Viṣṇu the Personality of Godhead. The demons are always busy in trying to vanquish the Personality of Godhead, but factually as soon as the Personality of Godhead appears, either by His transcendental name, form, attributes, pastimes, paraphernalia or variegatedness, the demon is at once vanquished. It is said that a ghost cannot remain as soon as the holy name of the Lord is chanted. The great saints and devotees of the Lord are in the list of His paraphernalia, and thus as soon as a saintly devotee is present, the ghostly sins are at once vanquished. That is the verdict of all Vedic literatures. One is recommended, therefore, to associate only with saintly devotees so that worldly demons and ghosts cannot exert their sinister influence.

Text 35] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami

TEXT 35

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api me bhagaviin pntafl,

krrQafl, piiru;lu-suta-priyafl,

paitr-ṣvaseya-pnty-artharh

tad-gotrasyiitta-biindhavafl,

1025

api-definitely; me-unto me; bhagaviin-the Personality of Godhead;

pnta□-pleased; kmw□-the Lord; piirtpu-suta-the sons of King Pat:tl;lu;

priyafl,-dear; paitr-in relation with the father; svaseya-the sons of the

sister;priti-satisfaction; artham-in the matter of; tat-their;gotrasya-of the descendent; iitta-accepted; biindhava□-as friend.

TRANSLATION

Lord Kṛṣṇa, the Personality of Godhead, who is very dear to the sons of King Paṇḍu, has accepted me as one of those relatives just to please His

great cousins and brothers.

PURPORT

A pure and exclusive devotee of the Lord serves his family interest more dexterously than others who are attached to illusory family affairs.

Generally people are attached to family matters, and the whole economic impetus of human society is moving under the influence of family affection. Such deluded persons have no information that one can render better service to the family by becoming a devotee of the Lord. The Lord gives special protection to the family members and descendants of a devotee, even though such members are themselves nondevotees! Maharaja Prahlada was a great devotee of the Lord, but his father Hiranyakasipu was a great atheist and declared enemy of the Lord. But despite all this, Hiranyakasipu was awarded salvation due to his being the father of Maharaja Prahlada.

The Lord is so kind that he gives all protection to the family members of His devotee, and thus the devotee has no need to bother about his family members, even if such family members are left aside to discharge devotional service. Maharaja Yudhishthira and his brothers were the sons of Kunti, the paternal aunt of Lord Kṛṣṇa, and Maharaja Parīkṣit admits the patronage of Lord Kṛṣṇa because of his being the only grandson of the great Paṇḍavas.

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TEXT 36

anyathā te 'vyakta-gate

darsanam na katham nr̥tiṃ

nitarīṃ mriyāmiṛtīṇi

samsiddhasya vaniyasā

anyathā-te otherwise; te-your; avyakta-gate

[l.-of one whose movements

are invisible; darsanam-meeting; na-for us; katham-how; nr̥tiṃ-of the

people; nitarīṃ-specifically; mriyāmiṛtīṇi-of those who are about to

die; samsiddhasya-of one who is all-perfect; vaniyasā-voluntary appear

ance.

TRANSLATION

Otherwise [without being inspired by Lord Kṛṣṇa] how is it that you have voluntarily appeared here, though you are moving incognito to the common man and are not visible to us who are on the verge of death.

PURPORT

The great sage Sukadeva Gosvami was certainly inspired by Lord Kṛṣṇa to appear voluntarily before Maharaja Parikṣit, the great devotee of the Lord, just to give him the teachings of Srimad-Bhīgavatam. One can achieve the nucleus of devotional service of the Lord by the mercy of the spiritual master and the Personality of Godhead. The spiritual master is the manifested representative of the Lord to help one achieve ultimate success. One who is not authorized by the Lord cannot become a spiritual master. Śrīla Sukadeva Gosvami is an authorized spiritual master, and thus he was inspired by the Lord to appear before Maharaja Parikṣit and instruct him in the teachings of Srimad-Bhīgavatam. One can achieve the ultimate success of going back to Godhead if he is favored by the Lord's sending His true representative. As soon as a true representative of the Lord is met by a devotee of the Lord, the devotee is assured a guarantee for going back to Godhead just after leaving the present body. This, however, depends on the sincerity of the devotee himself. The Lord is seated in the heart of all living beings, and thus he knows very well the movements of all individual persons. As soon as the Lord finds that a

Text 37] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvami 1027

particular soul is very eager to go back to Godhead, the Lord at once sends His bona fide representative. The sincere devotee is thus assured by the Lord of going back to Godhead. The conclusion is that to get the assistance and help of a bona fide spiritual master means to receive the direct help of the Lord Himself.

TEXT 37

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ata□ prcchiimi samsiddhim

. - . .

yogmam paramam gurum

puru□asyeha yat kiiryam

mriyamiirwsya sarvathii

ata□ -therefore; prcchiimi-beg to inquire; samsiddhim-the way of perfection; yogin iim-of the saints; paramam-the Supreme; guru m-the spiritual master; puru□asya-of a person; iha-in this life; yat-whatever; kiiryam-duty; mriyamiirwsya-of one who is going to die; sarvathii-in every way.

TRANSLATION

You are the spiritual master of great saints and devotees. I am there fore begging you to show the way of perfection for all persons, and especially for one who is about to die.

PURPORT

Unless one is perfectly anxious to inquire about the way of perfection, there is no necessity of approaching a spiritual master. A spiritual master is not a kind of decor? ..ion for a householder. Generally a fashionable materialist engages a so-called spiritual master without any profit. The psuedo-spiritual master flatters the so-called disciple, and thereby both the master and his ward go to hell without a doubt. Maharaja Parik□it is the right type of disciple because he puts forward questions vital to the interest of all men, particularly for the dying men. The question put forward by Maharaja Parik□it is the basic principle of the complete thesis of Srimad-Bhiigavatam. Now let us see how intelligently the great master replies.

1028 Srimad-Bhagavatam [Canto 1, Ch. 19

TEXT38

□'Qil<□□'lti1 □ □□ □: sm 1

□ 1NI4l4 □ il,_ft: □ Aq□t(□□□□□□

yac chrotavyam atho japyam

yat kartavyam nrbhi□ prabho

smartavyam bhajaniyam vii

brihi yadvii viparyayam

yat-whatever; srotavyam-worth hearing; atho-thereof; japyam

chanted; yat-what also; kartavyam-executed; nrbhi- by the people in

general; prabho-o master; smartavyam-that which is remembered;

bhajanijam-worshipable; vii-either;brihi-please explain;yadvii-what it

may be; viparyayam-against the principle.

TRANSLATION

Please let me know what a man should hear, chant, remember and worship, and also what he should not do. Please explain all this to me.

TEXT39

;@ iWo{ m ...4(1

;f Uct(IIIwt'lffl •n(lc;f IIQ..II

nunam bhagavato brahman

grheu grha-medhiniim

na lakṣyate hy avasthiinam

api go-dohanam kvacit

nunan-because; bhagavata-of you, who are powerful; brahman-o

briihmarza; grheu-in the houses; grha-medhiniim-of the householders;

na-not; lakṣyate-are seen; hi-exactly; avasthiinan-staying in; api-even;

go-dohanam-milking the cow;kvacit-rarely.

TRANSLATION

O powerful brahma-!J.a, it is said that you hardly stay in the houses of men long enough to milk a cow.

PURPORT

Saints and sages in the renounced order of life go to the houses of the householders at the time they milk the cows, early in the morning, and

Text40] Appearance of Sukadeva Gosvimi 1029

ask some quantity of milk for subsistence. A pound of milk fresh from the milk bag of a cow is sufficient to feed an adult with all vitamin values, and therefore saints and sages live only on milk. Even the poorest of the householders keep at least ten cows, each delivering twelve to twenty quarts of

milk, and therefore no one hesitates to spare a few pounds of milk for the mendicants. It is the duty of householders to maintain the saints and sages, like the children. So a saint like Sukadeva Gosvami would hardly stay at the house of a householder for more than five minutes in the morning. In other words, such saints are very rarely seen in the houses of householders, and Maharaja Parikṣit therefore prayed to him to instruct him as soon as possible. The householders also should be intelligent enough to get some transcendental information from visiting sages. The householder should not foolishly ask a saint to deliver what is available in the market. That should be the reciprocal relation between the saints and the householders.

TEXT40

□□

i(iilitlY11□6: 'l!: □ {lqT 'tW'I.:&l flm I

Slf441116 □ □ 'li((lq□: 11\loll

suta uviica

evam iibhii□ita□ Pfṣta□

sa riijiiii slakrrwyii girii

pratyabh□ata dharma-jii

bhagaviin biidariiyap,i□

suta□ uviica-Sri Suta Gosvami said; evam-thus;iibhii□ita□-being spoken;

pnt□-and asked for; s□-he; riijiiii-by the King; slak□flayii-by sweet;

giro-language; pratyabh□ata-began to reply; dharma-jii□-one who

knows the principles of religion; bhagaviin-the powerful personality;

biidariiya"!li□-son of Vyasadeva.

TRANSLATION

Sri Siita Gosvimi said: The King thus spoke and questioned the sage, using sweet language. Then the great and powerful personality, the son of Vyasadeva, who knew the principles of religion, began his reply.

Thus e n d the Bhaktivedanta purports of the First Canto, Nineteenth Chapter of Srimad-Bhagavatam, ..Appearance of Sri Sukadeva Gosviimi."

END OF THE FIRST CANTO

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The purports of Srimad-Bhagavatam are all confirmed by standard Vedic authorities. The following authentic scriptural sources are specifically cited in the First Canto.

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Brhan-Niirad'iya Purii{la

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Caitanya-caritiimrta

Chiindogya Upani{ad

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Hari-bhakti-viliisa

HarivarhSa.

Isopan{ad

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Riimiiya{la

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Sr'imad-Bhiigavatam (Bhiigavata Purii{la)

1033

1034

Vtimana Pum!Jll

Vtiyaviya 1'antra

Vediinta-siitra

Vedas

V□{lu-dharmottara

V□!_IU fura.!Jll

Srimad-Bhigavatam

ViSva-PrabiiSa (Sanskrit Dictionary)

Glossary

A

Acarya-an authorized teacher of a particular ctdt.

Adbhuta-the rasa of wonder.

Adi-ra□a-original pure sex psychology.

Ahankara- the meeting point of matter and spirit.

Ajita-Kr□Q.a, .the unconquerable.

Akiiicanas-those who have no material assets.

Anarthas-unwanted habits.

Anna-prasana-ceremony or samskara of offering solid food to a teething child at the age of six to seven months.

Apad-dharma-duty in emergencies.

Apara-material inferiority.

Apauru,eya-not made by man (transcendental).

Apavarga-the perfect stage of liberation.

Apsaras-the society girls of heaven.

Area-a form of the Lord manifested through a material agency such as mind, metal, earth, paint, wood, stone, jewel or drawing. It is accepted as an incarnation of Godhead and worshiped according to regulations.

Archan-the procedures followed in connection with worshiping the area.

Artha-economic development.

Asrama-orders of life in connection with self-realization.

A!fa-siddhi-the eightfold mystic perfections.

Asura-one who is against the service of the Lord.

Asuto□a-Siva, who is easily pleased.

Asvamedha-yajiias-horse sacrifices.

Atma-maya-K{□I}'a's internal potency.

Atmiirama-self-satisfied in spiritual values.

Atma-tattva-knowledge concerning liberation.

Atma-vidya-knowledge of Kr□Q.a.

Avatara-(lit., one who descends) an incarnation 'Of God.

Ave.sa-an incarnation of Godhead partially empowered.

Avidya-nescience.

A_yodh ya-loka-the V aikuQ.tha planet of Lord Ramacandra.

1035

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B

Bala-spiritual strength.

Bhagavata-in relation with the Personality of Godhead.

Bhiigavata-sangi-one who is always in Kr\$Qa's association.

Bhakta-vatsala-Kl;□l}a, lover of His devotee.

Bhakti-activities of the purified senses.

Bhakti-vediintas-pure devotees who are followers of Vedanta.

Bhakti-yoga-direct attachment to Kr\$Qa.

Bhava-the stage of transcendental ecstasy experienced after transcendental affection.

Bhayiinaka-the rasa of ghastliness.

Bhogf-a person who engages only in sense gratification.

Bhiitanatha-Siva, lord of the common people.

Brahmii-the first created being of a universe.

Brahma-bandhu-unqualified once-born sons of briihmaras.

Brahma-bhilita-self-satisfaction.

Brahmacarya-student life of celibacy and study of siistras under a spiritual master.

Brahman-the Absolute Truth.

Briihmarza-a person in the mode of goodness.

Brahma-sampradaya-the disciplic succession descending from Lord Brahma.

Brahmiistra-a nuclear weapon released by chanting certain hymns.

Brahma-sukham-absolute happiness.

Carzpiila-dog-eater.

Candratoka-the moon.

c

Carude□pa-a son of Kr□J}a and Rukmipi.

Cintiimarzi-dhiima-the abode of the Lord, Kr□J}aloka.

Diisya-the rasa of servitorship.

Dayii-the rasa of mercy.

D

Deva-a demigod or godly person.

Devaki-the mother of Lord Kr□J}a.

Devaki-nandana-l<f□J}a, the joy of Devaki.

Devata-a person obedient to the service of the Lord.

Glossary 1037

Dharma-the capacity to render service, which is the essential quality of a living being.

Dharmasya-glapifi.-misuse of human energy.

Dhenukasura-,a demon killed by Lord Baladeva.

Dhira-one who is undisturbed by the material energy.

Dhr□tadyumna-the son of Maharaja Drupada and brother of Draupadi.

Dhftara□tra-the father of the Kurus and brother of Vidura.

Draupadi-daughter of King Drupada and wife of the Pap□avas.

Dropiiciirya-the military teacher of Arjuna and commander-in-chief of the Kurus in the Battle of Kur□etra.

Durgii-sakti-the material energy.

Duryodhana-chief of the evil-minded sons of Dhrtarastra.

Dvīrakī-a fortified city built by Kṛlīla within the sea.

Dvīrapa-yuga-the third age of the cycle of a maha-yuga.

Dvija- twice-horn.

E

EkadaruJi-svami-an impersonalist in the renounced order.

G

Gandharvas-the celestial singers of the heavenly planets.

Ganges-the sacred river which runs throughout the entire universe.

Garbhadhana-samskīra-the seed-giving reformatory process.

Garbha-sthuti-hymns glorifying Garbhodakasayi Viṣṇu.

Garbhodakasayi Viṣṇu-the Viṣṇu expansion who enters each universe to create diversity.

Gayī-Lord Buddha's birthplace.

Goloka-a name of the planet of Kṛṇḍa.

Gosvīmī-master of the senses.

Govinda-a name of Kṛṇḍa, "one who gives pleasure to the land, the cows, and the senses."

Grhastha-the householder stage of life.

Grtsamada-the scholar entrusted by Vyāsadeva with the ṛg-veda.

H

Hīsyā-the rasa of comedy.

Hirapmayena-patrapa-the veil of impersonal Brahman which covers the personal feature of the Absolute.

Hirapyakasipu-a great atheist killed by Lord Nṛsimhadeva.

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Hṛtīdhīni-the potency of the Supreme Personality of Godhead for spiritual bliss.

Hṛṇḍīkesa-a name of Kṛṇḍa, "master of all senses."

I

Indra-the King of the heavenly planets.

Indraloka-the planet where Lord Indra resides.

Isvara-controller.

Itihasas- Vedic histories.

J

Jagannatha Misra-the father of Lord Caitanya.

Jaimini-the scholar entrusted by Vyasadeva with the Siima-veda.

Jamadagni-the father of Lord Parasurama.

Jatakiima-a purificatory process at birth.

Jitendriyii-one who has full control over his senses.

Jiva-the soul or atomic living entity.

Jivanmukta-a liberated person.

Jniina-transcendental knowledge.

Jniina-yoga-the empirical process of linking with the Supreme.

Jniini--one engaged in the cultivation of knowledge.

K

Kala-eternal time.

Kali-yuga-the age in which quarrel is a common affair.

Kalki-an incarnation of the Lord who appears at the end of Kali-yuga.

Kalpa-millennium or material manifestation during the day of Brahma.

Kiima-Iust and desire.

Kamadeva-Cupid.

Kamsa-Krgta's uncle, who was always trying to kill Him.

Kartada-author of Vaiseika philosophy.

Kanathiidhi/iiri- third- grade devotee.

Karartodakasayi Viartu-the Viartu expansion from whom all the material universes emanate.

Karatiilas-hand cymbals used by devotees.

Karca-authorized recorded notes.

Karma-material activities subject to reaction.

Kazi-a Muslim magistrate.

Kirtana-ehanting of the glories of Krta.

Krpaearya-Maharaja Parikjit's spiritual master.

Krpi-the mother of Asvatthama.

Kṛā-hathii-narrations spoken by or about Kṛṣṇa.

Glossary

Kātriya-the martial caste, which is in the mode of passion.

Kātra-bandhavas-unworthy sons of the royal order.

Kīrodakasayi Viṣṇu-the Supersoul.

Kuntī-the mother of Arjuna and aunt of Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Kuvera-the treasurer of the demigods.

L

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Lakṣmī-the goddess of fortune, eternal consort of the Supreme Personality of Godhead, Nārāyaṇa.

Lakṣmīpriyā-the first wife of Lord Caitanya.

Lanka-the kingdom of the demon Ravana.

Līlā-transcendental pastimes of the Lord.

M

Madana-Mohana-Kṛṣṇa, who attracts the mind of Cupid.

Madhurya-conjugal love of God.

Madhusīdana-Kṛṣṇa. killer of the Madhu demon.

Madhyaloka- the middle planets in the universe.

Madhyam-adhikāri-second-grade devotee.

Mahābhārata-epic poem written by Vyāsadeva.

Mahāmantra-the great chant for deliverance, the Hare Kṛṣṇa mantra.

Mahāpauruṣikas-the inhabitants of the Vaiṣṇava planets.

Mahatmī-a devotee of the Lord constantly engaged in His service.

Mahat-tattva-the total material energy.

Mahān-Corā- Kṛṣṇa, the butter thief.

Manasa-putras-the mental sons of Brahma.

Mantras-transcendental sound or Vedic hymns.

Manu-the father of mankind.

Manu-saṁhitā-the lawbook for mankind.

Mayapura-the birthplace of Lord Caitanya.

Mayavāda-the system of philosophy propounded by the impersonalists.

Mrdahga-a particular type of drum specially made in Bengal.

Mukti-recovery from material existence and reinstatement in one's original form.

Muktipada-Lord Viṣṇu, whose lotus feet are worshiped by the liberated souls.

Mukunda-Kṛṣṇa, giver of liberation.

Muni-a sage or self-realized soul.

N

Nagas-celestial serpents.

Nakula-one of Arjuna's younger brothers.

1040 Srimad-Bhigavatam

Nanda Maharaja-Lord Kṛṣṇa's foster father.

Narayatta-the four-handed expansion of the Supreme Lord Kṛṣṇa.

Niiriyā[la-pariīyā[la-a self-surrendered devotee of Kṛṣṇa.

Niiriyā[la-smṛti-constant remembrance of Kṛṣṇa.

Narottama-a first-class human being.

Nimai Paṭṭāṅga-a name of Lord Caitanya before His acceptance of the renounced order.

Nirodha[la-cessation of material existence.

Nitya-baddha-eternally conditioned souls.

Nivṛttas-liberated souls.

Nivṛtti-miirga-the path of renunciation.

Nṛsimha-half-man, half-lion incarnation of Kṛṣṇa.

p

Para-transcendental superiority.

Param brahma-the Supreme Brahman, the Personality of Godhead.

Paramatma-the Supersoul, or localized aspect of the Lord.

Paramparī-disciplic succession.

Param satyam-the Supreme Truth.

Parī-prakṛti-the superior potency of the Lord.

Paravyoma-the kingdom of God.

Pāṣaṇḍī-an offender to the Lord.

Patala-the lowest planetary system within the universe.

Pataijali-the author of the Yoga-sutras.

Phalguni Piirpima-the full moon night in the month of Phalguni (Feb.-March).

Pitrloka-the planet of the departed forefathers.

Prabhupiiida-a representative of the lotus feet of the Lord.

Prakṛta-sahajiyii-pseudo-devotees of Kṛṣṇa.

Prakṛti-energy or nature.

Prasīdam-mercy; divine remnants of foodstuffs offered to the Deity.

Pravṛtti-miirga-the path of sense enjoyment.

Premii-spontaneous attraction of love.

Purii[las-supplements of the Vedas.

Puruṣa-an incarnation of Godhead for material manifestation.

R

Rijarṣi-a great saint ruling as king.

Rasa-a spiritual relationship through spiritual sense perception.

Ratha-yītrii-a car festival in which the J agannatha Deity is paraded.

Raudra-the rasa of ane:er.

Glossary

Ravapa-a powerful atheist killed by Lord Ramacandra.

Rohipi-the mother of Baladeva.

Rilpa Gosvami-chief of the six Gosvamis of Vrndavana.

s

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Sac-cid..ananda vigraha-the eternal form of the Lord, full of bliss and knowledge.

Sacidevi-the mother of Lord Caitanya.

Siidhu-great sage.

Siikhya-the rasa of fraternity.

- Samiidhi-trance, or absorption in the service of the Lord.

Samba-a son of Kṛṣṇa and Jambavati.

Sarit.skiiras-purificatory processes.

Samvit-the knowledge potency of the Lord.
Saniitana-dharrna-man's eternal engagement.
Sandhini-the eternal existence potency of the Lord.
Sandipani Muni-teacher of Kṛṣṇa and Baladeva.
Sannyiisa-the renounced order of life for spiritual culture.
Santa-the rasa of neutrality.
Siistras-revealed scriptures or Vedic literatures.
Sattva-the material mode of goodness.
Siitvatas-eternal devotees of the Lord.
Satyaloka-the topmost planetary system within the universe.
Satya-yuga-the first of the four ages of a rnahii-yuga.
Siiyujya-impersonal liberation.
Sikṣatam-the eight slokas of Lord Caitanya.
Simanta-nayanam-a sarit.skiira performed during pregnancy.
Siva-the predominating deity of the mode of ignorance.
Soma-rasa-a beverage drunk by demigods.
Sravarta- hearing.
S.nigiira-the rasa of conjugal love.
Spi.gi-the briihna[la boy who cursed Maharaja Parikṣit.
Sruti-direct Vedic injunctions.
Sudarsana-cakra-the wheel weapon used by Kṛṣṇa.
Suddha-sattva-the purified state of the soul freed from matter.
Sudras-persons in the mode of ignorance, the laborer class.
Surabhi-the cows herded by Govinda.
Surasena-the father of Vasudeva and grandfather of Lord Kṛṣṇa.
Suryaloka-the sun.
Svargaloka-the heavenly planets.
Svarupa-original spiritual form.
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Svariipa Damodara Gosvami-Lord Caitanya's private secretary.
Svayamvara-a ceremony in which a girl selects a husband.
Syiimasundara-a name for the original form of Kṛṣṇa.

T

Tamas-darkness or ignorance of the undeveloped mind.

Tamo-gupa-the ignorant mode of nature.

Tapasya-voluntary acceptance of some material trouble for progress in spiritual life.

Tiiriika-Briihman-transcendence that delivers the soul.

Tatasthii-\$akti-the marginal potency of the Lord.

Tirtha-holy place, or a saint able to deliver fallen souls.

Treta-yuga-the second age in the cycle of a mahii-yuga.

Tridap{li gosviimi-a devotee of the Lord who is in the renounced order of life.

u

Upani]ads-the philosophical portions of the Vedas. They are 108 m number.

Urukrama-the Supreme Lord, whose activities are glorious.

Uttama-adhikari-an advanced devotee of the Lord.

v

Vaikm;ttha-the spiritual world, where there is no anxiety.

Vai□\}avas-devotees of the Lord.

Vaiiya-the mercantile caste, who are in the modes of passion and ignorance.

Varpas-castes or sections of society in terms of qualification and occupation.

Varpa-sankara-unwanted children.

Vasudeva-the father of Lord Kr□\la.

Vasudeva-Lord Kr□\la, the son of Vasudeva.

Vatsalya-the rasa of parenthood.

Vibhatsa-the rosa of shock.

VibhiUi-specific power deputed to a living being.

Vipras-graduates of Vedic knowledge.

Vim-the rasa of chivalry.

V□pu-jana-devotees of the Lord.

V□pu-miiyti-sense enjoyment.

Viṣṇu-lupriya Devi-the second wife of Lord Caitanya. .

Glosury

Viśvambhār-ur-one who is always protected by Viṣṇu.

Viṣṇu-tattva-the status of Godhead.

Viśva-dharma-universal religion.

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Vṛndavana-the village where Kṛṣṇa lived as a child; the topmost transcendental abode of the Supreme Lord.

Vyāsāsana-the seat of Sri Vyāsadeva or his genuine representative.

y

Yajña-sacrifice.

Yajñeśvara-the Supreme Lord, who is the beneficiary of all sacrifices.

Yamarāja-the demigod who punishes sinful living entities after death.

Yasoda-Lord Kṛṣṇa's foster mother.

Yasoda-nandana-the child of Yasoda, Kṛṣṇa.

Yoga-that which links with the Supreme.

Yoga.nidra-mystic slumber.

Yogesvara.._the master of all mystic powers, the Supreme Lord, Kṛṣṇa.

Yudhiṣṭhira-the eldest of the five Pāṇḍava brothers.

Yuga>--one of the four ages of the universe.

Sanskrit Pronunciation Guide

Vowels

(i u r stlr

Q: ai an o al) au

∴ ril (anusvīra) : 1;t (visarga)

Consonants

Gutturals: Cfi ka kha ilga gha ria

Palatals: ca cha ja "jha 5{ ria

Cerebrals: eta ?;tha :g a a tJT I}a

Dentals: a ta tJ tha da dha ;::rna

Labials: q pa q)pha i(ba l{bha rna

Semivowels: Cf ya { ra Ia q va

Sibilants: □Sa E(p □sa

Aspirate: □ ha S = • (avagraha)- the apostrophe

the vowels above should be pronounced as follows:

a - like the a in organ or the u. in but

ā - like the ii in far but held twice as long as a.

i - like the i in pin.

I - like the i in pique but held twice as long as i.

u - like the u in push.

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u - like the u in rule but held twice as long as u.

r - like the ri in Rita (but more like French ru).

r - same as ri but held twice as long.

\ - like lree (lruu).

e - like the e in they.

ai - like the ai in aisle.

o - like the o in go.

au- like the ow in how.

ril (anusviira) - a resonant nasal like the n in the French word bon.

tt (visarga) - a final h-sound: atJ is pronounced like aha; iQ like ihi.

The consonants are pronounced as follows:

k - as in kite kh- as in Eckhart

g - as in mgtve gh- as in dig-hard

ri - as in sing c - as in chair

ch - as in staunch-heart j - as in joy

jh - as in hedgehog ii - as in canyon

t - as in tub th - as in light-heart

Q - as in rna (prepare to say «;;ha- as in red-hot

the r and say na). I) - as in dove

Cerebrals are pronounced with tongue to roof of mouth, but the following

dentals are pronounced with tongue against teeth:

t - as in tub but with tongue against teeth.

th - as in light-heart but tongue against teeth.

d - as in dove but tongue against teeth.

dh- as in red-hot but with tongue against teeth.

n - as in nut but with tongue in between teeth.

p - as in pome ph- as in up-hill (not f)

b - as in bird bh- as in rub-hard

m - as in mother

r - as in run

y - as in yes

l - as in light

v - as in vine. s - as in sun

ṣ (palatal) - as in the s in the German word sprechen

ś (cerebral) - as the sh in shine

h - as in home

There is no strong accentuation of syllables in Sanskrit, only a flowing of short and long (twice as long as the short) syllables.

Index of Sanskrit Verses

This index constitutes a complete listing of the first and third lines of each of the Sanskrit verses of the

First Canto of the *Śrīmad-Bhagavatam*, arranged in English alphabetical order. In the first column the Sanskrit

transliteration is given, and in the second and third columns respectively the chapter-verse references and

page number for each verse are to be found.

A

abbhakā upasantatmii

iibhātainan abhinandya yuktiin

abhidravati mīm iśa

abhimanyu-sutam sii.ta

abhisangamya vidhivat

abhii.ta-pii.rvaḥ sahasa

abhyacāfitfinuriigisraiḥ

abhyarthitas tādii tasmai

abibhrad-aryamii daḥlam

abrohma(lyii nrpa-vyiija{l
adan me jiianam aiSvaryam
adharmiimsais trayo bhagna{l
adhijahur mudarit rojiiafl
adhikramanty anghribhir iihrtam
adhovadanam abbindii.n
adhvany urukrama-parigraham
adhyagiin mahad iikhyiinam
adrfitasruta-vastutviit
adyaiva rojyarit balam rddha-kosam
agnir nisrflto dattas ca
agrecaro mama vibho ratha
agre gunebhyo jagad-atmaniSvare
ahaituky aprotihata
aharit cadhyagamarit tatro
aharit ca tad-brahma-kule·
aham ca tasmai mahatarit mahiyase
aharit hi pnto 'ryama(lo bhavadbhifl
aharit purotitabhava 'bhavam mune
aha raja dharma-sutaft
aha□ye siras tasya
aharta4o 'svamedhlinam

13.53

19.22

8.10

4.9

13.5

18.29

9.11

17.38

13.15

17.27

5.39

17.24

12.6

14.38

14.23

15.20

7.11

3.32

19.3

13.24

15.15

10.21

2.6

3.44

6.8

6.25

18.23

5.23

8.47

7.38

12.25

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First Canto

<Part Tllree- Chapters 13-19>

with the original Sanskrit text, its Roman tran
literation, word-for-word synonyms, translation
and elaborate purports by

His DMne Grace

A.C. Bhaktivedanta swami Prabhupada

Founder-Acarya of the International Society

for Krishna Consciousness

446pages

12 color illustrations

EXPLANATION OF THE COVER

1. The original spiritual planet, which resembles the whorl of a huge lotus flower, is called Goloka Vrndavana. It is the abode of Lord Kf□l)a, the original Personality of Godhead.
2. This original planet Goloka throws off a spiritual ray of effulgence called brahmajyoti which is the ultimate goal of the impersonalists.
3. Within this unlimited brahmajyoti there are unlimited numbers of spiritual planets, as there are innumerable material planets within the sun rays of the material universes. These spiritual planets are dominated by plenary expansions of Lord Kf□l)a, and the inhabitants there are ever liberated living beings. They are all four-handed. The Lord is known there as Naraya) a, and the planets are known as Vaikufi!has.
4. Sometimes a spiritual cloud overtakes a corner of the spiritual sky of brahmajyoti, and the covered portion is called the mahat-tattva. The Lord then, by His portion as Maha-Vi□fiu, lies down in the water within the mahat tattva. The water is called the Causal Ocean (kiiraf}a-jala).
5. As He sleeps within the Causal Ocean, innumerable universes are generated with His breathing. These floating

universes are scattered all over the Causal Ocean. They stay during a breath of Maha-Viṣṇu.

6. In each and every universal globe the same Maha-Viṣṇu enters again as Garbhodakasayi Viṣṇu and lies there on the Garbha Ocean on the serpentine Śeṣa incarnation. From His navel-abdomen sprouts a lotus stem, and on the lotus, Brahma, the lord of the universe, is born. Brahma creates all living beings of different shapes in terms of desire within the universe. He also creates the sun, moon and other demi gods.

(continued on back flap)

7. The sun is situated almost in the center of each and every universe, and it distributes profuse light and heat all over the universe. There are millions and billions of suns in all the millions and billions of universes within the mahat tattva. The suns and moons are required within the universes because they are dark by nature. The Vedas instruct us to go out of the dark universes and reach the glowing effulgence, the brahmajyoti.

8. The brahmajyoti is due to the illuminating Vaikuṇṭha planets, which need no sun or moon or power of electricity. Śrīmad-Bhagavatam helps us reach the supreme planet, Goloka Vrndavana. The door is open for everyone. Human life is meant for this particular aim, for it is the highest perfection.

His Divine Grace A. C. Bhaktivedanta Swami Prabhupāda first met his spiritual master, Śrīla Bhaktisiddhanta Sarasvati Gosvami Maharaja, in Calcutta in 1922. Śrīla Bhaktisiddhanta liked this educated young man and injected in him the idea of preaching the message of Śrīmad-Bhagavatam all over the world. At Allahabad in 1933 Śrīla Prabhupada became his formally initiated disciple, and in 1937, just days before

Srila Bhaktisiddhanta's departure from this mortal world, he was specifically ordered to spread Kṛtā consciousness in the English language. Thus in 1944 Srila Prabhupada started Back to Godhead magazine, which is now circulated in six different languages throughout the world, and he also published, in English, the first three volumes of his Srimad-Bhagavatam.

In 1965, at the advanced age of 70, His Divine Grace sailed to the United States to fulfill his master's sacred mission, bringing with him only seven dollars, some books and a pair of hand cymbals. Shortly afterwards he began classes on Bhagavad-gītā in a small storefront in New York City. Now, only six years later, Srila Prabhupada's International Society for Krishna Consciousness, with more than seventy centers in major cities throughout the world, has become an important institution of spiritual knowledge and culture, and Srila Prabhupada's authoritative translations, commentaries and summary studies of Vedic literature have become standard textbooks of transcendental science.